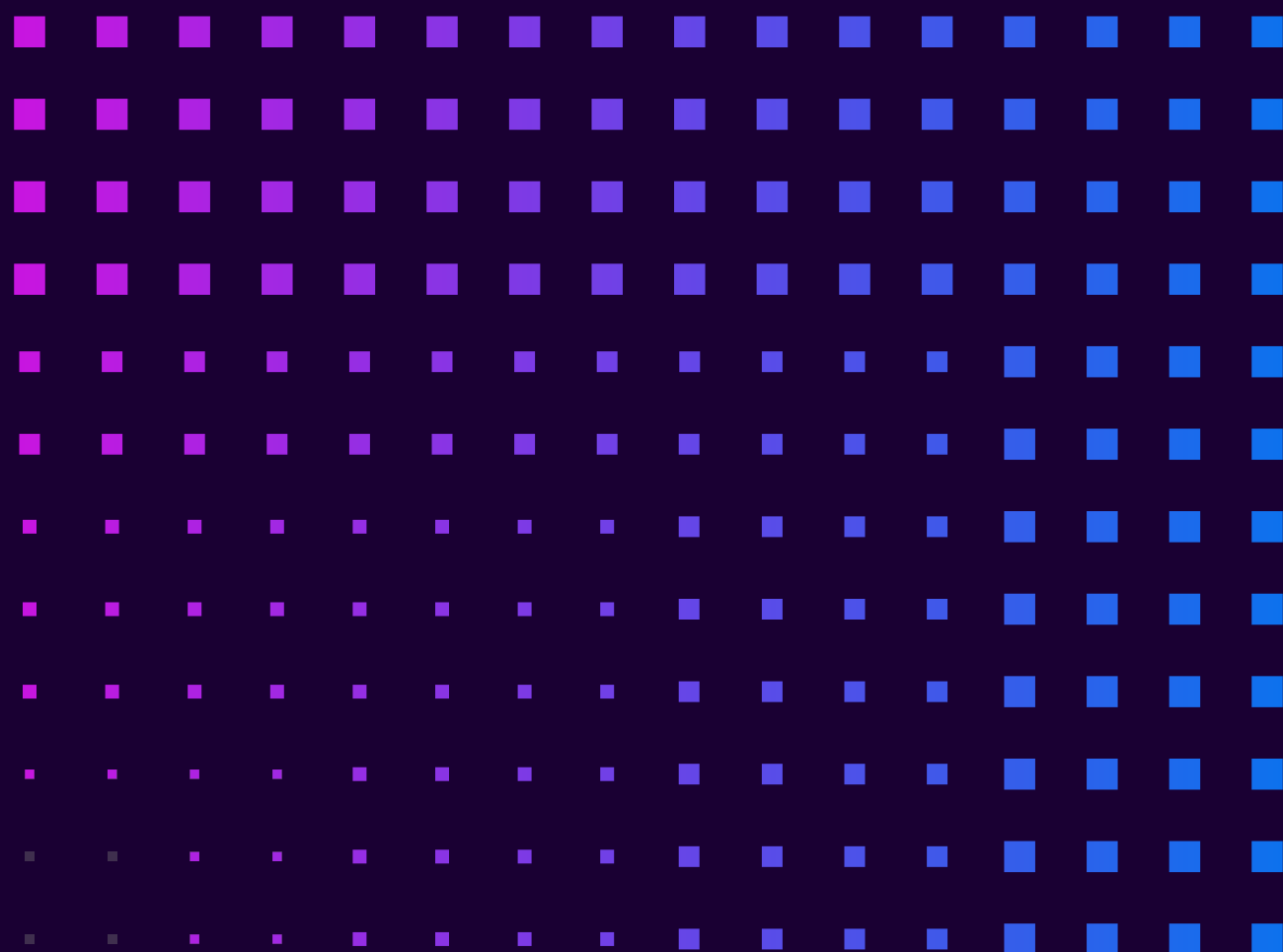




2025

Annual report

Key financial figures at a glance

Consolidated income statement

		2025	2024
Sales	EUR m	15,171.5	16,237.4
Operating gross profit	EUR m	3,831.7	4,025.4
Operating EBITA	EUR m	929.3	1,101.9
Operating EBITA / operating gross profit	%	24.3	27.4
Profit after tax	EUR m	269.7	543.7
Basic earnings per share	EUR	1.83	3.71
Diluted earnings per share	EUR	1.83	3.71

Consolidated balance sheet

		31.12.2025	31.12.2024
Total assets	EUR m	10,625.8	11,668.0
Total equity	EUR m	4,348.6	4,762.0
Working capital	EUR m	1,892.6	2,139.3
Net financial liabilities	EUR m	2,527.9	2,793.0

Consolidated cash flow

		2025	2024
Net cash provided by operating activities	EUR m	966.7	906.6
Payments to acquire intangible assets and property, plant and equipment	EUR m	- 293.0	- 342.2
Free cash flow	EUR m	940.8	892.6

Key data on the Brenntag shares

		2025	2024
Share price	EUR	49.56	57.88
Number of shares (unweighted)		144,385,372	144,385,372
Market capitalization	EUR m	7,156	8,357
Free float	%	80.00	85.00

Company Profile

Brenntag is the global market leader in chemical and ingredients distribution. The company plays a central role in connecting the chemical industry's customers and suppliers. Through its two global divisions, Brenntag Essentials and Brenntag Specialties, the company provides a broad and diversified portfolio of industrial and specialty chemicals and ingredients, as well as tailor-made application, marketing and supply chain solutions, technical and formulation support, comprehensive regulatory expertise and digital solutions for a wide range of industries.

Brenntag operates a global network spanning around 600 sites in more than 70 countries. With its workforce of over 17,300 employees, Brenntag generated sales of around EUR 15.2 billion in 2025.

Letter from the CEO



Dear Stakeholder,

As we navigate the longest downturn in the chemical industry in more than 20 years, Brenntag continues to face significant headwinds. Global production overcapacity, subdued industrial activity, and persistent pricing pressure are weighing on demand and margins. At the same time, cost inflation remains across several input factors.

These industry-specific challenges are unfolding against a continued complex macro-political backdrop. Heightened geopolitical tensions, ever-shifting trade policies, supply chain realignments, and regulatory uncertainty are contributing to high volatility in global markets and dampening investment confidence across key regions.

While this environment places considerable strain on chemical producers, Brenntag's position within the value chain remains uniquely resilient. Our distribution model offers flexibility, global diversification, and proximity to customers; capabilities that are not inherent to asset-intensive manufacturing models. This structural advantage enables us to adapt quickly to regional shifts in supply and demand dynamics.

To leverage this position, we are taking decisive action. Over the past months, we have removed a management layer, strengthened key roles within the new Executive Committee, and streamlined corporate overhead functions and group guidelines to increase agility and cost discipline and bring the company leadership closer to the market.

These measures reinforce our ability to navigate the current cycle with focus and resilience, while positioning Brenntag to capture growth opportunities as markets stabilize and recover.

2025 financial performance

The financial results for 2025 reflect the weak end-market demand and the macroeconomic headwinds our businesses faced throughout the year. Group sales amounted to EUR 15.2 billion (-3.7%), while operating gross profit reached EUR 3.8 billion, down 1.9%. The operating gross profit margin improved by 0.5 percentage points to 25.3%. Group operating EBITDA totaled EUR 1.29 billion (-8.6%), and operating EBITA came in at EUR 929 million (-12.6%).

Despite this challenging environment, our solid free cash flow of EUR 941 million (+5.4%) underscores our strong cash generation capabilities. Importantly, our sales teams successfully preserved gross margins across both divisions, despite ongoing pricing pressure and subdued demand throughout 2025.

The reported earnings per share were EUR 1.83 down from EUR 3.71 in the previous year, strongly impacted by non-cash impairments and other special items.

Dividend proposal

Despite the challenging market environment and the impact of one-time impairments and other special items, our consistently strong cash flow enables us to remain a reliable dividend payer.

The Board of Management and Supervisory Board therefore propose a dividend of EUR 1.90 per share, representing a reduction of approximately 10% compared to the previous year. This proposal reflects our balanced approach of safeguarding financial stability while maintaining our commitment to delivering attractive and sustainable returns to our shareholders.

Cost reduction

We are simplifying and streamlining our organizational structure and administrative processes, eliminating duplicate structures and structural overlaps. Our cost-out program is progressing as planned. In 2025, we delivered a further EUR 115 million in gross run-rate cost savings compared to the 2024 level.

Strengthening our footprint

Despite ongoing market headwinds, we continued to invest strategically in our footprint and portfolio, with transactions signed or closed totaling EUR 260 million in 2025. The two principal acquisitions – Chem Tech in the United States and Airedale in the UK – further strengthened our Essentials and Specialties offerings in core markets.

Safety is key

For our business, “Safety First” is a fundamental value. We recognize the inherent risks of our industry and meet them with a commitment to zero harm. This commitment encompasses the health and safety of our employees as well as product safety and the protection of the environment. Our efforts to lead the industry in responsible business practices were recognized externally this year, with Brenntag winning the German Sustainability Award in two categories.

Our key priorities

We are conducting a strategic review to develop the most competitive and scalable global distribution supply chain and to enable sustainable growth. We will present the outcome of this review, together with our updated Group strategy, in the second half of 2026.

At this stage, our immediate priorities are clear:

1. Sales

We have ruled out a separation of the company and are shifting our focus decisively outward. We are empowering local sales teams in both divisions to drive not only volume growth but also sales quality and customer service excellence. Proximity to the market remains the primary engine of our future growth.

2. Clarity and simplification

We are simplifying our structures to build a leaner and more agile organization. This includes reducing bureaucracy, accelerating decision-making, and strengthening accountability through empowered teams and clearer ownership.

The newly established Brenntag Executive Committee reinforces execution discipline and ensures a strong commercial and growth focus. We have already implemented many of the key structural measures required to support this shift.

With respect to our operating model, we remain fully committed to Brenntag Specialties and Brenntag Essentials as the two core divisions of the Group. They will continue to operate with distinct market approaches, supported by a shared backbone and aligned under one Group strategy and one corporate brand.

3. Execution

To enhance efficiency and align our cost base with current market realities, we are rigorously executing our cost-out program and driving operational improvements. Focused execution strengthens agility and enables us to reinvest in growth, reinforce resilience, and deliver sustainable value creation.

Moving into 2026

While we see some positive signs in certain markets, particularly pharma and the energy sector, the global economic environment remains subdued and, in aggregate, the current market outlook is flat at best. Geopolitical tensions and broader uncertainty across many regions continue to weigh on sentiment.

In this environment, we will remain close to our customers, suppliers, and business partners to ensure we respond to market developments in an informed and decisive manner. We will leverage our global presence, domain expertise, and resilient business model to navigate ongoing volatility.

We are using this phase of market softness to strengthen our structural foundations and position the Group for the next upcycle. Furthermore, we observe that the present market environment creates a favorable backdrop for strategic and bolt-on acquisitions to expand our footprint.

In closing, my sincere thanks go to our colleagues across the Brenntag organization for their unwavering commitment during a challenging year, and to our shareholders and partners for their continued trust and support.

Sincerely,

A handwritten signature in black ink, appearing to read 'Jens Birgersson', with a long horizontal stroke extending to the right.

Jens Birgersson

Chief Executive Officer and Chairman of the Board of Management
Brenntag SE

1 To our Shareholders

10	Brenntag on the Stock Market
18	Report of the Supervisory Board

Brenntag on the Stock Market

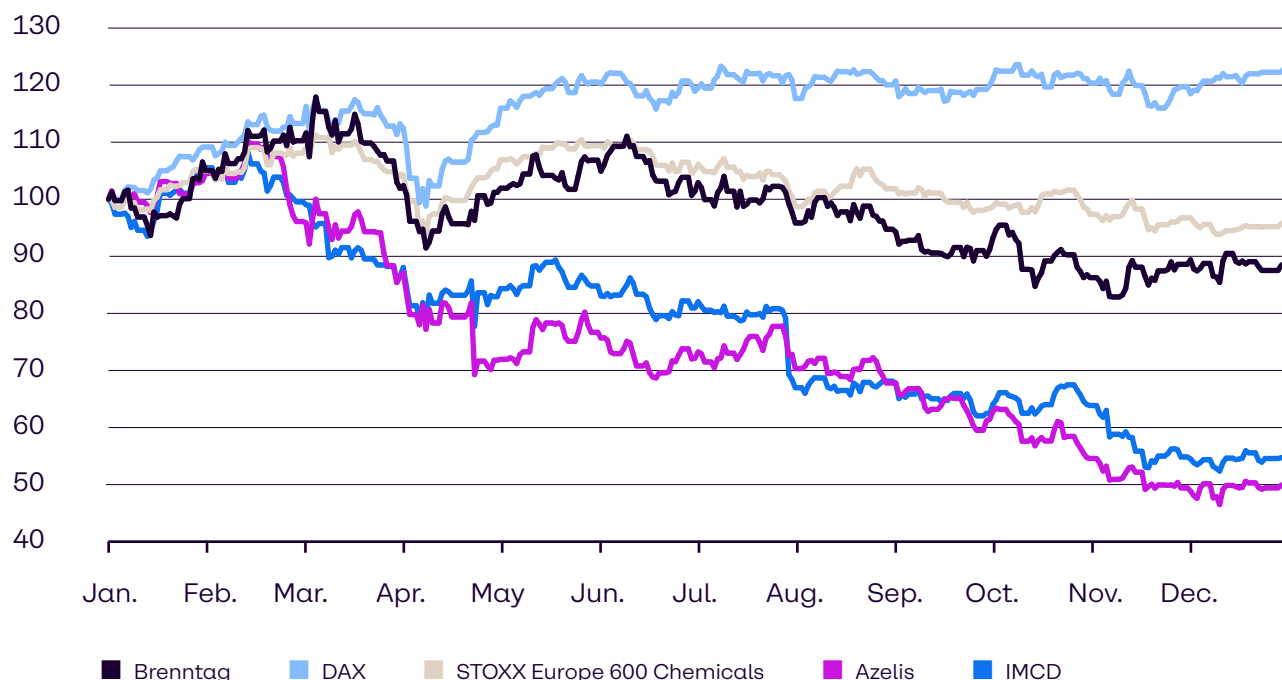
In 2025, Brenntag SE once again operated in a global market environment that remained challenging. Geopolitical tensions, an increasingly fragmented trading landscape and U.S. trade policy actions led to elevated uncertainty in international trade and curbed investment. Higher U.S. tariffs, a stronger euro and increasing trade conflicts clouded the economic outlook, particularly in Europe and Asia. Progressively normalizing inflation had a positive impact, as did the gradual easing of central banks' monetary policy, although interest rates remained restrictive overall. This supported consumer spending to some extent. Nevertheless, global economic growth remained subdued overall.

Economic performance varied from region to region again. In the U.S., the economy proved to be relatively robust despite protectionist measures, but lost momentum during the course of the year in the face of high financing terms and political uncertainty. The European Economic Area continued to be marked by structural challenges, weak external demand and trade tensions, which impacted negatively on international competitiveness. Several Asian economies posted a stable performance and remained the most important global growth drivers in 2025, while China continued to suffer as a result of systemic challenges and weak domestic demand. Latin America painted a mixed picture, with growth subdued overall. On the whole, global economic performance was once again shaped by a mix of growth drivers and headwinds. According to estimates by the International Monetary Fund, the global economy grew by around 3.2% in real terms in 2025, a slightly weaker rate of growth than in the previous year (3.3%).¹⁾

In the same period, global equity markets continued their positive performance. The major central banks gradually loosened their previously restrictive monetary policy in 2025. Both the ECB and the Fed cut key interest rates several times due to falling inflation rates and declining inflation expectations. The ECB reduced the deposit rate to 2.0% and kept it on hold from the middle of the year onwards, while inflation in the euro zone rose slightly from 2.1% to 2.2%. The Fed lowered the target range for the federal funds rate from 4.5% to 4.0% but maintained a restrictive stance overall despite the adjustments. Global equity markets also received a significant boost from the strong earnings performance from U.S. technology firms in the reporting period. Thus, Germany's leading index reached a new all-time high of 24,650 points in July 2025 and ended financial year 2025 up by 23%.

¹⁾ Source: IMF (International Monetary Fund) World Economic Outlook Update January 2026.

Brenntag share price performance



1.01 Brenntag share price performance in financial year 2025¹⁾ (indexed)

¹⁾ Total return incl. reinvestment of dividends.

Brenntag shares fell by around 14% (around 11% including dividend payments) in financial year 2025. There was a similar performance from the sector index, the STOXX Europe 600 Chemicals, and the shares of our listed specialty competitors, which were also impacted by falling share prices. In this challenging environment, Brenntag shares were able to hold their own against the listed specialty competitors. In contrast, Germany's leading index, the DAX, showed a clearly positive performance and ended the year on a gain.

The Brenntag shares' downward trajectory reflected the difficult market situation in the chemicals industry and Brenntag SE's operating performance.

Following a moderate performance in the first half of the year, Brenntag lowered its annual forecast for operating EBITA from an original guidance range of EUR 1.1 billion to EUR 1.3 billion to a range of EUR 950 million to EUR 1,050 million. When publishing the results for the third quarter of 2025, Brenntag guided toward the lower end of this range. These adjustments were due to falling quarterly earnings in the context of a persistently challenging market environment with fierce competition, ongoing price pressures, caution and uncertainty on the part of customers, and unfavorable exchange rate movements.

Brenntag shares reached their annual high at EUR 68.24 on March 6, 2025 and their annual low at EUR 46.26 on November 11, 2025. Brenntag shares closed the financial year at EUR 49.56.

Reference data on the Brenntag shares

The subscribed capital of Brenntag SE totals EUR 144.4 million. The share capital is divided into 144,385,372 no-par value registered shares, each with a notional value of EUR 1.00.

Since September 2021, Brenntag SE has been listed on the DAX; the stock market flotation was in 2010.

Brenntag shares are also included in major international indices such as selected MSCI indices and the STOXX Europe 600, which tracks the performance of the 600 largest companies from 17 European countries, as well as in various sector indices such as the STOXX Europe 600 Chemicals. In addition, Brenntag shares are included in various sustainability indices such as the DAX 50 ESG and the DAX ESG Target Index.

With a total market capitalization of EUR 7,156 million at the end of 2025, Brenntag shares ranked 40th among all listed companies in Germany, according to the Deutsche Börse AG criteria.

	Dec. 31, 2025	Dec. 31, 2024
Number of shares	144,385,372	144,385,372
WKN	A1DAH H	A1DAH H
ISIN	DE000A1DAH H0	DE000A1DAH H0
Trading symbol	BNR	BNR
Market segments	Regulated Market/ Prime Standard	Regulated Market/ Prime Standard
Trading venues	Xetra and all German regional exchanges	Xetra and all German regional exchanges
Selected indices	DAX, MSCI, STOXX Europe 600, STOXX Europe 600 chemicals, DAX 50 ESG, DAX ESG Target Index, STOXX Europe 600 ESG, MSCI Europe ESG Leaders	

1.02 Key data on the shares

Brenntag in dialog with the capital market

Brenntag SE's Investor Relations activities aim to deliver a fair and transparent communication policy that provides equal treatment to all stakeholders. This is intended to increase awareness of the company as an attractive investment and further develop Brenntag's standing on the capital market. The company's business performance and strategy are communicated continuously, promptly and reliably. This is intended to further strengthen investors' confidence in Brenntag and help to ensure that our shares are adequately valued on the capital market.

In 2025, Brenntag again attached significant importance to personal contact with capital market participants. The Board of Management and the Investor Relations team were in constant dialog with investors and analysts worldwide. In total, the Investor Relations team held over 1,000 meetings with investors. The company's performance was discussed in detail in the course of one-on-one meetings, various international roadshows and twelve investor conferences, which took place both virtually and in person, as well as at the Annual General Meeting.

The Chairman of the Supervisory Board of Brenntag SE held regular meetings with investors. Topics included the personnel changes on the Board of Management of Brenntag SE and corporate governance matters.

The results of external ratings underscore the importance attached to corporate governance at Brenntag SE. In 2025, as in the year before, the company was ranked first among the DAX companies by the German Association for Financial Analysis and Asset Management (DVFA). In 2022 and 2023, Brenntag had already improved its position in the ranking to third place, which reflects its continuous further development in this important area.

As in the previous year, in addition to the aforementioned activities, Brenntag SE's Investor Relations team expanded its activities in relation to dialog with retail investors and on December 10, 2025 presented itself to interested private shareholders at the Essen forum organized by Deutsche Schutzvereinigung für Wertpapierbesitz e.V. (DSW).

In 2026, we will continue to present the company at numerous roadshows and capital market events.

Shareholder structure

As at February 28, 2026, notification had been received from the following shareholders under Section 33 of the German Securities Trading Act (WpHG) that their share of the voting rights exceeded the 3%, 5%, 10%, 15% or 20% threshold:

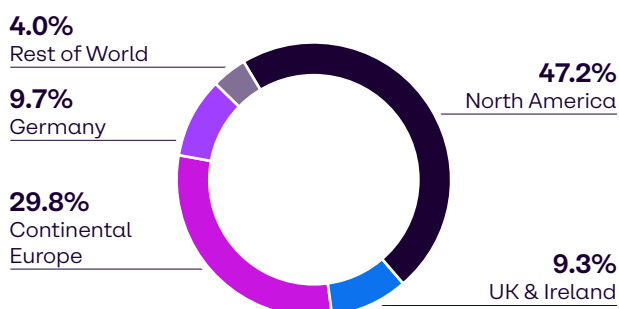
Shareholder	Interest in %	Date of notification
Kühne Holding AG ¹⁾	> 20	Dec. 8, 2025
Artisan Partners Limited Partnership	> 15	Sep. 26, 2025
BlackRock, Inc.	> 5	July 17, 2024
Flossbach von Storch AG	> 5	June 1, 2023
Wellington Management Group	> 5	Feb. 2, 2026
Harris Associates L.P.	> 3	Feb. 13, 2026

1.03 Shareholder structure

¹⁾ Details of person subject to the notification obligation: Klaus-Michael Kühne.

All voting rights notifications are published on the company's website at [Voting Rights Notifications | Brenntag](#).

As at December 31, 2025, 80% of Brenntag's shares were in free float as defined by Deutsche Börse (STOXX). Of those, over 97% are held by institutional investors and organizations.



1.04 Shareholdings of institutional investors by region¹⁾

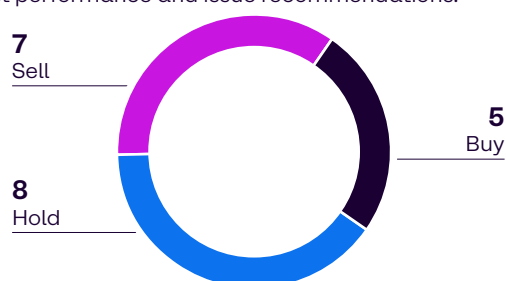
¹⁾ Data collected as at December 2025; Source: Nasdaq.

Directors' dealings

In financial year 2025, seven transactions were reported in directors' dealings notifications (managers' transactions). These can be viewed at any time on the Brenntag website at <https://corporate.brenntag.com/en/investor-relations/brenntag-share/managers-transactions/>.

Analysts' opinions

Brenntag is continuously monitored and rated by a large number of international financial analysts. Currently, 20 banks regularly publish research reports on our company's latest performance and issue recommendations.



1.05 Analysts' opinions as at Feb. 28, 2026

Five analysts have a buy recommendation, eight have a hold recommendation and seven have a sell recommendation on the Brenntag shares. The weaker operating performance, particularly in the specialty chemicals business, and the negative impacts of a difficult market environment and unfavorable exchange rates caused several banks to revise down their estimates. Over the short term, the experts see the shares under pressure, as the trend in demand remains weak across the chemical market and margins are under competitive pressure. Over the medium term, the success of the ongoing cost-reduction measures and the future strategic direction of the new Board of Management are regarded as key levers for achieving a potential improvement in competitiveness. Over the long term, analysts consider Brenntag to be a company with solid cash flow generation and stable foundations for growth, despite the current caution. On February 28, 2026, the average price target was EUR 51.90.

Analysts covering Brenntag SE

- Alphavalue
- Bank of America
- Bankhaus Metzler
- Barclays
- Berenberg
- Citigroup
- Deutsche Bank
- DZ Bank
- Exane BNP Paribas
- Goldman Sachs
- Jefferies
- J. P. Morgan
- Kempen
- Kepler Cheuvreux
- LBBW
- Morgan Stanley
- Mwb research
- ODDO
- UBS
- Warburg

Up-to-date information on this can be found on our website at <https://corporate.brenntag.com/en/investor-relations/brenntag-share/analysts-opinions/>.

Creditor relations

Brenntag has an extremely strong, long-term financial profile. We have a capital structure that enables the Group to cover its potential financing requirements, even in a difficult capital market environment. This gives us a high degree of security, independence and financial flexibility. The most important component in the financing structure of Brenntag SE is the Group-wide syndicated loan agreement. In addition, four bonds and a promissory note transaction are currently outstanding.

Brenntag's strong credit profile is reflected in investment grade ratings from the two international rating agencies Standard & Poor's and Moody's.

Since August 2023, Standard & Poor's has assigned Brenntag SE a "BBB+" rating (outlook: negative). Since March 2021, Moody's has assigned Brenntag SE a "Baa2" rating (outlook: stable).

In October 2025, Brenntag issued a new, EUR 600.0 million bond (Bond 2031) maturing in 2031 and carrying an annual coupon of 3.375%. The bond was issued under the existing debt issuance program, met with strong investor interest and was heavily oversubscribed. The following table provides an overview of the key data on the four outstanding bonds.

		Bond 2028	Bond 2029	Bond 2031	Bond 2032
Issuer		Brenntag Finance B.V.	Brenntag Finance B.V.	Brenntag Finance B.V.	Brenntag Finance B.V.
Listing		Luxembourg stock exchange	Luxembourg stock exchange	Luxembourg stock exchange	Luxembourg stock exchange
ISIN		XS2802928775	XS2394063437	XS3193854281	XS2802928692
Aggregate principal amount	EUR m	500	500	600	500
Denomination	EUR	100,000	100,000	100,000	100,000
Minimum transferrable amount	EUR	100,000	100,000	100,000	100,000
Coupon	%	3.750	0.500	3.375	3.875
Interest payment	annual	Apr. 24	Oct. 6	Oct. 2	Apr. 24
Maturity		Apr. 24, 2028	Oct. 6, 2029	Oct. 2, 2031	Apr. 24, 2032

1.06 Key data on the bonds of the Brenntag Group

Annual General Meeting

The virtual Annual General Meeting of Brenntag SE was held in Essen on May 22, 2025. With attendance at around 88%, the shareholders were extensively represented. The Annual General Meeting approved all items on the agenda, including the enlargement of the Supervisory Board.

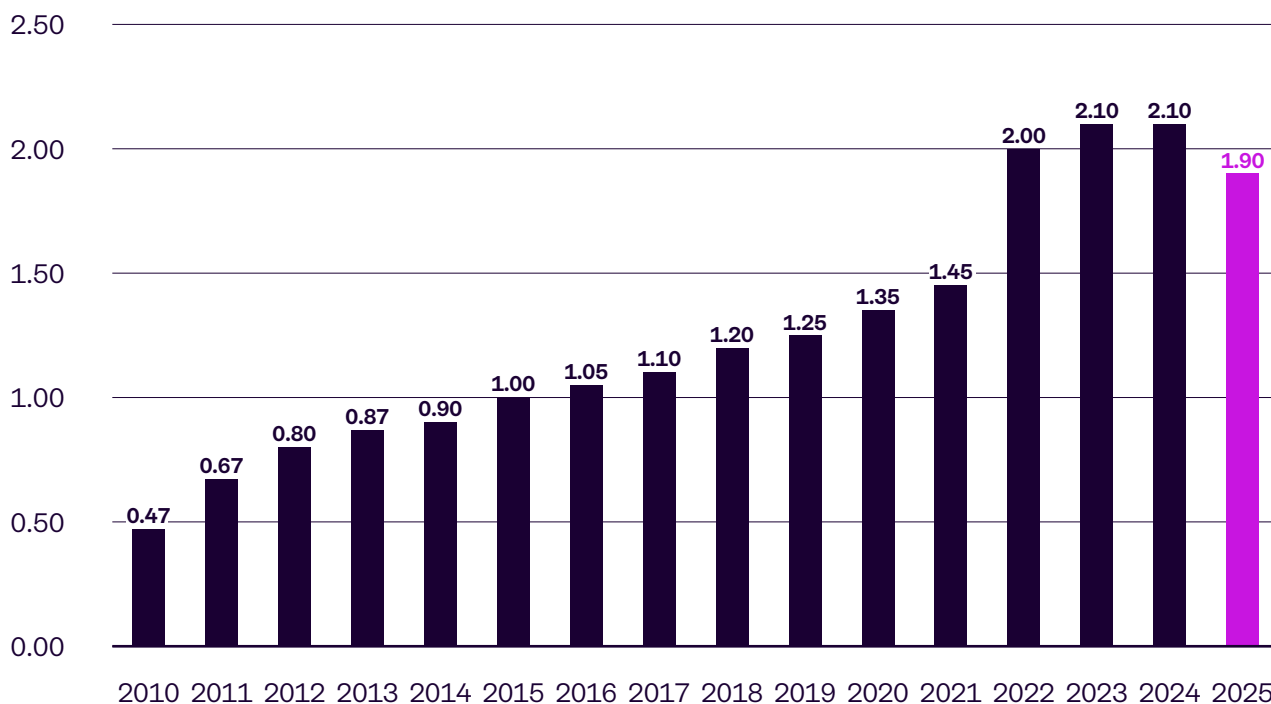
The proposal to pay a dividend of EUR 2.10 per share was also approved, enabling the dividend to be kept at the prior-year level.

Dividend proposal for 2025

Since going public in 2010, Brenntag has continuously paid its shareholders a dividend, increasing them annually through 2023 and then maintaining them at EUR 2.10 per share.

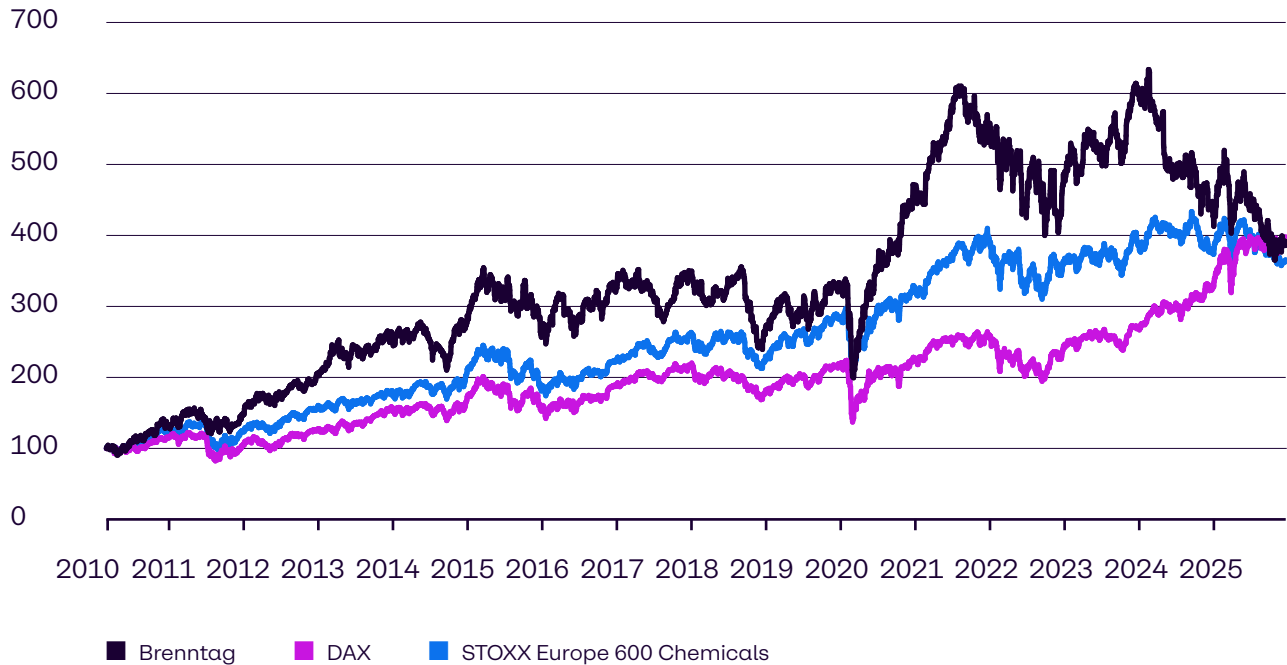
For the 2025 financial year the Board of Management and Supervisory Board will recommend shareholders to the Annual General Meeting on May 20, 2026 a dividend payment of EUR 1.90 per share. The proposal exceeds the dividend policy range and takes into account extraordinary write-off effects in the financial year.

This proposal reflects a balanced approach of safeguarding financial stability while maintaining a clear commitment to delivering attractive and sustainable returns to shareholders.



1.07 Dividend performance in EUR

Historical performance



1.08 Historical performance¹⁾ of Brenntag shares compared with the DAX (Mar. 29, 2010 to Dec. 31, 2025)

¹⁾ Share price performance including dividends

in %	1 year	3 years	5 years	10 years
Brenntag shares ¹⁾	-11.2	-3.0	-2.2	2.8
DAX	23.0	20.7	12.3	8.6
STOXX Europe 600 Chemicals	-4.3	2.0	2.7	5.8

1.09 Annual growth rate of Brenntag shares and relevant benchmark indices in percent

¹⁾ Received dividends reinvested. Due to rounding, the absolute totals may differ.

Service for shareholders

	Dec. 31, 2025	Dec. 31, 2024
No. of shares	144,385,372	144,385,372
Dividend (in EUR)	1.90 ⁷⁾	2.10
Dividend yield (in %) ¹⁾	3.83	3.63
Payout ratio (in %, rounded) ²⁾	> 100.00	57.00
Earnings per share (in EUR) ³⁾	1.83	3.71
Book value per share (in EUR) ⁴⁾	29.80	32.70
XETRA closing price (in EUR)	49.56	57.88
XETRA high (in EUR)	68.24	85.86
XETRA low (in EUR)	46.26	56.50
XETRA average price (in EUR)	55.77	69.35
Average daily trading volumes XETRA and Frankfurt		
Shares	308,291	314,645
EUR	17,197,656	21,853,990
Market capitalization (in EUR m) ⁵⁾	7,156	8,357
Price-earnings ratio ⁶⁾	27.08	15.60

1.10 Key data on the Brenntag shares

¹⁾ Dividend / closing price x 100

²⁾ Dividend taking into account the number of shares as at December 31, 2025 / profit attributable to shareholders of Brenntag SE

³⁾ Profit attributable to shareholders of Brenntag SE / average weighted number of outstanding shares (144.4 million)

⁴⁾ Equity attributable to shareholders of Brenntag SE / number of shares as at December 31, 2025

⁵⁾ Market capitalization at year-end

⁶⁾ Closing price / earnings per share

⁷⁾ As per the proposal for the appropriation of profit presented by the Board of Management and the Supervisory Board, subject to approval at the Annual General Meeting on May 20, 2026

You can find comprehensive information on Brenntag SE and the Brenntag shares on the Investor Relations website. In addition to financial reports, presentations and detailed information on the Annual General Meeting, it also contains all the key dates on the financial calendar. The conference calls on quarterly and annual financial statements are recorded and offered there in audio format. We also share a lot of information on the Brenntag Investor Relations LinkedIn channel. In addition, shareholders and interested parties can register by e-mail to be placed on the investor mailing list and, of course, the Investor Relations team are always available to help you in person.

Telephone: +49 (0) 201 6496 2100

Fax: +49 (0) 201 6496 2003

E-mail: IR@brenntag.de

Web: <https://corporate.brenntag.com/en/investor-relations/>

Report of the Supervisory Board



Dear ladies and gentlemen, dear shareholders,

The reporting year 2025 was a challenging year, prompting us as the Supervisory Board to drive Brenntag's realignment together with the Board of Management. We streamlined leadership by reducing the Board of Management to two members, creating an operationally focused Executive Committee, and expanding the Supervisory Board's expertise. Strategically, we confirmed Brenntag's integrated corporate model with two operating divisions – Essentials and Specialties – led jointly by our new CEO, Jens Birgersson. By ending preparations for a split and simplifying structures, we aim to sharpen our focus on organic growth and operating performance, and concentrate fully on serving our customers and suppliers more effectively.

Composition of the Board of Management and Supervisory Board

As of September of the reporting period, we were able to recruit Jens Birgersson, a manager with considerable international experience, as successor to our long-serving Chief Executive Officer, Dr. Christian Kohlpaintner, who had communicated at the end of 2024 that he would not be available to serve another term of office. Jens Birgersson was available for an intensive onboarding process prior to taking up his position, ensuring maximum continuity when the post was handed over. In Thomas Reisten, we also have a distinguished financial expert within the company, who took up his post as the new Chief Financial Officer and successor to Dr. Kristin Neumann in April 2025.

Following the departure of the two Board of Management members with operational responsibility, Ewout van Jarwaarde and Michael Friede, during the course of the year, the Supervisory Board took the decision to reduce the Board of Management in size and thus make it leaner and more efficient. In line with the strategic decision to continue to run both divisions, Essentials and Specialties, within one company, operational responsibility will also be amalgamated. The direct and equal assignment of both divisions to the Chief Executive Officer emphasizes the focus on the business and Jens Birgersson's task of managing the improvement of the company's operating performance.

The early and structured succession planning for the Board of Management ensured an orderly and seamless transition within the operational management. The first appointments were each made for a three-year term of office in accordance with the recommendations of the German Corporate Governance Code.

The composition of the Supervisory Board also changed in the reporting period, due in part to its enlargement from six to eight members resolved upon at the 2025 Annual General Meeting. The Board's breadth of expertise was strengthened with a view to meeting the increased requirements regarding the supervision of a globally active and complex company. The corresponding amendment to the Articles of Association entered into effect on July 9, 2025.

At the end of his term of office, our Deputy Chair, Dr. Andreas Rittstieg stepped down from the Supervisory Board at the close of the Annual General Meeting on May 22, 2025. On behalf of the Supervisory Board, I would like to sincerely thank him for his many years of dedicated service on the Supervisory Board and as Chair of the Nomination and Remuneration Committee. The Annual General Meeting followed the Supervisory Board's recommendations and elected Dominik de Daniel to the Supervisory Board as his successor for three years. Stefanie Berlinger was elected as Deputy Chair of the Supervisory Board. In enlarging the Supervisory Board, the Annual General Meeting also elected Karl von Rohr and Susanne Wiegand to the Board for a three-year term of office. All three candidates were selected and put forward for election based on their individual expertise, bearing in mind the diversity policy, the profile of skills and expertise, and the objectives for the optimum composition of the Supervisory Board.

At the governance roadshow in February 2026, I informed you, dear shareholders, that Sujatha Chandrasekaran and Wijnand Donkers have chosen not to stand for re-election after the 2026 Annual General Meeting. On behalf of the Supervisory Board, I would like to thank Sujatha Chandrasekaran and Wijnand Donkers for their many valuable contributions to Brenntag's strategic and operational development. Following the recommendation of the Nomination and Remuneration Committee, the Supervisory Board therefore put forward for election our Chair of the Audit Committee, Ulrich Harnacke, for a further year, and Claudine Mollenkopf and Guus Dekkers as new Supervisory Board members. Both candidates have extensive international management and transformation experience as well as distinct industry, supply chain and IT expertise.

Activities and working practices of the Supervisory Board

Dialog with the Board of Management

The Supervisory Board performed its supervisory and advisory duties with great diligence in the reporting period. Given the extensive personnel changes on the Board of Management and the new strategic and structural direction, close, continuous and focused interaction between the Supervisory Board and the Board of Management was of particular importance. Key strategic decisions – such as the decision not to pursue a split-up of the company – were discussed at an early stage and in close consultation with the Board of Management. In particular, the collaboration with Jens Birgersson as the new Chief Executive Officer and Thomas Reisten as Chief Financial Officer was also characterized by pragmatic, trusting and constructive interaction from the outset.

The established cadence of the Supervisory Board meetings was successfully maintained, with one regular meeting per quarter and a strategy offsite in September, enabling the relevant topics to be addressed in a focused and structured manner. In addition, there was regular, bilateral interaction between the Chair of the Supervisory Board and the Chief Executive Officer throughout the reporting period. To support the onboarding of the newly appointed Chief Executive Officer, this interaction was reinforced in the early stages in particular through additional discussions taking place at shorter intervals.

Moreover, the members of the Supervisory Board were kept continuously and comprehensively informed about business performance. Uniform KPI and performance standards in the reporting provided a consistent, transparent and fact-based basis for decision-making.

Organization and working practices of the Supervisory Board

In the reporting period, the Supervisory Board once again established three committees – the Audit and Compliance Committee, the Transformation and ESG Committee and the Nomination and Remuneration Committee. By regularly addressing the respective topics in depth, all committees made a significant contribution to fulfilling the Supervisory Board's supervisory and advisory role. In doing so, the Supervisory Board ensured that the composition of the Board and its committees always met statutory and regulatory governance requirements regarding effective supervision. In particular, the Supervisory Board members' professional suitability was regularly checked by the Nomination and Remuneration Committee based on the profile of skills and expertise and the qualification matrix.

The Chair of the Supervisory Board and the committee chairs continually coordinated their activities and also liaised with one another on a regular and ad hoc basis between the meetings. This ensured that information was continuously exchanged within the Supervisory Board, enabling relevant matters and risks to be appropriately recorded and assessed. In addition, the respective committee chairs regularly reported on the main content of the committee meetings at the subsequent meetings of the Supervisory Board. In the reporting period, the collaboration within the Board was characterized by an open atmosphere of trust.

Meetings of the Supervisory Board and its committees

A total of five ordinary Supervisory Board meetings took place in the reporting period, including a constituting meeting, with all meetings conducted in person. The Supervisory Board also held two extraordinary meetings, one of which took place in person and one virtually. The Supervisory Board members' attendance rate at the ordinary meetings was 100 percent. Ulrich Harnacke was excused from an extraordinary meeting of the Supervisory Board. In addition, Dominik de Daniel was excused from a meeting of the Audit and Compliance Committee.

The members of the Board of Management attended the ordinary meetings of the Supervisory Board. The Supervisory Board also met regularly without the Board of Management, in which case it concerned Board of Management personnel matters in particular. The Audit and Compliance Committee also consulted regularly with the auditor without the Board of Management.

In addition to the regular meetings, the Supervisory Board and the Board of Management held a three-day strategy offsite meeting in September 2025. In the course of this meeting, the Supervisory Board made a tour of inspection of various Brenntag sites in Spain, including an Innovation & Application Center for Home Care and Institutional & Industrial Cleaning (HI&I), both a Brenntag Essentials and a Brenntag Specialties warehouse site, and an administrative site. An intensive discussion took place with the local management with the aim of gaining a deeper understanding of operating processes and the business. The offsite meeting focused on onboarding the new members and agreeing on the company's strategic realignment.

The following table provides a detailed overview of the Supervisory Board members' attendance at the meetings of the Supervisory Board and the committees:

Name	Ordinary Supervisory Board meetings	Extraordinary Supervisory Board meetings	Audit and Compliance Committee	Nomination and Remuneration Committee	Transformation and ESG Committee
Richard Ridinger	5/5	2/2	-	6/6	5/5
Stefanie Berlinger	5/5	2/2	3/3	4/4	-
Dr. Andreas Rittstieg	2/2	1/1	-	2/2	-
Sujatha Chandrasekaran	5/5	2/2	9/9	-	-
Wijnand P. Donkers	5/5	2/2	-	2/2	5/5
Ulrich M. Harnacke	5/5	1/2	9/9	-	2/2
Dominik de Daniel	3/3	1/1	5/6	-	-
Karl von Rohr ¹⁾	2/2	1/1	-	4/4	-
Susanne Wiegand ¹⁾	2/2	1/1	-	-	2/2

1.11 Meeting attendance in 2025

¹⁾ Prior to their official appointment, and in light of the enlargement of the supervisory board the newly elected members to the Supervisory Board in 2025 attended selected meetings of the Supervisory Board and its committees as guests. They attended without voting rights and their attendance has therefore not been included in the overview above.

Topics addressed in the Supervisory Board meetings

During the course of 2025, the Board of Management reported continually to the Supervisory Board, which dealt in depth with the company's corporate planning, business performance, risk situation, risk management and compliance. In addition to the aforementioned focus on the restructuring of the Board of Management, attention continued to center on ensuring operational capacity, the cost-reduction program and further developing the company's strategic direction in light of the persistently challenging market environment. In this context, the Supervisory Board dealt in detail with the current status of business, current business performance and the progress of the cost-reduction program at each meeting. The status of the compliance and risk management system was also addressed at each meeting. Further points of focus were mainly as follows:

At the first ordinary meeting of the Supervisory Board on March 10, 2025, the Board of Management informed the Supervisory Board about Brenntag's current acquisition strategy and the divestment framework, which aims to streamline the portfolio. In addition, the Supervisory Board monitored the status of the IT infrastructure program and discussed current ESG performance. Finally, the Supervisory Board examined, discussed and approved the Annual Report 2024 and the audit report with the appointed auditors, Deloitte GmbH Wirtschaftsprüfungsgesellschaft, Düsseldorf, who also attended the Supervisory Board meeting. The Supervisory Board approved the 2024 consolidated financial statements, the 2024 annual financial statements of Brenntag SE, including the proposal for the appropriation of the distributable profit of Brenntag SE, and the 2024 Group management report combined with the management report of Brenntag SE, and thus adopted the annual financial statements of Brenntag SE. The Supervisory Board also discussed and decided on the 2024 report of the Supervisory Board, the 2024 remuneration report and the 2024 Group sustainability statement, which was prepared fully in accordance with European Sustainability Reporting Standards. The Supervisory Board endorsed the Board of Management's proposal for the appropriation of distributable profit, proposing to the Annual General Meeting a dividend payment of EUR 2.10 per share. The Supervisory Board examined and discussed the Board of Management's reports and proposals for resolutions in depth. The Supervisory Board also talked over the convening of the Annual General Meeting. In the course of doing so, the Supervisory Board also discussed the planned enlargement of the Supervisory Board.

At the second ordinary meeting on May 20 and 21, 2025, the Supervisory Board devoted particular attention to the further reinforcement of top-line initiatives and cost management, close monitoring of the changes in working capital and targeted management of volumes in light of the persistently challenging market environment and existing geopolitical uncertainty. Finally, the Supervisory Board dealt with the Annual General Meeting, which took place on the following day, May 22, 2025.

At the first extraordinary meeting on May 21, 2025, the Supervisory Board unanimously resolved to appoint Jens Birgersson as Chief Executive Officer of Brenntag SE for a term of office through to August 31, 2028 effective September 1, 2025 and to terminate the contract with the existing CEO, Dr. Christian Kohlpaintner, on August 31, 2025.

Following the Annual General Meeting on May 22, 2025, the Supervisory Board held its third ordinary meeting, which was also the first constituting meeting. Here, Stefanie Berlinger was elected as the new Deputy Chair of the Supervisory Board, and the Supervisory Board discussed and decided on its internal organization and the composition of its committees.

At the fourth ordinary meeting of the Supervisory Board, which took place on September 2, 2025 during the strategy offsite, the focus was on onboarding the new Supervisory Board members and the new Chief Executive Officer. In view of the previous adjustment to the forecast for operating earnings for the financial year, the Supervisory Board dealt in detail with the current performance of the two divisions. In addition, the Supervisory Board discussed the potential effects of a possible split-up of the company in the current market environment and the related consequences and agreed on a strategic realignment. The bodies also discussed the impact of macroeconomic conditions on Brenntag's finance and M&A strategy as well as on possible divestments and steps to optimize the portfolio. As at the other regular meetings, the Board of Management also reported on current developments in Internal Audit, Compliance, Accounting, QSHE, Sustainability and Digital, Data & Technology.

At its second extraordinary meeting on September 8, 2025, which took place virtually, the Supervisory Board addressed the decision taken by the CEO of Brenntag Essentials, Ewout van Jarwaarde, to resign his post with immediate effect as well as the resulting realignment of the management structure and the allocation of responsibilities on the Board of Management.

At the fifth ordinary meeting on December 10, 2025, the Supervisory Board addressed current business performance. Having thoroughly examined the planning for 2026, the Supervisory Board approved the budget for the coming financial year. In addition, the report from the Board of Management focused on the development of Brenntag Essentials' business in North America. The Board of Management also gave an update on the intensified cost-reduction program. Further points of focus included the discussion and adoption of the declaration of conformity with the German Corporate Governance Code and the updating of the travel guideline for Board of Management members. Having discussed it in depth, the Supervisory Board approved the acquisition of 100 percent of the shares in Airedale Newco Ltd., a chemical distributor and service provider based in the United Kingdom. The Supervisory Board also discussed the strategic priorities for the coming year as well as progress on IT and personnel matters. As proposed by the Nomination and Remuneration Committee, the Supervisory Board decided to propose to the 2026 Annual General Meeting that Ulrich Harnacke be re-elected and Claudine Mollenkopf and Guus Dekkers be elected members of the Supervisory Board.

Committee activities

In addition to the Audit and Compliance Committee, the Supervisory Board has established a Nomination and Remuneration Committee and a Transformation and ESG Committee.

Audit and Compliance Committee

The Audit and Compliance Committee was headed by Ulrich Harnacke as Chair throughout the reporting period. Sujatha Chandrasekaran was likewise a member of the committee throughout the period. Stefanie Berlinger was also a member of the committee until the date of the Annual General Meeting on May 22, 2025. Following his election by the Annual General Meeting on May 22, 2025, the newly elected Supervisory Board member Dominik de Daniel joined the committee in place of Stefanie Berlinger. The committee meets the statutory requirements under Section 100, para. 5 of the German Stock Corporation Act (AktG) and recommendation D.3 of the German Corporate Governance Code (GCGC) regarding the financial expertise of its members, as explained in further detail in the corporate governance statement. In the reporting period, the Audit and Compliance Committee held nine ordinary meetings, of which four took place in person and five virtually. In addition, regular calls took place for a preliminary discussion of the quarterly financial publications. In the reporting period, the Chief Financial Officer's attendance at the committee meetings was provided by Dr. Kristen Neumann until March 31 and then by Thomas Reisten. Depending on the topic of the agenda items, other members of the Supervisory Board and the Board of Management also attended the meetings, including Richard Ridinger, Jens Birgersson and Ewout van Jarwaarde. In addition, representatives from Deloitte as auditor attended the meetings on the half-year and full-year periods. Moreover, the committee also consulted regularly with the auditor without the Board of Management. The Chair of the committee also engaged in close, direct dialog with the Chief Financial Officer and members of senior management from Accounting, Internal Audit, Compliance & Whistleblowing, Sustainability and Legal.

In the reporting period, the committee dealt with the following matters of focus:

The committee carried out a comprehensive preliminary review of the 2024 annual financial statement documents, the Group sustainability statement and the statutory auditor's reports to the Supervisory Board and, following a careful analysis, recommended that the Supervisory Board endorse the findings of the audit and adopt the annual financial statements. In addition, the committee addressed and examined the quarterly financial statements, the half-year financial report and the statutory auditors' respective audit reports. After Deloitte GmbH Wirtschaftsprüfungsgesellschaft, Düsseldorf, was confirmed as statutory auditor at the Annual General Meeting in the

reporting period and stated to the committee that it was independent and that there were no circumstances that would call its impartiality into question, the committee assured itself of the auditor's required independence and issued the audit engagement. Subsequently, the Audit and Compliance Committee continuously monitored the quality of the audit and the independence of the statutory auditor. In addition, the committee kept itself informed about the internal organization of the audit team and discussed with the auditors the audit strategy, the planning and the focal points set for the audit.

At its meetings, the committee also dealt in depth with the Group's financial results and its financial accounting and reporting as well as with specific accounting matters, such as the disposal of Raj Petro and ongoing litigation. Other points of focus included reviewing the further development of compliance and risk management, the effectiveness and further development of the internal control system, the findings of internal audits, the status of relatively large IT projects and the safeguarding of information security.

Nomination and Remuneration Committee

Until the close of the 2025 Annual General Meeting, the Nomination and Remuneration Committee was composed of the members Dr. Andreas Rittstieg (Chair), Richard Ridinger and Wijnand Donkers. Karl von Rohr took over as Chair following his election at the Annual General Meeting; after the Annual General Meeting, the Supervisory Board elected Richard Ridinger and Stefanie Berlinger as further members. The committee held six in-person meetings in the reporting period, supplemented by regular consultations and telephone calls. The Nomination and Remuneration Committee devoted particular time and attention to the short- and long-term succession planning for the Board of Management and the Supervisory Board. The focus here was on identifying suitable external candidates with potential for future Board of Management or Supervisory Board positions and conducting appropriate discussions to assess their suitability. The committee also assumed responsibility for and managed the succession and selection processes for upcoming changes on the Board of Management. Furthermore, in view of the Supervisory Board election in 2026, the committee drew up candidate recommendations bearing in mind the qualification matrix adopted by the Supervisory Board in order to ensure that the skills-, expertise- and diversity-related targets were met. The committee also checked the compliance of the Board of Management and the Supervisory Board with the share ownership obligations and devoted attention to reviewing the Board of Management remuneration and assessing target achievement for the financial year.

Transformation and ESG Committee

Until the close of the Annual General Meeting, the Transformation and ESG Committee was composed of Wijnand Donkers (Chair), Richard Ridinger and Ulrich Harnacke. Following the 2025 Annual General Meeting, the Supervisory Board elected Susanne Wiegand to the committee as successor to Ulrich Harnacke. The Transformation and ESG Committee held five ordinary meetings in the reporting period, of which four took place in person and one virtually. The committee focused mainly on the further development of the Group strategy and on supporting the transformation process. The members discussed the strategic direction of the Brenntag Essentials and Brenntag Specialties divisions, their operating performance and the progress of the cost-reduction measures. The committee also reviewed the ESG strategy, management of the sustainable product portfolio and the achievement of the ESG targets for the reporting period as well as the development of the ESG agenda for 2026. In addition, the Board of Management reported to the committee on current HSE-related incidents, explained progress in HSE management and discussed measures to further improve site safety.

Governance on the Supervisory Board

In the reporting period, the Supervisory Board dealt in depth with the corporate governance standards put into practice within the company and with the implementation of the recommendations and suggestions in the German Corporate Governance Code. In doing so, the Supervisory Board regularly examined the appropriateness of its governance structures and processes.

Investor dialog

I, as Chair of the Supervisory Board, maintained regular dialog with major institutional investors, proxy advisers and shareholder associations in the reporting period. In addition, the governance roadshow took place in February 2026, where I primarily presented the plans for the personnel changes on the Supervisory Board, the remuneration of the Board of Management and other aspects of corporate governance.

Conflicts of interest

The Supervisory Board attaches considerable importance to promptly identifying, preventing and, if necessary, appropriately handling potential conflicts of interest. In this context, the external appointments held by the Supervisory Board members at other companies and on other bodies were also regularly reviewed for possible conflicts of interest. No significant conflicts of interest were identified in the reporting period. Therefore, the Supervisory Board once again confirms its assessment that all members are independent of the Board of Management and the company.

Further information on corporate governance and the declaration of conformity in accordance with the German Corporate Governance Code is contained in the corporate governance statement.

Training and professional development

In the reporting period, the members of the Supervisory Board undertook continuing development and training measures to further expand their skills for the purposes of effectively supervising and advising the Board of Management.

During the onboarding of the new Supervisory Board members, these were fully informed about corporate governance at Brenntag, the organization, the business processes and the work of the Supervisory Board. In addition, individual introductory meetings were held with members of the Supervisory Board and the Board of Management in order to explain the business model and corporate strategy.

Training formats were also offered by the company in the reporting period. These included an AI literacy course delivered in March, which conveyed central technical and regulatory developments in artificial intelligence and in particular looked at the implications for governance, compliance and supervisory duties at supervisory board level. In addition, training sessions were held to provide information on the current environment and challenges in the chemical industry and distribution as well as the distinguishing features of the various business models at Brenntag. During the aforementioned offsite meeting, the members of the Supervisory Board also took part in site visits where they were able to learn more about operating processes and interact directly with operations staff.

In addition, the Supervisory Board independently engaged in external training formats in order to enhance their professional expertise. In the reporting period, these included events on the current economic trend and market structure in China, roundtable discussions on current corporate governance issues and webcast series on the practical implementation of human rights and environmental due diligence obligations. In addition, some members took part in dialog formats where they exchanged experience of new accounting standards, in specialist Audit Committee formats and in general Board seminars. Some members of the Supervisory Board also attended conferences and professional events on geopolitical, security policy and defense policy issues.

Audit of the annual and consolidated financial statements

The Board of Management prepared the annual financial statements of Brenntag SE for the period ended December 31, 2025 and the Group management report combined with the management report of Brenntag SE in accordance with the requirements of the German Commercial Code (HGB) and the German Stock Corporation Act (AktG). The consolidated financial statements were prepared in accordance with IFRSs (International Financial Reporting Standards), as applicable in the EU, and the relevant supplementary provisions of German commercial law pursuant to Section 315e, para. 1 HGB. Deloitte GmbH Wirtschaftsprüfungsgesellschaft, Düsseldorf, which was appointed at the 2025 Annual General Meeting, was engaged by the Supervisory Board to audit the Annual Report 2025. Deloitte audited the annual financial statements of Brenntag SE, the consolidated financial statements, the management report of Brenntag SE and the combined Group management report (excluding the Group sustainability statement) and in each case issued an unqualified auditors' report. In addition, an engagement to obtain limited assurance or reasonable assurance was performed on the Group sustainability statement contained in the combined management report. All documents, the annual financial statements of Brenntag SE, the consolidated financial statements and the Group management report combined with the management report of Brenntag SE, including the Group sustainability statement, the Board of Management's proposal for the appropriation of profit and the statutory auditor's audit reports were made available to the members of the Audit and Compliance Committee in good time. The documents were discussed in detail at a preparatory meeting held by the committee on March 9, 2026. They were dealt with in depth at the meeting held by the committee on March 9, 2026, and then at the Supervisory Board meeting on March 10, 2026, in each case with the statutory auditor in attendance. In the process, the audit findings, the key audit matters identified, the audit focal points and the audit procedures performed were discussed in full. Following the preliminary review by the Audit and Compliance Committee, and based on its own examination, the Supervisory Board raised no objections. It endorses the findings of the financial statements audit and the examination of the non-financial Group report and approves the financial statements prepared by the Board of Management. The annual financial statements are thus regarded as adopted on March 10, 2026. The Supervisory Board supports the Board of Management's proposal to use the distributable profit to pay a dividend of EUR 1.90 per dividend-bearing no-par value share.

Conclusion and outlook

Overall in the reporting period, the Supervisory Board and the Board of Management worked very closely together in a relationship of trust and took the reporting period as an opportunity to position the company for sustainable, long-term success. In this context, and on behalf of the entire Supervisory Board, I would first like to again sincerely thank our long-serving Deputy Chair of the Supervisory Board, Andreas Rittstieg, for the excellent working relationship and his considerable dedication. On behalf of the Supervisory Board, I would also like to wholeheartedly thank Dr. Christian Kohlpaintner for his reliable management of Brenntag SE as Chief Executive Officer in the geopolitically uncertain and economically challenging times since 2020 and in particular for initiating and implementing the extensive program to transform the company. Our sincere thanks also go to the Board of Management members who stepped down during 2025, Dr. Kristin Neumann, Ewout van Jarwaarde and Michael Friede, for their efforts and achievements on behalf of Brenntag.

Looking to the current financial year, we, as the Supervisory Board, will carefully track and constructively support the company's strategic positioning, its operational resilience and the effectiveness of the initiated measures in light of an ever-evolving market environment. Responsible business conduct, robust governance and sustainable value creation for shareholders remain the points of reference for the Supervisory Board's work here. Building on the change processes put in place in the reporting period, I believe that Brenntag is well-equipped for the challenges in our markets and the economy as a whole.

On behalf of the Supervisory Board, I would like to take this opportunity to sincerely thank all employees, the Executive Committee and the Board of Management for their dedicated service. Together, Brenntag will successfully expand our leading market position, even in the currently difficult macroeconomic environment.

For the Supervisory Board



Richard Ridinger

Chair

Essen, March 2026

Combined

2 Management Report

of the Brenntag Group and Brenntag SE

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Preamble

The German Corporate Governance Code (“GCGC”) provides for disclosures on the internal control and risk management system that go beyond the legal requirements for the management report. The disclosures are excluded from the statutory auditor’s audit of the management report content (“disclosures not typically part of the management report”). In the following, these disclosures are allocated thematically to the main elements of the internal control / risk management system; they have also been set apart from the disclosures required to be audited by placing them in separate paragraphs and labeled accordingly.

The management report contains a corporate governance statement pursuant to Sections 289f and 315d of the German Commercial Code (HGB) which reflects the recommendations of the German Corporate Governance Code. At the same time, the content of the corporate governance statement is an integral part of the management report. In accordance with Section 317, para. 2, sentence 6 of the German Commercial Code, the disclosures in the corporate governance statement are not included in the financial statements audit. Some sections of the corporate governance statement contain disclosure requirements under European Sustainability Reporting Standards (ESRSs) in relation to the Group sustainability statement contained in the combined management report and in this context were subjected to a limited assurance engagement.

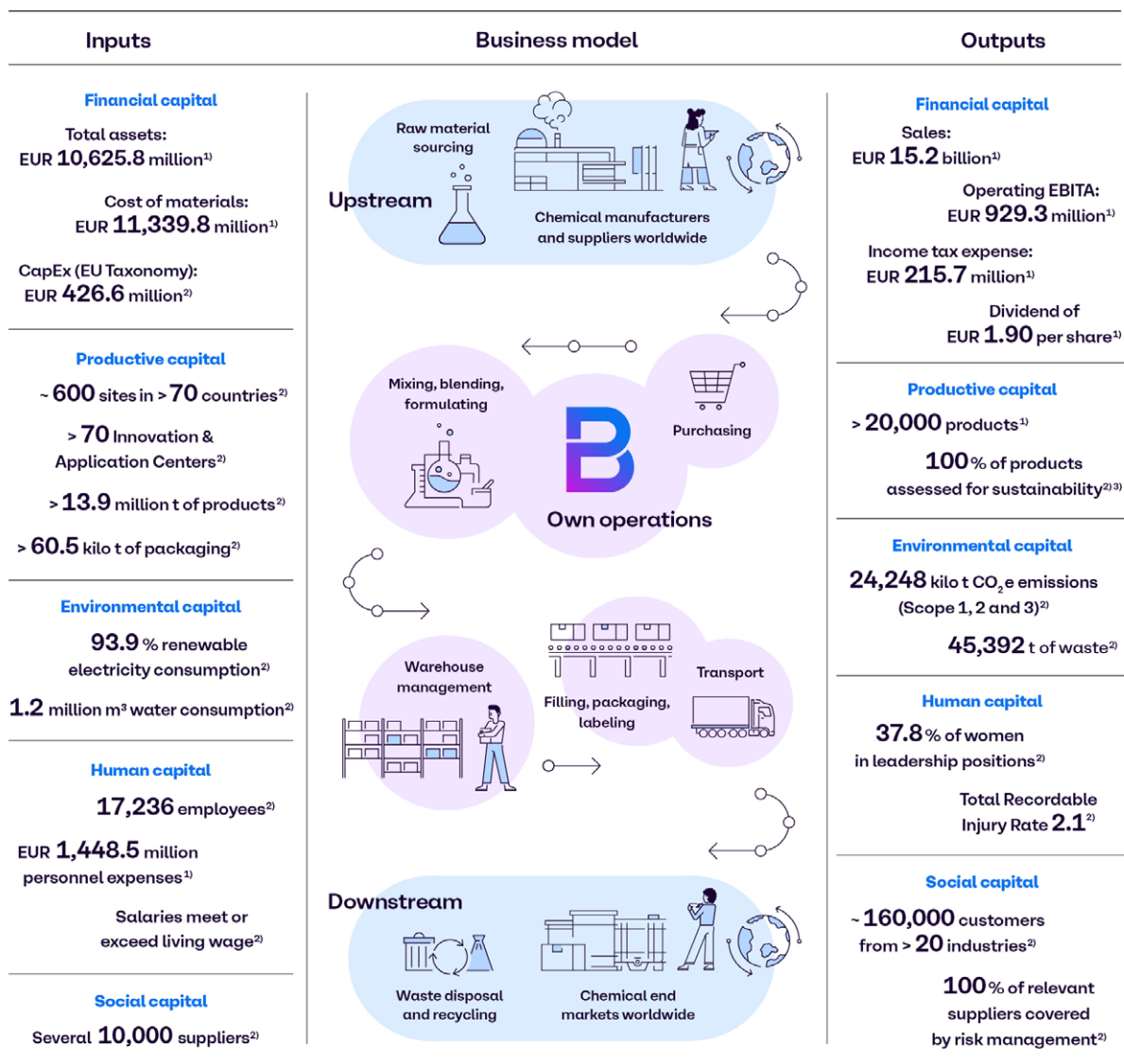
Group overview

Business activities and Group structure¹⁾

Brenntag's business model and growth opportunities are based not only on complete geographic coverage, a wide product portfolio and a comprehensive offering of value-added services, but especially on high diversity across its suppliers, customers and industries and the targeted use of the potential offered by outsourcing on the part of suppliers.

Brenntag is a partner to chemical manufacturers (its suppliers) on the one hand and chemical users (its customers) on the other. As the global market leader in chemical and ingredients distribution, Brenntag has the vision of shaping the future of the industry.

¹⁾ The disclosures in this section also meet disclosure requirements under ESR 2 (SBM1 – Strategy, business model and value chain).



2.01 Brenntag's business model

¹⁾ KPI subjected to a reasonable assurance engagement.

²⁾ Not audited as part of the annual financial statements and consolidated financial statements audit. Subjected to a limited assurance engagement for sustainability reporting purposes.

³⁾ This corresponds to 95% of total sales. The remaining 5% relates primarily to data from recently acquired companies whose product portfolio is not yet available in the global ERP system.

Brenntag purchases large-scale quantities of industrial and specialty chemicals and ingredients from a large number of suppliers. This enables it to achieve economies of scale and offer a comprehensive range of products and value-added services. The products it purchases are stored in distribution facilities, packed into quantities the customers require and delivered, typically in less-than-truckloads. Overall, Brenntag supplies a broad product range comprising around 20,000 chemicals¹⁾ and ingredients, and offers extensive value-added services such as just-in-time delivery, product mixing, repackaging, inventory management and drum return handling.

Among other things, Brenntag also offers tailor-made application, marketing and supply chain solutions, technical and formulation support, regulatory know-how and digital solutions such as digital sales channels and product platforms.

Brenntag manages its business through two global divisions, Brenntag Specialties and Brenntag Essentials. Brenntag Specialties focuses on selling ingredients and value-added services, and is managed globally through the Life Science, Material Science and Specialties Other segments. Brenntag Essentials markets a broad portfolio of process chemicals across a wide range of industries and applications, and is managed through the geographical segments EMEA, North America, Latin America and APAC. In addition, a further reportable segment, "Transregional", was introduced in the Brenntag Essentials division in order to manage the international operations of BRENNTAG International Chemicals GmbH (BIC), which buys and sells chemicals in bulk on an international scale without regional boundaries.

The two divisions are supported by "Group and Regional Services", which mainly include the central functions for the entire Group, the regional service functions and the activities with regard to the digitalization of Brenntag's business.

To ensure an agile decision-making process across the entire Group, Brenntag streamlined its governance model and introduced a two-member Board of Management, consisting of CEO and CFO, and an Executive Committee effective December 1, 2025. This structure replaces the model with divisional CEOs and divisional Executive Committees introduced in 2023. A full separation of Brenntag Specialties and Brenntag Essentials is no longer under consideration as it is not in the interest of Brenntag. Both divisions benefit from significant synergies in costs, personnel, operational infrastructure and market access, representing a unique competitive advantage for Brenntag.

As at December 31, 2025, the scope of consolidation comprised Brenntag SE and in addition 26 (Dec. 31, 2024: 25) domestic and 209 (Dec. 31, 2024: 216) foreign consolidated subsidiaries including structured entities. Four (Dec. 31, 2024: four) associates were accounted for using the equity method.

Objectives and strategy

In the coming years, Brenntag aims to strengthen and further expand its position as the global market leader in chemical and ingredients distribution in a changing global market environment.

In financial year 2025, Brenntag worked systematically to drive the execution of its "Strategy to Win" presented in November 2022. Firstly, the core elements comprised **differentiated strategies for the two divisions** Brenntag Specialties and Brenntag Essentials.

Brenntag Essentials' strategy is based on local (last-mile) delivery services, regional provision and regional supply chain services, global sourcing and interregional optimization. Through this business model, Brenntag Essentials plans to accelerate its growth in the highly attractive, globally expanding market for the distribution of commodity and industrial chemicals.

Brenntag Specialties is placing emphasis on price and margin management, cost and efficiency improvements, portfolio management and strategic portfolio decisions, and value-added services. With its global industry segments, Brenntag Specialties is implementing dedicated industry strategies and plans to extend its focus on very attractive market segments and further increase Life Science's share of the portfolio.

Secondly, in addition to the dedicated strategies, Brenntag is pursuing a **sustainability agenda** with the aim of assuming a leading role in the responsible distribution of sustainable chemicals and ingredients. This includes achieving net-zero emissions by 2050, for example.

¹⁾ Chemical substances, including the quality grade and concentration level (in the case of diluted products) or the product form (in the case of solid substances), are recorded as chemicals.

Thirdly, Brenntag aims to drive market consolidation through value-creating **M&A activity**. The focus here is on selectively expanding the market position in EMEA and the Americas in both divisions, strengthening strategic capabilities and market positions, adding to the existing portfolio and enhancing technical capabilities.

Fourthly, it is transforming itself into a **data- and technology-driven** company (Digital.Data.Excellence (DiDEX) initiative).

At the same time as pursuing the aforementioned “Strategy to Win” with its four core elements, Brenntag will in future place a clear focus on improving operational efficiency. The further disentanglement of Brenntag Specialties and Brenntag Essentials still planned at the beginning of 2025 will not be pursued. Since the beginning of the year, the company has also been implementing a stringent cost-reduction program at an accelerated pace, with an annual target of EUR 300 million in savings. A key element of the accelerated program is to reduce organizational complexity, simplify and streamline administrative processes, and eliminate duplicate structures and structural overlaps. The initiatives also include implementing a worldwide reduction in personnel in a socially responsible manner. The focus is primarily on administrative costs, mainly at the corporate headquarters and within support functions. The program is subject to the usual consultations with works council representatives. In addition, Brenntag will continue to optimize the global site network, including assessing site closures and market exits.

Management systems

Financial performance indicators

The Brenntag Group’s financial management system is based on the key performance indicators operating gross profit, operating EBITA, working capital turnover and free cash flow. Brenntag also measures return on capital and sets strict requirements for the performance of investment projects and acquisitions.

In the following, the performance indicators used to measure the Group’s financial performance are explained. They also include alternative performance indicators not defined under IFRSs (operating EBITA, working capital turnover and free cash flow), as a result of which these terms may be defined differently by other companies. These alternative performance indicators are calculated continuously using a uniform approach, which ensures that metrics from different financial years can be compared. Brenntag sometimes also adjusts for acquisition effects, in which case it talks about organic growth.

Most significant financial performance indicators

For Brenntag as a chemical distributor, **operating gross profit** is an important factor for increasing enterprise value over the long term. Operating gross profit is defined as the difference between external sales and cost of materials, adjusted for certain items. The goal is for the growth in operating gross profit to exceed macroeconomic benchmarks such as industrial production and the Global Manufacturing Purchasing Managers’ Index (PMI). In order to ensure that measurement of performance at Group or regional level is meaningful, the growth in operating gross profit is adjusted for currency translation effects.

GROUP OVERVIEW

Operating EBITA is the key performance indicator in the Brenntag Group. This is the operating profit as recorded in the consolidated income statement, plus amortization and impairment of intangible assets and depreciation and impairment of investment property, adjusted for certain items.

Brenntag adjusts operating EBITA for income and expenses arising from special items, and at segment level for holding charges, so as to improve comparability in presenting the performance of its business operations over multiple reporting periods and explain it more appropriately. Holding charges are certain costs charged between holding companies and operating companies. At Group level, these effects net to zero. Special items are income and expenses outside ordinary activities that have a special and material effect on the results of operations.

In revising its strategy and changing its corporate management, Brenntag decided to replace operating EBITA with operating EBITDA as its key performance indicator. In contrast to operating EBITA, operating EBITDA does not factor in depreciation and impairment of property, plant and equipment and right-of-use assets. As of 2026, this metric will be used as the key indicator, as it more precisely reflects operating performance and is a significant component of free cash flow. The aim is to continuously increase operating EBITDA throughout the business cycle.

In its efforts to generate increasing cash flow, Brenntag analyzes **working capital turnover**. This is defined as:

$$\text{working capital turnover} = \frac{\text{sales}}{\text{average working capital}}$$

Working capital is defined as trade receivables plus inventories less trade payables.

Average working capital for a particular year is defined as the arithmetic average of working capital at each of the following five dates: the beginning of the year, the end of each of the first, second and third quarters, and the end of the year.

To measure cash generation, Brenntag uses the performance indicator **free cash flow**. Free cash flow is an important performance indicator for Brenntag, as it shows what level of cash is generated from operating activities and will therefore be available for growth through acquisitions as well as for lenders, shareholders and tax payments.

Free cash flow is defined as follows:

Operating EBITDA

- payments to acquire intangible assets and property, plant and equipment
- + / - changes in working capital
- principal and interest payments on lease liabilities
- = free cash flow

Additional financial performance indicators

In addition to the aforementioned most significant financial performance indicators, Brenntag uses several other metrics to assess the economic success of its business activities.

In the Brenntag Group, return on capital is measured using the indicator return on capital employed (ROCE). ROCE is defined as:

$$\text{ROCE} = \frac{\text{Operating EBITA}}{(\text{average carrying amount of equity} + \text{average carrying amount of financial and lease liabilities} - \text{average carrying amount of cash and cash equivalents})}$$

The average carrying amounts in the denominator are defined for a particular year as the arithmetic average of the amounts at each of the following five dates: the beginning of the year, the end of each of the first, second and third quarters, and the end of the year.

The conversion ratio is an indicator calculated in order to measure the efficiency of a segment or the Group, more specifically by expressing operating EBITA for a given period as a percentage of operating gross profit for the same period. The indicator is used primarily to assess longer-term trends and less so to analyze short-term fluctuations between quarters.

To determine whether a particular investment project is expected to generate value for Brenntag, it takes the modified internal rate of return (MIRR) and the payback period as measures of the risk involved in the project. An investment project is generally only approved if the MIRR is above the hurdle rate and the combination of return and payback seems attractive. The hurdle rate for the MIRR varies according to the risk involved in the project and depends, among other factors, on the respective country risk.

In addition to these metrics, Brenntag has also set strategic objectives as well as financial hurdle rates that generally have to be considered when an acquisition is carried out. In particular, potential acquisitions must be able to satisfy the hurdle rate of return in the form of free cash flow on capital employed. Again, the hurdle rate of return depends, among other factors, on the country risk of the acquisition.

Further performance indicators such as tax rate, earnings per share (EPS) and net debt leverage are only used at Group level. They are not used to measure the performance of Brenntag's divisions and segments since factors such as interest or tax are less a reflection of the operating performance of the segments, but are above all based on central decisions.

Net debt leverage is used to continuously review the adequacy of the company's capital structure. In this case, the difference between financial and lease liabilities and cash and cash equivalents is expressed relative to operating EBITDA.

Adjustments for exchange rate effects

For Group accounting, the results of all Group companies are translated into the Group currency, the euro. The results are generally translated at the average rate for the reporting period or, for Group companies in hyperinflationary economies, at the closing rate.

Therefore, the results and in particular the change between reporting periods may not only be affected by changes in operating performance, but also by effects of translation from functional currencies into the Group currency, the euro (translation effects). As Brenntag considers it important to assess the operating performance of the Group companies and in particular the change in operating performance between reporting periods free of distortions from translation effects, it also reports the changes adjusted for these effects.

Exchange rate-adjusted financial metrics are not to be seen as substitutes or as more meaningful financial indicators, but always as additional information on sales, operating expenses, earnings or other metrics.

Non-financial performance indicators

The Brenntag Group's non-financial performance indicators are not regarded as among the most significant performance indicators. However, Brenntag believes that non-financial objectives also have a supporting role to play in the company's success. A sustainability strategy has been developed with a view to strengthening sustainable governance.

Climate change mitigation plays a particularly important role within Brenntag's sustainability strategy, as the entire value chain is affected. Not only do Brenntag's own activities produce CO₂ emissions; the products that the company buys have also emitted greenhouse gases during their manufacture. Moreover, climate change mitigation is important to many of Brenntag's customers. Brenntag's climate change mitigation targets cover Scope 1, Scope 2 and Scope 3 emissions and meet the requirements of the Science Based Targets initiative (SBTi). All targets were successfully validated by the SBTi at the beginning of 2025. For Scope 1 and 2 greenhouse gas emissions, the Brenntag Group has set several targets so that it contributes to the 1.5°C target: to reduce Scope 1 and 2 emissions by 58.8% by 2034 and by 90.0% by 2045, in each case compared with base year 2023¹⁾. Targets have also been set with regard to Scope 3 emissions: Brenntag has undertaken to reduce its absolute Scope 3 emissions by 35% by 2034, starting from base year 2023, and to reach net-zero greenhouse gas emissions across the value chain by 2050. **Scope 1 emissions** are all direct emissions from sources that are owned or controlled by a company itself, e.g. emissions from fuels and coolants at the company's own site or from the company's own vehicle fleet. **Scope 2 emissions** are indirect emissions from the generation of purchased energy, e.g. electricity or district heating from an energy provider. The market-based method is taken as the basis for setting tar-

gets. Under this method, the calculation uses the emission factors of the energy supplier or an individual electricity product. Using the market-based method enables company-specific purchases of energy from renewable sources to be presented in a transparent manner. **Scope 3 emissions** are other indirect emissions occurring in the value chain for upstream and downstream activities. These emissions can only be cut in cooperation with Brenntag's suppliers and customers. Scope 3 emissions are calculated in accordance with the method set out in the Greenhouse Gas Protocol (GHG Protocol) Corporate Value Chain (Scope 3) Accounting and Reporting Standard. In doing so, different approaches are used for the individual categories, depending on the availability of the data required for the calculation. Further information on this can be found in the section "Climate change", under "Targets and metrics".²⁾

To improve health and safety in the workplace, training sessions, safety projects and dedicated campaigns are carried out so as to continuously raise employee awareness of health and occupational safety, particularly the safe handling of chemicals. The **Total Recordable Injury Rate (TRIR)** is used as a performance indicator. This is defined as the number of work-related injuries requiring medical treatment beyond first aid per one million hours worked.

For Brenntag as a company with operations worldwide, the diversity of its workforce is another factor in its success. Brenntag strives for diversity at all levels of the company. The aim by 2030 is to increase the **percentage of women at all levels of management** below the Group Board of Management to at least 30%. This target does not apply in countries where setting targets is prohibited by law. In financial year 2026, it will no longer be included among the non-financial performance indicators.

¹⁾ The target boundary includes land-related emissions and removals from bioenergy feedstocks.

²⁾ The disclosures presented in the section "Climate change", sub-section "Targets and metrics", are not audited as part of the annual and consolidated financial statements audit. Instead, they are subjected to a limited assurance engagement for sustainability reporting purposes.

Report on economic position

Economic and sector-specific environment

In 2025, global economic developments were once again shaped by a mix of growth drivers and headwinds. According to estimates by the International Monetary Fund, the global economy grew by around 3.2% in real terms in 2025, a slightly weaker rate of growth than in the previous year (3.3%). As in previous years, Brenntag's market environment was affected by geopolitical tensions and an increasingly fragmented global trading landscape. Higher U.S. tariffs, a stronger euro and tensions in trade relations had an adverse impact on economic developments, particularly in Europe and Asia. Elevated uncertainty led to restrained investment, weaker industrial momentum and declining market valuations in several end markets.

Monetary policy among major central banks remained restrictive in 2025, but was gradually loosened. The European Central Bank cut the deposit rate in several steps to 2.0% over the course of the year and kept it unchanged from mid-2025 onward to support the economy. Inflation in the euro zone remained close to the ECB's target, but recently showed a slight uptick – from 2.1% in October to 2.2% in November. The U.S. Federal Reserve gradually lowered the target range for the federal funds rate from 4.5% to 4.0% in 2025, but maintained a restrictive monetary policy stance to curb inflation.

Global industrial activity continued to recover in 2025, although growth was still impacted by uncertainty. International production indices indicate global industrial production growth of around 2.8%. The Global Manufacturing Purchasing Managers' Index continued to rise over the course of the year, reaching 52.7 in November. Although slightly below the 17-month high recorded in October (53.0), it remained clearly above the average over the expansion phase ongoing since February 2023 (52.1). This signals a moderate regional improvement in global industrial demand. At the same time, the environment remained challenging due to geopolitical tensions, new trade tariffs and an increasingly fragmented trade order, prompting companies worldwide to adopt cautious inventory management and more selective investment decisions.

Europe experienced a subdued but slightly improved economic environment in 2025. The IMF expects GDP growth of 1.2% in the euro zone and 1.4% in the EU, indicating only a moderate recovery. Despite monetary easing, industrial sentiment remained muted due to structural competitive disadvantages, weak external demand and trade tensions. The

energy-intensive chemical industry in particular continues to face strong competitive pressure, dampening investment and leading to capacity adjustments.

North America showed solid economic performance in 2025. U.S. GDP growth is expected to reach 1.8%, supported by robust consumer spending, while persistently high financing terms and political uncertainty limited investment momentum. Industrial production advanced moderately, expanding by around 1.1%.

In Latin America, the picture remained mixed: The region's GDP is expected to grow by around 2.4%. Many commodity-exporting and Central American economies achieved solid growth in 2025, while others were held back by high inflation, weak investment and ongoing uncertainties. Overall, the industrial upturn in Latin America remained relatively subdued.

Asian emerging markets remained the most important global growth driver in 2025. GDP growth of 4.5% is expected for the Asia Pacific region, supported by strong expansion in South Asia (6.0%) and solid growth impetus in East and Southeast Asia. Strong demand for technology-intensive goods, robust domestic markets and normalizing supply chains support industrial development. Despite structural challenges – including weak consumer demand, pressures in the real estate market and rising trade conflicts – China is expected to grow by 4.8%, continuing to place pressure on certain industrial segments and prompting companies to make more selective investments.

Performance across the global chemical industry varied considerably from region to region in 2025. Following a generally weak market environment in 2024, the American Chemistry Council expects a 1.9% rebound in chemical production in 2025. The industry continues to be shaped by price competition, subdued demand in certain end markets and persistent cost pressure, especially in Europe, where stagnating or slightly declining output is expected. Chemical production is expected to grow by 0.1% in North America and by 0.4% in Europe, while Asia Pacific – with an increase of 2.7% – continues to consolidate its role as the global growth engine. Overall, the chemical industry environment remains challenging, while simultaneously requiring adaptability and focused portfolio management.

Business performance

Major events impacting on business in 2025

The Supervisory Board of Brenntag SE appointed Jens Birgersson as the company's new Chief Executive Officer and a member of the Board of Management with effect from September 1, 2025. Jens Birgersson most recently served as President and CEO of the Rockwool Group, Denmark. Prior to that, he held various management positions at international, market-leading companies in different industries. Jens Birgersson succeeds Dr. Christian Kohlpaintner, who decided not to extend his contract and stepped down from his post on August 31, 2025.

As part of the steps to develop the portfolios of Brenntag's global divisions and focus them on their respective core competencies, Brenntag Essentials disposed of Indian company Raj Petro Specialties Pvt. Ltd. and its subsidiary Raj Petro Specialties DMCC based in Dubai (Raj Petro). The disposal led to an overall loss of EUR 63.8 million, of which EUR 10.4 million is attributable to financial year 2025.

At the beginning of October 2025, Brenntag successfully placed a EUR 600 million bond on the European capital market. Brenntag Finance B.V. issued the bond with a maturity of six years and carrying a coupon of 3.375%. The bond was issued at 99.43% of par. The funds from the new bond serve to refinance the EUR 600 million bond that was repaid in September 2025.

In November 2025, Brenntag acquired Chem Tech Services, Inc., based in Levelland, Texas, U.S. The company provides professional oilfield chemical solutions in Texas and New Mexico. In financial year 2024, it generated sales of USD 79 million.

Statement by the Board of Management on the situation and business performance in 2025

The Brenntag Group achieved operating EBITA of EUR 929.3 million in financial year 2025, a decrease of 15.7% compared with the previous year. On a constant currency basis, this represents a decline of 12.6%. The results achieved in the past financial year remained below expectations, bearing in mind the challenging economic environment marked by geopolitical uncertainty.

In 2025, Brenntag continued to operate in a difficult macro-economic environment. Features of particular note here include falling global economic demand, the war in Ukraine and other geopolitical tensions. In light of these challenging conditions, Brenntag was able to continue to invest in the modernization of its sites, supply its customers with the required products and offer its employees a safe working environment due primarily to its solid financial position and its business model. As market leader, Brenntag plays an important role in global distribution markets, especially in times of major uncertainty. In particular, Brenntag's broad and globally diversified customer and product portfolio and its close relationships with suppliers paid off again in 2025.

Contrary to expectations, both divisions, Brenntag Specialties and Brenntag Essentials, posted a year-on-year decline in earnings. At Brenntag Specialties, the combination of a meaningful decline in volumes due to lower demand and a slight year-on-year fall in sales prices resulted in a lower absolute operating gross profit compared with the previous year. In the Brenntag Essentials division, operating gross profit was impacted by falling sales prices in particular. In both divisions, the trend in costs was determined by the positive effects of the measures under the cost-reduction program. In both divisions, those positive effects of the cost-reduction program failed to fully offset the negative performance at operating gross profit level, resulting in a year-on-year decline in earnings overall.

Due to the difficult market environment in the course of the year, Brenntag accelerated the implementation of the measures under the cost-reduction program in order to reduce the Group's operating costs, including organically reducing the headcount by 1,007 since the end of 2024 and making extensive improvements to the site network. On an organic basis, the Group's personnel costs were roughly in line with the prior-year figure.

Working capital was below the prior-year figure in financial year 2025. This is due in particular to lower cost prices. Annualized working capital turnover decreased year on year due to a fall in sales.

At EUR 293.0 million in financial year 2025, the total cash outflow for investments was below the prior-year figure (2024: EUR 342.2 million). Investments were made in the global site network in particular.

Brenntag generated free cash flow of EUR 940.8 million in financial year 2025 (2024: EUR 892.6 million), a meaningful increase on the prior-year figure. While the previous year's free cash flow was influenced by a slight outflow from the increase in working capital, free cash flow for the reporting period included a significant inflow from the decrease in working capital, which, in combination with lower payments to acquire intangible assets and property, plant and equipment, more than offset the decline in operating EBITDA.

Profit after tax decreased significantly to EUR 269.7 million in financial year 2025 (2024: EUR 543.7 million). The decline was driven mainly by weaker operating performance and by impairment losses recognized on assets during the reporting period, which further weighed on earnings performance.

Due to its long-standing relationships with its suppliers and customers, its broad range of products and services, and the organization's ability to adapt to changing market requirements, Brenntag believes it is well positioned for future success and an active role in shaping the industry.

Results of operations

Business performance of the Brenntag Group

in EUR m	2025	2024	Change	
			in %	in % (fx. adj.) ¹⁾
Sales	15,171.5	16,237.4	- 6.6	- 3.7
Operating gross profit	3,831.7	4,025.4	- 4.8	- 1.9
Operating expenses	- 2,544.2	- 2,568.6	- 0.9	1.9
Operating EBITDA	1,287.5	1,456.8	- 11.6	- 8.6
Adjusted depreciation and impairment of property, plant and equipment and right-of-use assets	- 358.2	- 354.9	0.9	3.7
Operating EBITA	929.3	1,101.9	- 15.7	- 12.6
Net expense from special items	- 106.5	- 111.4	-	-
EBITA	822.8	990.5	-	-
Amortization of intangible assets	- 205.2	- 75.1	-	-
Net finance costs	- 132.2	- 172.8	-	-
Profit before tax	485.4	742.6	-	-
Income tax expense	- 215.7	- 198.9	-	-
Profit after tax	269.7	543.7	-	-

2.02 Business performance of the Brenntag Group

¹⁾ Change in % (fx. adj.) is the percentage change on a constant currency basis.

The Brenntag Group generated **sales** of EUR 15,171.5 million in financial year 2025, a year-on-year decline of 6.6%. On a constant currency basis, sales were down by 3.7% on the prior-year figure. The decline is due especially to a fall in sales prices. Both divisions contributed to this performance.

The Brenntag Group generated **operating gross profit** of EUR 3,831.7 million in financial year 2025, a decrease of 4.8% compared with the previous year. On a constant currency basis, operating gross profit was down slightly on the prior-year figure (- 1.9%). The Brenntag Specialties division posted a decline in earnings due to a meaningful fall in volumes. The Brenntag Essentials division experienced a meaningful deterioration in operating gross profit compared with the prior-year period due to a fall in sales prices.

The Brenntag Group's **operating expenses** amounted to EUR 2,544.2 million in financial year 2025, a decrease of 0.9% year on year (on a constant currency basis: an increase of 1.9%).

Adjusted depreciation and impairment of property, plant and equipment and right-of-use assets amounted to EUR 358.2 million in financial year 2025. This represents a rise of 0.9% compared with the previous year, or 3.7% on a constant currency basis, due in part to acquisitions.

The Brenntag Group's **operating EBITA** came to EUR 929.3 million in financial year 2025, a decrease of 15.7%. On a constant currency basis, this represents a decline in earnings of 12.6% compared with the prior-year figure. This significant decline in earnings stemmed from both divisions in financial year 2025 and was driven by lower sales prices and exchange rate effects. In the Brenntag Essentials division, operating earnings were also affected by the fall in operating gross profit per unit.

Net expense from special items breaks down as follows:

in EUR m	2025	2024
Expenses for strategy projects	- 40.5	- 49.7
Expenses for legal risks	- 32.2	- 42.6
Impairment losses	- 26.6	-
Loss on the disposal of Raj Petro	- 11.3	- 42.1
Other special items	4.1	23.0
Net expense from special items	- 106.5	- 111.4

2.03 Net expense from special items

REPORT ON ECONOMIC POSITION

Expenses for strategy projects amounted to EUR 40.5 million in financial year 2025. They mainly include severance and advisory expenses which will help to achieve the cost-reduction targets.

In financial year 2025, expenses of EUR 32.2 million were recognized for legal risks in connection with the sale of talc and similar products in North America.

Impairment losses of EUR 26.6 million were recognized in the reporting period, with property, plant and equipment at a site in the Brenntag Essentials APAC segment accounting for EUR 13.1 million of that amount. This measure was taken in light of ongoing geopolitical uncertainty in relations between the U.S. under the Trump administration and China, and the related unfavorable earnings prospects expected in the region. In addition, impairment losses of EUR 11.5 million were recognized on property, plant and equipment in the context of realigning the site network, and impairment losses of EUR 2.0 million on right-of-use assets from leases in connection with goodwill impairment at Brenntag Essentials Latin America.

The deconsolidation of Raj Petro resulted in a loss of EUR 11.3 million in financial year 2025.

Other special items amounted to EUR 4.1 million in financial year 2025. This includes insurance payouts in connection with the major fire at the warehouse site in Canada in 2023.

Amortization of intangible assets amounted to EUR 205.2 million. Compared with financial year 2024, Brenntag recorded an increase of EUR 130.1 million. The increase is due predominantly to impairment losses on the goodwill and other intangible assets in the cash-generating units Brenntag Essentials Latin America (EUR 82.6 million) and Brenntag Essentials APAC (EUR 58.9 million) as a result of the reduced earnings prospects in these regions.

Net finance costs came to EUR 132.2 million in financial year 2025 (2024: EUR 172.8 million). The year-on-year change was mainly the result of three effects. On the one hand, net interest expense increased from EUR 133.7 million to EUR 138.0 million, as net debt was slightly higher on average in 2025. On the other, income arose both on the translation of foreign currency receivables and liabilities and on the measurement of liabilities relating to the acquisition of non-controlling interests, whereas these two items had each resulted in an expense in financial year 2024.

Despite the year-on-year decline in earnings, **income tax expense** increased from EUR 198.9 million to EUR 215.7 million. The increase is primarily attributable to the impairment of deferred tax assets related to tax loss carryforwards. This adjustment reflects updated profitability forecasts that reduce the expected utilization of certain tax loss carryforwards.

Profit after tax stood at EUR 269.7 million in financial year 2025 (2024: EUR 543.7 million).

in EUR m	2025	2024	Change	
			abs.	in %
Operating EBITA	929.3	1,101.9	-172.6	-15.7
Average carrying amount of equity	4,491.9	4,499.1	-7.2	-0.2
Average carrying amount of financial and lease liabilities	3,403.2	3,211.1	192.1	6.0
Average carrying amount of cash and cash equivalents	-681.9	-648.4	-33.5	5.2
ROCE	12.9%	15.6%	-	-
ROCE after special items	11.4%	14.0%	-	-

2.04 Return on capital employed (ROCE)

The Brenntag Group posted **ROCE** of 12.9% in financial year 2025, a fall of 2.7 percentage points compared with the previous year. This change is due mainly to the significant reduction in operating EBITA. Unadjusted for special items, ROCE fell to 11.4% in financial year 2025 (2024: 14.0%).

REPORT ON ECONOMIC POSITION

Business performance in the divisions

in EUR m	Brenntag Specialties	Brenntag Essentials	Group and Regional Services	Brenntag Group
Operating gross profit				
2025	1,098.3	2,733.4	-	3,831.7
Change versus 2024 in %	- 6.4	- 4.2	-	- 4.8
fx. adj. change versus 2024 in %	- 3.6	- 1.2	-	- 1.9
Operating EBITDA				
2025	420.3	973.4	- 106.2	1,287.5
Change versus 2024 in %	- 12.5	- 10.8	- 7.8	- 11.6
fx. adj. change versus 2024 in %	- 9.5	- 8.5	- 10.5	- 8.6
Operating EBITA				
2025	387.0	658.7	- 116.4	929.3
Change versus 2024 in %	- 13.4	- 15.6	- 7.4	- 15.7
fx. adj. change versus 2024 in %	- 10.4	- 13.4	- 9.7	- 12.6

2.05 Business performance in the divisions

Brenntag Specialties

in EUR m	Life Science	Material Science	Specialties Other	Brenntag Specialties
Operating gross profit				
2025	775.8	307.5	15.0	1,098.3
Change versus 2024 in %	- 6.5	- 5.5	- 16.2	- 6.4
fx. adj. change versus 2024 in %	- 3.5	- 3.1	- 15.7	- 3.6
Operating EBITDA¹⁾				
2025	300.5	104.0	17.1	420.3
Change versus 2024 in %	- 12.4	- 12.3	- 26.0	- 12.5
fx. adj. change versus 2024 in %	- 9.0	- 10.0	- 24.3	- 9.5
Operating EBITA¹⁾				
2025	293.8	99.2	- 4.7	387.0
Change versus 2024 in %	- 13.2	- 13.3	176.5	- 13.4
fx. adj. change versus 2024 in %	- 9.8	- 10.9	291.7	- 10.4

2.06 Business performance in the segments / Brenntag Specialties

¹⁾ The difference between the sum total of the reportable segments and a particular division is the result of central activities which are part of the division but not directly attributable to any one segment.

Operating gross profit in the Brenntag Specialties division came to EUR 1,098.3 million in financial year 2025, a decrease of 6.4% on the prior-year figure. On a constant currency basis, this represents a decline of 3.6%. This performance is attributable to a meaningful fall in volumes and slightly lower sales prices. The Life Science and Material Science segments played an equal role in the performance at operating gross profit level. In the Life Science segment, the slight rise in operating gross profit per unit failed to offset the meaningful fall in volumes. In the Material Science segment, both volumes and operating gross profit per unit for financial year 2025 showed a moderate decline.

Operating EBITA in the Brenntag Specialties division came to EUR 387.0 million in financial year 2025, a decrease of 13.4% on the prior-year figure. On a constant currency basis, this represents a decline of 10.4%. All of the division's segments contributed to this result. Overall, the meaningful year-on-year deterioration in operating gross profit and the moderate decline in costs resulted in a significant decline in operating EBITA. Both segments showed the corresponding trend in costs, which impacted positively on operating EBITA due to the cost-reduction measures.

REPORT ON ECONOMIC POSITION

Brenntag Essentials

in EUR m	EMEA	North America	Latin America	APAC	Trans-regional	Brenntag Essentials
Operating gross profit						
2025	957.7	1,443.6	191.9	129.1	11.1	2,733.4
Change versus 2024 in %	-3.7	-6.1	15.2	-8.8	-11.2	-4.2
fx. adj. change versus 2024 in %	-3.5	-1.7	21.4	-4.3	-11.2	-1.2
Operating EBITDA¹⁾						
2025	346.7	551.6	47.7	23.3	8.4	973.4
Change versus 2024 in %	-13.4	-11.5	43.7	-16.2	-12.5	-10.8
fx. adj. change versus 2024 in %	-13.8	-7.5	51.4	-13.1	-12.5	-8.5
Operating EBITA¹⁾						
2025	225.1	393.8	26.7	12.2	5.3	658.7
Change versus 2024 in %	-18.6	-16.1	89.4	-29.5	-17.2	-15.6
fx. adj. change versus 2024 in %	-19.3	-12.2	100.8	-26.1	-17.2	-13.4

2.07 Business performance in the segments / Brenntag Essentials

¹⁾ The difference between the sum total of the reportable segments and a particular division is the result of central activities which are part of the division but not directly attributable to any one segment.

Operating gross profit in the Brenntag Essentials division decreased by 4.2% year on year to EUR 2,733.4 million in financial year 2025. On a constant currency basis, operating gross profit was down slightly on the prior-year figure (-1.2%). With the exception of the Latin America segment, which showed growth in earnings due to the acquisitions made, all other segments posted a decline in operating gross profit. Acquisition activity enabled the EMEA segment to keep volumes roughly in line with the prior-year figure. However, a moderate decrease in both sales prices and operating gross profit per unit resulted in a deterioration in earnings. Taking into account exchange rate effects, the meaningful fall in sales prices in the North America segment in combination with moderately lower volumes led to a slight decline in operating gross profit. The Latin America segment benefited from significantly higher volumes due to acquisition activity, which, in combination with steady sales prices, resulted in a substantial year-on-year improvement in earnings. The APAC segment recorded a meaningful fall in volumes compared with financial year 2024 due to the disposal of Raj Petro Specialties Pvt. Ltd.

Operating EBITA in the Brenntag Essentials division came to EUR 658.7 million in financial year 2025, a decrease of 15.6% on the prior-year figure. On a constant currency basis, it was down by 13.4%. In all segments, operating EBITA was determined by the aforementioned performance at operating

gross profit level. The costs arising from acquisition activity overlay the positive trend in costs attributable to measures under the cost-reduction program. In the EMEA segment, there were initial signs of a reduction in costs on an organic basis. In the North America segment, the performance described at operating gross profit level resulted in a substantial reduction in operating EBITA despite the cost-reduction measures taken. On an organic basis, the reduction in costs in the Latin America segment almost fully offset the negative trend in operating gross profit. The significant year-on-year fall in operating EBITA in the APAC segment was driven by the aforementioned performance at operating gross profit level and was not offset by a meaningful reduction in costs driven especially by the disposal of Raj Petro Specialties Pvt. Ltd.

Group and Regional Services

In addition to the central functions for the entire Group, "Group and Regional Services" also include the regional service functions and the activities with regard to the digitalization of Brenntag's business. In financial year 2025, Brenntag recorded a meaningful year-on-year reduction in costs. This was achieved mainly as a result of strict cost management over advisory, travel and other operating expenses, among others.

Overall, the **operating EBITA** of "All other Segments" came to EUR -116.4 million in financial year 2025, an improvement of 7.4% year on year (on a constant currency basis: 9.7%).

Forecast / Actual comparison

In financial year 2025, the chemical markets served by Brenntag remained in the industry cycle trough marked by strong competition and the associated pressure on average sales prices. Bearing in mind these macroeconomic conditions, the global impact of geopolitical tensions in the Middle East, Eastern Europe and, most recently, Venezuela, and the resulting uncertainty, the operating EBITA performance is acceptable. Forecast earnings include the contribution from acquisitions closed and exclude foreign currency translation effects arising after the date of the forecast's preparation. For financial year 2025, Brenntag had initially forecast operating EBITA of between EUR 1,100 million and EUR 1,300 million, which it ultimately missed by a significant margin. In the first quarter of 2025, Brenntag guided toward the lower end of the communicated range. At the time of the publication of the half-year results, the guidance was lowered to between EUR 950 million and EUR 1,050 million in light of the trends and forecasts in the chemical industry. The guidance adjustments were based on the performance in the past quarters of 2025, the trend in earnings in the current quarter and the outlook for the rest of the year. One factor particularly worthy of mention here is the lack of a recovery in average sales prices, which led to the original forecast for operating gross profit being missed. The forecast also reflected expectations for future market conditions. The forecasts were based on the assumption at the date of their publication that exchange rates would remain stable. Most recently, when the financial results for the third quarter were published, the revised earnings forecast was confirmed, with Brenntag specifying that the lower end was the most likely scenario. At year-end, the Brenntag Group achieved operating EBITA of EUR 929.3 million, putting it slightly below the range given in August 2025.

The Brenntag Group forecast a meaningful rise in operating EBITA in both divisions in financial year 2025, with the relative rise for the Brenntag Essentials division expected to be higher than for the Brenntag Specialties division. For Brenntag Essentials, operating EBITA was down by 13.4% on the prior-year figure on a constant currency basis. For Brenntag Specialties, operating EBITA fell by 10.4% on a constant currency basis. Therefore, the forecast issued at the beginning of the year could not be confirmed.

Moreover, the Brenntag Group anticipated a moderate rise in operating gross profit below that in operating EBITA. It expected the rise in operating gross profit to be attributable to both divisions and assumed that the relative rise at Brenntag Specialties and Brenntag Essentials would be of a similar magnitude. In financial year 2025, the Brenntag Group generated operating gross profit of EUR 3,831.7 million in total, a year-on-year decrease of 1.9% on a constant currency basis. Operating gross profit showed a year-on-year decline of 1.2% for Brenntag Essentials and a year-on-year decline of 3.6% for Brenntag Specialties on a constant currency basis. The forecasts for operating gross profit were therefore missed.

At the beginning of financial year 2025, Brenntag anticipated a moderate improvement in annualized working capital turnover compared with the reported averages for the previous financial year. Combined with moderate sales growth, Brenntag expected a slight increase in average working capital. Contrary to expectations, external sales for the reporting period were lower than in the previous year. In combination with a decline in sales, a fall in annualized working capital turnover from 7.6 to 7.3 resulted in a year-on-year decrease in average working capital of around EUR 40 million in total in financial year 2025.

Brenntag expected a significant increase in free cash flow in financial year 2025. This forecast was based in particular on an increase in operating earnings compared with financial year 2024. With free cash flow at EUR 940.8 million (2024: EUR 892.6 million), the forecast for higher free cash flow was confirmed. However, the increase was only moderate and was driven especially by lower capital expenditure and positive working capital movements.

Financial position

Capital structure

Brenntag's capital structure strategy ensures financial resilience, maintaining flexibility to meet investment needs and strategic expansion. Our liquidity, interest rate and currency risks are largely managed on a Group-wide basis. Derivative financial instruments are only used to hedge the above-mentioned risks from underlying transactions and not for speculative purposes. A Group-wide Finance Guideline ensures the implementation of these policies and standard processes throughout the Group.

The most important component in Brenntag's financing structure is the Group-wide **syndicated loan** agreement. As at December 31, 2025, this totaled the equivalent of EUR 1.4 billion. The syndicated loan originally had a term running until February 2028, which has now been extended until February 2030 through two extension options. It is based on variable interest rates with margins depending on the credit rating, and is divided into two revolving credit facilities – one credit facility in the amount of EUR 1.0 billion and a USD credit facility in the amount of USD 525.0 million (equivalent in euros as at Dec. 31, 2025: EUR 446.8 million). To a small extent, the margin is also linked to the achievement of certain Brenntag Group sustainability targets.

As at December 31, 2025, Brenntag had no outstanding liabilities under the syndicated loan (before offsetting of transaction costs). Only a very small amount of the EUR 1 billion credit facility had been drawn down for bank guarantees. The USD credit facility, on the other hand, was entirely unutilized as at December 31, 2025. Both credit facilities are available for further drawdowns at any time. The syndicated loan is guaranteed by Brenntag SE.

In addition, the Brenntag Group's financing consists of the following instruments (in ascending order according to maturity):

- promissory notes totaling EUR 330.0 million and USD 180.0 million (equivalent in euros as at Dec. 31, 2025: EUR 153.2 million) maturing in 2027 and 2029 (**Promissory Notes 2027 / 2029**);
- a EUR 500.0 million bond maturing in 2028 and carrying an annual coupon of 3.750% (**Bond 2028**);
- a EUR 500.0 million bond maturing in 2029 and carrying an annual coupon of 0.500% (**Bond 2029**). Most of the proceeds from the Bond 2029 were swapped for U.S. dollars by way of a long-dated derivative (cross-currency interest rate swap);
- a EUR 600.0 million bond issued in October 2025, maturing in 2031 and carrying an annual coupon of 3.375% (**Bond 2031**);
- a EUR 500.0 million bond maturing in 2032 and carrying an annual coupon of 3.875% (**Bond 2032**).

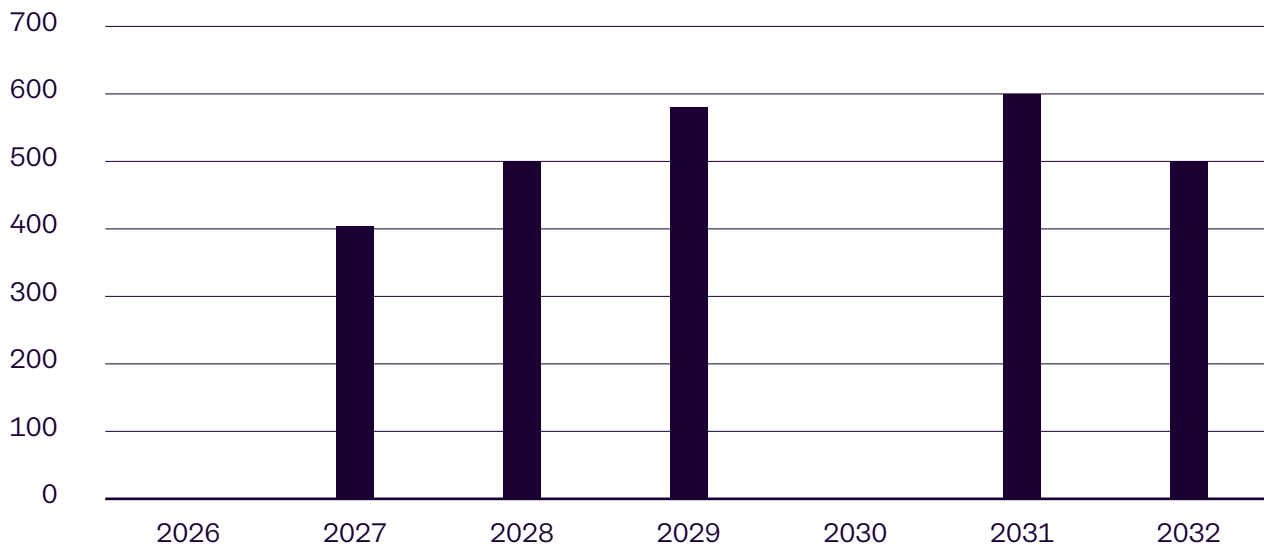
The four above-mentioned bonds were all issued under the debt issuance program newly established in 2021.

To a small extent, in addition to the above-mentioned financing instruments, there are also credit lines with local banks, which some Group companies use in consultation with Group Treasury.

Due to the four fixed-rate bonds and the partly fixed-rate promissory notes, approximately 80% of the Brenntag Group's financial liabilities were hedged against the risk of interest rate increases as at December 31, 2025.

According to its short- and mid-term financial planning, Brenntag expects the capital requirements for operating activities, planned investments and projects, and dividends and acquisitions on the assumed scale to be covered by the cash provided by operating activities. To cover short-term liquidity requirements and for general corporate purposes, it likewise has the aforementioned credit facilities under the syndicated loan.

REPORT ON ECONOMIC POSITION

2.08 Maturity profile of our credit portfolio³⁾ as at December 31, 2025 in EUR m

³⁾ Promissory Notes 2027 / 2029, Bond 2028, Bond 2029, Bond 2031 and Bond 2032, each excluding accrued interest and transaction costs. As explained above, there were no financial liabilities (before offsetting of transaction costs) under the syndicated loan (maturing in 2030) as at December 31, 2025.

Investments

In financial year 2025, investments in property, plant and equipment and intangible assets (excluding additions from acquisitions) led to a total cash outflow of EUR 293.0 million (2024: EUR 342.2 million).

Brenntag regularly invests in the maintenance, replacement and extension of the Group infrastructure necessary to perform its services, such as warehouses, offices, trucks, field service vehicles and IT hardware for various systems.

Among a vast number of investments, one notable example is a project in France to upgrade the truck fleet, entailing a total investment of EUR 10.6 million in 2025. The project comprises the purchase of 93 units, consisting of semi-trailer tractors, trucks, tanker trailers and box trailers, in order to meet safety, environmental and efficiency standards. This will enable us both to reduce our costs through lower maintenance expense and cheaper biodiesel, and to achieve a positive impact on the environment through reduced carbon emissions, as well as on safety and working conditions. The project is expected to be completed in 2026.

In addition, investments were made at our two sites in Poland, Jankowice and Gora Kalwaria, in order to enable the implementation of an optimized operating strategy. Among other things, the EUR 7.1 million invested in 2025 encompassed the closure of existing secondary warehouses and the implementation of a cross-docking transport solution. Jankowice was completed in 2025 and the remaining capital expenditure was used for Gora Kalwaria once the building permit had been issued. The project as a whole is expected to be completed in 2026.

Investments in intangible assets amounted to EUR 23.0 million in financial year 2025 (2024: EUR 18.8 million) and related mainly to digitalization.

Investments are usually funded from cash flow and / or available cash from the respective Group companies. With larger investment projects which cannot be covered by local funds, financing is provided by the Group.

REPORT ON ECONOMIC POSITION

Cash flow

in EUR m	2025	2024
Net cash provided by operating activities	966.7	906.6
Net cash used in investing activities	-410.2	-749.0
of which payments to acquire consolidated subsidiaries, other business units and other financial assets	-155.7	-436.4
of which payments to acquire intangible assets and property, plant and equipment	-293.0	-342.2
of which proceeds from divestments	38.5	29.6
Net cash used in / provided by financing activities	-489.1	23.0
of which dividends paid to Brenntag shareholders	-303.2	-303.2
of which bonds issued	1.2	994.9
of which repayments of / proceeds from borrowings	-183.5	-338.4
of which payments to acquire treasury shares	-	-250.1
of which other financing activities	-3.6	-80.2
Change in cash and cash equivalents	67.4	180.6

2.09 Cash flow

Net cash provided by operating activities rose to EUR 966.7 million (2024: EUR 906.6 million) due primarily to a EUR 121.6 million decrease in working capital (2024: increase of EUR 45.8 million).

Of the net cash of EUR 410.2 million used in investing activities (2024: EUR 749.0 million), EUR 293.0 million (2024: EUR 342.2 million) comprised payments to acquire intangible assets and property, plant and equipment. Payments to acquire consolidated subsidiaries, other business units and other financial assets, in the amount of EUR 155.7 million, consisted mainly of payments to acquire all shares in Chem Tech Services, Inc., based in Levelland, Texas, U.S., and Química Delta S.A. de C.V., based in Teoloyucan, Mexico, which had already been acquired in the previous year.

Net cash used in financing activities amounted to EUR 489.1 million (2024: net cash provided by financing activities of EUR 23.0 million). In addition to the EUR 303.2 million dividend payment to Brenntag shareholders, the main drivers were bank loans taken out and repaid as well as lease liabilities repaid. The net cash outflow and inflow arising on the repayment of the Bond 2025 and the placement of the Bond 2031, each in the amount of EUR 600 million, largely offset one another.

Free cash flow

in EUR m	2025	2024	Change	
			abs.	in %
Operating EBITDA	1,287.5	1,456.8	-169.3	-11.6
Payments to acquire intangible assets and property, plant and equipment	-293.0	-342.2	49.2	-14.4
Change in working capital	121.6	-45.8	167.4	-365.5
Principal and interest payments on lease liabilities	-175.3	-176.2	0.9	-0.5
Free cash flow	940.8	892.6	48.2	5.4

2.10 Free cash flow

The Brenntag Group's free cash flow amounted to EUR 940.8 million in financial year 2025, an increase of 5.4% on the previous year.

The main driver was the change in working capital compared with the previous year. This performance was also supported by a year-on-year fall in payments to acquire intangible assets and property, plant and equipment. Overall, this more than offset the decline in operating EBITDA.

Net assets

in EUR m	Dec. 31, 2025		Dec. 31, 2024	
	abs.	in %	abs.	in %
Assets				
Current assets	4,590.4	43.2	5,088.9	43.6
of which trade receivables	2,039.9	19.2	2,282.5	19.6
of which inventories	1,351.0	12.7	1,518.4	13.0
Non-current assets	6,035.4	56.8	6,579.1	56.4
of which goodwill	3,157.1	29.7	3,446.0	29.5
Total assets	10,625.8	100.0	11,668.0	100.0
Liabilities and equity				
Current liabilities	2,459.5	23.1	3,478.2	29.8
of which trade payables	1,498.3	14.1	1,661.6	14.2
of which financial and lease liabilities	260.8	2.5	949.4	8.1
Equity and non-current liabilities	8,166.3	76.9	8,189.8	70.2
of which financial and lease liabilities	3,065.0	28.8	2,606.9	22.3
of which equity	4,348.6	40.9	4,762.0	40.8
Total liabilities and equity	10,625.8	100.0	11,668.0	100.0

2.11 Net assets

As at December 31, 2025, total assets had decreased by EUR 1,042.2 million compared with the end of the previous year to EUR 10,625.8 million (Dec. 31, 2024: EUR 11,668.0 million). The decrease is due largely to the fall in the U.S. dollar against the euro. The sale of Raj Petro and impairment losses on the goodwill of the Brenntag Essentials Latin America and Brenntag Essentials APAC segments also contributed to this change.

Working capital fell from EUR 2,139.3 million to EUR 1,892.6 million.

At 7.3, annualized working capital turnover was below the prior-year figure (7.6).

The Brenntag Group's non-current assets fell by EUR 543.7 million year on year to EUR 6,035.4 million (Dec. 31, 2024: EUR 6,579.1 million). In this case too, the fall is due predominantly to the change in the U.S. dollar/euro exchange rate and impairment losses on the goodwill of the Brenntag Essentials Latin America and Brenntag Essentials APAC segments.

Overall, net financial liabilities changed as follows compared with the end of the previous year:

in EUR m	Dec. 31, 2025	Dec. 31, 2024
Liabilities under syndicated loan	–	–
Other liabilities to banks	113.6	132.8
Promissory notes (Schuldschein)	486.9	508.1
Bond 2025	–	601.1
Bond 2028	511.1	510.4
Bond 2029	499.0	498.4
Bond 2031	599.4	–
Bond 2032	508.6	507.8
Derivative financial instruments	8.6	44.4
Other financial liabilities	57.2	136.0
Total	2,784.4	2,939.0
Lease liabilities	541.4	617.3
Cash and cash equivalents	797.9	763.3
Net financial liabilities	2,527.9	2,793.0

2.12 Net financial liabilities

Annual financial statements of Brenntag SE

General information

Brenntag SE is the parent and the strategic management holding company of the Brenntag Group. The key management functions at overall Group level are the responsibility of the Board of Management. These primarily include setting the Group strategy and deciding on the allocation of resources, as well as executive development and financial management.

The annual financial statements of Brenntag SE have been prepared in accordance with the provisions of the German Commercial Code (HGB) and the German Stock Corporation Act (AktG). Brenntag SE has its registered office at Messeallee 11, 45131 Essen and is entered in the commercial register at the Essen Local Court under commercial register number HRB 31943.

The full annual financial statements of Brenntag SE are submitted to and published in the Company Register in electronic format.

Business performance

The net assets, financial position and results of operations of Brenntag SE are determined mainly by the business success of the Brenntag Group's investees. The section "Business performance" in the Report on economic position reports in detail on the performance and success of the Group and the divisions.

At EUR 200.7 million, the net income achieved in financial year 2025 was significantly lower than the prior-year figure (2024: EUR 312.4 million), whereas net income had been expected to be in line with the prior-year amount. Lower profit distributions from subsidiaries and second-tier subsidiaries were the main contributors to this change.

Results of operations of Brenntag SE

in EUR m	2025	2024
Sales	312.9	298.5
Other own work capitalized	0.3	0.6
Other operating income	114.3	114.1
Cost of materials	-288.8	-277.4
Personnel expenses	-60.0	-55.5
Amortization and write-downs of intangible assets and depreciation and write-downs of property, plant and equipment	-14.4	-10.3
Other operating expenses	-238.2	-218.1
Net finance income	383.5	471.6
Profit before tax	209.5	323.6
Taxes on income	-8.8	-11.2
Profit after tax / net income for the financial year	200.7	312.4
Appropriation to retained earnings	-	-9.2
Withdrawal from retained earnings	73.6	-
Distributable profit	274.3	303.2

2.13 Brenntag SE / Income statement in accordance with the German Commercial Code (HGB)

Sales resulted exclusively from sales to affiliated companies. Of the total, revenues from the provision of services to affiliated companies, which resulted mainly from IT services and other management services provided, accounted for EUR 308.9 million (2024: EUR 294.8 million). The year-on-year rise in sales in financial year 2025 is due to the increased volume of intra-Group services.

Other operating income rose by EUR 0.2 million to EUR 114.3 million.

Cost of materials of EUR 288.8 million (2024: EUR 277.4 million) consisted solely of the cost of purchased services. Cost of materials rose due to the increased volume of intra-Group service agreements.

The EUR 4.5 million rise in personnel expenses to EUR 60.0 million is due to increased pension costs.

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Other operating expenses amounted to EUR 238.2 million (2024: EUR 218.1 million). Derivative financial instruments, translation of foreign currency receivables and liabilities at the closing rate and advisory expenses, primarily in IT and other strategic projects, were the main contributors to expenses.

Only depreciation and amortization charges were recognized in financial year 2025.

Net finance income stood at EUR 383.5 million in financial year 2025 (2024: EUR 471.6 million). As in the previous year, net finance income consisted mainly of income from profits transferred by Brenntag Holding GmbH, Essen. Net interest expense in the amount of EUR 18.4 million (2024: EUR 15.7 million) was driven mainly by intra-Group financing activities.

As at December 31, 2025, temporary differences – both Brenntag SE's own and those at companies in the consolidated tax group and German partnerships – gave rise to a future tax receivable, as deferred tax assets exceeded deferred tax liabilities. Applying the option under Section 274, para. 1, sentence 2 of the German Commercial Code, a deferred tax asset was not recognized for the excess of deferred tax assets over deferred tax liabilities.

Financial position and net assets of Brenntag SE

in EUR m	Dec. 31, 2025	Dec. 31, 2024
Fixed assets	2,634.5	2,629.1
Current assets including prepaid expenses	2,004.9	1,818.0
Total assets	4,639.4	4,447.1
Equity	1,769.0	1,871.5
Provisions	107.4	92.7
Liabilities	2,763.0	2,482.9
Total equity and liabilities	4,639.4	4,447.1

2.14 Brenntag SE / Balance sheet in accordance with the German Commercial Code (HGB) – condensed version

The net assets of Brenntag SE reflect the company's holding function and its activity as the Group's central financing company. Fixed assets in the amount of EUR 2,634.5 million (Dec. 31, 2024: EUR 2,629.1 million) consisted almost exclusively of financial assets. These comprise the investment in Brenntag Holding GmbH, an intermediate holding company with further subsidiaries and second-tier subsidiaries.

Current assets including prepaid expenses rose by EUR 186.9 million to EUR 2,004.9 million. The rise is attributable to higher cash at bank and in hand amounting to EUR 310.7 million (Dec. 31, 2024: EUR 85.8 million). It is important to bear in mind here that the amount for the reporting period includes invested funds from the placement of the Bond 2031.

The equity of Brenntag SE decreased by EUR 102.5 million to EUR 1,769.0 million. This decrease is due mainly to the dividend of EUR 303.2 million paid for financial year 2024.

As at December 31, 2025, the subscribed capital totaled EUR 144.4 million (Dec. 31, 2024: EUR 144.4 million) and was divided into 144,385,372 (Dec. 31, 2024: 144,385,372) no-par value registered shares.

Provisions amounted to EUR 107.4 million in total (Dec. 31, 2024: EUR 92.7 million) and consisted mainly of provisions for pensions and similar obligations, provisions for staff restructuring measures, provisions for taxes and provisions for outstanding invoices. The rise in provisions was driven by the provisions for staff restructuring measures, which amounted to EUR 17.0 million as at December 31, 2025 (Dec. 31, 2024: none).

Liabilities of EUR 2,763.0 million (Dec. 31, 2024: EUR 2,482.9 million) related mainly to liabilities to affiliated companies, which rose by EUR 279.6 million year on year to EUR 2,240.2 million.

Expected development, opportunities and risks of Brenntag SE

In line with its function as a holding company, Brenntag SE's future results mainly depend on the receipt of dividends from companies in the Group and therefore also on the business performance of subsidiaries and decisions on dividend distributions. Thus, Brenntag SE's expected performance in financial year 2026 and the risk situation also depend to a significant extent on the performance of the Group as a whole and its opportunities and risk situation. This is covered in the Report on expected developments, opportunities and risks in the Brenntag Group's combined management report. In this respect, the statements made there regarding the expected performance and the risk position of the Group also apply to the future performance and the risk position of Brenntag SE. In addition, the risk management tools and methods for the financial instruments of Brenntag SE are explained in the report on opportunities and risks.

Brenntag SE's most significant financial performance indicator is the net income for the financial year recognized in the financial statements prepared in accordance with German commercial law. Due to the potential for distributions of retained profits at subsidiaries and the profit and loss transfer agreements entered into, we expect to generate net income for financial year 2026 that by far exceeds the prior-year figure. At Brenntag, intra-Group profits are distributed taking local financing requirements and further constraints into consideration. Even if no intra-Group dividends are distributed to Brenntag SE in a financial year, there are sufficient reserves to pay an appropriate dividend to the Brenntag shareholders.

Appropriation of distributable profit of Brenntag SE

The net income of Brenntag SE as at December 31, 2025 was EUR 200,716,766.75. After allowing for a withdrawal of EUR 73,615,440.05 from retained earnings, the distributable profit is EUR 274,332,206.80.

At the Annual General Meeting on May 20, 2026, the Board of Management and the Supervisory Board will propose that the distributable profit of Brenntag SE amounting to EUR 274,332,206.80 be used to pay a dividend of EUR 1.90 per no-par value share entitled to a dividend; that is EUR 274,332,206.80 in total.

Report on expected developments, opportunities and risks

Report on expected developments

While Brenntag observes some positive signs in certain markets, particularly pharma and the energy sector, the global economic environment remains subdued and, in aggregate, the current market outlook is flat at best. Geopolitical tensions and broader uncertainty across many regions continue to weigh on sentiment. According to the latest forecast from Oxford Economics, the global economy, measured by industrial production, is expected to see only slight growth again in 2026.

Using the data from Oxford Economics on external macroeconomic indicators, Brenntag expects the markets in the territories it operates to decline by approximately 2.5% with all figures weighted according to Brenntag's geographical footprint

In this environment, we will remain close to our customers, suppliers, and business partners to ensure we respond to market developments in an informed and decisive manner. We continue to pursue our goal of leveraging our global presence, domain expertise, and resilient business model to navigate ongoing volatility.

Beginning in financial year 2026, operating EBITDA will serve as Brenntag's most significant key financial performance indicator. The company expects Group's operating EBITDA for financial year 2026 to be in a range between EUR 1,150 million and EUR 1,350 million. Brenntag expects the Brenntag Essentials business division to generate operating EBITDA at the level of the prior year, and the Specialties division to experience a moderate decline in operating EBITDA.

We expect gross profit in both business divisions to decline slightly, while operating costs will be reduced as a result of the measures implemented. The forecast includes the earnings contributions of acquisitions already completed and is based on the assumption of stable exchange rates compared to the time of forecasting.

Compared to the reported average values of the previous financial year, a moderately lower working capital turnover is forecasted for financial year 2026.

Given the persistently uncertain market environment, Brenntag expects working capital to remain at the prior-year level. As the previous year benefited from a significant cash inflow resulting from the reduction of working capital, we consequently anticipate a corresponding significant reduction in free cash flow for the current financial year. From today's perspective, this reduction in cash flow is not expected to have any operational or strategic implications, particularly with regard to the acquisition strategy, dividend policy, or the implementation of cost-reduction measures.

This forecast excludes potential impacts of the current geopolitical developments in the Middle East, which cannot be reliably assessed at this point in time.

Main elements of the internal control / risk management system¹⁾

It is essential to Brenntag's long-term success that opportunities and risks are identified at an early stage and leveraged or managed. The aim of risk management is to identify, monitor and mitigate emerging risks at an early stage or to prevent them completely. The risk management system consists of risk reporting (an early detection system), controlling, an internal monitoring system and individual measures to identify new risks at an early stage and limit any known risks. The planning, controlling and reporting processes of the Brenntag Group are integral parts of the risk management systems of all operational and legal units as well as the central functions.

The risk management system is continuously further developed in accordance with the requirements of Section 91, para. 2 of the German Stock Corporation Act (AktG). In the reporting period, the risk management software underwent further technical development to improve transparency in the capture process. By building a risk management hub, we are promoting knowledge transfer in risk management for everyone involved in the process.

The Risk Management and Internal Control Committee continuously monitors, coordinates and improves risk management and internal control functions and activities. It reviews risk management-related strategies and guidelines and monitors their implementation, maintenance and approval. It also deals with the process-related review in that it tracks countermeasures and checks their plausibility.

The risk-bearing capacity concept is based on a combined equity and liquidity approach.

To determine the entities included in the risk capture process, risk-related materiality thresholds are derived from Brenntag's risk appetite, with the respective EBITDA serving as the key metric. Material qualitative risk factors such as business model complexity, the maturity of governance, risk and compliance functions, specific local regulatory requirements and an entity's significance are also considered.

To take into account early risk detection, the risks for the following two years are also captured.

Measures to effectively reduce a potential or real risk are assigned a specific mitigation strategy and a status. If the measure is to be implemented in the future, a partial completion rate or an implementation date must be given.

Risk reporting (early detection system)

Brenntag continually identifies and analyzes risks at the Group companies and constantly improves internal workflows and the IT systems used throughout the Group.

Responsibility for risks at the entities included in the risk capture process lies initially with the legal units in the Brenntag Group. This includes identifying risks and estimating their effects. It must also be ensured that there are suitable measures in place to reduce risks.

The biannual risk inventories are one important tool for global risk management. These are performed at the Group companies and at the highest Group level with system support and documented by the system. In addition, all units have been instructed to immediately report any significant risks emerging (ad hoc reporting) to Group headquarters. The risk capture process is software-assisted.

The risk inventories gather estimations on existing risks. Standardized risk catalogs giving examples of the typical risks for the Brenntag Group are used as a system for gathering this information. In doing so, thematically related risks are grouped into risk categories. Any risks which are identified are assessed with regard to the possible extent of damage and their probability of occurrence, in each case on a five-level scale.

First, the gross risk is assessed. The gross risk is the maximum damage if no counteraction is taken. If a risk can be reliably counteracted by effective action, these measures have to be shown in risk profiles and assessed with regard to their effectiveness. The residual risk (net risk) is then the gross risk less the effect of measures taken to reduce the risk. These measures are supplemented with the mitigation strategy applied and the status of implementation.

¹⁾ The disclosures in this paragraph also meet disclosure requirements under ESRs 2 (GOV-5 – Risk management and internal controls over sustainability reporting).

REPORT ON EXPECTED DEVELOPMENTS,
OPPORTUNITIES AND RISKS

Brenntag classifies net risks as “critical”, “high”, “medium” or “low” according to the estimated probability of occurrence and the possible extent of damage, i.e. the negative impact on the results of operations, the financial position and cash flow. The extent of damage is classified by inferring percentages with respect to Group EBITDA (previous year: EBITA). As at December 31, 2025, this gives the following risk matrix for the 2026 analysis period:

			Probability of occurrence				
Possible extent of damage			Highly improbable	Improbable	Possible	Probable	Highly probable
Qualitative	in EUR m	in EUR m (old)	< 6%	6–25%	26–50%	51–70%	> 70%
Critical	> 320	> 267	Medium	High	High	Critical	Critical
High	> 130–320	> 107–267	Low	Medium	High	High	Critical
Medium	> 60–130	> 53–107	Low	Medium	Medium	High	High
Low	> 10–60	> 11–53	Low	Low	Medium	Medium	High
Insignificant	≤ 10	≤ 11	Low	Low	Low	Low	Medium

2.15 Risk assessment matrix

The individual risks reported are consolidated at regional level and for the Group and then presented to the Risk Management and Internal Control Committee, the Board of Management and the Supervisory Board.

A Monte Carlo simulation is used to assess and aggregate the risks. The resulting value at risk (VaR 95) is compared against risk-bearing capacity in order to ensure the stability and sustainability of business activities from a risk perspective as well.

Risk capture at local level includes risks only, not opportunities. In addition, the risks identified are evaluated and opportunities assessed by the function heads at the level of Brenntag SE (top-down review). The estimate of the risks per risk category and the opportunities and risks are explained in detail in the section “Report on opportunities and risks”.

The process for systematically identifying and assessing risks for the Group companies is regularly audited by Internal Audit Brenntag Group. In addition, the statutory auditor, as an independent, external party, assesses the general suitability of the risk early detection system in the course of its audit of the annual financial statements.

Controlling

The Corporate Controlling department immediately processes the information gained from the monthly and quarterly reports and can thus identify and communicate risks and opportunities. This also includes an analysis of the reasons for any deviations from planned figures. On the basis of any identified deviations from planned figures, the Corporate Controlling department regularly examines the achievability of targets in forecasts, indicating the associated opportunities and risks. The financial indicators examined are described mainly in the section “Financial performance indicators”, first and foremost operating EBITA.

The ongoing evaluation of opportunity and risk potential in all segments is also an elementary part of Brenntag’s strategy, which is described in detail in the section “Objectives and strategy”. As part of regular strategy development, Brenntag analyzes the market opportunity and risk situation in each Brenntag segment and, on this basis, establishes goals and value-enhancing measures designed to mitigate risks and exploit opportunities. Finally, the situation analysis and business operation plans are regularly reviewed in discussions on business performance.

Internal monitoring system

Another important part of risk management in the Brenntag Group is the internal monitoring system consisting of the organizational security measures, internal controls and internal audit.

The internal control system comprises all central and decentralized policies and regulations adopted by the Board of Management and the regional and local management teams with the aim of ensuring

- the effectiveness and efficiency of the workflows and processes,
- the completeness, correctness and reliability of internal and external financial reporting as well as
- the Group-wide observance of applicable laws and regulations (compliance).

Both the efficiency of the workflows and processes and the effectiveness of the internal control systems set up in the decentralized units as well as the reliability of the systems used are regularly examined by Internal Audit Brenntag Group. The results of these audits are reported immediately. Thus, Brenntag ensures that the Board of Management and the Audit Committee are kept continuously informed of any weaknesses and any resulting risks, along with the appropriate recommendations to eliminate the weaknesses. Moreover, in 2025 measures were implemented to further develop the internal control system. These aim to extend the control environment and further enhance the quality and transparency of internal controls. In the reporting period, a comprehensive ICS self-evaluation was carried out to systematically review and continuously further develop the design and effectiveness of the existing internal controls.

In order to ensure that its sustainability reporting is adequate bearing in mind the requirements of the EU Taxonomy Regulation and European Sustainability Reporting Standards (ESRSs), Brenntag integrates the preparation of the sustainability statement into the overarching financial reporting process. Internal control activities are tailored to the individual steps in the reporting process. It is intended that the main risk generally that data will be incomplete, incorrect or incorrectly processed is mitigated through specific control measures, such as automated data transfers, application of the dual control principle and systematic variance analyses. In the reporting period, work began to formalize these controls to a greater extent.¹⁾

Internal control system related to the (Group) accounting process (report in accordance with Section 289, para. 4 and Section 315, para. 4 of the German Commercial Code (HGB))

The Group accounting process is managed by the Corporate Accounting department. A major element of the internal control system related to the (Group) accounting process is an IFRS accounting manual applicable throughout the Group which specifies accounting and measurement policies for all companies included in the consolidated financial statements. Brenntag SE is also fully integrated into the Group-wide internal control system. The guidelines and control processes applicable to the Group are likewise applied to the annual financial statements of Brenntag SE. Preparation of the consolidated financial statements is supported by the use of uniform, standardized reporting and consolidation software (OneStream) containing comprehensive testing and validation routines. The services of external experts are used for special areas of accounting, e.g. the annual goodwill impairment test as well as environmental and pension actuarial reports to determine the relevant provisions.

There are also other Group-wide guidelines which have concrete effects on accounting. The management of the local units confirms compliance with these guidelines by issuing a management certificate. Particularly notable examples include the "Internal Control Guideline", which contains requirements on the performance of monitoring routines as well as the separation of functions, the dual control principle and access authorizations, the "Transfer Pricing Guideline" and the "Finance Guideline".

In addition, Internal Audit Brenntag Group regularly checks compliance with these Group guidelines at the subsidiaries.

Summary assessment of the internal control and risk management system²⁾

In continually addressing internal control and risk management in financial year 2025, the Board of Management identified potential for improvement in some areas. It responded to any risks detected by initiating immediate measures and organizational changes. In summary, bearing in mind these initiatives, the Board of Management has no indications that the internal control and risk management system is not appropriate and effective.

¹⁾ The disclosures in this paragraph also meet disclosure requirements under ESRS 2 (GOV-5 – Risk management and internal controls over sustainability reporting).

²⁾ The disclosures in this paragraph are disclosures not typically part of the management report as defined in the preamble to this management report.

REPORT ON EXPECTED DEVELOPMENTS,
OPPORTUNITIES AND RISKS

Report on opportunities and risks

Brenntag's strategy is geared to steadily improving the Group's efficiency and underlying profitability. The Brenntag Group companies are exposed to a number of risks arising from their business activities in the field of chemical distribution and related areas. At the same time, these business activities also give rise to numerous opportunities to safeguard and nurture the company's competitiveness and growth.

Projects, in particular the strategic initiatives (see the section "Objectives and strategy"), are regularly implemented to maintain and strengthen the Group's profitability. These projects focus on exploiting opportunities to increase operating gross profit and on optimizing costs.

To limit or entirely eliminate possible financial consequences of risks that may occur, Brenntag has, insofar as is possible, taken out appropriate insurance to cover damage and liability risks within the Group. The following sections describe the risks and opportunities which could influence the business performance, financial position and results of operations of the Brenntag Group. Similar, organizationally or functionally related risks have been systematically grouped in risk categories. The estimates made per risk category relate to the net risk. Unless stated otherwise or obvious from the context, the following statements on risks and opportunities refer to all Brenntag segments.

As part of Group risk management and the risk management methods described above, Brenntag also analyzes environmental, social and governance-related (ESG) aspects, such as environmental matters, employee matters, human rights, anti-corruption and bribery matters and their respective risk aspects. The risks are transferred into the Group sustainability statement if they were identified as material in the course of the double materiality assessment.¹⁾

The process of aggregation into risk categories includes risks only and does not offset risks against opportunities. In the further explanations of the risk categories, possible opportunities are considered individually and described separately and independently of the risks. Possible changes, if any, in the risk categories' overall risk are discussed separately in the relevant paragraphs. The assessment of the corporate risks made in financial year 2025 (as at Dec. 31, 2025) for the following year and the prior-year disclosure are as follows:²⁾

¹⁾ The disclosures in this paragraph also meet disclosure requirements under ESRS 2 (GOV-5 – Risk management and internal controls over sustainability reporting).

²⁾ The disclosures in this paragraph also meet disclosure requirements under ESRS 2 (GOV-5 – Risk management and internal controls over sustainability reporting).

Risk category	Possible extent of damage	Probability of occurrence	Overall risk	
			Dec. 31, 2025	Dec. 31, 2024
Economic environment and political stability	High	Possible	High	High
Market risks	Critical	Possible	High	High
Strategic risks	High	Improbable	Medium	High
IT risks	High	Possible	High	High
Legal risks	Medium	Possible	Medium	High
Tax risks	Medium	Possible	Medium	High
Personnel risks	High	Possible	High	Medium
Financial risks	High	Improbable	Medium	Medium
Operational risks	High	Improbable	Medium	Medium
Environmental protection, health and safety	Critical	Possible	High	Medium
Compliance risks	High	Improbable	Medium	Medium
ESG risks	High	Improbable	Medium	Medium
Acquisition risks	High	Improbable	Medium	Medium
Quality assurance risks	Low	Improbable	Low	Low

2.16 Overview of corporate risks

■ Economic environment and political stability:

Due to the international nature of its business, Brenntag is exposed to a number of economic, political and other risks, and the possibility that negative developments in individual regions or countries might have an adverse effect on its business or financial position cannot be entirely ruled out. For example, natural disasters, pandemics or the instability of the economic and political situation in regions or countries in which Brenntag operates may have a negative impact on its business and its operating result. Countries and regions with an unstable economic and political situation are often emerging markets, which offer great opportunities due to above-average growth. Overall, the international nature and related diversification of the business balances out the risks. Moreover, a large percentage of business is conducted in stable economies. In some cases, however, these have seen an increase in populist or protectionist tendencies, which over the medium term could also result in heightened uncertainty for free trade.

Economic downturns may also have a negative impact on Brenntag's sales and operating gross profit. In addition to sales risks arising from rising unemployment in certain countries, high levels of public debt and moderate inflationary pressures, a pronounced economic downturn in our core markets in particular, the increase in protectionist tendencies that has now begun in the United States and the possible escalation of global, geopolitical tensions may lead to falling demand. Global supply chains have remained very strained and the trend in energy prices poses an additional challenge for international trade. The significant factors influencing the outlook include further developments and effects attributable to higher energy and supply costs in Europe, the trend in inflation in the U.S. and Europe, and the economic trend in China. Brenntag has drawn up lists of measures for various scenarios, depending on possible political and economic developments.

The constant dialog with customers and suppliers in the respective regions also enables Brenntag to identify any impact on its business and supply chains at an early stage and respond accordingly. In a recession, lower profitability on the part of customers could lead to higher bad debt losses. We counter this risk through a high level of diversification – by geography, customer industries, suppliers, products and customers – and, where appropriate, by using credit insurance and credit reference agencies.

The increase in geopolitical risks could lead to more supply chain bottlenecks and therefore require rapid adaptability and flexibility in sourcing goods. In addition, difficult-to-predict processes of industrial change have accelerated. Due to its broad geographical footprint, close and long-established supplier relationships, diversified product portfolio, and global supplier and customer relationships, Brenntag is well able to balance out and overcome bottlenecks in the supply chain. However, any strain on global supply chains harbors the risk of further increases in raw materials prices as well as the risk that these additional costs cannot be fully passed on to customers. In order to ensure a supply of raw materials at the best possible price, Brenntag continuously analyzes supply chains and occasionally stockpiles inventories as a safety cushion. This, in turn, raises the risk that, if the situation in the raw materials market were suddenly to ease, the inventories could be too expensive and have to be sold at less than their value. This risk is countered by Brenntag's business model due to a high level of inventory turnover. There is a further risk that customers could start substituting products with cheaper alternatives, especially in the case of commodity chemicals.

Brenntag continuously analyzes all risks relevant to its business and promptly takes all the necessary and possible measures to counter them.

On the sales side, risks may arise from political measures, more specifically from tighter standards and increasing regulation, which frequently, however, represent an opportunity for advantage over many medium-sized competitors. Based on its global expertise, such as in the field of regulation, and its broad portfolio of products and services, as a result of which alternative procurement channels can frequently be used, Brenntag is superbly positioned to be able to serve its customers' requirements at all times. This was seen especially during the COVID-19 pandemic and the container shortage, for example.

■ Market risks and opportunities:¹⁾

Geopolitical developments may disrupt sales markets.

Brenntag's strategic development is geared to the current global, regional and local market growth drivers.

¹⁾ The disclosures in this paragraph also meet disclosure requirements under ESRS 2 (GOV-5 – Risk management and internal controls over sustainability reporting).

REPORT ON EXPECTED DEVELOPMENTS,
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Brenntag's business is managed through two global divisions focused on customer and supplier needs: Brenntag Specialties and Brenntag Essentials. Based on this, there are major sales opportunities of strategic significance for Brenntag in the flexible and efficient marketing of process chemicals and in the large, globally relevant focus industries served by Brenntag Specialties, namely Life Science (Nutrition, Pharma and Beauty & Care) and Material Science. In addition, its global network and comprehensive portfolio of products and services place Brenntag in a unique position to meet customers' increasing requirements for pan-regional and global end-to-end solutions. The growing demand for customer-specific solutions, blending and services and alternative sales channels also open up further growth opportunities.

As an international Group, Brenntag SE sees opportunities in all regional markets to extend its market lead. The continuous expansion of its geographic presence in emerging markets, particularly in the Asia Pacific region, offers above-average growth opportunities. Brenntag intends to continue to optimally exploit the opportunities presented by company acquisitions and the active consolidation of the fragmented chemical distribution market.

In terms of product sourcing, Brenntag's operating model enables it to achieve economies of scale. The optimization of the local product portfolios through sales partnership agreements with chemical producers for new products or product categories offers further potential. In addition, Brenntag intends to continue to actively realize the potential that arises as a result of chemical producers outsourcing supply chain and sales activities. Especially when demand is relatively weak and because producers are under pressure to reduce costs, this is a fillip to distributors. The global distribution network and the experienced professional organization at all levels of the Brenntag Group are key elements for tapping this potential.

In order to make optimum use of the opportunities outlined (please also see the section "Objectives and strategy"), Brenntag manages the two divisions, Brenntag Specialties and Brenntag Essentials, using differentiated market approaches. At the same time, Brenntag has confirmed that the two divisions will remain under the shared Group umbrella so as to leverage synergies by making shared use of Business Services, for example, thereby achieving economies of scale.

Brenntag plans to leverage customers' increasing need for sustainable solutions and products to strengthen its position as market leader through the pioneering role it aims to play in responsible and sustainable chemical distribution. Through its transformation into a data- and technology-driven company which began some years ago, it also intends to fully exploit the potential of digital solutions while at the same time enabling more efficient and reliable supply chains. In order to lay the foundations for this, it is working vigorously to harmonize the master data and ERP landscape. Moreover, through continuing M&A activities, Brenntag wishes to leverage growth opportunities in attractive market segments. At local level, Brenntag creates the right conditions through its operating activities to effectively and efficiently exploit the opportunities which the markets offer.

In some local markets Brenntag serves, competition from other chemical distributors is growing. This stronger competition, which is partly due to the increasing pan-regional activities and consolidation among competitors as well as the development of new sales channels, some of them digital, is a risk that might negatively impact sales and earnings. Brenntag therefore works continually to improve its product and service portfolio and expand its own digital sales channels and tools. The local business might also be impacted by customers relocating to low-cost countries. However, Brenntag sees its extensive global presence as a key factor in balancing out these local risks.

As far as possible, the sourcing risk related to the supply of strategically important raw materials is offset through long-term contracts and / or partnerships with different suppliers and alternative supply sources. However, the purchase prices can vary considerably depending on the market situation and impact on cost structures. To safeguard its competitiveness, Brenntag counteracts these risks by adjusting sales prices, through international procurement and through strict cost management.

The risk arising from future market developments is counteracted by constantly monitoring markets and competitors as well as by holding regular strategy meetings.

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■ Strategic risks:

Strategic opportunities for the Brenntag Group stem primarily from implementing strategic alignment initiatives and transformation efforts. These opportunities contrast with the risk that these efforts will be delayed or ultimately fail.

Emerging or widening geopolitical risks, for example as a result of the war between Russia and Ukraine, in Northeast Asia, in the Middle East or as a result of increased protectionist measures on the part of the U.S. government, could adversely affect the Brenntag Group's regional business performance. Due to its global footprint, however, Brenntag is well positioned to offset the effects in a region.

Intensifying competition as a result of competitors' transformative M&A activities may lead to an increased risk of falling behind the growth rates of other competitors in the trend toward consolidation in chemical distribution markets regionally and globally. However, Brenntag intends to carefully analyze such inorganic growth opportunities and actively participate if the risk/reward profile is judged to be positive for Brenntag.

In the course of the central review, the rating of the probability of occurrence resulting from aggregation was changed from "possible" to "improbable" based on the current assessment. This reduced the overall risk estimate from "high" to "medium".

■ IT risks and opportunities:

IT and cyber risks result, on the one hand, from the dependency of business processes on digital technologies and the centralization of business workflows, and on the other from external cybersecurity risks, such as the increasing cyber threat posed by malicious actors (e.g. manipulation and theft of data through hacker attacks and the use of leading-edge technologies). These risks could result in a partial or complete interruption to business operations; data could be manipulated, stolen or destroyed.

In order to address these risks applying a risk-based approach and in accordance with the defense-in-depth principle, Brenntag relies on a comprehensive cybersecurity and resilience framework based on people, processes and technology:

People: Regular, role-based, global training on digital security, campaigns to raise awareness of digital security, and the active involvement of managers all foster safe digital behavior and risk-informed decision-making.

Processes: Brenntag operates a structured cyber risk management program based on international, regional and local regulatory requirements and industry standards. This includes clear security guidelines and standards covering topics such as data security, access controls, user behavior, supply chains and third parties. There are also established guidance documents on threat detection, investigation, containment and incident resolution, as well as business continuity plans (BCPs), disaster recovery plans (DRPs) and an information security crisis management framework.

Technology: Brenntag uses leading-edge solutions such as endpoint security, intrusion prevention systems, firewalls and secure network segmentation, as well as identity and access management (IAM) and data loss prevention (DLP) systems to protect data and control access. In addition, security information and event management (SIEM) systems are used for real-time monitoring, detection and response.

Business continuity plans are designed and implemented, enabling business operations to be rapidly restored in the event of a serious cyber incident and ensuring that processes critical to business operations are maintained.

Brenntag believes that using leading-edge technologies to achieve its strategic objectives is a necessity and a business imperative. The company therefore invests continuously in the further development and reliability of its digital landscape, in particular but not exclusively in the confidentiality, integrity, availability and resilience of the ERP systems, the digital platforms and the supply chain ecosystem.

■ Legal risks:

Brenntag SE and individual subsidiaries have been named as defendants in various legal actions and proceedings arising in connection with their activities as a global group. In some cases, Brenntag is also the subject of investigations by the authorities. Brenntag cooperates with the relevant authorities and, where appropriate, conducts internal investigations regarding alleged wrongdoings with the assistance of in-house and external counsel.

The decision issued by the French Competition Authority in 2013 in relation to the allocation of customers and coordination of prices was set aside by a court of appeal due to procedural errors at the request of the French subsidiary BRENTAG SA in February 2017. In December 2020, the court imposed a fine of EUR 47 million, which was payable immediately. BRENTAG SA lodged an appeal against the decision, whereupon the paid fine was reimbursed in November 2023 and the proceedings referred back by the Cour de cassation (Court of cassation) for a further decision. With further steps expected to be taken by the French authorities responsible, a

provision was recognized in the amount of the EUR 47 million reimbursement. In December 2025, after more than 20 years of investigation, the French Competition Authority dismissed complaints concerning whether BRENNTAG SA made illegal use of its market position. The decision is not yet final and non-appealable, and can be contested by the original complainants during the first quarter of 2026. Two civil liability actions that had been filed in connection with these investigations were rejected on the basis of this decision. Given the number of legal disputes and other proceedings that Brenntag is involved in, it is possible that a ruling may be made against Brenntag in some of these proceedings. The company contests actions and proceedings where it considers it appropriate. Provisions are established for ongoing legal disputes on the basis of the estimated risk and, if necessary, with the help of external consultants. Predicting the outcome of such matters, particularly in cases in which claimants seek indeterminate compensation, entails considerable uncertainties. Any adverse decisions rendered in such cases could have a substantial impact on Brenntag's net assets, financial position and results of operations for a reporting period. However, Brenntag currently does not expect its net assets, financial position and results of operations to be materially affected.

In connection with the sale of talc and similar products, North American subsidiaries of the Brenntag Group are involved in court and out-of-court proceedings with end consumers and other parties. The resulting legal risks pertain in particular to product liability. In the lawsuits, the plaintiffs claim to have suffered damage to health as a result of contact with the products sold. In these proceedings, Brenntag has reached settlement agreements with some of the plaintiffs and their attorneys to resolve the legal disputes. In addition, compensation claims arising from product liability are being asserted against the Group in relation to the talc business of a U.S. company that was acquired as part of corporate transactions. Moreover, there are legal risks associated with potential, as-yet unknown cases, which the executive directors have commissioned an external assessor to investigate. The number of pending cases was approaching the prior-year level. Taking into account legal advisory costs, the expense amounted to EUR 32.2 million in financial year 2025. The underlying cases are continuously monitored and the provisions adjusted as and when necessary. In addition, Brenntag has taken measures to mitigate the risk and is asserting claims for compensation from third parties. Nevertheless, the possibility that these legal disputes will result in further significant adverse effects on the results of operations cannot be ruled out.

Based on current developments and assessments, both the potential, aggregated extent of damage and the overall risk estimate are rated as "medium" in the reporting period (previous year: both "high"), with the probability of occurrence remaining unchanged.

■ Tax risks:

As a global company, Brenntag has to comply with the country-specific tax laws and regulations in each jurisdiction. Tax exposures could result in particular from current and future tax audits of German and foreign subsidiaries. We counter these risks by continuously improving the tax compliance management system in accordance with the criteria in auditing standard IDW PS 980 and gradually rolling out this system to other Group companies in Germany and abroad. Tax exposures are generally reflected in the balance sheet by recognizing provisions. We currently see nothing to indicate that we should expect significant new findings from the tax authorities or customs authorities that could lead to additional tax expenses.

The aggregated rating of the possible extent of damage for tax risks was changed from "high" to "medium" based on current assessments. The estimate of the probability of occurrence is unchanged at "possible". All in all, this results in a reduction in the overall risk estimate from "high" to "medium".

■ Personnel risks and opportunities:¹⁾

Personnel risks result mainly from the steadily increasing skills shortage, particularly in sales, logistics and IT, as a result of which Brenntag may lose high performers and staff in key positions or be unable to find a sufficient number of qualified staff to fill vacancies within the Group. The strategic measures that have been initiated, including the cost structure measures, also result in an increased risk of employees leaving the company. Moreover, there is a risk that qualified Brenntag employees will be headhunted by competitors. Brenntag counters these risks by positioning itself globally as the preferred employer in chemical distribution and through measures aimed at long-term employee retention. It also limits these risks through Brenntag's global employer brand and through globally uniform HR programs and measures that allow the Brenntag companies to take into account country-specific legislation and circumstances. Information on Brenntag's HR strategies and tools is provided in the "Social" sec-

¹⁾ The disclosures in this paragraph also meet disclosure requirements under ESRS 2 (GOV-5 – Risk management and internal controls over sustainability reporting).

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tion of the Group sustainability statement for 2025. Combining these with other early warning indicators, Brenntag is able to promptly identify possible changes in employees' attachment to the company and initiate appropriate management measures where necessary.¹⁾

In the course of the central review, the rating of the probability of occurrence resulting from aggregation was changed from "improbable" to "possible" based on the current assessment. As a result, the overall risk estimate changed from "medium" to "high".

■ Financial risks and opportunities:

Brenntag's business is generally exposed to exchange rate, interest rate, credit and price risks. Due to the fact that Brenntag conducts business in different currency areas, changes in exchange rates may have positive or negative translation effects on the results of the Group. In particular, any change in the euro / U.S. dollar exchange rate may have a substantial impact as a large proportion of business is conducted in the U.S. dollar area. Brenntag has decided not to hedge exchange rate differences resulting from the translation of financial statements of subsidiaries whose functional currency is not the euro (translation risks). On the other hand, transaction exposures resulting from the translation of foreign currency receivables and liabilities into the functional currency of a subsidiary are hedged insofar as is possible and where it makes economic sense to do so. This is based on a Group-wide Finance Guideline that sets out basic requirements and objectives, threshold values and hedging instruments to be used. The Finance Guideline requires Group companies to offset the risks of open net foreign currency exposure using suitable instruments such as forward and swap contracts or to keep them within certain limits. Any exceptions exceeding the above limits must be agreed on a case-by-case basis with the Treasury department.

Unfavorable political developments and fiscal policy decisions in specific countries may have a particularly negative impact in this context.

Risks related to cash investments are limited by only doing business with banks and business partners considered to be of good credit standing. Payments are also handled through such banks. The credit facility under the syndicated loan is made available by a large number of international banks, meaning that availability is ensured through high diversity. Uncollectibility risk is reduced by continually monitoring customers' credit ratings and payment behavior and setting appropriate credit limits. The risk is limited by the large number of customers the company has in different countries; even the largest key account customer only accounts for a very small single-digit percentage of Group sales. In some cases, credit insurance is also taken out in order to limit risks.

The Brenntag Group is partly financed with debt capital. Brenntag is confident that the loan agreements and credit lines, the bonds issued and the liquid funds available are adequate to cover the Group's future liquidity needs, even if requirements should increase unexpectedly. Like comparable loan agreements, the syndicated loan contains a number of customary termination provisions. In the event of a severe breach of the provisions of the loan agreement, the facility agent appointed by the lenders may call in the loans if he deems this move necessary to safeguard the lenders' interests. As the Group's main financing instruments (syndicated loan, four bonds and promissory notes) all contain cross-default clauses, any breach of contract or calling due of outstanding amounts in respect to one financing instrument could also have a negative impact on the others.

The terms and conditions of the financing instruments are also influenced by the Group's credit rating. A change in the rating that the international rating agencies Standard & Poor's and Moody's assign to Brenntag may impact on the Group's financing terms. The rating may have a positive or a negative impact. Both rating agencies assign an investment grade rating, thereby confirming Brenntag's high credit standing. Moody's currently rates Brenntag at "Baa2" with a stable outlook, while Standard & Poor's has given Brenntag a rating of "BBB+" with a negative outlook.

¹⁾ Disclosures related to the Group sustainability statement are "unaudited" in the sense of the consolidated financial statements audit and were subjected to a limited assurance engagement in the course of the sustainability reporting.

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A smaller portion of Brenntag's financing is based on variable interest rates which are subject to fluctuations in market interest rates. This means that Brenntag has both the opportunity to participate in falling market interest rates but also the risk of incurring higher interest cost as a result of rising market interest rates. The split between variable and fixed interest rates is determined as part of interest risk management. Derivative instruments such as foreign exchange forwards, interest rate and currency swaps or combined instruments may be used to hedge risks from financing. Interest rate-related financial risks are mainly managed by the Treasury department at Group headquarters. If individual companies hedge financial risks from operating activities themselves, this is done in consultation with and under the supervision of Group headquarters. This permits a balancing of risks throughout the Group.

The Brenntag Group has obligations to current and former employees as a result of pension commitments. Some of the pension obligations are covered by plan assets. The plan assets are subject to capital market risks, as a portion of them is invested in funds and equities. Any changes in relevant inputs, such as an increase in life expectancy or salaries, may lead to higher cash outflows and higher present values of the defined benefit obligation. To some extent regionally, contributions are also paid into defined benefit pension plans maintained by more than one employer (termed multi-employer plans). If other participating employers do not meet their payment obligations, Brenntag may be liable for the obligations of those employers.

The above-mentioned financial risks are also relevant mainly for the single-entity financial statements of Brenntag SE prepared in accordance with German commercial law. In addition, the company is exposed to impairment risk on the equity investments it holds. The continuous monitoring of the investments in subsidiaries is an integral part of our risk management, meaning that potential impairments are identified at an early stage and, if necessary, countermeasures can be taken to stabilize or improve the subsidiaries' profitability.

Operational risks:

Brenntag's business is subject to operational risks. As a chemical distributor, Brenntag is exposed to the risk of interruptions to business, quality problems or unexpected technical difficulties, for example as a result of the incorrect handling of chemicals or machinery and equipment on site and during transportation. Disruptions and outages at its warehouse sites or during transportation may lead to delivery delays and falling sales revenues. Brenntag counters this risk through extensive safety measures at its sites and regionally standardized quality and safety manuals, by specifically training employees in how to handle chemicals correctly and through safety campaigns across the sites. In addition, Brenntag has taken out appropriate business interruption insurance for sites where any disruption might pose the threat of interruptions to business due to the local geographical site structure and/or portfolio structure, as well as increased cost of working cover for all sites. As Brenntag frequently uses the sites of external providers as well as its own sites, it is possible that it may (partly) relocate to different external sites in the event of an interruption to business so that it can continue to ensure that customers are supplied.

Risks may also arise if the products purchased and delivered to customers do not meet the specified and agreed quality, the wrong products are delivered or if, in specific cases, their sale is subject to restrictions. The distribution of certain products may result in particular liability risks. However, the procedures that have been established guarantee a good level of assurance that products are procured from reliable sources and that they are the right ones, meet the required standard of quality and are sold on in accordance with the law. In addition, there is product liability insurance, including extended product liability cover, to cover the above-mentioned losses.

■ Quality management, safety, health, environmental protection and ESG:¹⁾

The safety, health and environmental risks associated with chemical distribution are managed through rigorous measures at the sites and are an integral part of Brenntag's QSHE (Quality, Safety, Health, Environment) strategy. The QSHE strategy is based on central pillars that place a culture of safety front and center, supported by a team that fosters shared responsibility at all levels. A robust management system provides for clear guidelines, directives and proven practices, and ensures that these are adapted in line with regional requirements, depending on the risks inherent in the divisions. Active training, communication and strict monitoring by way of self-assessments, audits and action plans foster continuous improvements.

As a chemical distributor, Brenntag generally operates in a complex regulatory environment. Cross-country teams of product regulation specialists are deployed to ensure that operating and business processes are in compliance with the relevant requirements. Among others, Brenntag trades in regulated products such as substances of concern. Back in 2023, the Global Safe Product Policy was introduced with a view to ensuring that the most stringent statutory provisions are adhered to at Brenntag worldwide. This Policy is aimed at gradually reducing the sale of substances of concern around the globe. Risks relating to these substances are monitored and managed. For further information on business involving substances of concern, please refer to our Group sustainability statement. Overall, Brenntag SEes itself in a good position due to its scale, its central systems and its expertise.

As an important player in the chemical industry, Brenntag is aware of its responsibility as regards social standards. Respect for international human rights is embedded in the Group through a human rights risk management system that is monitored by the Human Rights Officer.

Among other things, the system includes risk analyses and risk-mitigation measures that are carried out both in Brenntag's own operations and at suppliers. Further information on human rights and the supply chain is published in the sustainability statement. The monitoring of human rights compliance and environmental, health and safety risks is part of the sustainability strategy. The Board of Management sets the ESG targets at the beginning of the year and is informed about the achievement of targets once a quarter.

Environmental protection and climate change mitigation play an important role at Brenntag. Brenntag's goal worldwide is to conserve resources, make optimum use of them and minimize the impact of its business activities on the environment. Climate change may give rise to a range of different risks for Brenntag, but also to opportunities. Brenntag has sites all over the world and acute risks are increasingly expected as a result of extreme weather events such as hurricanes and flooding. In order to better prepare the Brenntag sites for such climatic changes, Brenntag analyzed the threat to its sites posed by physical risks in three global warming scenarios. In addition, extensive precautionary measures are set out for foreseeable critical weather conditions. In particular, these include removing or securing sensitive products and equipment from storage areas that are particularly under threat. Plans are drawn up to ensure that customers will be supplied by other sites in the Brenntag network should sites be temporarily out of operation following such events. In addition, the global fight against climate change will lead to structural, regulatory and technological changes in the market on the one hand, but also to increased costs as a result of preventive technologies or government carbon taxes on the other.

Reducing CO₂ emissions (Scope 1 and 2) by 90% in order to reach net-zero greenhouse gas emissions by 2045 and reaching net-zero emissions across the value chain (Scope 3) by 2050 are important ESG targets. For Brenntag's product portfolio too, sustainability is an important metric that ensures that Brenntag is well positioned with regard to possible market changes.

The possible extent of damage for environmental protection, health and safety risks is rated as "critical" in the reporting period (previous year: "high"). The overall probability of occurrence is rated as "possible" (previous year: "improbable"). All in all, this results in an overall risk estimate of "high" (previous year: "medium").

Similarly, the extent of damage for ESG risks is rated as "high" (previous year: "medium"). However, the aggregated probability of occurrence is rated as "improbable" (previous year: "possible"). All in all, the overall risk estimate for ESG risks remains unchanged at "medium".

¹⁾ The disclosures in this paragraph also meet disclosure requirements under ESRS 2 (GOV-5 – Risk management and internal controls over sustainability reporting).

■ Compliance and data protection risks and opportunities:¹⁾

As a global company, Brenntag is subject to a large number of laws and provisions in each country in which it operates. Brenntag sees compliance and data protection as strategic success factors that help to reduce the risks to the company, while at the same time creating added value for its partners.

For Brenntag to be able to cooperate with its business partners as a reliable partner of integrity, it is essential to comply with the applicable laws and regulations, as this ensures a working relationship of trust based on shared fundamental beliefs. Among other things, Brenntag has introduced a compliance management system to minimize the risk of unethical business conduct. This is constantly further developed so as to meet current requirements and developments. Compliance involves conducting business in accordance with the relevant regulations. In particular, any form of corruption, bribery or fraud is forbidden at Brenntag. Other focal points of the compliance activities at Brenntag include working toward compliance with antitrust, foreign trade and data protection requirements.

As the global market leader in chemical distribution and as a Group with operations around the globe, Brenntag conducts business worldwide. In a rapidly changing environment, Brenntag's business may be impacted by export control regulations, embargoes or other types of trade restriction, among other things. Brenntag must comply with all the foreign trade laws applicable to it, such as restrictions on exports and imports of particular goods, services and technologies to or from countries subject to sanctions or embargoes. Internal regulations set out further specifications for employees in foreign trade.

Identifying sanctioned companies and persons, and the related task of ensuring compliance with various sanctions provisions are other duties performed in compliance work at Brenntag. For this, Brenntag uses an automated, IT-based solution, among other things. With the help of a special software application, regular checks are carried out against the sanction lists issued by the United Nations, the European Union, the U.S. and various other countries.

The binding rules requiring all employees to treat one another and business partners fairly are set out in particular in Brenntag's Code of Business Conduct and Ethics and in other internal guidelines. Failure to observe those rules can give rise to risks and this is counteracted primarily through various controls, checks and audits. All employees receive regular information on new guidelines and updates to guidelines through global newsletters. Brenntag employees are required to familiarize themselves with the content of the guidelines and comply with their provisions.

Brenntag has established processes to receive and handle internal and external complaints and compliance notifications throughout the company. Reports of possible compliance violations are received, among other means, through an electronic whistleblowing system. All incoming reports are taken seriously and investigated. If an investigation of the underlying circumstances confirms the suspicion, measures are taken to punish a violation and further develop relevant processes.

As a Group with operations worldwide, Brenntag is also subject to laws and regulations relating to data protection. Breaches of data protection regulations may lead to large penalties and substantial reputational damage. Brenntag has introduced a data protection management system to mitigate these risks. A global data protection unit has been established, which works together with regional and local data protection coordinators to continuously ensure compliance with relevant data protection requirements and further develop the data protection management system.

Employees are made aware of compliance and data protection issues through various communication measures, such as newsletters and information campaigns, and through comprehensive training measures, among other things.

The introduction of compliance and data protection management systems and regular employee training play an essential role in establishing a corporate culture characterized by integrity and a sense of responsibility. This not only strengthens internal collaboration, but also enhances the Group's market position and reputation over the long term. Brenntag responds flexibly and with foresight to regulatory changes and, accordingly, continuously further develops the management systems taking into account local requirements. This enables potential risks to be identified at an early stage and helps to foster innovative approaches.

The possible extent of damage for compliance risks is rated as "high" in the reporting period (previous year: "medium"). The aggregated probability of occurrence is regarded as lower and is rated as "improbable" (previous year: "possible"). This results in an unchanged overall risk estimate of "medium".

¹⁾ The disclosures in this paragraph also meet disclosure requirements under ESRG 2 (GOV-5 – Risk management and internal controls over sustainability reporting).

■ Acquisition risks and opportunities:

In the Brenntag Group, every decision to acquire is linked to minimum requirements on the internal rate of return of the particular investment. The company valuations incorporating the findings of due diligence work performed are of central importance in acquisitions. Therefore, all significant risks and opportunities are systematically recorded and an appropriate purchase price determined. Company acquisitions always involve risks surrounding the integration of employees and business operations. Particularly when acquiring small companies, there is often a particular dependency on a handful of key employees. Significant integration risks mainly include the loss of the acquiree's key employees and the loss of business relationships with suppliers and customers. Achieving the planned growth in the acquired business and realizing the planned synergies from the transaction are other significant areas of risk. Brenntag strives to limit these risks with adequate transaction structures, by conducting opportunity and risk analyses at an early stage in the approval process, with the support of external consultants and with specific contract structures (e.g. incentive, warranty and retention clauses). In previous years, M&A activities were spread, with a strategic focus, across all regions in which Brenntag operates, while in 2025 the core markets of EMEA and the U.S. were a focal point. In the case of acquisitions in emerging markets in Asia and Latin America, purchase prices are sometimes higher and the risks are also higher (e.g. compliance risks, higher working capital funding requirements, integration risks, foreign currency risks). On the other hand, however, there are also much greater opportunities due to higher expected growth rates. Strong market fragmentation regularly gives rise to acquisition opportunities for Brenntag (multitude of acquisition opportunities). Brenntag can selectively pursue acquisition targets with the most suitable target entities and a number of opportunities arise to support strategic objectives through acquisitions. Systematic use of a practiced acquisition and integration process helps to minimize risks and exploit potential. We counter integration risk with an updated version of the post-merger integration manual. The current market dynamics in chemical distribution, with falling price levels in some cases and possibly lower share prices or transaction multiples, may result in more favorable M&A opportunities, but at the same time pose a risk of the company itself becoming an acquisition target.

The possible extent of damage for acquisition risks is rated as "high" in the reporting period (previous year: "medium"). The aggregated probability of occurrence is regarded as lower and is rated as "improbable" (previous year: "possible"). This results in an unchanged overall risk estimate of "medium".

Summary of the opportunities and risk situation

During the past financial year, the executive directors once again continuously updated and assessed the risk situation for the Brenntag Group. The Group's risk position did not change significantly during that period. In our opinion, the risks described in the section "Report on opportunities and risks" do not jeopardize the continued existence of the company, either individually or collectively, and do not exceed its risk-bearing capacity. It can be concluded, therefore, that none of the risks, either in isolation or in aggregate, compromises the going concern principle from an equity or liquidity standpoint. Additional risks and opportunities that are not yet known or risks that are currently considered immaterial may also have a negative impact on our business operations. Brenntag is convinced that the challenges arising from the risks described above can continue to be mastered successfully.

Explanatory report on information required under Sections 289a and 315a of the German Commercial Code (HGB)

Composition of the subscribed capital

As at December 31, 2025, the subscribed capital of Brenntag SE totaled EUR 144,385,372. The share capital is divided into 144,385,372 no-par value registered shares, each with a notional value of EUR 1.00.

According to article 7, para. 3 of the Articles of Association of Brenntag SE, any right of shareholders to certification of their shares is excluded to the extent permitted by law and that certification is not required under the rules of any stock exchange on which the share is admitted to trading. The company is entitled to issue share certificates embodying several shares (consolidated certificates). Pursuant to Section 67, para. 2 of the German Stock Corporation Act (AktG) in conjunction with Article 9, para. 1 (c) (ii) of Council Regulation (EC) No 2157/2001 on the Statute for a European company ("the SE Regulation"), only those persons recorded in the company's share register will be recognized as shareholders of Brenntag SE. For purposes of recording the shares in the company's share register, shareholders are required to submit to Brenntag SE the number of shares held by them, and, in the case of individuals, their name, address and date of birth, or in the case of legal entities, their company name, business address and registered offices. All shares confer the same rights and obligations. At the Annual General Meeting, each share has one vote and accounts for the shareholders' proportionate share in the net income of Brenntag SE. Excepted from this rule are any treasury shares held by Brenntag SE that do not entitle Brenntag SE to any membership rights. Brenntag SE does not currently have any treasury shares. The shareholders' rights and obligations are governed by the provisions of the German Stock Corporation Act (which apply to an SE as a European stock corporation by way of the reference to other relevant provisions contained in Article 9 of the SE Regulation), in particular by Sections 12, 53a ff., 118 ff. and 186 of the German Stock Corporation Act.

Restrictions on voting rights or transfer of shares

The Board of Management of Brenntag SE is not aware of any agreements relating to restrictions on voting rights or on the transfer of shares.

Direct or indirect interests in the capital of the company exceeding 10% of the voting rights

As at December 31, 2025, the company was aware of two direct or indirect interests in the capital of the company that exceeded 10% of the voting rights. Section 33 of the German Securities Trading Act (WpHG) requires that any investor whose percentage of voting rights in Brenntag SE reaches, exceeds or falls below certain thresholds as a result of purchases, disposals or otherwise must notify Brenntag SE and the German Federal Financial Supervisory Authority (Bundesanstalt für Finanzdienstleistungsaufsicht (BaFin)). On December 8, 2025, Brenntag was informed pursuant to Section 33 of the German Securities Trading Act that Kühne Holding AG's share of the voting rights exceeded 20%. On September 26, 2025, Artisan Partners Limited Partnership provided notification that its share of the voting rights exceeded 15%. Other voting right notifications in accordance with Section 33 of the German Securities Trading Act received by Brenntag SE in the reporting period concern shares of the voting rights in excess of the 3% and 5% thresholds.

Shares with special rights conferring powers of control

There are no shares with special rights conferring powers of control.

System of control of any employee participation scheme where the control rights are not exercised directly by the employees

Brenntag SE does not have a general employee participation scheme.

Legislation and provisions of the Articles of Association applicable to the appointment and removal of the members of the Board of Management and governing amendments to the Articles of Association

The appointment and removal of members of the Board of Management are subject to the provisions of Sections 84 and 85 of the German Stock Corporation Act. The Supervisory Board appoints the members of the Board of Management for a maximum term of five years. Their appointment may be resolved according to article 13, para. 4 of the Articles of Association of Brenntag SE by simple majority of votes. In the event of a tie, the Chair of the Supervisory Board has the casting vote. According to article 9, para. 1 of the Articles of Association of Brenntag SE, the Board of Management consists of one or more persons. The specific number of members of the Board of Management is determined by the Supervisory Board. As at December 31, 2025, the Board of Management of Brenntag SE consisted of two members.

Contrary to Sections 133, para. 1 and 179, para. 2, sentence 1 of the German Stock Corporation Act, article 20 of the Articles of Association of Brenntag SE stipulates that in cases that require the majority of the share capital represented when the resolution is passed, the simple majority of the capital represented is sufficient. However, this does not apply to changes to the object of the company, as Section 179, para. 2, sentence 2 of the German Stock Corporation Act only permits amendments to a company's Articles of Association regarding the object of the company to be adopted with larger majorities than three-quarters of the capital represented when the resolution is passed. The authority to adopt purely formal amendments to the Articles of Association is transferred to the Supervisory Board under article 14, para. 2 of the Articles of Association of Brenntag SE. In addition, by resolution of the Annual General Meeting on June 9, 2022, the Supervisory Board was authorized to amend the Articles of Association of Brenntag SE in connection with the creation of new authorized capital after implementation of each capital increase and after expiry of the authorization period without use of the authorized capital.

Powers of the Board of Management to issue or repurchase shares

Authorization to create authorized capital

By resolution of the Annual General Meeting on June 9, 2022, the Board of Management was authorized, with the approval of the Supervisory Board, to increase the share capital of Brenntag SE on one or more occasions in the period to June 8, 2027 by a total of up to EUR 35,000,000 by issuing up to 35,000,000 new registered ordinary shares in return for cash contributions or contributions in kind. The shareholders shall generally be granted a subscription right. However, in certain cases the Board of Management is authorized, with the approval of the Supervisory Board, to exclude the shareholders' statutory subscription rights for one or more capital increases under the authorized capital. This shall apply, for example, if the capital increase is effected against cash contributions and the issue price of the new shares is not significantly lower than the stock market price of the shares of the same class and carrying the same rights already traded on the stock market at the time of final determination of the issue price within the meaning of Section 203, para. 1 and para. 2 and Section 186, para. 3, sentence 4 of the German Stock Corporation Act and the total pro rata amount of registered share capital represented by the new shares issued in accordance with this paragraph with exclusion of subscription rights pursuant to Section 186, para. 3, sentence 4 of the German Stock Corporation Act is not less than 10% of the registered share capital (simplified exclusion of subscription rights). The 10% threshold will be determined based on the share capital at the time the authorization becomes effective. If the share capital is lower at the time this authorization is exercised, that lower amount will apply.

The Board of Management shall decide on the further content of the share rights and the conditions of the issuance of shares with the approval of the Supervisory Board.

Authorization to acquire and use treasury shares in accordance with Section 71, para. 1, no. 8 of the German Stock Corporation Act

By resolution of the Annual General Meeting on May 23, 2024, the Board of Management was authorized, with the approval of the Supervisory Board, to acquire treasury shares up to a total of 10% of the share capital. The shares acquired on the basis of this authorization, together with other shares in the company which Brenntag SE has already acquired and still holds, may at no time account for more than 10% of the respective registered share capital. The authorization may be exercised in whole or in part, once or several times. It took effect at the close of the Annual General Meeting on May 23, 2024 and shall be valid until May 22, 2029. If the shares are purchased on the stock exchange or through a multilateral trading facility within the meaning of Section 2, para. 6 of the German Stock Exchange Act (MTF), the purchase price (excluding incidental costs) may not be more than 10% higher or lower than the arithmetic mean of the share prices (closing auction prices of Brenntag SE shares in Xetra trading or a comparable successor system) on the Frankfurt Stock Exchange on the last five trading days prior to the purchase or the entering into an obligation to purchase. In the case of acquisition by means of a public purchase offer, Brenntag SE may either publish a formal offer or issue a public invitation to submit offers for sale. The purchase price offered (excluding incidental costs) or the limits of the purchase price range per share determined by Brenntag SE (excluding incidental costs) may not exceed or fall below the arithmetic mean of the share prices on the Frankfurt Stock Exchange on the last five trading days prior to the publication of the purchase offer or the invitation to submit offers by more than 10%. The authorization may be exercised for any purpose permitted by law. The Board of Management was authorized, with the approval of the Supervisory Board, to cancel the treasury shares acquired on the basis of the authorization pursuant to Section 71, para. 1, no. 8 of the German Stock Corporation Act without any further resolution by the Annual General Meeting. The cancellation may be limited to a portion of the shares acquired. The authorization to cancel shares may be exercised more than once. The cancellation of shares generally leads to a reduction in registered share capital. In derogation of this, the Board of Management may determine that the registered share capital shall remain unchanged and that instead the cancellation shall increase the proportion of the registered share capital represented by the remaining shares in accordance with Section 8, para. 3 of the German Stock Corporation Act. In this case, the Board of Management is authorized to adjust the indication of the corresponding number in the Articles of Association. Treasury shares may, under certain circumstances, also be used subject to exclusion of the shareholders' subscription rights existing in principle and in particular by way of simplified exclusion of subscription rights as specified above.

Authorization to issue bonds and to create conditional capital

By resolution of the Annual General Meeting on June 9, 2022, the Board of Management was authorized ("Authorization 2022"), with the approval of the Supervisory Board, to issue holder or registered convertible bonds or bonds with warrants as well as profit participation rights or profit participating bonds with option or conversion rights on one or more occasions up to June 8, 2027 for a total nominal amount of up to EUR 2,000,000,000 with or without limited term ("Bonds") and to grant the holders or creditors of the Bonds option or conversion rights to up to 15,450,000 new Brenntag SE shares with a pro rata total amount of the registered share capital of up to EUR 15,450,000 in accordance with the respective option or convertible bond conditions or profit participation right or participating bond conditions ("Conditions") to be determined by the Board of Management. In order to grant shares to the holders or creditors of Bonds, the registered share capital was conditionally increased at the Annual General Meeting on June 9, 2022 by up to 15,450,000 no-par value registered shares conferring profit-sharing rights from the beginning of the financial year in which they were issued ("Conditional Capital 2022"); this equates to an increase in the registered share capital of up to EUR 15,450,000. The Bonds may, in addition to euros, also be issued in a foreign legal currency, subject to a limit of the corresponding equivalent value in euros, and by companies dependent on Brenntag SE or in which it holds a majority interest; in this case, the Board of Management was authorized, with the approval of the Supervisory Board, to assume the guarantee for the Bonds on behalf of Brenntag SE and to grant the holders of such Bonds option or conversion rights to Brenntag SE shares and to make other declarations and take other actions necessary for a successful issue. The issues of Bonds may be divided into partial Bonds each having equal rights. Bonds may only be issued against contribution in kind, provided that the value of the contribution in kind corresponds to the issue price and that this price is not significantly lower than the theoretical market value of the Bonds determined in accordance with recognized methods of financial mathematics. The Board of Management is authorized, under certain circumstances and with the approval of the Supervisory Board, to exclude shareholders' subscription rights to the Bonds. However, with regard to the exclusion of subscription rights against cash payment, this authorization shall apply only provided that the shares issued to fulfil the option or conversion rights and / or in the case of fulfilment of the conversion obligation represent no more than 10% of the registered share capital (simplified exclusion of subscription rights). The 10% threshold will be determined based on the share capital at the time the authorization becomes effective. If the share capital is lower at the time this authorization is exercised, that lower amount will apply.

When convertible bonds, profit participation rights or profit participating bonds with conversion rights are issued, the holders are granted the right to exchange their Bonds for new Brenntag SE shares in accordance with the more detailed Conditions.

When bonds with warrants, profit participation rights or profit participating bonds with option rights are issued, one or more warrants shall be attached to each partial bond or each profit participation right or each participating bond, entitling the holder to subscribe for Brenntag SE shares in accordance with the more detailed Conditions.

New shares are issued at the option or conversion price to be set in accordance with the aforementioned resolution granting authorization.

Significant agreements which take effect, alter or terminate upon a change of control of the company following a takeover bid

As at the reporting date, the most important component in Brenntag's financing structure is the Group-wide loan agreement concluded with a consortium of international banks. The total loan volume is described in the section "Capital structure". The main conditions are laid down in a syndicated facilities agreement entered into in February 2023. Under this agreement, individual lenders have the right to terminate the agreement if any person or group of persons acting in concert acquire directly or indirectly more than 50% of the shares issued or the voting rights in Brenntag SE. The right to terminate in the event of a change of control is preceded by a 30-day negotiating period on the continuation of the loan agreements. If the parties involved cannot reach agreement on the continuation of the loan agreements in this period, each lender can within ten days terminate his involvement as a lender in the agreement by giving notice of at least another 30 days and request payment of the outstanding loan amounts.

Section 5 of the conditions of issue relating to the Bond 2025 in the amount of EUR 600.0 million issued by Brenntag Finance B.V. in September 2017 also contained provisions governing a change of control, under which bondholders could request that the bond be repaid early if the rating were downgraded within a certain period of a change of control (in each case as defined in the conditions of issue).

Furthermore, section 5 of the conditions of issue relating to the Bond 2029 in the amount of EUR 500.0 million placed by Brenntag Finance B.V. in September 2021 and paid out in October 2021 (first issue under the newly established debt issuance program) also contains a provision governing a change of control, under which bondholders may likewise request that the bond be repaid early if the rating is downgraded within a certain period of a change of control (in each case as defined in the conditions of issue).

Section 5 of the loan agreement relating to the promissory note transaction placed by Brenntag SE in August 2022 for around EUR 640 million also contains provisions governing a change of control. In this case too, the lenders may request that the notes be repaid early if the rating is downgraded within a certain period of a change of control (as defined in the loan agreement).

The conditions of issue relating to the Bonds 2028 and 2032 placed by Brenntag Finance B.V. in April 2024, in each case in the amount of EUR 500.0 million, also contain the same provision governing a request for early repayment in the event of a change of control and a rating downgrade. In addition, the lenders may request early repayment if there is a change in the ownership structure (as defined in the conditions of issue) of a division of Brenntag SE as a result of an M&A transaction, a stock market flotation or a transaction with a similar effect. For this, the division or a part of it must make up at least 20% of the Brenntag Group's consolidated operating gross profit. For this right to be exercised, the rating must also be downgraded as a result (as defined in the conditions of issue).

Section 5 of the conditions of issue relating to the Bond 2031 in the amount of EUR 600.0 million issued by Brenntag Finance B.V. in October 2025 also contains provisions governing a change of control, under which bondholders may request that the bond be repaid early if the rating is downgraded within a certain period of a change of control (in each case as defined in the conditions of issue).

Compensation agreements with members of the Board of Management or employees in the event of a takeover bid

There are no compensation agreements with members of the Board of Management or employees in the event of a takeover bid.

Corporate governance statement

Brenntag has always attached great importance to good corporate governance. As a globally operating DAX 40-listed company, we are particularly aware of our responsibility and our obligations in this area. The Board of Management and Supervisory Board jointly issue the corporate governance statement pursuant to Sections 289f and 315d of the German Commercial Code (HGB) and report on the principles of responsible corporate governance at Brenntag, each being responsible for the parts of the report that relate to them. In accordance with Principle 23 of the German Corporate Governance Code in its current version of April 28, 2022, the corporate governance statement is the central instrument of corporate governance reporting.

Corporate governance

Commitment to responsible corporate governance

As in previous years, in this reporting period the Board of Management and the Supervisory Board thoroughly examined corporate governance and the requirements of the German Corporate Governance Code ("GCGC"). On the basis of these deliberations, they issued, on December 10, 2025, the following declaration of conformity with the recommendations of the GCGC of April 28, 2022:

"Declaration of Conformity by the Board of Management and Supervisory Board of Brenntag SE in accordance with Article 9, para. 1, lit. c) ii) SE-VO in conjunction with Section 161 of the German Stock Corporation Act (Aktiengesetz)

The Board of Management and Supervisory Board of Brenntag SE are obliged to resolve a Declaration of Conformity in accordance with Article 9, para. 1, lit. c) ii) SE-VO in conjunction with Section 161 of the German Stock Corporation Act. This declaration was last resolved on December 17, 2024. The Board of Management and Supervisory Board declare that since the last declaration was resolved, all recommendations of the Government Commission on the German Corporate Governance Code in the version dated April 28, 2022 (GCGC 2022) published by the Federal Ministry of Justice in the official section of the Federal Gazette have been complied with and that the recommendations of the GCGC 2022 will continue to be complied with in the future."

Declaration on the suggestions made in the GCGC

Brenntag complies with all suggestions made in the GCGC 2022.

Brenntag publishes an overview of implementation of the GCGC's suggestions on its corporate website at <https://corporate.brenntag.com/en/about/corporate-governance/corporate-governance-code/>.

Disclosures on corporate governance practice

In line with responsible, prudent and sustainability-focused corporate governance, Brenntag aims to observe legal requirements and voluntary internal codes of conduct (compliance) so it always acts honestly and fairly. To ensure this, the management makes use of various internal control and risk management systems. Furthermore, a compliance organization has been established in the company. Every Brenntag employee is personally responsible for complying with all applicable laws, directives, policies and regulations. The information on corporate governance practice is also published on the website at <https://corporate.brenntag.com/en/about/compliance/>.

Compliance management and organization: The compliance organization of Brenntag SE is headed by the Board of Management and, within the Board, by the Chairman. The Senior Vice President (SVP) Compliance Brenntag Group of Brenntag SE provides the Board of Management and the Supervisory Board with information on compliance matters every quarter. Reports on compliance and whistleblowing cases and the development of the Group-wide compliance management system are also given in the regular Audit and Compliance Committee meetings of the Supervisory Board. The compliance management system will continue to be developed in 2026 to keep it in line with the organizational developments in the company. Regional compliance managers ensure coordination of the compliance management system at regional level. They are supported in their work by local compliance contacts. The regional compliance managers are responsible for implementing the compliance management system in their respective regions and are the people to contact with regard to compliance matters in their region.

They regularly exchange information and experience with SVP Compliance Brenntag Group. This ensures the close networking of compliance management with Brenntag's business activities at global, regional and local levels.

Code of conduct and company guidelines: As a global company, Brenntag is subject to a large number of laws, directives, regulations and ordinances. In addition to compliance with rules and regulations, honesty and integrity are a particular priority at Brenntag. A comprehensive Code of Business Conduct and Ethics summarizes all fundamental company values, ethical principles, compliance with laws, rules and regulations as well as the relevant guidelines and procedures which are of key significance for Brenntag and its reputation. The Code of Business Conduct and Ethics contains in particular the standards and rules Brenntag applies in the areas of health, safety and the environment, human rights and working conditions, dealings with business partners and public institutions, combating bribery and corruption, competition and antitrust law, avoidance of conflicts of interest as well as data privacy and information security. The Code of Business Conduct and Ethics has been published both on the external website of the Brenntag Group and on the Intranet and is available in various languages. It applies to all employees at all levels of the company. Its aim is to give guidance in the legal and ethical challenges of their daily work and to encourage correct and compliant conduct. Every infringement of this code of conduct may lead to disciplinary action and have further consequences under employment law and even criminal law for employees committing an infringement. In addition to the Code of Business Conduct and Ethics, there are further Group guidelines detailing compliance requirements, such as the Anti-corruption Guideline and the Corporate Guideline on Foreign Trade Compliance. In addition to the Code of Business Conduct and Ethics, all Group-wide guidelines can be accessed by all employees on the Group-wide Intranet.

Monitoring: The compliance processes and their implementation are regularly monitored both centrally and decentrally, in particular by the compliance organization. Appropriate measures are developed and implemented to counteract any weaknesses that are identified. Internal Audit Brenntag Group regularly reviews the internal control and compliance management system of the Brenntag Group companies. If weaknesses regarding compliance are identified during the audits, the Compliance department is informed accordingly. Compliance develops and implements measures to eliminate the weaknesses and further develop the compliance management system.

Training: Adherence to the Code of Conduct, the antitrust requirements as well as the prevention of corruption are particular focal points of the compliance program. Brenntag employees receive regular training on these topics – either at in-person events or through e-learning systems worldwide. The aim is to keep all employees' knowledge up to date, avoid any illegal actions as well as to protect the environment and employees from harm. Regular participation in compliance training, in particular on the Code of Business Conduct and Ethics, is mandatory for employees. In addition, there are in-depth compliance training courses at global, regional and local levels, particularly on the topics of bribery and corruption, fraud prevention, antitrust law and data privacy. In the reporting period, the members of the Board of Management were regularly updated personally on relevant compliance topics, in particular in relation to the Code of Conduct and anti-corruption.¹⁾

Whistleblowing: Brenntag has set up procedures for receiving and handling internal and external complaints and reports of compliance issues throughout the Group. Employees can either make such reports to their direct supervisor or the regional compliance manager, or alternatively submit them through central or regional whistleblowing channels and whistleblowing systems. It is also possible to make an anonymous report using the whistleblowing system in particular. Persons outside the company can submit complaints and report infringements by using the whistleblowing channel on the website of Brenntag SE. The information received is always treated in strict confidence. Any reports received are reviewed internally and at the meetings of the Audit and Compliance Committee. Appropriate counteraction is taken if a compliance infringement has occurred.

¹⁾ The disclosures in this paragraph are disclosures required by ESRS 2 (GOV-1 – The role of the administrative, management and supervisory bodies) as specified in the preamble to this management report.

Embedding sustainability in corporate governance: Sustainability is of key importance to the corporate strategy of the Brenntag Group and is firmly anchored in the organizational and management system. The Supervisory Board of Brenntag SE has set up a separate Transformation and ESG Committee to oversee implementation and pursuance of the corporate and sustainability strategies, including the sustainability targets, at the highest corporate level. The Board of Management of Brenntag SE makes all strategic decisions regarding sustainability topics. In the reporting period, a particular focus was on the impacts, risks and opportunities related to climate change, environmental pollution, occupational health and safety, and workers in the value chain. Potentially conflicting targets were appropriately taken into account. The Sustainability Council was established in 2022 to advise and support the Board of Management. The Sustainability Council is made up of members of the Global Leadership Team from different departments, regions and functions and is chaired by the CEO. It met four times in the reporting period and focused particularly on the carbon management system, the ESG framework and the current status of progress in achieving the annual targets through an internal ESG scorecard. These elements are used to monitor impacts, risks and opportunities. Appropriate measures are discussed and initiated if there is a possibility that the targets will not be met. The ESG scorecard is also submitted quarterly to the Board of Management and the Transformation and ESG Committee for monitoring purposes. The Sustainability Brenntag Group department, headed by the Vice President Sustainability, supports the CEO in driving forward and implementing the sustainability strategy. It manages sustainability topics throughout the Group. The department works closely with the sustainability teams of the two divisions, Brenntag Specialties and Brenntag Essentials. Both divisions have set up their own sustainability teams. A Sustainability Community was established in the Brenntag Group in July 2024 to further promote and raise awareness of sustainability topics. Here, representatives from different departments, divisions, regions and functions can find out about current topics and projects and get involved. In order to strengthen our sustainability management structure and further consolidate corporate governance, Brenntag has made progress in integrating sustainability even more strongly as a central element in decision-making processes and daily business operations. In

line with the goal of increasing the number of managers with ESG-related targets by 2027, cross-unit workshops were held during the reporting period to systematically review existing ESG targets. In addition, the goal of integrating a sustainability organization into the operational structure by 2027 was advanced by introducing sustainability engineer roles in EMEA and North America. These roles provide technical expertise to support the CERO project, which focuses on decarbonizing Brenntag's fleet of vehicles and warehouse operations.¹⁾

Working practices of the Board of Management and Supervisory Board as well as the composition and working practices of their committees: Brenntag SE has a two-tier management system consisting of the Board of Management and the Supervisory Board in accordance with the legal requirements of Article 9, para. 1, number (c) (ii) of Regulation (EC) no. 2157/2001 on the Statute for a European company (SE) ("SE Regulation") and the German Stock Corporation Act. The management of business by the Board of Management and supervision of the Board of Management by the Supervisory Board are therefore clearly separated. The Board of Management and the Supervisory Board are guided by the applicable legislation, the principles of the GCGC 2022, the company's Articles of Association as well as their respective rules of procedure. The working practices of both bodies are geared to responsible corporate governance, which is characterized by open discussions and transparency.

¹⁾ The disclosures in this paragraph are disclosures required by ESRS 2 (GOV-1 - The role of the administrative, management and supervisory bodies and GOV-2 - Information provided to and sustainability matters addressed by Brenntag's administrative, management and supervisory bodies) as specified in the preamble to this management report.

Our Board of Management



Jens Birgersson
Chief Executive Officer
Chairman of the Board of Management



Thomas Reisten
Chief Financial Officer

Board of Management

Since December 1, 2025, the Board of Management of Brenntag SE has consisted of two members: the Chairman of the Board of Management (CEO) of Brenntag SE, Jens Birgersson, and the Chief Financial Officer (CFO) of Brenntag SE, Thomas Reisten.¹⁾

In accordance with the GCGC 2022, Thomas Reisten was appointed with effect from April 1, 2025, initially for a period of three years. He succeeded Dr. Kristin Neumann, who decided for personal reasons not to extend her contract, which ended on March 31, 2025.

Dr. Christian Kohlpaintner also informed the Supervisory Board at an early juncture that he would not be extending his contract, which ended on December 31, 2025. Also in accordance with the GCGC 2022, the Supervisory Board appointed Jens Birgersson as the new Chairman of the Board of Management (CEO) of Brenntag SE with effect from September 1, 2025, initially for a period of three years.

Ewout van Jarwaarde, CEO Brenntag Essentials, had been a member of the Board of Management of Brenntag SE since January 2021. He left the Board of Management with effect from September 8, 2025. Furthermore, Michael Friede, CEO of Brenntag Specialties and member of the Board of Management of Brenntag SE decided not to extend his contract. He left the company with effect from November 30, 2025.

Further information on the members of the Board of Management can be found on the website at <https://corporate.brenntag.com/en/about/corporate-governance/board-of-management/>. Information on the remuneration of the Board of Management can be found in the Remuneration Report.

¹⁾ The disclosures in this paragraph are disclosures required by ESRS 2 (GOV-1 – The role of the administrative, management and supervisory bodies) as specified in the preamble to this management report.

Members of the Board of Management

The members of the Board of Management hold the following offices on statutory supervisory boards and comparable supervisory bodies of business enterprises.

	Jens Birgersson	Thomas Reisten
Position	CEO	CFO
First appointed	September 1, 2025	April 1, 2025
Responsibilities	- Brenntag Essentials - Brenntag Specialties - Corporate Board Office - Corporate Planning, Strategy & M&A Brenntag Group - Global Communications - Global Human Resources - Global Marketing - Internal Audit Brenntag Group - QSHE Brenntag Group - Sustainability Brenntag Group	- Accounting Brenntag Group and Corporate ICS & Risk Management - Corporate Investor Relations - Controlling - Compliance, Privacy & Data Protection Brenntag Group - Digital, Data and Technology - Finance Brenntag Group - Legal Brenntag Group - Shared Services Brenntag Group - Tax Brenntag Group - Treasury and Insurance Management Brenntag Group
External positions		
Group company positions		

2.17 Position and membership of statutory supervisory boards and comparable German and foreign supervisory bodies of business enterprises

Working practices of the Board of Management

The Board of Management is responsible for managing the company with the aim of creating sustainable value. It develops the company's strategy, taking due account of the environmental and social impacts of the company's activities.¹⁾ The members of the Board of Management bear joint responsibility for the entire management of the company's business. They work together in a spirit of collective responsibility and keep one another informed about all significant business transactions and other important transactions and measures adopted in their respective areas of responsibility. Notwithstanding the joint responsibility of all Board of Management members for the conduct of Brenntag SE's business, each Board member is individually responsible for the areas assigned to him under the business responsibility plan or through other resolutions of the Board of Management.

The Board of Management manages the business of Brenntag SE independently. In doing so, it must act in the company's best interest, and therefore in the interest of the shareholders, employees and other stakeholders. The Board of Management operates in accordance with the applicable laws and the provisions of the individual service agreements of its members as well as the company's Articles of Association, its rules of procedure and the business responsibility plan. The Board of Management has set up a sustainable risk management and risk monitoring system that also covers sustainability goals and includes processes and systems for collecting and processing sustainability-related data.²⁾ Furthermore, the Board of Management develops the strategy of the Brenntag Group in cooperation with the Supervisory Board and discusses the current status of its implementation with the Supervisory Board at regular intervals.

Board of Management meetings are to take place every two weeks but at least once a month. The Board of Management has a quorum if all its members have received invitations to the meeting and at least half of its members participate in adopting resolutions. Resolutions may be adopted outside meetings either by circulating the documents or in another form, for example by video conference. The Board of Management must do everything in its power to ensure that its resolutions are adopted unanimously. Insofar as other majorities are not prescribed by law or by the Articles of Association of Brenntag SE, the Board of Management is to adopt resolutions with a simple majority of the members of the Board participating in the vote. In the event of a tie, the Chair of the Board of Management has a second vote.

The Board of Management has currently not set up any committees.³⁾ The transactions for which a resolution adopted by the Board of Management is required by law, the Articles of Association or the rules of procedure for the Board of Management of Brenntag SE include but are not limited to the following measures:

- Board of Management's reports to the Supervisory Board,
- fundamental organizational measures, such as the conclusion of company agreements, transformation measures within the meaning of the German Transformation of Companies Act or acquisitions, carve-outs or the sale of material parts of the company as well as strategy and business planning issues,
- measures related to the implementation and controlling of a monitoring system,
- issuance of the declaration of conformity with the German Corporate Governance Code,
- preparation of the annual financial statements and the management report,
- convening of the Annual General Meeting as well as the Board of Management's requests and proposals for resolutions to be dealt with and voted on at the Annual General Meeting,
- matters with respect to which the Chair of the Board of Management or any two members have requested a resolution by the Board of Management.

Furthermore, internal guidelines applicable throughout the Group have been implemented which also require a resolution passed by the entire Board of Management or by individual members of the Board of Management for certain matters.

The Board of Management must regularly inform the Supervisory Board, in due time and comprehensively, of all issues of Brenntag SE and its subsidiaries with regard to strategy, corporate governance, the business policy it plans and other fundamental questions of corporate planning, the company's profitability, business performance and current position, risk management and compliance. The Board of Management addresses in particular any departures of business performance from the plans made or targets agreed, stating the reasons for such departures. In addition, the Board of Management requires the prior consent of the Supervisory Board for certain major matters which are described in detail in the section "Supervisory Board".

¹⁾ The disclosures in this paragraph are disclosures required by ESRs 2 (GOV-1 – The role of the administrative, management and supervisory bodies) as specified in the preamble to this management report.

²⁾ The disclosures in this paragraph are disclosures required by ESRs 2 (GOV-2 – Information provided to and sustainability matters addressed by Brenntag's administrative, management and supervisory bodies) as specified in the preamble to this management report.

³⁾ The disclosures in this paragraph are disclosures required by ESRs 2 (GOV-1 – The role of the administrative, management and supervisory bodies) as specified in the preamble to this management report.

Supervisory Board

Since the 2025 Annual General Meeting, at which it was decided to expand the Supervisory Board from six to eight members as proposed by the Supervisory Board, the Supervisory Board of Brenntag SE has consisted of eight members. There are no employee representatives on the Supervisory Board of Brenntag SE as the German One-Third Employee Participation Act (Drittelbeteiligungsgesetz) and the German Codetermination Act (Mitbestimmungsgesetz) are not applicable. The members of the Supervisory Board mentioned by name below are therefore all shareholders' representatives.¹⁾

Members of the Supervisory Board

The members of the Supervisory Board hold the following positions on statutory supervisory boards and comparable supervisory bodies of business enterprises.²⁾

¹⁾ The disclosures in this paragraph are disclosures required by ESRS 2 (GOV-1 – The role of the administrative, management and supervisory bodies) as specified in the preamble to this management report.

²⁾ The disclosures in this paragraph are disclosures required by ESRS 2 (GOV-1 – The role of the administrative, management and supervisory bodies) as specified in the preamble to this management report.

CORPORATE GOVERNANCE STATEMENT

	Richard Ridinger	Stefanie Berlinger
Position	Chair	Deputy Chair
Member from	June 10, 2020	June 9, 2015
Profession	Independent Management Consultant	Managing Director Lilja & Co. GmbH
Committee	– Nomination and Remuneration Committee – Transformation and ESG Committee	– Nomination and Remuneration Committee
Membership of statutory supervisory boards and comparable German and foreign supervisory bodies of business enterprises (as at December 31, 2025)	– DSM-Firmenich AG, Kaiseraugst, Switzerland (listed) (Non-executive Member of the Board of Directors) – Roar HoldCo AB, Stockholm, Sweden (not listed) (Non-executive Member and Chair of the Board of Directors) and – Recipharm AB, Stockholm, Sweden (Group company, shares held by Roar HoldCo AB, not listed) (Non-executive Member and Chair of the Board of Directors)	
	Sujatha Chandrasekaran	Dominik de Daniel
Position	Member	Member
Member from	June 15, 2023	May 22, 2025
Profession	Independent Management Consultant	Chief Executive Officer Kühne Holding AG
Committee	– Audit and Compliance Committee	– Audit and Compliance Committee
Membership of statutory supervisory boards and comparable German and foreign supervisory bodies of business enterprises (as at December 31, 2025)	– American Eagle Outfitters Inc., Pittsburgh, PA, U.S. (listed) (Non-executive Member of the Board of Directors) – Agendia Inc., Irvine, CA, U.S. (not listed) (Non-executive Member of the Board of Directors) – Atos SE, Bezons, France (listed) (Non-executive Member of the Board of Directors) – PandoAI, Chicago, Illinois, U.S. (not listed) (Non-executive Member of the Board of Directors) – Jabil Inc. St Petersburg, Florida, U.S. (listed) (Non-executive member of the Board of Directors)	– Flix SE, Munich, Germany (not listed) (Member of the Supervisory Board) – Aenova Holding GmbH, Starnberg, Germany (not listed) (Group company of Kühne Holding AG) (Chair of the Supervisory Board) – Kühne + Nagel International AG, Schindellegi, Switzerland (listed) (Group company of Kühne Holding AG) (Non-executive Member of the Board of Directors)

2.18a Membership of committees and statutory supervisory boards and comparable German and foreign supervisory bodies of business enterprises

CORPORATE GOVERNANCE STATEMENT

	Wijnand P. Donkers	Ulrich M. Harnacke
Position	Member	Member
Member from	June 8, 2017	June 8, 2017
Profession	Independent Management Consultant	Chartered Accountant and Independent Business Consultant
Committee	– Nomination and Remuneration Committee – Transformation and ESG Committee	– Audit and Compliance Committee – Transformation and ESG Committee
Membership of statutory supervisory boards and comparable German and foreign supervisory bodies of business enterprises (as at December 31, 2025)		– Zentis GmbH & Co. KG, Aachen, Germany (not listed) (Member of the Advisory Board)
	Karl von Rohr	Susanne Wiegand
Position	Member	Member
Member from	July 9, 2025	July 9, 2025
Profession	Lawyer, member of Company and Foundation Boards	Supervisory Board member and investor
Committee	– Nomination and Remuneration Committee	– Transformation and ESG Committee
Membership of statutory supervisory boards and comparable German and foreign supervisory bodies of business enterprises (as at December 31, 2025)	– DWS Group GmbH & Co. KGaA, Frankfurt am Main, Germany (listed) (Member of the Supervisory Board)	– BWI GmbH, Meckenheim, Germany (not listed) (Member of the Supervisory Board) – Volkswagen AG, Wolfsburg, Germany (listed) (Member of the Supervisory Board)

2.18b Membership of committees and statutory supervisory boards and comparable German and foreign supervisory bodies of business enterprises

Working practices of the Supervisory Board

As the second governing body of a stock corporation (Aktiengesellschaft), the Supervisory Board has the task of monitoring the management of the company by the Board of Management as well as advising the Board of Management on the management of the company. The Supervisory Board also appoints and dismisses the members of the Board of Management.¹⁾ The Supervisory Board bases the composition of the Board of Management on the company's strategy, the requirements of the recommendations of the Government Commission "German Corporate Governance Code" and on the internal diversity policy. The Supervisory Board regularly discusses the company's strategy with the Board of Management and the progress made in its implementation. Furthermore, the Board of Management regularly informs the Supervisory Board of all issues with regard to planning, business development, the risk situation and risk management of the company in compliance with Section 90 of the German Stock Corporation Act (AktG).

Furthermore, the prior consent of the Supervisory Board is required for some major Board of Management decisions, including the business responsibility plan of the Board of Management, major changes in the business strategy of the Brenntag Group, the acquisition or sale of major plots of land, companies or business operations, the conclusion of agreements in connection with the granting or raising of loans or the assumption of guarantees, the amount of which exceeds certain thresholds.

The Supervisory Board has adopted rules of procedure and, according to these rules, holds at least two meetings in the first two quarters and at least two meetings in the last two quarters of each calendar year. If necessary and on a case-by-case basis, additional meetings are held or circular resolutions are passed outside Supervisory Board meetings. The Supervisory Board has a quorum when at least three members participate in the voting. Insofar as other majorities are not prescribed by law, resolutions are passed by a simple majority. In the event of a tie, the Chair has the casting vote. He/she is also authorized to make any declarations on behalf of the Supervisory Board which are necessary to implement its resolutions.

The Supervisory Board members are in principle elected for a period up to the close of the Annual General Meeting which resolves on the formal discharge of the Supervisory Board for the fourth financial year after commencement of the respective term of office. The financial year in which the term of office starts is not counted for this purpose. The Annual General Meeting can determine a shorter term of office for the Supervisory Board members. Members of the Supervisory Board may be re-elected. All members of the Supervisory Board are bound by the company's best interests and must immediately inform the Supervisory Board of any conflicts of interest. In line with recommendation D. 11 of the GCGC 2022, new members of the Supervisory Board are given a comprehensive introduction to their office in a set onboarding process and already receive targeted information material prior to taking up office in order to prepare them for their work. The resignation of Supervisory Board members is accompanied by a structured offboarding process to ensure that data and documents are deleted or returned and access is blocked.

Brenntag SE also complies with recommendation D. 11 of the GCGC 2022 by providing the Supervisory Board with sufficient support during training and professional development measures. In 2025, the members of the Supervisory Board received training and professional development sessions specially tailored to their requirements. They attended conferences and specialized events, e.g. on artificial intelligence, current economic developments, corporate governance, sustainability and reporting, compliance and risk management. They were also actively involved in industry associations and networks, such as the German Audit Committee Network, the Financial Experts Association e.V. or Deutsche Schutzvereinigung für Wertpapierbesitz.²⁾

Information on the remuneration of the Supervisory Board members can be found in the section "Remuneration report"; this information can also be found on the website.

¹⁾ The disclosures in this paragraph are disclosures required by ESRS 2 (GOV-1 – The role of the administrative, management and supervisory bodies) as specified in the preamble to this management report.

²⁾ The disclosures in this paragraph are disclosures required by ESRS 2 (GOV-1 – The role of the administrative, management and supervisory bodies) and ESRS G1-3 (Prevention and detection of corruption and bribery) as specified in the preamble to this management report.

Good corporate governance also involves a regular assessment of how effectively the Supervisory Board as a body as a whole and its committees as such are fulfilling their duties. The Supervisory Board performs an assessment of its activities on a regular basis. In December 2024, the Supervisory Board conducted an evaluation with the support of an external consultant which focused on the meeting structure, internal coordination of the committees with the Supervisory Board and the profile of skills and expertise. To ensure that the qualification matrix is validated objectively, the external consultant also examined the classification of skills and expertise.¹⁾ The next self-assessment is scheduled for 2026.

The Supervisory Board has set up three committees, namely the Nomination and Remuneration Committee, the Audit and Compliance Committee, and the Transformation and ESG Committee. The members of the committees are appointed for the entire period of office as members of the Supervisory Board. Each chair reports regularly to the Supervisory Board on the committee's activities.

Nomination and Remuneration Committee

The Nomination and Remuneration Committee established by the Supervisory Board of Brenntag SE is made up of Karl von Rohr (Chair), Stephanie Berlinger and Richard Ridinger. The committee makes proposals regarding the appointment and removal of members of the Board of Management, the terms of the Board of Management service agreements within the framework of the remuneration system structure adopted by the Supervisory Board as well as any application to reduce the remuneration of a Board of Management member, and regularly provides the Supervisory Board with information for reviewing the remuneration system as a whole. It ensures long-term succession planning and sets the necessary qualifications of the Board of Management members. In this connection, the Nomination and Remuneration Committee works closely with the Board of Management. Furthermore, it prepares a diversity policy for the Board of Management and Supervisory Board. In addition, the Committee represents Brenntag SE vis-à-vis former members of the Board of Management in accordance with Section 112 of the German Stock Corporation Act, consents to sideline activities of Board of Management members in accordance with Section 88 of the German Stock Corporation Act and grants loans to the persons named in Sections 89 and 115 of the German Stock Corporation Act. In addition, the Committee approves contracts with Supervisory Board members in accordance with Section 114 of the German Stock Corporation Act and proposes suitable candidates as Supervisory Board members to the Annual General Meeting in case of the election of Supervisory Board members, taking into account the concrete objectives for the composition of the Supervisory Board and the profile of skills and expertise for the Supervisory Board as a whole.

Audit and Compliance Committee

The Supervisory Board of Brenntag SE has set up an Audit and Compliance Committee, which meets at least four times in each calendar year and in particular monitors the accounting process and the quality of the audit of the annual financial statements. The Audit and Compliance Committee has three members who were appointed by the Supervisory Board. The committee is made up of Ulrich Harnacke as its Chair, Dominik de Daniel and Sujatha Chandrasekaran. Thanks to the many years he has spent working as a chartered accountant and tax consultant, the Chair of the Audit and Compliance Committee, Ulrich Harnacke, has expertise in financial statement auditing and special knowledge and experience of applying accounting principles and internal control procedures. Furthermore, he is not a former member of the company's Board of Management. Dominik de Daniel has special expertise in the field of accounting, which he has acquired through his many years of experience as the CFO of various companies. The expertise of both also refers to sustainability reporting and auditing. Both qualify as finance experts within the meaning of Section 100, para. 5 German Stock Corporation Act and the recommendation D.3 of the GCGC. Sujatha Chandrasekaran has additional expertise in cybersecurity, data protection, enterprise risk management, compliance and artificial intelligence risk assessment. In addition, she has years of service on listed company boards of directors and on other listed company audit committees.

The Chair reports regularly to the Supervisory Board about the activities of the Committee. The Audit and Compliance Committee prepares the resolutions of the Supervisory Board on the auditing and adoption of the annual financial statements as well as the approval of the consolidated financial statements, the proposal for the appropriation of profit and the engagement to provide assurance on the Group sustainability statement. Furthermore, the Audit and Compliance Committee prepares the Supervisory Board's proposal to the Annual General Meeting on the election of the auditors for the statutory financial statements of Brenntag SE and consolidated financial statements and the auditors for the half-year and quarterly financial reports, insofar as the latter are audited or reviewed by auditors. For this purpose, the Audit and Compliance Committee pre-reviews the documentation relating to the consolidated and annual financial statements,

¹⁾ The disclosures in this paragraph are disclosures required by ESRS 2 (GOV-1 - The role of the administrative, management and supervisory bodies) as specified in the preamble to this management report.

the combined group management report and the management report, the Group sustainability statement within sustainability reporting as well as the proposal for the appropriation of profit. The Audit and Compliance Committee discusses the audit reports with the auditor. The Committee deals with accounting issues on behalf of the Supervisory Board, in particular the treatment of subjects of fundamental importance, such as the application of new accounting standards and the monitoring of the accounting process. It deals with half-year and quarterly financial reports or quarterly statements as well as their audit or review. Furthermore, it reviews the adequacy and effectiveness of the company's internal control system, risk management system and internal audit system.

The Committee also reviews observance of and compliance with the statutory provisions and internal company policies as well as compliance with the relevant rules of the German Corporate Governance Code. On behalf of the Supervisory Board, the Committee also monitors in particular the quality of the audit and the auditor's independence, including compliance with statutory requirements regarding the tendering process, proper awarding of non-audit services, compliance with the upper limit for permissible non-audit services and observance of requirements to rotate the statutory auditor. In addition, the Committee engages the auditor to conduct the audit of the annual and consolidated financial statements and, if necessary, a review of the half-year and quarterly financial reports. Furthermore, it discusses the scope and main points of the audit as well as cooperation between the statutory auditor and Internal Audit Brenntag Group and other departments involved in risk management. On behalf of the Supervisory Board, the Committee authorizes the auditor's fee. In addition, the Audit and Compliance Committee discusses the financial, investment and liquidity plans with the Board of Management, including the plans with respect to the observance of financial covenants and the adequacy of interest hedging for the Group as well as deviations of the actual development from targets previously reported. The

Audit and Compliance Committee is responsible for the receipt and handling of complaints by employees and third parties about the accounting, the internal company control system, risk management, the audit of the financial statements and other accounting-related issues (whistleblowing). The Audit and Compliance Committee may assume other tasks which the Supervisory Board assigns to it. It obtains regular reports about the work of the Corporate Internal Audit department, in particular about that department's audit focuses and audit findings. The same applies to risk management, the monitoring of compliance and cybersecurity.

Transformation and ESG Committee

The Supervisory Board has also set up a Transformation and ESG Committee. The Committee reports to the Supervisory Board and prepares the consultations and resolutions of the Supervisory Board in the fields of strategy and sustainability. To this end, it reviews and monitors the corporate strategy and the optimization of company structures and other transformations. It also reviews and monitors the sustainability and digitalization strategies. Wijnand Donkers chairs the Transformation and ESG Committee due to his proven experience and expertise in the fields of Environment, Social und Governance. The other members of the Transformation and ESG Committee are Richard Ridinger and Susanne Wiegand.¹⁾

Shares held by the Board of Management and Supervisory Board members

On December 31, 2025, no member of the Board of Management or the Supervisory Board held share packages of Brenntag SE or financial instruments relating to such shares, which in each case exceed 1% of the shares issued by Brenntag SE either directly or indirectly. At that date, the total number of shares held by all members of the Board of Management and Supervisory Board together also did not exceed 1% of the shares issued by the company.

¹⁾ The disclosures in this paragraph are disclosures required by ESRS 2 (GOV-1 – The role of the administrative, management and supervisory bodies) as specified in the preamble to this management report.

Avoidance of conflicts of interest on the Board of Management and the Supervisory Board

In the reporting period, there were no conflicts of interest of Board of Management or Supervisory Board members which are to be reported immediately to the Supervisory Board owing to the duty of loyalty to the company. Furthermore, as was also the case in the previous years, in the reporting period there were no advisory or other service agreements and contracts for work between a member of the Supervisory Board and the company or the other consolidated subsidiaries. No member of the Board of Management has accepted more than a total of three offices in non-Group listed companies or on supervisory bodies of non-Group entities that make similar requirements. A detailed list of the positions held by the members of the Supervisory Board on supervisory boards to be established by law or on comparable German and foreign supervisory bodies of business enterprises is given in the section "Members of the Supervisory Board".

Reportable securities transactions of Board of Management and Supervisory Board members

Pursuant to Section 26, para. 2 of the German Securities Trading Act (WpHG) in conjunction with Article 19 of the Regulation (EU) no. 596/2014, termed the Market Abuse Regulation, any persons working in a management capacity for an issuer of securities and any persons closely associated with persons named are obliged to report transactions involving shares of Brenntag SE or related financial instruments if the value of the transactions which they have made in one calendar year reaches or exceeds EUR 20,000. Transactions reported in financial year 2025 were duly published and are available on Brenntag's website at <https://corporate.brenntag.com/en/investor-relations/brenntag-share/managers-transactions/>. Transactions in previous reporting periods were also duly published and can also be accessed at any time on the website.

D&O insurance deductible

For details on the D&O insurance (Directors & Officers insurance, liability insurance against financial losses), we refer you to the information given in the section "Remuneration report".

Appropriate control and risk management

An effective control and risk management system is a prerequisite for the Board of Management and Supervisory Board of Brenntag SE to ensure that opportunities and risks arising from the business activities of Brenntag SE and its subsidiaries are handled appropriately. One particular focus remains the financial risks, in particular the liquidity and credit default risks. Systematic risk management enables potential uncertainties to be identified and assessed at an early stage and risk positions optimized. The Board of Management reports regularly to the Supervisory Board on any existing risks and their development. The Audit and Compliance Committee of the Supervisory Board is responsible for monitoring the accounting process, effectiveness and efficiency of the company's internal controls, risk management and the internal audit system. The Audit and Compliance Committee's work is described in detail in the previous section "Audit and Compliance Committee". Brenntag SE's control, risk management and audit systems are continually refined and regularly adapted to changing conditions. Details on the internal control and risk management system including the adequacy and effectiveness of the systems can be found in the section "Main elements of the internal control/risk management system" in the combined management report.

Transparency and equal treatment through comprehensive information

Brenntag SE aims to ensure that communications with the capital market are as transparent as possible and that all market participants are treated equally. Hereby, it is ensured that all market participants receive information continuously, promptly and comprehensively. For Brenntag SE, constant dialog with its shareholders and potential investors is a matter of course. Communications with the capital market are handled by the Board of Management and the Investor Relations team. The company maintained its dialog with capital market participants at a high level in 2025. An overview of the various activities in this area can be found in the section "Brenntag on the Stock Market". In addition, the Chair of the Supervisory Board is, if required, available to discuss specific topics that fall within the scope of the Supervisory Board. Brenntag SE regards corporate governance as an integral part of communications with the capital market and its investor relations activities. For example, in the reporting year Richard Ridinger regularly conducted talks with investors on corporate governance topics and personnel changes on the Board of Management.

In line with its transparent communications policy, Brenntag SE makes all material new information available to shareholders on its corporate website without delay, including, in particular, financial reports, investor presentations, financial news, ad-hoc news, the Articles of Association as well as details on the Annual General Meeting and the financial calendar. The financial calendar contains important event and publication dates and can also be found at the end of this annual report.

Shareholders and Annual General Meeting

The shareholders exercise their membership rights at the Annual General Meeting and, as shareholders, express the collective will of the company. As provided for by law and in the Articles of Association, the shareholders of Brenntag SE exercise their rights before or during the Annual General Meeting and, in this respect, may also exercise their voting rights. Each share of Brenntag SE carries one vote in the Annual General Meeting. The Annual General Meeting resolves, among other things, on the appropriation of profit, the discharge of the Board of Management and of the Supervisory Board and on the election of the auditor. As a rule, the Chair of the Supervisory Board presides over the Annual General Meeting. The Annual General Meeting takes place once a year. Shareholders who are registered with the share register of the company and whose application for attendance is received by the company in good time before the Annual General Meeting are entitled to participate in the Annual General Meeting and exercise their voting rights. Shareholders may exercise their right to vote at the Annual General Meeting either personally or through a representative of their choice, or by a company-appointed proxy acting on their instructions.

As was also the case in the previous year, shareholders were offered the option of exercising their right to vote at the 2025 Annual General Meeting in writing by electronic postal vote, without appointing a person to represent them. It is also planned to offer the option of electronic postal voting for the 2026 Annual General Meeting. To provide information for the shareholders, Brenntag SE posts the annual report on the past financial year on its website promptly after the Supervisory Board meeting at which the annual financial statements are adopted. As was also the case in the previous year, notice of the 2026 Annual General Meeting will be given at least 36 days before the date on which it is to be held. The invitation to attend will include a list of items on the agenda as well as an explanation of conditions for attendance and the rights of the shareholders. All documents and information on the forthcoming Annual General Meeting are also available in good time for downloading from the website of Brenntag SE. After the Annual General Meeting, Brenntag SE also publishes attendance and the results of votes on the Internet.

The Annual General Meeting, which took place on May 22, 2025, was held as a virtual annual general meeting without the physical presence of the shareholders. In accordance with the new provisions of the German Stock Corporation Act on virtual annual general meetings, shareholders connected electronically had the opportunity to speak by means of video communication. All questions were answered at the Annual General Meeting.

Accounting and financial statement auditing

The consolidated financial statements of Brenntag SE are prepared in accordance with the International Financial Reporting Standards (IFRSs), as adopted by the European Union. The financial statements of Brenntag SE, on which the dividend payment is based, are drawn up in accordance with the German Commercial Code and the German Stock Corporation Act. The single-entity and consolidated financial statements of Brenntag SE for financial year 2025 are being audited by Deloitte GmbH Wirtschaftsprüfungsgesellschaft. As for financial year 2024, the audits are being managed centrally by the Deloitte branch in Düsseldorf. The undersigned statutory auditors are André Bedenbecker (consolidated financial statements) and Christian Siepe (both for the single-entity and consolidated financial statements). The statutory requirements and the obligations to rotate pursuant to Sections 319 and 319a of the German Commercial Code (HGB) are met. For financial year 2025, it was again agreed with the statutory auditor that the Chair of the Audit and Compliance Committee would be informed immediately of any possible grounds for exclusion or bias arising during the audit insofar as they are not immediately eliminated, and that the auditor would report immediately on any findings or occurrences during the audit which have a significant bearing on the duties of the Supervisory Board. It was also agreed that the auditor would inform the Supervisory Board or make a note in the audit report of any facts ascertained during his examination that conflict with the declaration of conformity with the recommendations of the Government Commission "German Corporate Governance Code"; this declaration was issued by the Board of Management and Supervisory Board pursuant to Section 161 of the German Stock Corporation Act.

Information on targets for the percentage of women and diversity

In accordance with Section 111, para. 5 of the German Stock Corporation Act, Brenntag SE is required to set targets for the share of women on the Supervisory Board, Board of Management and, in accordance with Section 76, para. 4 of the German Stock Corporation Act, on the first two management levels below the Board of Management. The Supervisory Board set targets for the share of women in 2021. In each case, the deadline for implementing the target is January 31, 2026. It set the target for the share of women on the Supervisory Board at 33.3% and the target for the share of women on the Board of Management at 20%. For the Supervisory Board, this corresponds to two women; for the Board of Management one woman.

The Board of Management set targets for the share of women on the two management levels in the company below the Board of Management in February 2022. The Board of Management aimed to achieve a target of at least 30% for both levels by January 31, 2026. Taking into account the current structure and staffing of these management levels, a target of six women has been set for the first management level. A target of eight women has been set for the second management level.

In Sujatha Chandrasekaran, Stefanie Berlinger and Susanne Wiegand, the Supervisory Board has three female members so the share of women on the Supervisory Board was 37.5% in the reporting period and remains so. The Board of Management initially achieved its 20% target in 2025 as, in Dr. Kristin Neumann, a female member was represented on the Board. Following the departure of Dr. Kristin Neumann, Ewout van Jarwaarde and Michael Friede during the course of the year, the Board of Management was reorganized and reduced to two members. The restructured two-member Board of Management consists of Jens Birgersson and Thomas Reisten and is therefore 100% male.¹⁾

As at December 31, 2025 the percentage of women on the first management level below the Board of Management was 36.4%, which corresponds to four women. The share of women on the second management level below the Board of Management was 30.2%, which corresponds to 13 women.

In January 2026, the Board of Management and Supervisory Board of Brenntag SE set new targets for increasing the proportion of women in management positions. By January 31, 2031, four women are to be represented on the first management level below the Board of Management and 13 women on the second management level. For the Board of Management, it was decided that at least one member of the Board of Management should be female by January 31, 2031 at the latest. In addition, a target of three female members out of a total of eight seats was set for the Supervisory Board.

Apart from Brenntag SE, Brenntag GmbH is the only Group company pursuant to Section 36 and Section 52 of the German Limited Liability Companies Act (GmbHG) required to set targets for the percentage of women on the Supervisory Board, in the managing director team and on the two management levels below the managing directors. Brenntag GmbH is not required to disclose a management report because it has applied the exemption provisions pursuant to Section 264, para. 3 HGB. In accordance with Section 289a, para. 4, sentence 2 in conjunction with para. 1, sentence 2 HGB, Brenntag GmbH publishes its declaration with the specifications and disclosures in accordance with Section 289a, para. 2, no. 4 HGB on its website at <https://www.brenntag.com/en-de/compliance/proportion-of-women-in-management-positions/>.

¹⁾ The disclosures in this paragraph are disclosures required by ESRS 2 (GOV-1 – The role of the administrative, management and supervisory bodies) as specified in the preamble to this management report.

Information on the diversity policy

With respect to the composition of the Board of Management and Supervisory Board, Brenntag has a diversity policy in place that is designed to ensure diversity with regard to age, gender, training, educational and professional background as well as experience gained abroad. Brenntag promotes an informal and open-minded work culture with the greatest possible diversity ("Explore variety"). The diversity policy for the Board of Management and the Supervisory Board ensures that this approach is also reflected in these bodies. Brenntag is convinced that a holistic approach to diversity will strengthen the company in the long term by taking into account different perspectives, experiences and backgrounds, and it will create added value for Brenntag's customers and suppliers as well as its employees.

Diversity policy for the Board of Management

The diversity policy for the Board of Management is based on a holistic approach to ensure successful, long-term succession planning:

- The age limit for membership of the Board of Management is 65.
- The aim is to achieve the target and timeframe set for the percentage of women on the Board of Management. The target set for the proportion of women on the Board of Management is that by January 31, 2031 at least one woman will be a member of the Board of Management.
- The Board of Management members shall collectively have particularly extensive experience gained abroad.
- The Board of Management members must collectively have multiple years of management experience.¹⁾
- The Board of Management members must collectively be familiar with the field of chemical distribution. At least one Board of Management member shall have special knowledge or professional experience in the chemical industry or the distribution sector.²⁾
- At least one Board of Management member shall have demonstrated knowledge of financial reporting and accounting.³⁾

The Supervisory Board takes these requirements into consideration when appointing new Board of Management members. Together with the Board of Management, the Supervisory Board ensures long-term succession planning that is geared to the company's interests. Alongside the diversity policy, long-term succession planning takes into account the requirements of the German Stock Corporation Act, the German Corporate Governance Code, the Supervisory Board's rules of procedure and the targets for the percentage of women on the Board of Management set by the Supervisory Board. Internal and external candidates for Board of Management positions are discussed on a regular basis. For this purpose, potential candidates are divided into the categories immediate, medium-term and long-term succession candidates. Furthermore, the Chair of the Board of Management regularly reports to the Nomination and Remuneration Committee on any developments regarding the members of the internal talent pool. If necessary, external consultants provide support in identifying suitable external succession candidates.

The Nomination and Remuneration Committee took account of the above-mentioned criteria in appointing the new member of the Board of Management effective April 1, 2025. With the appointment of Thomas Reisten as the successor of Dr. Kristin Neumann, a male candidate was chosen as the new CFO. The decision made during the selection process was based both on the specific profile requirements for this position and on the pool of candidates available.

Brenntag firmly believes that gender diversity in management positions contributes significantly to the company's success and remains committed to achieving gender representation on the Board of Management in line with the targets it has set itself.

¹⁾ The disclosures in this paragraph are disclosures required by ESRS 2 (GOV-1 - The role of the administrative, management and supervisory bodies) as specified in the preamble to this management report.

²⁾ The disclosures in this paragraph are disclosures required by ESRS 2 (GOV-1 - The role of the administrative, management and supervisory bodies) as specified in the preamble to this management report.

³⁾ The disclosures in this paragraph are disclosures required by ESRS 2 (GOV-1 - The role of the administrative, management and supervisory bodies) as specified in the preamble to this management report.

Diversity policy for the Supervisory Board / Targets for its composition / Profile of skills and expertise

The composition of the Supervisory Board shall ensure that it can effectively monitor and advise the Board of Management and can perform its duties prescribed by law and by the Articles of Association in the best-possible way. The Supervisory Board's diversity policy follows the following requirements with regard to its composition:

- No member of the Supervisory Board shall continue to hold office beyond the close of the Annual General Meeting following his / her 70th birthday. Moreover, election proposals by the Supervisory Board shall consider that the members of the Supervisory Board shall generally not serve on the Supervisory Board for more than twelve years.
- At least three of the eight seats on the Supervisory Board shall be filled by women by January 31, 2031.
- At least 50% of the members of the Supervisory Board shall have particularly extensive experience gained abroad. This requirement for extensive expertise gained abroad is met if the respective member had regular employment abroad for at least 18 months or worked in an international working environment for more than five years.
- The Supervisory Board shall take account of the different educational and / or professional backgrounds of its members, giving due consideration to their knowledge, skills and experience when describing the goals for the composition of the Supervisory Board.

The current composition of the Supervisory Board satisfies all aspects of the diversity policy.

In addition to the diversity policy, the Supervisory Board has defined specific goals for its composition as a whole and taken qualitative criteria on company-specific requirements into account:

- The Supervisory Board shall collectively have suitable knowledge, skills and experience in the following areas:
 - corporate governance, compliance and risk management,
 - the chemical industry, distribution, supply chain management and B2B services,
 - strategy, portfolio management and M&A
 - change management and HR,
 - the fields of accounting and financial reporting (in accordance with Section 100, para. 5 of the German Stock Corporation Act),
 - capital markets,
 - digital transformation and IT,
 - ESG, sustainability, CSR and security.¹⁾
- The Supervisory Board shall collectively have experience abroad.
- The Supervisory Board shall – in its own estimation – have an adequate number of independent members, more than half of the members being independent. When assessing independence, the Supervisory Board shall take all aspects mentioned in C.6 and C.7 of the German Corporate Governance Code into account.
- The Supervisory Board shall ensure that all Supervisory Board members have sufficient time to perform their duties.
- The Supervisory Board takes all aspects of the diversity policy into account as goals for the composition of the Supervisory Board.

¹⁾ The disclosures in this paragraph are disclosures required by ESRS 2 (GOV-1 – The role of the administrative, management and supervisory bodies) as specified in the preamble to this management report.

CORPORATE GOVERNANCE STATEMENT

The profile of skills and expertise for the entire Board specifies the skills, expertise and experience considered important by the Supervisory Board and sets the specific requirements, in particular with regard to educational and professional background:

- The members of the Supervisory Board in the aggregate shall have several years of executive leadership and CEO experience.
- The members of the Supervisory Board in the aggregate shall be familiar with the chemical distribution sector. At least one member of the Supervisory Board shall have educational or professional expertise in the chemical industry or the distribution sector.
- At least one member of the Supervisory Board shall have expertise in the field of accounting and at least one other Supervisory Board member shall have expertise in the field of auditing.
- At least one member of the Supervisory Board shall be familiar with digital transformation and / or IT.
- At least one member of the Supervisory Board shall be familiar with sustainability, in particular ESG.

The Supervisory Board aims to continually improve its composition so as to meet the needs of the company and new business developments and ensure a composition suitable for the effective supervision and monitoring of the company, taking into account management experience and specific expertise in various fields such as accounting, auditing, digitalization and sustainability.

The Supervisory Board pursues these objectives and the implementation of the diversity policy as a whole in its proposals to the Annual General Meeting for the election of Supervisory Board members, last for the re-election of Stephanie Berlinger and the election of Dominik de Daniel, Karl von Rohr and Susanne Wiegand at the 2025 Annual General Meeting.

The current composition of the Supervisory Board is in line with its self-imposed objectives and the profile of skills and expertise. The members of the Supervisory Board of Brenntag SE have been chosen for their professional qualifications, their knowledge and their particular experience. The members of the Supervisory Board as a whole are familiar with the business sector in which Brenntag operates and have the required experience.

	Stefanie Berlinger	Sujatha Chandrasekaran	Wijnand P. Donkers	Ulrich M. Harnacke	Dominik de Daniel	Richard Ridinger	Karl von Rohr	Susanne Wiegand
Elected	June 2015	June 2023	June 2017	June 2017	May 2025	June 2020	May 2025	May 2025
Independence (in accordance with GCGC)	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
No overboarding (in accordance with GCGC)	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Gender	Female	Female	Male	Male	Male	Male	Male	Female
Year of birth	1973	1967	1962	1957	1975	1958	1965	1972
Nationality	German	American, Australian, Indian	Dutch	German	Swiss, German	German	German	German
International expertise	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Profession	Business economist	Electrical Engineer Software and Data Engineer	Business economist	Business economist	Business economist	Chemical Engineer	Lawyer	Business economist

2.19 Composition of the Supervisory Board

CORPORATE GOVERNANCE STATEMENT

Expert Qualification	Stefanie Berlinger	Sujatha Chandrasekaran	Wijnand P. Donkers	Ulrich M. Harnacke	Dominik de Daniel	Richard Ridinger	Karl von Rohr	Susanne Wiegand
Safety / ESG / Corporate Social Responsibility / ESG Expertise relevant to Brenntag Group	☒	☒	☒	☒	☐	☒	☒	☐
Management / C-Level experience	☐	☒	☒	☒	☒	☒	☒	☒
Corporate Governance / Compliance	☒	☒	☒	☒	☒	☒	☒	☒
Chemical industry	☐	☐	☒	☐	☐	☒	☐	☐
Distribution / Supply Chain Management / B2B Services industry	☒	☒	☒	☒	☒	☒	☐	☒
Strategy / Portfolio Management / M&A	☒	☒	☒	☒	☒	☒	☒	☒
Change Management / HR	☐	☒	☒	☒	☒	☒	☒	☒
Financial Expert: (in accordance with Section 100, para. 5 AktG)	☒	☐	☐	☒	☒	☐	☐	☒
Capital Markets	☒	☒	☒	☒	☒	☒	☒	☒
Digital transformation / IT	☐	☒	☒	☐	☒	☒	☒	☐

2.20 Qualification matrix and profile of skills and expertise of the Supervisory Board

An overview of the current qualifications and expertise of the Supervisory Board members is published on our website at <https://corporate.brenntag.com/en/about/corporate-governance/supervisory-board/>.

Independence

In the Supervisory Board's opinion, a suitable number of independent members is at least three. The Supervisory Board believes that all current members are to be regarded as independent as defined by the GCGC so the share of independent members is 100%.¹⁾

Further information on the members of the Supervisory Board can be found on the website at <https://corporate.brenntag.com/en/about/corporate-governance/supervisory-board/>.

¹⁾ The disclosures in this paragraph are disclosures required by ESRS 2 (GOV-1 – The role of the administrative, management and supervisory bodies) as specified in the preamble to this management report.

Group sustainability statement

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General disclosures

About this Group sustainability statement

General basis for preparation of the Group sustainability statement

ESRS 2 BP-1, ESRS 2 BP-2

This Group sustainability statement for the 2025 reporting period (January 1, 2025 to December 31, 2025) informs Brenntag's stakeholders about its sustainability activities. It was prepared on a consolidated basis, with the scope of consolidation the same as for the financial reporting. It incorporates both Brenntag SE, which is included in the consolidated financial statements, and the consolidated subsidiaries, which are also included along with structured entities. No subsidiary was excluded from the scope of consolidation.

The Group sustainability statement was prepared in accordance with Sections 289c to 289e in conjunction with Section 315c of the German Commercial Code (HGB) and meets both the legal requirements of the HGB and the statutory provisions under Article 8 of Regulation (EU) 2020/852 of the European Parliament and of the Council of 18 June 2020 on the establishment of a framework to facilitate sustainable investment, and amending Regulation (EU) 2019/2088 (EU Taxonomy Regulation). The non-financial reporting is prepared by fully and voluntarily applying the first set of European Sustainability Reporting Standards (ESRS) as a framework in accordance with Section 289d of the HGB. In this regard, Brenntag refers to the opinion set out in the answer to question ID 1090 of the EFRAG ESRS Q&A Platform – Compilation of Explanations (November 2024) that voluntary early publication does not affect the phase-in requirement periods granted by ESRS 1.

In this context, the following table illustrates how the mandatory aspects listed in Section 289c, para. 2 in conjunction with para. 3 of the HGB are fulfilled in the reporting prepared in accordance with ESRS as the applicable framework. Further information on the identification of material topics can be found in the section "Double materiality assessment".

Social matters were identified as being not material to Brenntag within the meaning of the law and were therefore not included in the Group sustainability statement applying a global policy. However, Brenntag reports on local social activities outside the annual report on the corporate website and on social media.¹⁾

Aspects	Topics according to ESRS
Environmental matters	E1 – Climate change E2 – Pollution E3 – Water E5 – Resource use and circular economy
Employee matters	S1 – Own workforce
Social matters	Non-material (according to ESRS)
Respect for human rights	S1 – Own employees S2 – Workers in the value chain
Anti-corruption and bribery matters	G1 – Business conduct

2.21 Material topics pursuant to Section 289c, para. 2 in conjunction with para. 3 of the HGB

Incorporation by reference

In this Group sustainability statement, Brenntag publishes the content required to be reported and refers to other parts of Brenntag's Annual Report 2025 for further disclosures. To enhance understanding, some information is not reported in this section, but can instead be found in other parts of the management report, such as the section "Group overview", the "Report on expected developments, opportunities and risks" or the "Corporate governance statement". A detailed overview can be found in the Appendix. No information corresponding to intellectual property, know-how or the results of innovation is omitted. Neither is use made of the exemptions in connection with Directive 2013/34/EU (Accounting Directive).

Value chain analysis

In identifying and presenting material impacts, risks and opportunities, Brenntag considered both its own operations and the Group's upstream and downstream value chain. Matters that relate solely to its own operations are expressly disclosed. Policies, actions and targets include the upstream and downstream value chain, depending on topical relevance.

A description of Brenntag's value chain can be found in the section "Business model and value chain" below and in the section of the management report entitled "Business activities and Group structure".

¹⁾ Information outside the management report is not part of the limited assurance engagement.

External assurance

Brenntag's consolidated Group sustainability statement, including all metrics, was subjected to a limited assurance audit by Deloitte GmbH Wirtschaftsprüfungsgesellschaft (Deloitte). The Practitioner's Report can be found in the relevant section of the Appendix. Unless stated otherwise, no metrics are validated by other external bodies.

Disclosures in relation to specific circumstances[ESRS 2 BP-2](#)**Time horizons considered**

The reporting is based on short-, medium- and long-term time horizons that Brenntag has defined and applied in accordance with ESRS 1, paragraph 6.4. Unless stated otherwise, in line with Brenntag's financial reporting, short-term matters relate to a time horizon of one year. The medium-term time horizon covers periods of one to five years, while long-term time horizons exceed five years. In identifying the material impacts, risks and opportunities, Brenntag defined an additional time horizon that is designated constant. This category denotes that certain impacts, risks and opportunities are ongoing or occur continuously.

Accounting principles, estimations and outcome uncertainties

The different accounting principles applied to the disclosed metrics in the topic-specific sections provide information on the underlying data. This specifies to what extent the upstream and downstream value chain is taken into account and to what extent estimation is used. In the environment-related sections in particular, a large number of data are subject to various uncertainties. This applies to the metrics on Scope 3 emissions, substances of (very high) concern, water consumption, circular products and circular packaging, and waste. In particular in the case of the metrics mentioned, repeated collection, validation and adaptation of the methodology will reduce this uncertainty in the future. Over the coming reporting periods, the learning effects arising in the process will be used to continuously improve data quality.

Restatement of prior reporting periods

Where applicable, information on the restatement and correction of prior reporting periods is provided in the accounting principles in the topic-specific sections.

The role of the management and supervisory bodies[ESRS 2 GOV-1, ESRS 2 GOV-2, ESRS 2 GOV-4](#)

Brenntag SE has a two-tier management system consisting of the Board of Management and the Supervisory Board in accordance with the legal requirements of Article 9, (1) (c) ii) of Council Regulation (EC) No 2157/2001 on the Statute for a European company (SE) ("SE Regulation") and the German Stock Corporation Act. The management of business by the Board of Management and supervision by the Supervisory Board are therefore clearly separated. Detailed information on the role of the management and supervisory bodies, including the sustainability and business conduct matters addressed by them, is provided in the Corporate governance statement. A tabular overview of the allocation of the core elements of due diligence can be found in the Appendix to this Group sustainability statement.

Integration of sustainability-related performance in incentive schemes[ESRS 2 GOV-3](#)

In order to strengthen Brenntag's commitment to sustainable business conduct, ESG targets have been explicitly implemented in the Board of Management remuneration system. Following its approval at the 2023 Annual General Meeting, a revised Board of Management remuneration system became effective, through which the Supervisory Board integrated ESG targets into long-term variable remuneration.

Long-term variable remuneration is awarded in the form of virtual shares. The number of virtual shares may increase or decrease, depending on Brenntag's long-term performance measured over a four-year performance period using specified performance criteria. The number of virtual shares finally awarded to the Board of Management member is linked to two financial performance criteria and, via an ESG multiplier, to ESG targets.

On the basis of Brenntag's sustainability strategy, the Supervisory Board selects up to three performance criteria and sets targets, which are to be achieved at the end of the performance period of the respective tranche and result in a multiplier of between 0.8 and 1.2 for each ESG target. The multipliers for each ESG target are weighted equally, resulting in an overall ESG multiplier of between 0.8 and 1.2.

The specific ESG targets for the 2023–2026, 2024–2027 and 2025–2028 tranches of long-term variable Board remuneration are:

- Reduction in greenhouse gas emissions (Scope 1 and Scope 2 emissions)
- Further increase in occupational safety (reduction in the Total Recordable Injury Rate; TRIR)
- Increase in the percentage of female employees at different levels of management

The target values, including the threshold and stretch value for the ESG targets, are in each case set by the Supervisory Board together with target values for the financial targets for variable remuneration in the financial year ending before a tranche is awarded. The target values relate to the last year of the performance period of the respective tranche. The target values and the achievement of each ESG target are in each case disclosed together with the achievement of the financial targets after the performance period of the respective tranche has ended. Taking the 2025 tranche as an example, this means that the target values were set in December of financial year 2024, relate to a measurement in 2028 and will therefore be disclosed in the 2028 remuneration report.

For the 2023–2026 and 2024–2027 tranches, the target values for the reduction in greenhouse gas emissions (Scope 1 and Scope 2) are aligned with the ESG targets for a syndicated credit facility. For the 2025–2028 tranche, the target values for the reduction in greenhouse gas emissions (Scope 1 and Scope 2) are aligned with the Group-wide reduction targets. These were successfully validated by the SBTi at the beginning of 2025. For the 2023–2026, 2024–2027 and 2025–2028 tranches, the target values for the TRIR and the increase in the percentage of female employees are aligned with the ESG targets for a syndicated credit facility.

Due to the use of multiplicative linking, the percentage of variable remuneration accounted for by the ESG targets can only be shown for the specific target amounts of variable remuneration depending on the total payout factors and as the extent of the influence of the multiplier. Assuming total payout factors for variable remuneration of 100% for the Chief Executive Officer, the percentage influence of the ESG targets is between –11.3% and +11.3%. As the three ESG targets are weighted equally, the influence of the reduction in greenhouse gas emissions (Scope 1 and 2 emissions) is a third of the stated influence. With regard to the total remuneration awarded or due to the Board of Management in 2025, the long-term variable remuneration from 2022 is taken into account, meaning that the specified ESG targets remain unconsidered. As a result, the impact of the emissions reduction target on the total remuneration awarded or due to the Board of Management in 2025 is 0%.¹⁾

In line with Board of Management remuneration, the three aforementioned ESG targets were also integrated into the long-term variable remuneration of the most senior management level (Global Leadership Team).

A preview of the tranche of long-term variable remuneration to be awarded in 2026 is omitted, as it is currently under review.

Risk management and internal controls over sustainability reporting

ESRS 2 GOV-5

In the course of the materiality assessment implemented in 2024 and revalidated in 2025, Brenntag conducted assessments of sustainability-related impacts, risks and opportunities. The risks identified as material are also covered in the Group-wide risk management system. For example, risks in relation to business conduct are recorded under risk category compliance risk while risks in relation to pollution are recorded under environmental protection, health and safety. Detailed information on this and on the internal control system can be found in the section "Report on expected developments, opportunities and risks".

¹⁾ Further information on the structure of the variable remuneration can be found in the "Remuneration report".

Business model, value chain and strategy

ESRS 2 SBM-1

Business model and value chain

As a chemical distributor, Brenntag connects several 10,000 chemical and ingredients manufacturers with customers from the chemical processing industry and other branches of industry. The Group purchases large-scale quantities of industrial and specialty chemicals and ingredients from a large number of suppliers, which, for their part, purchase raw materials from a large number of upstream suppliers. This enables the Group to achieve economies of scale in procurement and offer a comprehensive range of products and value-added services. The products it purchases are stored in distribution facilities, packed into quantities according to customer requirements and delivered, typically in less-than-truckloads. Efficient logistics and transport management is essential to ensuring that items are stored safely and transported safely. To secure its inputs, Brenntag relies on close supplier relationships and diversification across the product portfolio and the global supplier and customer relationships. Brenntag complies with the various regional legislative requirements that govern and, in some cases, prohibit the sale of chemicals.

Overall, Brenntag's customers benefit from a broad product range comprising around 20,000 different chemicals and ingredients as well as extensive value-added services, including just-in-time delivery, product mixing, repackaging, inventory management and drum return handling. The Group also provides tailor-made solutions, such as application, marketing and supply chain solutions, including recycling solutions, technical and formulation support, in-depth regulatory know-how and digital services such as online sales channels and product platforms. In addition, by offering more sustainable products and solutions, Brenntag helps its customers to meet their own sustainability targets. This also opens up further business opportunities for the Group, particularly in relation to the more sustainable product portfolio.

Further information on the business model and the value chain can be found in the section "Group overview", sub-section "Business activities and Group structure".

Sustainability strategy

Brenntag aims to fulfill its responsibility as global market leader and actively shape the future of the industry. The company supports its partners within its networks and promotes collaboration and shared success.

Sustainability has been an integral part of Brenntag's corporate strategy for many years now. As far back as 2014, the company became a member of the UN Global Compact and committed to its principles for human rights, labor standards, environmental protection and fighting corruption. In the same year, Brenntag joined Together for Sustainability (TfS), an industry initiative that works to enhance sustainability in the supply chain, and in 2016 it became the first chemical distributor to obtain full membership. In 2020, the CEO signed the Global Compact Statement from Business Leaders for Renewed Global Cooperation together with over 1,000 CEOs of other companies from more than 100 countries. In 2021, Brenntag joined the global RE100 initiative and thus pledged to source 100% of the required power from renewable sources by 2025. In 2022, Brenntag signed up to the Science Based Targets initiative (SBTi), thereby committing to have its climate targets validated. The process to validate the climate targets was completed at the end of January 2025.

Also in 2022, the Group developed its sustainability vision Future Sustainable Brenntag and formulated an ESG strategy. The vision describes Brenntag's overarching set of long-term objectives and the Group's basic direction. The strategy sets out this approach in greater detail and states the actions taken to achieve this objective. The strategy breaks down into six central focus areas:

- Portfolio and investment steering
- Climate change mitigation and reduction of CO₂e emissions
- Resource efficiency and circular economy
- Fair and safe employer
- Responsible partner for suppliers and communities
- Management structures for business ethics

Brenntag has set clear medium-term targets and some long-term targets for each focus area. In order to achieve these, it has also defined short-term targets, the progress toward which must be measured on a yearly basis. Details of the topic-specific targets and the current status of implementation are explained in further detail in the following topic-specific sections. In addition, further information on the Group's overarching objectives and its strategy, including significant groups of products and services offered, can be found in the section "Group overview" in the sub-section "Business activities and Group structure" and in the sub-section "Objectives and strategy".

GROUP SUSTAINABILITY STATEMENT

Focus area	Targets 2025-2030	Targets 2030-2050	(Interim) target achievement 2025	
Management structures	Increase the number of managers with ESG-related targets (2027) ¹⁾		Cross-unit workshops to identify existing ESG targets	
	Implement a sustainability organization within the operational structure (2027) ¹⁾		Sustainability engineer roles implemented in EMEA and North America	
Portfolio- and investment-steering	Assess and steer 100% of the product portfolio (sales in EUR) for / toward sustainability (2025)		100% of the product portfolio (sales in EUR) assessed for and steered toward sustainability	
	Develop strategies to support technological advancement in important industry segments (2025)		Further business development for battery materials and biopharma established	
Climate change	100% electricity consumption from renewable sources (2025)		93.9% electricity consumption from renewable sources	
		Scope 1&2: 58.8% reduction in CO ₂ e vs. 2023 (2034) Scope 3: 35% reduction in CO ₂ e vs. 2023 (2034) ²⁾ Net-zero CO ₂ e emissions vs. 2023: Scope 1&2 (2045), Scope 3 (2050)	6.4% reduction in CO ₂ e emissions (Scope 1 & 2) 19.4% reduction in CO ₂ e emissions (Scope 3)	
Pollution		25% reduction in process spills vs. 2023 (2030)	Process spill rate of 2.62 (increase of 39% vs. 2023)	
Resource use and circular economy	Ten circular businesses, each generating > EUR 1 million a year (2025)		Ten circular businesses implemented	
Own workforce		Total Recordable Injury Rate (TRIR): < 2,0 (2030)	TRIR: 2.1	
	Annual global employee engagement survey (eNPS), including action planning and monitoring (2024-2026)		eNPS implemented	
		Female representation of at least 30% across our entire management below the Board of Management (2030) ³⁾	Female representation across management levels: 37.8%	
	100% targeted expansion of unconscious bias training for leaders, HR managers and recruiters (2025)		Unconscious bias training partially expanded (participation rate: 35.4%)	
Workers in the value chain	All suppliers share our vision on human rights and environmental protection (2027)		Actions and interim targets for 2025 defined and achieved.	

2.22 Targets

General	Environment	Social
 achieved	 partially achieved	 not achieved

¹⁾ Further information can be found in the corporate governance statement.²⁾ The target boundary includes land-related emissions and removals from bioenergy feedstocks.³⁾ Except in jurisdictions where prohibited by law.

Sustainable product portfolio and investment steering

Portfolio steering

The product portfolio's focus on innovative and sustainable products is a central element of the sustainability vision Future Sustainable Brenntag. Along the value chain, these contribute to greater efficiency, reduced resource consumption and a smaller impact on people and the environment. Developing a sustainable product portfolio is therefore a fundamental part of Brenntag's business model and integrates not only economic but also social and environmental matters.

In 2025, based on data available in the global ERP system, 100% of the product portfolio was segmented on the basis of established methods such as the Framework for Portfolio Sustainability Assessments of the World Business Council for Sustainable Development (WBCSD). This corresponds to 95% of total sales.¹⁾ In doing so, each product is classified with regard to its sustainability performance, from products that make a particular contribution to sustainability ('accelerator') through products that meet standard market sustainability requirements ('sustainable standard') to products with (significant) sustainability deficiencies ('conversion' and 'challenged'). The business units label products in accordance with these four sustainability categories. Key material data and product performance data are captured by regional ERP systems and consolidated in a master data file. This file serves as the basis for extracting commercial metrics and carrying out analyses.

Brenntag's aim of using sustainability criteria to steer 100% of its portfolio by the end of 2025 was also achieved based on data available in the global ERP system. This corresponds to 95% of total sales.¹⁾ Since then, the intent has been to increase the proportion of 'accelerator' products, which include products with a reduced product carbon footprint (PCF), circular products and safer products.²⁾ The targets were developed by Group Sustainability in close consultation with the Brenntag Specialties and Brenntag Essentials divisions and finalized with the involvement of the Board of Management and the management. Progress in achieving the target is reviewed by the Board of Management on a quarterly basis using an ESG scorecard.

Based on the portfolio segmentation results, targets will be set in 2026 to increase the accelerator growth rate. In addition, data improvement is ongoing, as is the digitalization of processes to facilitate accelerator management.

To improve the availability and transparency of sustainable products, Brenntag offers the Sustainable Solutions Platform. This platform provides customers with information on products and services that advance climate protection, foster circularity, and uphold responsible sourcing practices. The platform also includes a customer survey to gather insights into preferences and needs related to safer alternatives and circular economy projects. These insights help to connect customers with the right experts and drive the development of more sustainable solutions.

In its efforts to promote the technological transformations driven by sustainability in key customer industries and sectors such as electromobility and biopharma, Brenntag has set itself the goal of developing corresponding strategies by the end of 2025. In the field of lithium-ion batteries, activities include the supply of materials and process chemicals for critical process steps in raw material extraction, refining, cell manufacturing, and recycling. In addition, applications in the adjacent sectors of photovoltaics and electronics are addressed through global and local process integration, materials expertise, and concepts aimed at reducing energy and resource consumption.

At the same time, in the pharmaceutical sector, the shift from conventional chemical synthesis to biologically-based production methods is gaining relevance. In this context, Brenntag provides materials, services, and technical support for biopharmaceutical applications. These efforts aim to enable more resource-efficient and sustainable healthcare technologies in response to evolving market requirements.

In financial year 2025, Brenntag generated sales of EUR 15,171.5 million in total.³⁾ Brenntag operates a network of around 600 sites in over 70 countries with approximately 17,000 employees. A detailed overview of the number of employees broken down by region can be found in the section "Own workforce", sub-section "Material impacts, risks and opportunities related to own workforce".

¹⁾ The remaining 5% relates primarily to data from recently acquired companies whose product portfolio is not yet available in the global ERP system. These data will be incorporated once the required integration and data quality processes have been completed.

²⁾ Further information on this can be found in the sections "Climate change", sub-section "Scope 3 emissions", "Pollution", sub-section "Safe products and substitution of substances of (very high) concern", and "Resource use and circular economy", sub-section "Circular product portfolio".

³⁾ Further information on sales can be found in the "Report on economic position", sub-section "Results of operations".

Investment steering

When it comes to assessing mergers and acquisitions, Brenntag prepares sustainability appraisals in which it determines how the company in question fits Brenntag's ESG strategy. The assessment criteria here include a review of energy consumption, energy sources, scope 3 impacts, the supplier assessment, and the products offered by the company under analysis that are classified as sustainable. Portfolio risks relating to sustainability are also examined and incorporated into the investment assessment. Five assessments were prepared for all targeted acquisitions in the reporting period (2024: seven assessments).

Since 2022, Group Sustainability has also played a key role in investments with a sustainability dimension. For example, the department assesses investments in buildings or means of transport such as heavy goods vehicles and forklift trucks. It is determined what impact the investment will have on the Group's carbon footprint and the achievement of the CO₂e targets, and, if applicable, how this needs to be counteracted from a sustainability perspective.

Interests and views of stakeholders

ESRS 2 SBM-2, S1-2, S2-2

Brenntag maintains regular dialog with its various stakeholders with a view to understanding their interests and views, and also establishing a mutual understanding of challenges or longer-term perspectives. The insights from the dialog inform the Group's strategic decisions, and the interaction is part of the Group-wide due diligence processes.¹⁾ Significant issues are discussed at the meetings of the Supervisory Board's Transformation and ESG Committee.

The key stakeholder groups include employees, customers, suppliers, other business partners, investors and other representatives of society. In the course of the 2024 materiality assessment, the list of stakeholders was categorized in accordance with ESRS. In the reporting period, a further review identified additional stakeholder groups and added dialog formats. Brenntag distinguishes between internal and external stakeholders who are or could in future be affected by the impacts of Brenntag's business activities and those of the Group's value chain, and users of the Group sustainability statement. This view results in the following overview, including different dialog formats:

Stakeholders	Internal or external	Affected stakeholders / users / both	Dialog formats
Own employees, works councils, external employees	Internal	Affected stakeholders	Employee surveys, town halls including question and answer sessions, intranet, newsletters, Sustainability Community, various training options, Safety Week
(Potential) employees	External	Both	Company websites, job fairs, social media
Management and leadership (Level L1)	Internal	Affected stakeholders	Sustainability Council, Board of Management meetings, ESG scorecard
Customers	External	Both	Direct dialog between key account managers and customers, self-assessment questionnaires, audits, conferences, Brenntag Sustainability Survey
Suppliers and business partners	External	Both	Direct interaction, audits, EcoVadis assessments, grievance mechanism
Investors	External	Users	Press releases, annual general meeting, investor conferences, roadshows, Capital Markets Day, ESG ratings
Industry associations, research institutes, non-governmental organizations	External	Users	Active member of industry and sector associations, cooperation with universities and non-governmental organizations

2.23 Stakeholder engagement

Through engagement with stakeholders in various dialog formats, Brenntag shares information about its ESG activities, gathers feedback and strengthens cooperation, transparency and trust. The findings of these dialog formats are taken into account in developing and refining the sustainability strategy. For example, the findings of the Brenntag Sustain-

ability Survey have helped to incorporate the interests and views of stakeholders, especially customers. These were also specifically taken into account when assessing the material impacts, risks and opportunities in relation to climate change, pollution, water, and circular economy and resource use.

¹⁾ Further information on this can be found in the statement on due diligence in the Appendix.

Double materiality assessment

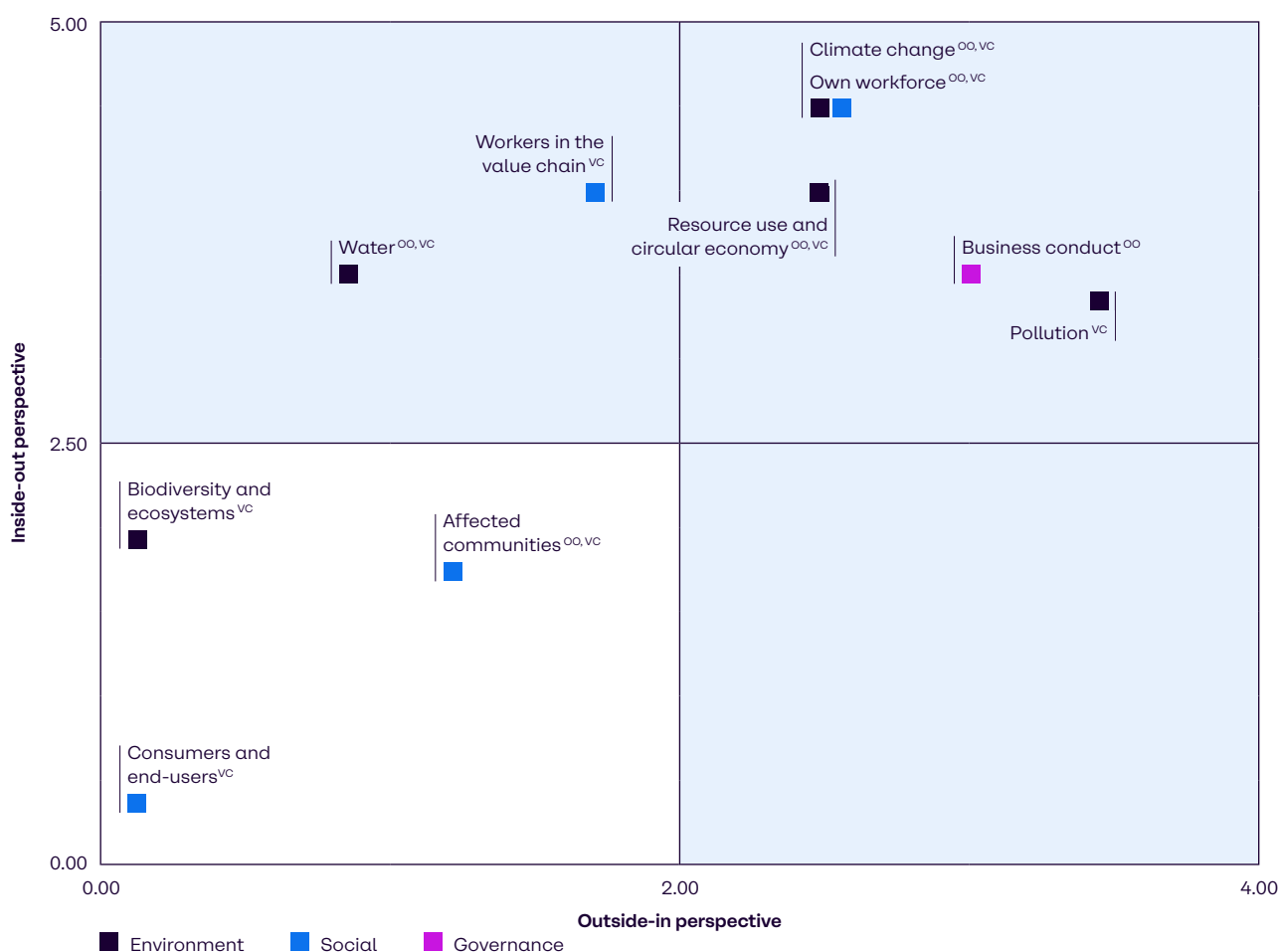
Material impacts, risks and opportunities and their interaction with strategy and business model

ESRS 2 SBM-3, ESRS 2 IRO-1, ESRS 2 IRO-2

Brenntag's operations have material societal, social, economic and environmental impacts. The following matrix provides an overview of the results of the double materiality assessment performed by Brenntag in 2024 in accordance with ESRS. This materiality assessment was validated in the reporting period, and the allocation of individual impacts was adjusted to ensure consistent presentation. These adjust-

ments include, in particular, the reassignment of specific IROs, the revision of selected wording, and the updating of the risk assessment scale based on current data from the financial reporting. The overall assessment was confirmed as still valid.

The matrix shows the material risks and opportunities or the financial materiality of the topics for Brenntag on the X axis (outside-in perspective) and the materiality of the impacts of Brenntag's operations on people and the environment on the Y axis (inside-out perspective). This comparison enabled Brenntag to identify its strategic focus areas and align the sustainability strategy accordingly.



2.24 Materiality matrix

Threshold inside-out perspective: 2.50
 Threshold outside-in perspective: 2.00
 OO = Own operations
 VC = Value chain

Details of the individual material impacts, risks and opportunities are contained in the sections on the topical standards. These provide information on how Brenntag manages those impacts and addresses the risks and opportunities in the context of the Group's own sustainability strategy. Information on the upstream materiality assessment process can be found in the sections on material environmental topics and business conduct. In 2025, a qualitative assessment of Brenntag's strategy and business model was conducted again in the course of a workshop with Brenntag sustainability experts. This showed that the Group still has the resilience to address the material impacts and risks and take advantage of the opportunities. For example, material impacts, risks and opportunities are addressed within the sustainability strategy and/or in functions and departments explicitly put in place for the purpose.

A list of disclosure requirements for material data points in accordance with ESRS and the table containing all the data-points that derive from other EU legislation can be found in the Appendix.

Process to identify and assess material impacts, risks and opportunities

ESRS 2 IRO-1

In 2024, the following steps were taken to identify and assess the material impacts, risks and opportunities. In doing so, all Group activities were taken into account and the core elements of due diligence were included, the mapping of which is shown in a tabular overview in the Appendix to this Group sustainability statement:

1. Stakeholder identification and engagement

The starting point was the stakeholder survey conducted in 2022. In 2024, the stakeholder membership was extended and, as described above in the section on the interests and views of stakeholders, also categorized into "affected stakeholders" and "users of the Group sustainability statement" in accordance with ESRS.

2. Preparation of a list of (potentially) relevant sustainability topics

An initial list of material topics was based on the topics identified by Brenntag back in 2022. This was made more granular by further distinguishing the topics into sub-topics and sub-sub-topics in accordance with ESRS. An additional peer group analysis ensured the completeness of the topics and resulted in an initial list of possible material topics (long list).

3. Definition of impacts, risks and opportunities

In further steps, the sustainability matters were classified as an actual or potential impact, risk or opportunity. Internal Brenntag stakeholders and sustainability experts were consulted for the purposes of this assessment. These are able to assess the external stakeholder perspective either because they are in direct and regular contact with stakeholders (e.g. customer advisors) or because they, as experts, possess specialist knowledge (e.g. with regard to human rights in the supply chain). Direct consultations with affected communities were not conducted as part of the identification of impacts, risks and opportunities in connection with the environmental topics.

4. Assessment of impacts

In accordance with the approach set out in ESRS 1, (actual and potential) negative and positive impacts were assessed with Brenntag using both gross and net considerations, i.e. the situation before and after the effects of policies, actions and targets.

Brenntag assessed actual negative impacts on the basis of severity, while likelihood was in each case added as an assessment criterion in the case of potential negative impacts. However, in accordance with ESRS, likelihood was excluded from the assessment of potential negative impacts on human rights in order to give the severity of the impacts precedence.

Severity was assessed based on scale, scope and irremediable character. Scale refers to how grave (in the case of a negative impact) or how beneficial (in the case of a positive impact) the impact is. Its scope is how widespread the impact is. Irremediable character refers to the extent to which the affected environment or people can be restored to their original state.

In assessing positive impacts, Brenntag considered scale and scope (actual impacts) or scale, scope and likelihood (potential impacts).

The assessment was performed on the basis of close, cross-departmental, interdisciplinary collaboration with both internal analyses, such as a climate risk assessment, threat assessments or supplier assessments, and external studies, e.g. IPCC, UN Global Compact or sector analyses, playing a role. Consideration was also given to regulatory requirements, such as the EU Taxonomy or the Corporate Sustainability Due Diligence Directive (CSDDD).

5. Assessment of risks and opportunities

For the purposes of assessing financial materiality, Brenntag evaluated the risks and opportunities from sustainability matters. This involved examining whether they may affect, or could reasonably be expected to affect, the financial position, financial performance or cash flows over the short, medium or long term. No current or anticipated financial effects of Brenntag's material risks and opportunities on its financial position, financial performance or cash flows were identified for the 2025 reporting period either.

The cross-departmental assessment of risks and opportunities was supported by financial reports, risk analyses and scenario analyses. Market data, such as carbon prices or regulatory costs, and studies on market- and climate-related risks are also important sources of information. Dependencies and interdependencies between these risks and opportunities and the impacts identified were also considered. The thresholds taken as a basis and the risks thus identified are aligned with and managed as part of Brenntag's general internal risk management. No sustainability risks were given priority over other risks. Further information on risk management can be found in the Report on expected developments, opportunities and risks.

6. Validation of the results

In the reporting period, the results of the double materiality assessment were once again validated with internal stakeholders, submitted to the Board of Management and approved by the Audit and Compliance Committee.

As a result of the process described above, the topic of biodiversity and ecosystems continued to be assessed as being not material. However, ESRS require data points to be disclosed on the upstream materiality assessment process for the environment-specific topics regardless of their materiality. Accordingly, Brenntag considered potential impacts on ecosystems such as those arising from the use of its vehicle fleet on roads, as well as possible dependencies that could result from its product portfolio. For example, components of Brenntag's product portfolio could rely on biodiversity and ecosystems or be linked to their loss. A detailed assessment of individual sites, regardless of whether they might be located in or near biodiversity-sensitive areas, was not conducted, as the potential impacts are general rather than site-specific. Brenntag also concluded that it is not necessary to implement any biodiversity mitigation measures. Aspects such as potential local pollution, which could have a minor impact on biodiversity, are covered in more detail in the section on pollution. Systemic, transition or physical risks were not included in assessing the topic of biodiversity and ecosystems.

Environment

Climate change

Material climate change-related impacts, risks and opportunities

ESRS 2 SBM-3, ESRS 2 IRO-1

Climate change mitigation plays a particularly important role in the sustainability vision Future Sustainable Brenntag,

and the climate strategy is derived directly from it. It is based on two different and equally important components. Firstly, the focus is on minimizing the carbon footprint. At the same time, Brenntag strives to increase its positive contribution and leverage opportunities, such as by developing environmentally friendly and environmentally compatible products and solutions. In the course of the materiality assessment, Brenntag identified the following material climate change-related impacts, risks and opportunities:¹⁾

Material topic	Impacts, risks or opportunities	Value chain	Time horizon	Description
Climate change mitigation	Impact (negative)	Own operations	Constant	Contribution to climate change through Scope 1 and Scope 2 emissions
	Impact (negative)	Upstream and downstream	Constant	Contribution to climate change through Scope 3 emissions
	Impact (positive)	Along the value chain	Constant	Possible impact on the distribution market as an influential market player (Scope 1 and Scope 2 emissions)
	Opportunity	Own operations	Constant	Sales opportunities as a result of the potential for differentiation offered by a lower-carbon product portfolio
Energy	Impact (positive)	Downstream	Constant	Possible positive impact on customers in relation to energy consumption and energy efficiency
	Impact (positive)	Upstream	Constant	Possible positive impact on suppliers in relation to energy consumption and energy efficiency
Climate change adaptation	Risk	Own operations	Long-term	Physical risks due to potential damage at Brenntag sites/supply chains as a result of extreme weather conditions

2.25 Material climate change-related impacts, risks and opportunities

Transition plan

E1-1, E1-8

In 2022, Brenntag joined the Science Based Targets initiative (SBTi) in order to address climate change-related impacts, risks and opportunities in a focused manner and align its strategy with the latest scientific findings. Under the SBTi, Brenntag aligned its targets for Scope 1 and Scope 2 emissions with the 1.5°C target under the Paris Agreement and its targets for Scope 3 emissions with the goal of limiting global warming to well below 2°C (WB2C). The targets were validated by the SBTi in January 2025.

Brenntag has introduced and continued two key actions in relation to Scope 1 and Scope 2 emissions in order to meet the targets set. These include the carbon management program and the CERO (Carbon Emission Reduction in Operations) project. In the course of these two projects, various decarbonization pathways have been identified and analyzed. Examples of derived actions include implementing energy efficiency measures, such as developing a more sustainable vehicle fleet through the use of biofuels, fitting installations with lower-emission technologies, for example replacing gas heating systems with heat pumps, and training and raising awareness among the Group's employees with regard to energy-saving behavior and how they can help to achieve the climate targets.

¹⁾ Further information on this is contained in the section "General disclosures", sub-section "Double materiality assessment".

Carbon management program and CERO project

As part of the carbon management program, each Brenntag entity is held accountable for 100% of the Scope 1 and Scope 2 emissions it causes through a set internal price of EUR 30 per tonne of CO₂e. The fixed price is calculated by taking into account the emissions reductions achieved, carbon taxes, emissions certificates, renewable energy costs and voluntary offsetting. Key reference points for this calculation draw on major international carbon-pricing overviews, global market analyses, industry fuel-price trends, and relevant EU frameworks on emissions trading and sectoral regulation. The resulting amount is paid virtually into an internal climate protection fund. Each company or site can apply for this budget by submitting emissions-saving projects. The Sustainability Council is responsible for setting the internal carbon price and selecting eligible projects for support.

Under the CERO project, the regional organizations are assigned annual emissions reduction targets so as to set clear responsibilities for operating units in reaching Brenntag's SBTi Scope 1 and Scope 2 targets. In addition, a working and steering structure has been established with dedicated decarbonization engineers to support locally feasible reduction initiatives. The initiatives are prioritized based on abatement cost and fit with the overall strategy by regional steering committees, led by business and supply chain leaders. Cross-regional collaboration is fostered through regular best-practice sharing sessions, while awareness and process integration are embedded into relevant business functions.

The largest lever for reducing Scope 3 emissions lies in the development of a more sustainable product portfolio at Brenntag. The Group therefore aims to systematically steer this in line with the climate transition plan by offering and actively marketing products with a reduced product carbon footprint (PCF). To this end, the Synapse project was launched in the reporting period to support the Brenntag portfolio's shift toward lower-PCF products and away from more carbon-intensive lines of business.

Synapse project

In 2025, the Synapse project was launched to support Brenntag's Scope 3 emissions reduction strategy. This project is a carbon emissions reduction program, inclusive of regional carbon emissions reduction targets, an organizational structure and a development plan being driven by the divisions and regions, and supported globally by Group Sustainability. The main focus of the project is on reducing Scope 3.1 (Purchased Goods and Services) and Scopes 3.11 and 3.12 (Use and End of Life Treatment of Sold Products) by steering Brenntag's portfolio toward lower-PCF products and gradually phasing out emission-intensive business based on internally defined thresholds. The project addresses approximately 92% of our Scope 3 emissions.

The transition plan is the responsibility of Brenntag's CEO as part of his direct responsibility for Group Sustainability, which has functional management responsibility for all climate change mitigation-related matters. In addition, the individual parts of the transition plan were approved by the entire Board of Management.

The Sustainability Council discusses the implementation of the transition plan and cross-function actions, and tracks implementation using the ESG scorecard. Moreover, the Vice President Sustainability Brenntag Group is involved in all important investment decisions as well as decisions regarding mergers and acquisitions so that alignment with the transition plan is ensured in these areas, too. Due to Brenntag's business model, no significant locked-in CO₂e emissions were identified from our assets and products. Brenntag is not excluded from the EU Paris-aligned Benchmarks.

Not least of all, Brenntag is scored by leading sustainability ratings such as CDP, which assesses companies on the reporting of data relevant to climate protection. In 2025, Brenntag maintained its CDP rating of A-, placing the company among the top 7% of all rated companies.

Policies and actions

E1-2, E1-3

In 2025, Brenntag developed an integrated, company-wide climate protection policy. This covers all Brenntag sites, facilities and activities as well as the upstream and downstream value chain in relation to climate change mitigation, climate change adaptation, energy efficiency and renewable energy. These topics are also covered in other corporate policies, such as the Brenntag Code of Business Conduct and Ethics, and the QSHE guidelines (QSHE: Quality, Safety, Health, Environment). All of the aforementioned guidelines and procedural instructions were adopted by the Board of Management and are available on the intranet. The Brenntag Code of Business Conduct and Ethics can also be downloaded from the company website.

With the aim of collaborating, exchanging ideas and offering our point of view, Brenntag participated in the Science Based Targets initiative (SBTi) pilot test for the Corporate Net-Zero Standard V2 and the UN Global Compact Climate Ambition Accelerator project during 2025. Above and beyond these activities in the reporting period, Brenntag implemented a diverse range of actions in relation to Scope 1, Scope 2 and Scope 3 emissions with a view to achieving the central goal of reducing CO₂e emissions.

Scope 1 and Scope 2 emissions

E1-3, E1-7

Procuring electricity from renewable energy sources is a major lever for reducing Scope 2 emissions and something that Brenntag continued to drive forward in 2025. In doing so, Brenntag relies on a combination of on-site generation, direct supply contracts and purchases of guarantees of origin, with the share of renewable electricity totaling 93.9% in the reporting period (2024: 87.4%). Around 52,581 tonnes of Scope 2 emissions were thus avoided (2024: 52,397 t Scope 2 emissions).

This 2025 reporting period marks Brenntag's target milestone for achieving 100% renewable electricity, in alignment with the RE100 commitment.¹⁾ This goal was successfully met at all locations except Singapore, where Brenntag is actively working to install its own photovoltaic system starting in 2026. The project is supported by the company's carbon management program and underscores Brenntag's continued efforts to expand renewable energy use globally. It is intended to install photovoltaic systems at sites where it is technically feasible (e.g. there must be no storage of flammable liquids) and economically worthwhile. During 2025, several photovoltaic systems were installed at Brenntag

sites, for example in Borås (Sweden), Scunthorpe (United Kingdom) and Traun (Austria). These supplement the existing installations on Brenntag warehouses and office buildings, including in Añelo and Zarate (Argentina), Kandrzin-Cosel (Poland), Padua (Italy), Bangkok (Thailand), Gurugram (India) and Santa Fe Springs (U.S.).

Various project ideas were submitted and implemented under the carbon management program (budget: around EUR 6.2 million)²⁾ in 2025 and are to save a total of around 6,752 tonnes of Scope 1 emissions and 441 tonnes of Scope 2 emissions annually as of 2026. The carbon management program projects implemented in 2024 reduced Scope 1 emissions by around 247 tonnes in the reporting period (2024: 1,521 t Scope 1 emissions; 594 t Scope 2 emissions). The projects included, for example:

- Electric heavy goods vehicles, including the necessary charging stations in the U.S.,
- Retrofitting multiple internal combustion engines with an Optimus Vektor system in the U.S.,
- Electric forklifts in Singapore and the U.S.,
- Replacing gas heating systems with heat pumps in the Czech Republic and Belgium,
- Improving insulation at multiple sites in preparation for further decarbonization.

One of the biggest projects in 2025, partly funded by the carbon management program, was Brenntag's net-zero site in Traun, Austria. In this context, a comprehensive energy-efficiency approach was implemented at the site, combining thermal renovation of buildings with the optimization of heating controls for the acid and alkali tanks. The heating system was converted to groundwater heat pumps in combination with low-temperature radiators. To support the transition, a photovoltaic system was installed to supply renewable electricity for the heat pumps, site operations, and electric vehicle charging stations. With a capacity of 220 kWp, the photovoltaic system will generate around 220,000 kWh of electricity per year, thus covering the annual consumption of the two heat pumps. The total savings amount to around 120 tonnes of CO₂e per year. The site now serves as a blueprint and global flagship for Brenntag's other sites around the globe.

In 2025 under the CERO project, the decarbonization roadmaps were developed for North America and EMEA for the period to 2028. Initial investments to enable far-reaching decarbonization initiatives in Brenntag's fleet and facilities were approved and local teams were upskilled to identify and execute quick-wins in decarbonizing assets.

¹⁾ RE100 provides a global guideline where businesses pledge to source 100% renewable electricity over the medium term.

²⁾ The funds for the carbon management program cannot be linked directly to items in the financial report, as those funds are disbursed after a lag of one year. This results in a delay that makes it difficult to allocate them directly.

Another key initiative in 2025 was the further transition to low-emission fuels for Brenntag's fleet. A detailed analysis of the technical aspects and fuel availability was performed during the reporting period, finding good sourcing opportunities for biodiesel and hydrotreated vegetable oil (HVO) in France, Italy and California (U.S.). As a result, biofuels (biodiesel and bioethanol) accounted for 5.4% of total fuel consumption in 2025 (2024: 0.7%). This saved around 7,391 tonnes of Scope 1 emissions (2024: 922 t Scope 1 emissions). In addition, Brenntag uses efficient transport logistics to plan the fleet's routes such that fuel consumption, CO₂e emissions and harmful emissions are minimized. Using freight quotations for intermodal transportation enables the use of more environmentally friendly modes of transport on suitable routes.

In 2025, Brenntag offset some of the Scope 1 and Scope 2 emissions with the help of a new certified project (41,181 t CO₂e). In the reporting period, around 22.6% (2024: 67.7%) were offset in this way. A carbon offset project was selected that goes beyond emissions offsetting by addressing broader sustainability aspects. For example, it supports the preservation of the Brazilian rainforest, one of the most biodiverse ecosystems on the planet. The project is located in Brazil, where Brenntag operates its own sites, and complies with the Verified Carbon Standard (VCS), ensuring high environmental integrity and transparency.

CO₂e certificates canceled in the reporting period

	2025	2024
Total (t CO₂e)	41,181	131,126
Share from removal projects (%)	0%	0%
Share from reduction projects (%)	100%	100%
Verified Carbon Standard (in %)	100%	100%
Share from projects within the EU (%)	0%	0%
Share of CO ₂ e certificates that qualify as corresponding adjustments (%)	0%	0%

CO₂e certificates planned to be canceled in the future

10,000 (from 2026)

2.26 CO₂e certificates

Scope 3 emissions

E1-3

One action to optimize the portfolio involves building a portfolio of products with a reduced product carbon footprint (PCF) that offer customers an alternative to fossil-based products. This is supported by a globally valid ISCC+ certificate for mass-balance products and the Brenntag low-carbon product range, among other things.

Since 2024, project successes have already been seen in EMEA, for example, where Brenntag offers more sustainable sodium hydroxide. This is produced using 100% renewable energy and has a carbon-saving potential of approximately 65% compared with conventionally produced sodium hydroxide. Similarly, in 2025, Brenntag introduced renewable ammonia, manufactured using hydrogen derived from renewable biogas instead of fossil fuels. This transition is expected to reduce CO₂e emissions by up to 87% compared with previous deliveries. Brenntag is also exploring this approach for other high-volume commodities, such as circular glycols, to accelerate industry conversion in other countries as well.

Moreover, Brenntag's CO₂Xplorer provides support in developing new lines of business with lower-carbon products and creates more transparency over Scope 3 emissions along the chemical value chain. Since December 2022, Brenntag has been providing its customers with detailed product carbon footprint (PCF) data for the products they purchase from Brenntag if they so request. The calculation option has been continuously further developed over the last few reporting periods, culminating in the CO₂Xplorer core and the CO₂Xplorer on-demand in 2024. These tools enable the CO₂e emissions of chemical products to be calculated throughout their lifecycle.

The aim is to increase transparency over CO₂e emissions and thus drive the reduction of emissions throughout the supply chain. In 2023, the calculation method used for CO₂Xplorer was certified by the independent external testing service provider TÜV Rheinland following a systematic review. The certification confirms that Brenntag's PCF methodology meets the requirements of the internationally recognized ISO 14067:2018 standard and the Together for Sustainability (TfS) PCF Guideline. Moreover, in 2024, the tool was awarded the prize for the best digital innovation by the independent industry information platform ICIS.

CO₂Xplorer

The CO₂Xplorer tool uses various product data to calculate cradle-to-customer-gate CO₂e emissions. Carbon footprints from external data providers are used in addition to suppliers' primary data. In the reporting period, PCF (product carbon footprint) data were available for more than 2,100 chemical products. Supply chain CO₂e emissions for different means of transport and CO₂e emissions from warehousing are also taken into account. Emissions data for different product packaging, such as IBCs and drums, complete the comprehensive CO₂e emissions calculation.

CO₂Xplorer core can be accessed by Brenntag-internal users. The tool enables them to easily calculate PCFs for mixes, blends, solutions and products with multiple sources of supply, for example. Measuring the relevant CO₂e-emitting inputs – product, logistics, warehousing and product packaging – also allows different alternatives to be compared. Conventional products can thus be directly compared with more sustainable products, as can different transportation options, e.g. road-based versus rail-based transportation, or single-use versus reusable packaging.

CO₂Xplorer on-demand is a fee-based Brenntag customer service that enables business partners to independently establish CO₂e transparency for their purchased products on the basis of Brenntag's operational reference data and for selected supplier locations. They receive a CO₂e-centered product passport that offers complete emissions transparency. In the reporting period, the service was still offered only in the EMEA region.

Building on this foundation, Brenntag started to apply a new calculation methodology for circular and reused products, also in accordance with ISO 14067:2018 and ISO 14040/44:2006. This enables a transparent and auditable distinction to be drawn between virgin and circular product pathways, helping customers to validate defossilization and circular-economy claims.¹⁾

On the Synapse project in 2025, steps were taken to enhance the quality and scalability of Scope 3 emissions data. A project was launched to automatically extract and map supplier PCF data from unstructured sources, directly into Brenntag's global PCF database. This innovation is designed to significantly reduce manual data handling and supports both supplier prioritization and hotspot analysis to identify carbon-intensive products across the portfolio. The enhanced visibility helps to identify products and supply chains with the highest CO₂e impact, enabling targeted collaboration with both suppliers and customers to jointly reduce emissions and advance Scope 3.1 decarbonization initiatives. The Synapse project aims to further reduce Scope 3 emissions by 2028. Approximately 6 million tonnes are to be saved by expanding lines of business with a low product carbon footprint (PCF). A further 0.09 million tonnes are expected to be saved by expanding business activities with an extremely low PCF, while the gradual phasing-out of emission-intensive lines of business is expected to contribute around 1.6 million tonnes to the reduction.

Resilience analysis

ESRS 2 SBM-3, ESRS 2 IRO-1

In the reporting period, Brenntag validated and reviewed the resilience analysis of its sustainability strategy and business model in the context of climate change, which had been conducted in the previous year and incorporated the findings of the double materiality assessment.²⁾ It also examined climate-related transition events, i.e. economic, regulatory, technological and societal changes that may occur during the transition to a low-carbon and sustainable economy. For Brenntag as a distribution company, topics such as increased carbon pricing,³⁾ the development of low-emission technologies and changes in consumer behavior are of key importance in this context. These factors may affect the value chain through rising transport costs or changes in demand for more sustainable products, for example. Against this background, assumptions were developed for long-term scenarios that shed light on the possible implications for Brenntag. It was then assessed to what extent Brenntag's climate strategy is geared to addressing all opportunities

¹⁾ Further information on this can be found in section "Resource use and circular economy", sub-section "Circular product portfolio".

²⁾ Further explanatory notes on the double materiality assessment and the definition of the assessment time horizons can be found in the section "General disclosures", sub-section "Double materiality assessment".

³⁾ For the purposes of assessing carbon pricing, consideration was given to external sources such as the price range recommended by the High-Level Commission for 2030 in order to keep the rise in temperatures below 2°C.

and risks identified as material – over the short, medium and long term. Ultimately, Brenntag believes that it is resilient to the challenges of climate change identified due to its strong market position and its strategic alignment with the 1.5°C target.¹⁾

Nevertheless, the uncertainties that Brenntag faces must also be examined. For example, Brenntag's long-term decarbonization options in relation to Scope 1 and Scope 2 emissions depend on the further development of low-emission technologies and the regional availability of sustainable fuels. Therefore, Brenntag will first drive the decarbonization of the truck fleet over the short and medium term through the use of biofuels before making a more extensive switch to electric and hydrogen vehicles over the long term. Reducing Brenntag's Scope 3 emissions requires close cooperation with suppliers and targeted steering of the product portfolio toward more sustainable products. So far, improvements in the product carbon footprints (PCFs) of chemicals and ingredients are being driven mainly by the worldwide increase in the share of renewable energy in national power grids. Products that are deliberately designed to achieve a lower PCF still face commercial challenges, as demand and willingness to pay remain limited. This gap between ambition and market uptake continues to constrain the pace at which Scope 3 emissions can be reduced through portfolio transformation. Nevertheless, Brenntag tries to best leverage opportunities by continuously analyzing the specific requirements and potential of different industries with a view to making advances in decarbonizing the chemical value chain together with partners.

In the course of the resilience analysis, Brenntag also incorporated the results of a pilot project launched in 2022 that solely assessed long-term climate-related physical risks, such as rising sea levels or exceptional heatwaves, at the company's sites around the world. Together with an external service provider, it conducted a qualitative analysis of the long-term threat from climate risks for three global warming scenarios (RCP2.6, RCP4.5 and RCP8.5) for 2050. The three scenarios selected represent different global warming trends – an optimistic (RCP 2.6), a moderate (RCP 4.5) and a pessimistic estimate (RCP 8.5). This gives Brenntag a thorough understanding of the range of possible future devel-

opments, which can be embedded into strategic planning. Consideration was given to the likelihood, scale and duration of the risks and the geographical coordinates. Brenntag sites were thus assessed in terms of their exposure to such risks on a scale from 0 (very low risk) to 1 (very high risk). The results show that physical damage due to climate change may be a material risk over the long-term.²⁾ The assessment also highlighted that exposure and sensitivity can vary considerably, depending on geographical location and climate scenario. For example, coastal regions are at greater risk from storm surges and sea level rise, whereas interior regions may be more affected by droughts or heatwaves, depending on the scenario selected. The analysis is intended to help strengthen resilience to climate change on an ongoing basis.

The threat of physical risks is also captured and systematically assessed as part of the Group-wide risk reporting. Detailed information on the risk management process is contained in the section "Report on expected developments, opportunities and risks".

Targets and metrics

[E1-4, E1-5, E1-6, ESRS 2 BP-2](#)

The following are Brenntag's science-based CO₂e reduction targets. They were approved by the Board of Management and validated by the SBTi:

Medium-term targets

- Brenntag commits to reduce absolute Scope 1 and Scope 2 greenhouse gas (GHG) emissions by 58.8% by 2034 from a 2023 base year.³⁾
- Brenntag commits to reduce absolute Scope 3 GHG emissions by 35% by 2034 from a 2023 base year.³⁾

The Scope 1, Scope 2 and Scope 3 emissions reduction targets are gross targets and were developed on the basis of the relevant SBTi methodology, i.e. the SBTi Corporate Near-Term Criteria (version 5.2) for medium-term targets and the SBTi Corporate Net-Zero Standard (version 1.2) for net-zero targets using the cross-sectoral emission pathway. In doing so, the absolute contraction approach was selected, which requires a linear reduction in emissions, irrespective of the sector. The market-based method was also used.

¹⁾ No assets or business activities were identified that are incompatible with or need significant efforts to be compatible with the transition to a climate-neutral economy.

²⁾ The assessment perspective is also used in analyzing potential impacts of climate-related physical risks on net assets, financial position and results of operations.

³⁾ The target boundary includes land-related emissions and removals from bioenergy feedstocks.

GROUP SUSTAINABILITY STATEMENT

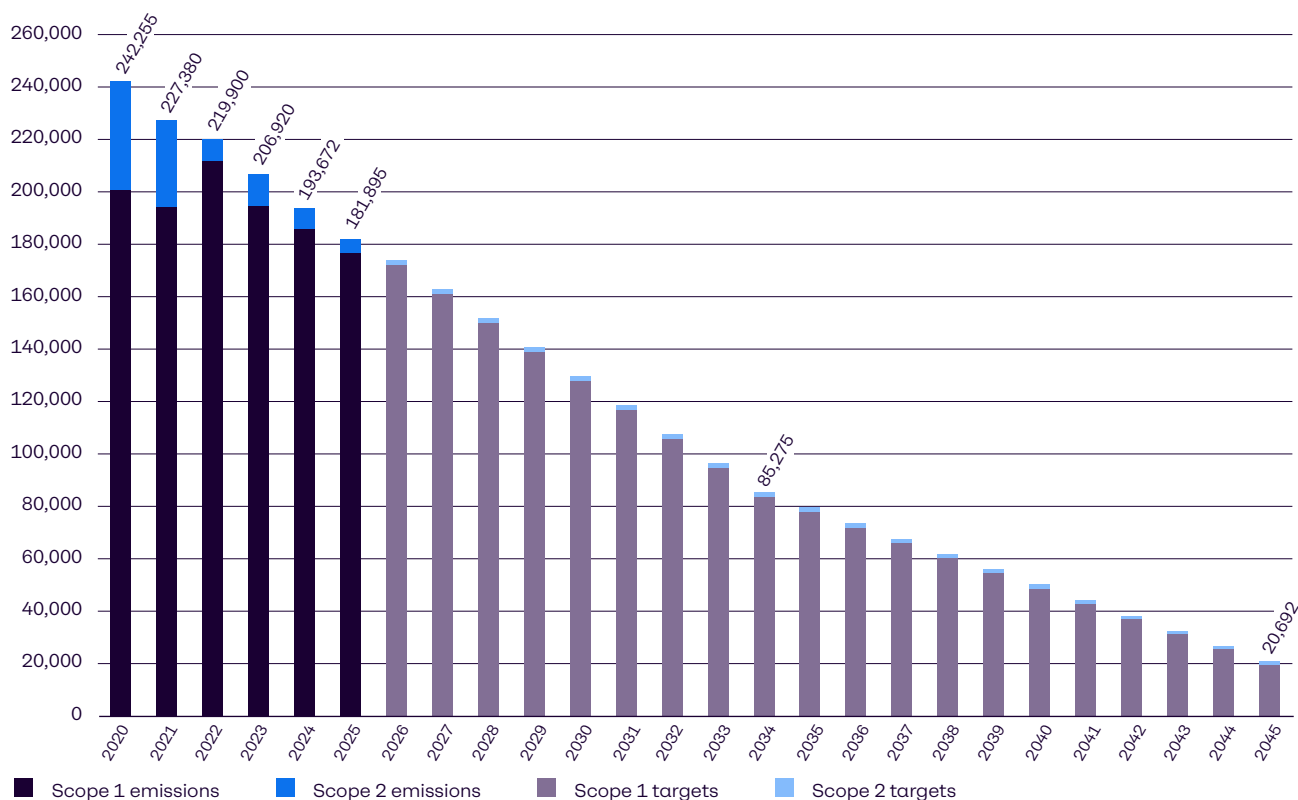
Net-zero targets

- Brenntag commits to reach net-zero GHG emissions across the value chain by 2050.
- Brenntag commits to reduce absolute Scope 1 and Scope 2 GHG emissions by 90% by 2045 from a 2023 base year.¹⁾
- Brenntag commits to reduce absolute Scope 3 GHG emissions by 90% by 2050 from a 2023 base year.¹⁾

Brenntag expects to be able to reduce Scope 1 and Scope 2 emissions almost completely by 2045. The remaining emissions are to be offset through carbon credits available and permitted from 2045. For Scope 3 emissions, Brenntag relies on the actions of its suppliers, which either offset their emissions or will use authorized emissions-removal methods through to 2050.

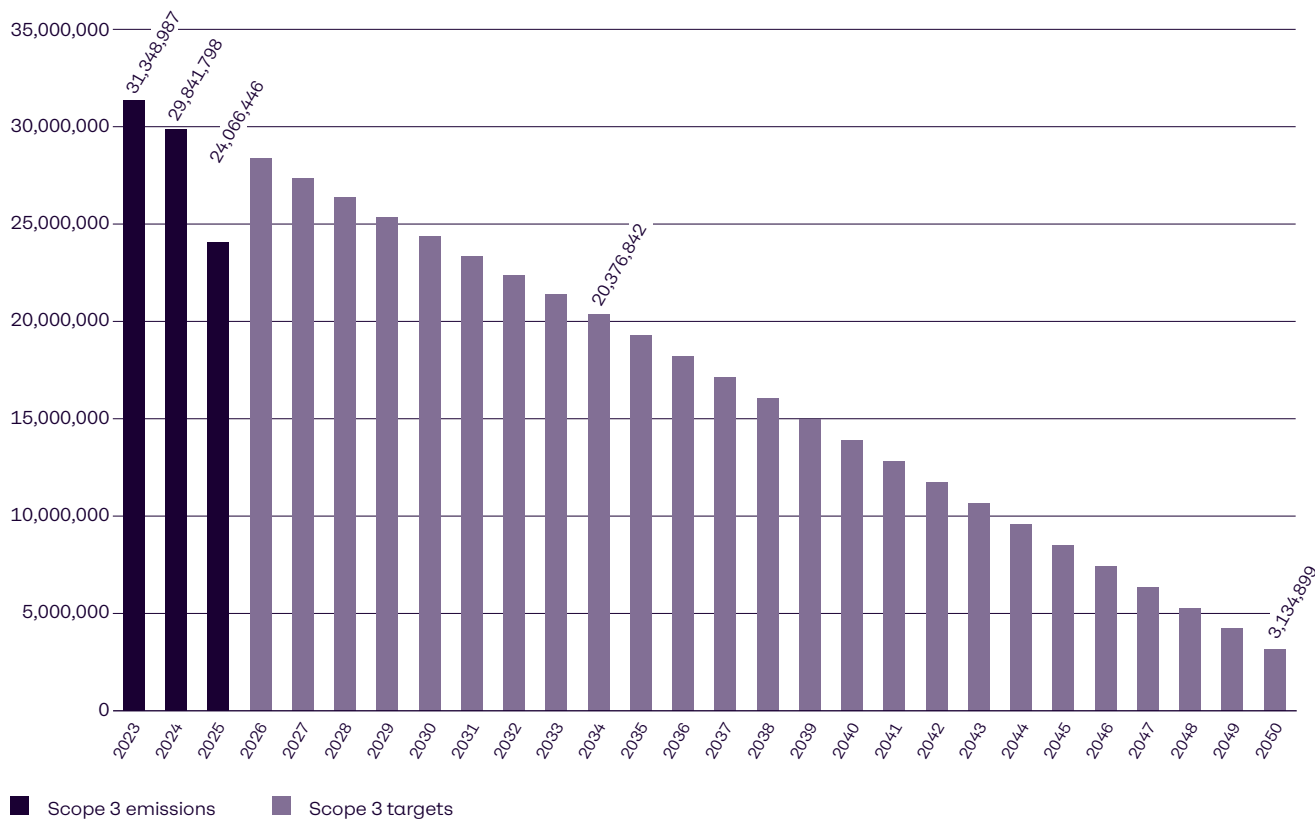
Linear progression is used to set annual interim targets. The other annual sub-targets are shown in the two graphics below, as are the emissions reductions achieved since 2020. In 2025, for example, a 6.1% (2024: 6.4%) reduction was achieved in Scope 1 and Scope 2 emissions. Scope 3 emissions were reduced by 19.4% (2024: 4.8%).

The targets cover all Brenntag business units and the upstream and downstream value chain, with the exception of emissions from the processing of sold products (GHG Protocol category 3.10) and some emissions from the use of sold products (GHG Protocol category 3.11), as these cannot be calculated due to the large number of customers and applications. This approach is in line with the requirements of both the GHG Protocol and the SBTi Chemicals Sector Guidance.

2.27 Scope 1 and 2 emissions – market-based (t CO₂e)

¹⁾ The target boundary includes land-related emissions and removals from bioenergy feedstocks.

GROUP SUSTAINABILITY STATEMENT

2.28 Scope 3 emissions (t CO₂e)

The following decarbonization levers and their overall quantitative contribution to the achievement of the CO₂e emission reduction targets by 2030 compared with base year 2023 were identified:

- Use of electricity from renewable energy sources: 5% (Scope 2)
- Switching to heat pumps and e-boilers: 6% (Scope 1)
- Decarbonization of the truck fleet: 21% (Scope 1)
- Decarbonization of the company car fleet: 4% (Scope 1)
- Electrification of forklift trucks: <0.5% (Scope 1)
- Gradual withdrawal from distributing very carbon-intensive products: approx. 5% (Scope 3)
- Expansion of the product portfolio of low-carbon products: approx. 7% (Scope 3)
- Sustainability criteria in the product procurement process: approx. 9% (Scope 3)

The goal of sourcing 100% renewable electricity worldwide by 2025 remains in place and this target will continue to be pursued going forward. It is in accordance with Brenntag's Green Electricity Policy in line with the RE100 initiative and its standards. This goal was achieved in all our operations except for Singapore, as explained in the section "Policies and actions, Scope 1 and 2 emissions" above.

Progress in achieving climate and energy targets is tracked by the Board of Management on a quarterly basis using an ESG scorecard.

GROUP SUSTAINABILITY STATEMENT

Energy consumption and mix	2025	2024
Fuel consumption from coal and coal products (MWh)	-	-
Fuel consumption from crude oil and petroleum products (MWh)	525,001	632,205
Fuel consumption from natural gas (MWh)	181,564	147,946
Fuel consumption from other fossil sources (MWh)	-	-
Consumption of purchased or acquired electricity, heat, steam and cooling from fossil sources (MWh)	18,535.0	26,005
Total fossil energy consumption (MWh)	725,100	806,156
Share of fossil sources in total energy consumption (%)	81.0%	85.8%
Consumption from nuclear sources (MWh)	-	-
Share of consumption from nuclear sources in total energy consumption (%)	0%	0%
Fuel consumption for renewable sources, including biomass (also comprising industrial and municipal waste of biologic origin, biogas, renewable hydrogen, etc.) (MWh)	26,722	3,296
Consumption of purchased or acquired electricity, heat, steam and cooling from renewable sources (MWh)	138,575.0	127,707
Consumption of self-generated non-fuel renewable energy (MWh)	4,794.0	2,890
Total renewable energy consumption (MWh)¹⁾	170,091	133,892
Share of renewable sources in total energy consumption (%)	19.0%	14.2%
Total energy consumption (MWh)	895,190	940,048

2.29 Energy consumption and mix

¹⁾ Of the total amount of renewable electricity, 3.3% of the electricity comes from on-site generation, 11.9% from direct supply contracts and 84.8% from purchases of guarantees of origin.

Energy intensity per net revenue ¹⁾	2025	2024	Δ %
Total energy consumption per net revenue (MWh/mEUR)	59.0	57.9	1.9%

2.30 Energy intensity per net revenue

¹⁾ In financial year 2025, Brenntag generated sales of EUR 15,171.5 million. All of Brenntag's business activities are in high climate-impact sectors. Further information on sales can be found in the "Report on economic position", sub-section "Results of operations".

GROUP SUSTAINABILITY STATEMENT

CO ₂ e emissions	Retrospective				Milestones and target years			
	2025	2024	Δ %	2023 (base year)	2025	2030	2050	Annual % target/ base year ¹⁾
Scope 1 GHG emissions								
Scope 1 GHG emissions (t CO ₂ e)	176,381	185,546	-4.9%	194,390	182,805	127,501	18,699	
Percentage of Scope 1 GHG emissions from regulated emission trading schemes (in %)	-	-	-	-				
Scope 2 GHG emissions								
Location-based Scope 2 GHG emissions (t CO ₂ e)	44,416	48,317	-8.1%	49,017				
Market-based Scope 2 GHG emissions (t CO ₂ e)	5,513	8,127	-32.2%	12,530	1,993	1,993	1,993	
Scope 1 and Scope 2 GHG emissions								
Location-based Scope 1 and Scope 2 GHG emissions (t CO ₂ e)	220,798	233,863	-5.6%	243,407				
Market-based Scope 1 and Scope 2 GHG emissions (t CO ₂ e)	181,895	193,672	-6.1%	206,920	184,798	129,494	20,692	5.3%
Significant Scope 3 GHG emissions								
Scope 3 GHG emissions (t CO ₂ e)	24,066,446	29,841,798	-19.4%	31,348,987	29,354,052	24,366,713	3,134,899	3.2%
1. Purchased goods and services	20,319,526	25,796,193	-21.2%	27,193,880				
2. Capital goods	96,469	148,070	-34.8%	28,513				
3. Fuel- and energy-related activities (not included in Scope 1 or Scope 2) ²⁾	46,361	47,643	-2.7%	50,522				
4. Upstream transportation and distribution	780,468	741,915	5.2%	755,684				
5. Waste generated in operations	17,964	23,222	-22.6%	117,007				
6. Business travel	20,748	20,370	1.9%	23,247				
7. Employee commuting	12,179	12,464	-2.3%	12,608				
8. Upstream leased assets	299	141	112%	93				
9. Downstream transportation	46,052	40,635	13.3%	34,353				
10. Processing of sold products								
11. Use of sold products	1,094,918	1,252,283	-12.6%	1,342,416				
12. End-of-life treatment of sold products	1,621,311	1,741,850	-6.9%	1,765,867				
13. Downstream leased assets	-	-	0.0%	-				
14. Franchises	-	-	0.0%	-				
15. Investments	10,150	17,013	-40.3%	24,798				
Total GHG emissions								
Total GHG emissions (location-based) (t CO₂e)	24,287,243	30,075,661	-19.2%	31,592,394				
Total GHG emissions (market-based) (t CO₂e)	24,248,340	30,035,471	-19.3%	31,555,908	29,538,850	24,496,207	3,155,591	
Out-of-scope-emissions	6,875	812	747%	680				

2.31 CO₂e emissions¹⁾ Annual percentage reduction from base year 2023 required to reach the 2034 target.²⁾ This value includes upstream emissions from biofuels of 606 t CO₂e for 2025, 184 t CO₂e for 2024 and 145 t CO₂e for 2023.

Of this amount, 24.2% of the Scope 1 and Scope 2 emissions are emitted in the EMEA region (2024: 22.7%), 69.4% in North

America (2024: 69.6%), 4.0% in Asia Pacific (2024: 4.7%) and 2.4% in Latin America (2024: 3.0%).

GROUP SUSTAINABILITY STATEMENT

Carbon intensity per net revenue¹⁾

	2025	2024	Δ %
Total CO ₂ e emissions (location-based) per net revenue (t CO ₂ e/mEUR)	1,601	1,852	-13.6%
Total CO ₂ e emissions (market-based) per net revenue (t CO ₂ e/mEUR)	1,598	1,850	-13.6%

2.32 Carbon intensity per net revenue

¹⁾ In financial year 2025, Brenntag generated sales of EUR 15,171.5 million. All of Brenntag's business activities are in high climate-impact sectors. Further information on revenue can be found in the "Report on economic position", sub-section "Results of operations".

Accounting principles

Brenntag follows the operational control approach and reports its energy consumption and its CO₂e emissions in accordance with the ESRS, taking into account the principles and requirements of the Greenhouse Gas (GHG) Protocol.

Since not all energy consumption data for the fourth quarter were available at the time of the audit, extrapolations were made. In the reporting period, the emissions estimated for Q4 2024 (2024 report) were compared against the actual values determined in the first quarter of 2025. This resulted in only minimal changes (1.1%). Nevertheless, the extrapolation method was further refined. The new method now analyzes the consumption trend from the first and fourth quarters of the previous years and applies it to the current year's Q1 value to produce a more accurate forecast for natural gas, district heating and electricity consumption.

The emissions are calculated using 2025 emission factors from the UK Department for Business, Energy & Industrial Strategy (DBEIS). The calculation for district heating was carried out using the factor according to UBA (2018).

To increase transparency over Scope 2 emissions, Brenntag has calculated these emissions using the market-based method in addition to the location-based method since 2020. In the case of the location-based method, average emission factors in the respective regions and

IEA emission factors are used for the reporting period. In the case of the market-based method, an emission factor of 0 kg CO₂e is used if renewable electricity was procured. Otherwise, the emission factors of the respective country electricity mix (excluding renewable sources) are used. If it is not possible to exclude renewable sources, the same emission factor is used for the location- and the market-based method. Using the market-based method enables company-specific purchases of energy from renewable sources to be presented in a more transparent manner. It therefore also serves as the basis for setting targets. The calculations under the location-based method merely enable better comparability with earlier reports.

Scope 3 emissions are quantified by applying the equation set out in the GHG Protocol Corporate Value Chain (Scope 3) Accounting and Reporting Standard:

greenhouse gas emissions = activity data * emission factor.

As listed in the table below, different approaches were selected for the various GHG Protocol categories, depending on the data available for the calculation. The reporting on Scope 3 emissions includes emissions related to Brenntag's business activities in the current financial year. This approach therefore also includes emissions that were emitted outside the period under analysis but were caused by business activities carried out in the reporting period.

Emissions category	Methodology
3.1 Purchased goods and services – chemical products	Activity data: mass-based method, of which 0% primary data from suppliers
3.1 Purchased goods and services	Spend-based method, of which 0% primary data
3.2 Capital goods	Spend-based method, of which 0% primary data
3.3 Fuel- and energy-related activities (not included in Scope 1 or Scope 2)	Fuel-based method: direct allocation based on Scope 1 and Scope 2 emissions data, of which 100% primary data from Brenntag activities
3.4 Transportation and distribution (upstream)	Hybrid approach: average data-, spend-based, distance-based method, depending on the data available in each region, of which 0% primary data
3.5 Waste generated (in own operations)	Activity data-based method: waste-type-specific method, of which 100% primary data from Brenntag activities
3.6 Business travel	Spend-based method, of which 0% primary data
3.7 Employee commuting	Countries, number of employees and number of working days as inputs for the calculation, of which 0% primary data
3.8 Leased assets (upstream)	Average energy intensity method, of which 0% primary data
3.9 Transportation and distribution (downstream)	Hybrid approach: activity data- and spend-based method, of which 0% primary data
3.10 Processing of sold products	Not calculated due to complexity (permitted under the GHG Protocol and SBTi Chemicals Sector Guidance)
3.11 Use of sold products	Only calculated for refrigerants operations, in accordance with comment on 3.10, of which 0% primary data
3.12 End-of-life treatment of sold products	Activity data: mass-based method, of which 0% primary data
3.13 Leased assets (downstream)	Not relevant with regard to Brenntag's business activities
3.14. Franchises	Not relevant with regard to Brenntag's business activities
3.15 Investments	Method based on the investee's sales, of which 0% primary data

2.33 Scope 3 emissions calculation method

Pollution

Material pollution-related impacts, risks and opportunities

ESRS 2 SBM-3, ESRS 2 IRO-1

As a distributor, Brenntag bears particular responsibility, as the processing and use of chemicals and chemical products may cause environmental damage in the event of an accidental release or improper use. The safe handling of chemicals is therefore of paramount importance to Brenntag in all respects. As part of the materiality assessment, any historical pollution at individual sites and the consultations held with individual stakeholders in this context were taken into account. Within Brenntag's risk management, environmental provisions for soil and groundwater contamination are

calculated on an issue-by-issue basis using a standardized methodology in line with the requirements of International Financial Reporting Standards (IFRS): Local site managers update known and potential contamination cases in the internal Site Management System (SMS). Cost estimates / cash flow assumptions are independently checked and, where needed, modelled to determine a best-estimate provision. The provision levels are continuously monitored and formally refreshed at each reporting date through the recurring SMS update cycle, including review of new site information, remediation progress, revised cost assumptions and timing.

The following table summarizes the material impacts and risks of Brenntag's business activities on the environment:¹⁾

Material topic	Impacts, risks or opportunities	Value chain	Time horizon	Description
Pollution of water and soil, pollution of living organisms and food resources (accidental releases)	Impact (negative)	Along the value chain	Constant	The accidental release of chemicals may lead to the contamination of/harm to (ground)water and soil, flora and fauna.
	Risk	Own operations	Constant	Remediation, restoration or rehabilitation costs due to accidental releases
Substances of concern, substances of very high concern; pollution of living organisms and food resources	Impact (negative)	Downstream	Constant	Possible degradation of the environment / living organisms due to the use of products containing substances of (very high) concern

2.34 Material pollution-related impacts and risks

Accidental releases

Policies and actions

E2-1, E2-2

During the transportation, handling and warehousing of chemicals along Brenntag's value chain, there is generally a risk of an accidental release that may lead to water and soil pollution. Therefore, there is also a potential risk to living organisms and food resources. The Global QSHE Policy (QSHE: Quality, Safety, Health, Environment) combines the Group's strategy and standards for quality, health, safety and the environment. Brenntag strives for process safety, occupational health and safety, customer satisfaction, respect for the environment and continuous improvement at all times. The Group undertakes to provide the resources required for this.

The QSHE management system is a central pillar in this policy's implementation and is supported by the QSHE manual and the guidelines, procedures and responsibilities contained in it. The system is aimed at ensuring that Brenntag's sites are operated safely, its products are transported safely and its customers are supplied safely, thereby preventing any negative environmental impacts. The Global QSHE Policy and the related guidelines were developed by the functional department, which gave particular consideration to the handling of hazardous products. The policies and guidelines were approved by the Board of Management, which also has overall responsibility for their implementation. They apply to all Brenntag companies worldwide and are available through the QSHE management platform on the intranet.²⁾

¹⁾ Further information on this is contained in the section "General disclosures", sub-section "Double materiality assessment".

²⁾ Further information on the Global QSHE Policy and the QSHE management system is provided in the section "Own workforce", sub-section "Occupational health and safety".

The actions that build on the guidelines follow a three-step approach to preventing environmental damage as a result of spillages: prevention, retention, elimination. The actions are to be implemented at all operating sites and during transport.

The task, first of all, is to generally prevent releases. This includes measures such as structural requirements and operational specifications for storage facilities or loading and unloading points. There are also specific requirements for products with increased risk exposure. The intention is to prevent the risk of a release due to overfilling, incorrect filling and other incidents, for example.

Secondly, in case product releases nevertheless occur, Brenntag has installed various internal retention systems at its sites to collect spilled products and prevent them from entering the environment. These structural measures are complemented by easily accessible mobile materials and measures that enable leaked chemicals to be collected or absorbed quickly.

Thirdly, if, in exceptional cases, releases into the environment nevertheless occur – whether at the sites or during transportation – Brenntag takes actions necessary to clean up and restore the affected areas. Where necessary, these actions are taken in close consultation with the authorities responsible.

In addition, the safe handling of loose, unpackaged chemicals, termed bulk goods, requires specialized facilities and carefully designed processes. To ensure safety, Brenntag continuously implements a global Process Safety Management (PSM) system at all sites working with these bulk goods. Each site conducts a self-assessment every one to two years using a standardized questionnaire (SAQ) based on the internationally recognized Center for Chemical Process Safety (CCPS) framework. Additionally, a structured, risk-based review program ensures that formal PSM assessments are carried out at all operating sites. The frequency of these assessments is determined by a tiering system based on each site's risk profile. Both the SAQs and the audit programs are intended to assess the maturity level of the sites in implementing PSM and to identify potential areas for improvement.

In the reporting period, Brenntag expanded its PSM program. With the inclusion of additional processes and products, the number of designated PSM focus sites grew from 363 to 375. To enhance its risk-based approach, Brenntag introduced a refined site classification and tiering system. This enables more accurate prioritization and allocation of expert resources according to each site's risk profile. A strengthened team of internal and external auditors completed 35 centrally organized Tier 1 assessments and additional regional Tier 2 and Tier 3 assessments. The company also continued to build internal capabilities through structured training, certification programs, and knowledge-sharing initiatives. In the APAC region, for example, a dedicated training program was launched to prepare regional auditors for PSM assessments, with direct support and collaboration from EMEA resources.

To monitor PSM, process safety events are recorded. These are accidental releases from process facilities. In this context, PSE-1 events are higher-category events as defined by the CCPS. In 2025, there were a total of eight PSE-1 events at Brenntag sites: four product releases from processes that were classified according to CCPS criteria as a PSE-1 event due to the quantity of product released. In all cases, the released product was collected in full by the retention systems, as a result of which nothing entered the environment. In addition, there were four further releases of smaller quantities of product, which resulted in lost time injuries. These were also classified as PSE-1 events in line with CCPS criteria.

In September 2024, Brenntag launched a global initiative aimed at preventing product releases. In the course of the first phase of this initiative back in 2024, a seminar took place for leaders from HSE, production and management. Compact information formats, such as 'Safety Moments' on specific topics, were also provided. The number of process spills initially continued to increase. An analysis of the spills showed that the increase was due mainly to operational errors, whereas the number of technical issues remained at a comparable level with the previous year. For that reason, in 2025, the second part of the initiative focused on "Operational discipline". Following some challenging results in the first quarter of 2025, the process spill rate has since improved.

Targets and metrics

E2-3, E2-4, E2-6, ESRS 2 BP-2

Building on the policies and actions described above, Brenntag aims to reduce the rate of process spillages by at least 25% by 2030, starting from 1.88 cases per one million tonnes of outgoing products from warehouse sites in 2023. Ultimately, this general reduction is also intended to further reduce the relatively low number of releases into the environment, thereby preventing potential water and soil pollution. This includes releases of chemicals containing substances of (very high) concern. The target was developed by specialists in the QSHE department in close collaboration with Group Sustainability and finalized with the involvement of the Board of Management. It is voluntary and is not based on any specific scientific findings. Progress in achieving the target is reviewed by the Board of Management on a quarterly basis using an ESG scorecard.

At Brenntag, process spillages are classified in the same way as other incidents according to defined criteria and are reported by the sites to Corporate QSHE via their local/regional QSHE organizations. Twenty-six process spillages were reported during the reporting period, resulting in a rate of 2.62 cases per million tonnes of outgoing products from warehouse sites. This represents a slight improvement compared with the 2024 rate of 2.76. Following a challenging result in the first quarter, with the rate at 3.58, performance improved in the following months, but the rate nevertheless remained above the interim target of 1.81 (4% reduction vs. the 2023 base year). No significant releases of pollutants into soil or water were reported in 2025.¹⁾ There were operating expenses of EUR 3.1 million in connection with a fire at a warehouse site in Canada in 2023.²⁾ Further costs may be incurred in subsequent years due to environmental monitoring measures that are currently planned in consultation with the authorities for the period to 2027.

Accounting principles

Spillages/releases are defined as a loss of primary containment (LOPC). At Brenntag, all spillages in excess of 200 liters that may stem from liquid and solid products classified as dangerous goods in accordance with the international UN transport regulations and are released from processes (according to the CCPS definition) at Brenntag sites are included in the process spillage rate. The number of these releases is expressed in relation to outgoing products from warehouse sites in millions of tonnes. In the assessment of relevance for significant environmental impacts according to Regulation (EC) No. 166/2006, releases of pollutants smaller than 200 liters were also considered if they entered soil or water. Relevance is considered individually in each case depending on the chemical released. This applies to releases at Brenntag sites or during transportation.

Safe products and substitution of substances of (very high) concern

Policies and actions

E2-1, E2-2

Brenntag strives to make its product portfolio more sustainable. On the one hand, the intention is to identify products within the portfolio that make a positive contribution to sustainability, expand their share and market them more strongly. At the same time, products in the portfolio that could pose a risk to health and the environment if used improperly are to be reduced and alternatives offered. In optimizing the portfolio, Brenntag is guided by the guidelines issued by the World Business Council for Sustainable Development. A product offering that meets safety standards above and beyond regional regulations is a sustainable distinguishing feature. Due to different statutory provisions in the various regions around the globe, certain products carrying potential health or environmental risks are still permitted there, even though their use is already prohibited or restricted in the EU under the REACH regulation³⁾.

Back in 2023, the Global Safe Product Policy was introduced with a view to ensuring that the most stringent statutory provisions are adhered to at Brenntag worldwide. This guideline is aimed at gradually reducing the sale of substances of very high concern (SVHCs) in products at a concentration above 0.1% not just in the EU, but worldwide as well. The focus here is on SVHCs on the EU-REACH authorization list (Annex XIV) and the EU-REACH candidate list. For substances on the SVHC candidate list, Brenntag aims to gradually offer safer alternatives that have smaller environmental impacts, improved product labeling and a reduced toxicity profile compared with the industry standard.

¹⁾ Relevant releases are reported in accordance with the substances listed in Annex II to Regulation (EC) No 166/2006 of the European Parliament and of the Council (European Pollutant Release and Transfer Register, E-PRTR).

²⁾ Further information on this can be found in the section "Report on economic position", sub-section "Results of operations of the Brenntag Group (net expense from special items)".

³⁾ REACH is a regulation concerning the registration, evaluation, authorization and restriction of chemicals in the EU.

GROUP SUSTAINABILITY STATEMENT

The Board of Management approved the policy and is responsible for its implementation. The policy applies globally and is available to all Brenntag employees on the intranet. External stakeholders are informed about the policy on the company website.

In implementing the Global Safe Product Policy, Brenntag leverages its global presence, the broad supplier network, and its application and product expertise, especially in heavily regulated markets. This knowledge is also applied in less regulated markets to support customers who wish to exceed regional regulations by offering them suitable alternatives.

As it works closely together with suppliers and customers, Brenntag has an understanding of the technical functions a particular chemical product must fulfill and is able to offer the customer a selection of safer alternative products.

Back in 2024, an internal website was created as a knowledge hub for internal use by the Brenntag Essentials division. This website serves to foster internal dialog with regard to alternative solutions and products so that the learning effects from different areas of application can be applied throughout the Group. In addition, product-specific training was delivered for customer- and supplier-facing roles regarding safer alternatives. Brenntag Essentials also works with academic research on an ad hoc basis to explore strategic approaches to identifying and prioritizing safer alternatives. In 2025, a master thesis project investigated how regulatory

requirements and internal decision-making frameworks can be aligned to guide substitution efforts. This research contributes to our broader goal of proactively managing chemical risks and promoting safer, more sustainable product offerings.

To support internal decision-making and improve visibility of SVHCs, a dedicated Power BI tool was developed for internal use. The tool gathers data from a central hub that consolidates inputs from the local ERP systems worldwide, enabling teams to efficiently access and analyze information related to SVHCs. This improved data infrastructure strengthens Brenntag's ability to proactively manage chemical risks, identify substitution opportunities, and advance safer product offerings across regions.

Targets and metrics

E2-3, E2-5, ESRS 2 BP-2

The Global Safe Product Policy is aimed at reducing the sale of SVHCs from both the existing portfolio and acquisitions by offering alternative products. To this end, sales are continuously monitored as described above. Beyond that, there are currently no further targets in accordance with the requirements of ESRS.

In the 2025 reporting period, Brenntag is for the second time publishing figures on the production, use, distribution, sale, import and export of substances of concern and very high concern.

Hazard category	Substances of concern		Of which substances of very high concern	
	2025	2024 ³⁾	2025	2024 ³⁾
Respiratory sensitization (t)	9,381	11,112	2,034	2,580
Skin sensitization (t)	54,863	58,919	2,926	3,277
Germ cell mutagenicity (t)	108,932	128,576	1,276	1,166
Carcinogenicity (t)	387,051	508,790	1,685	1,858
Reproductive toxicity (t)	230,719	237,892	44,131	40,176
Specific target organ toxicity (single exposure) (t)	248,159	246,758	477	513
Specific target organ toxicity (repeated exposure) (t)	441,626	409,406	9	5
Hazard to the aquatic environment long term (t)	314,934	263,451	27,586	13,973
Hazardous to the ozone layer (t)	-	-	-	-
In total (t)	1,124,590	1,236,752	61,192	61,195

2.35 Substances of (very high) concern

³⁾ The prior-year figures were adjusted (see also accounting principles below).

Accounting principles

The published data include substances that are classified as 'substances of very high concern' pursuant to the REACH Regulation or fall under the ESRs definition as 'substances of concern'. According to this definition, 'substances of concern' are substances that meet the criteria laid down in Article 57 and were identified in accordance with Article 59(1) of Regulation (EC) No 1907/2006 of the European Parliament and of the Council and are classified in Part 3 of Annex VI to Regulation (EC) No 1272/2008 of the European Parliament and of the Council in the hazard categories named in the ESRs. Substances are also regarded as of concern if they negatively affect the reuse and recycling of materials in the product in which they are present. Substances of very high concern are a subset of substances of concern and include substances that meet the criteria laid down in Article 57 of Regulation (EC) No 1907/2006 (REACH) and were identified in accordance with Article 59(1) of that Regulation.

In capturing the reported data, it is assumed that the material inflow essentially corresponds to the material outflow. The total weight of the products is determined on the basis of sales data. In calculating the weights, only substances at a concentration of over 0.1% are taken into account. For products where the substance is only one of multiple components, the weight is based on the substance, not the weight of the product as a whole. The data were generated from the global and local ERP systems. Unavailable data were extrapolated using appropriate comparative data from the product portfolio. Any lack of data is due either to a lack of tracking in the case of products outside the scope of REACH (outside the EU) or a lack of information from suppliers due to trade secrets. If concentration ranges were available, the respective mean values were used. A substance may be named multiple times if it is classified into multiple hazard classes. The total quantity shows each substance only once, regardless of its classification into individual hazard classes.

As part of the current reporting, quantities disclosed for the previous year were corrected. There are three main reasons for these adjustments: Firstly, SVHCs were not reported as part of substances of concern in the previous year, but were instead recorded separately. Secondly, products are now counted only once in the total quantity, regardless of whether they are assigned to one or several hazard classes. Thirdly, data from one region proved to be incomplete in the previous year. These missing quantities were added and corrected retroactively. As a result, the total volume of substances of concern decreased by 373,279 tonnes, while the total volume of SVHCs increased by 8,365 tonnes.

Substances will gradually be classified according to the following hazard classes as of financial year 2026. As the European Chemicals Agency (ECHA) has granted a transitional period through to November 1, 2026 for mandatory labeling of hazard classes, report quality will depend on the data available:

- Endocrine disruption for human health
- Endocrine disruption for the environment
- Persistent, mobile and toxic properties or very persistent, very mobile properties
- Persistent, bioaccumulative and toxic properties or very persistent, very bioaccumulative properties

Water

Material water resources-related impacts, risks and opportunities

ESRS 2 SBM-3, ESRS 2 IRO-1

Brenntag uses water in many areas of its business operations, for example to produce solutions, to clean pipe systems and

to cool or heat chemicals and tank facilities. At the same time, Brenntag leverages its product portfolio and expertise to improve water quality and optimize water treatment processes for its customers. The following table shows the material impacts of Brenntag's business activities on water resources identified in the course of the materiality assessment:¹⁾

Material topic	Impacts, risks or opportunities	Value chain	Time horizon	Description
Water	Impact (negative)	Own operations	Constant	Contribution to water scarcity through water consumption
	Impact (positive)	Downstream	Constant	Improving the water quality of polluted bodies of water through the use of the water treatment and water purification product portfolio

2.36 Material water resources-related impacts

Water consumption

Policies and actions

E3-1, E3-2

Water management at the Brenntag sites is carried out as part of the management system of the QSHE (Quality, Safety, Health and Environment) department. The Global QSHE Policy sets out the Group's overarching strategy and standards. Building on this, the QSHE environmental management guideline requires all Brenntag sites to implement an efficient water and wastewater management system in accordance with local statutory provisions. The implementation of this requirement is tracked globally. The environmental management guideline applies to all Brenntag companies, was approved by the Board of Management and can be viewed through the QSHE management platform on the intranet. As part of the organization's commitment to continuous improvement, this guideline is being updated to include specific requirements regarding water management, including the systematic collection and sharing of best practices in water management across regions.

Brenntag obtains the majority of its water from the public water supply network. In addition, some sites use alternative sources of water, such as rainwater or their own wells. One example is the site in Zarate (Argentina), where rainwater is captured, treated and used for industrial purposes. Based on

data from the World Resources Institute (WRI), a water-risk analysis was carried out for all Brenntag sites. This analysis identified 87 sites in areas at water risk, including those with water stress. Our water management strategy prioritizes sites facing extremely high water stress, which reflects the relationship between water availability and consumption. According to the WRI, 63 Brenntag sites are located in regions of extremely high water stress. Of these 63 sites, only 30 have material water consumption for mixing and blending (>120 m³/year).

These 30 sites constitute Brenntag's priority group for water stewardship. In future, there will be a focus on building robust, site-specific water management plans for these locations. One example is the site located in Bari, Italy, where a rain-water collection system has been designed by an engineering firm and submitted to the authorities for approval. If approved, the system is expected to capture and reuse approximately 1,248 cubic meters of water per year. This accounts for 15% of the water consumed for mixing and blending in Bari in 2025, reducing stress on the public supply and improving resilience. As a next step, additional, site-specific actions will be evaluated across other operations located in areas of extremely high water stress to mitigate impacts and strengthen Brenntag's overall approach to water management.

¹⁾ Further information on this is contained in the section "General disclosures", sub-section "Double materiality assessment".

Targets and metrics

E3-3, E3-4, ESRS 2 BP-2

In the context of water management, although there are currently no targets in accordance with ESRS requirements, Brenntag has produced a global data collection policy that is intended to ensure standardized monitoring of water consumption. The aim is to derive suitable actions to optimize water management on the basis of those data. In the reporting period, an analysis of the global data capture processes was carried out. As mentioned above, the identification of priority sites marks a first step in Brenntag's strategy for water stewardship targeted at extremely high water stress areas.

In the reporting period, the company voluntarily participated in the CDP Water environmental disclosure initiative in order to take one step forward toward better water stewardship based on increased transparency.

Water consumption	2025	2024
Total water consumption (m³)	1,248,644	1,069,511
Total water consumption in areas at water risk, including areas of high-water stress (m³)	251,422	303,597
Total water consumption per net revenue (m³/mEUR)	82.3	65.9

2.37 Water consumption

Accounting principles

Water consumption is defined as the amount of water withdrawn within a company or facility that is not discharged back into the water environment or to a third party over the course of the reporting period. Brenntag collects data on water consumption specifically related to mixing and blending (M&B) processes. The water consumption data are obtained directly from operating sites. Some sites collect this information from water bills, others extract data from local product databases, and some estimate consumption based on average percentages of water added to products during M&B processes. For example, a site may assume that 40% of the total chemicals produced for M&B consist of added water and subtract this percentage from the total production volume. The data for the fourth quarter are based on estimates. It is assumed that the first to third quarters account for 75% of the year, with the remaining 25% scaled accordingly. The extrapolation was performed at the site level and subsequently aggregated to produce the Brenntag Group's total value.

Water treatment product portfolio

Policies and actions

E3-1, E3-2, E3-3

Brenntag is not only committed to sustainable water management at its own sites; it also offers a comprehensive product portfolio for water treatment and environmental applications in a variety of sectors. The range of treatment chemicals and technologies covers the entire water cycle – from raw water pretreatment to sludge dewatering and every stage in between – and therefore meets the complex challenges of water management.

Thanks to its application expertise and its global centers of excellence for water treatment, Brenntag is driving the introduction of leading-edge technologies. These increase water efficiency, reduce consumption and optimize reuse while at the same time minimizing negative environmental impacts. In response to the increasing scarcity of water and changing legal requirements, Brenntag promotes water reuse and circular economy models. Beyond these approaches, no specific policy to improve the water quality of polluted bodies of water using Brenntag chemicals has been developed and approved in accordance with ESRS. The continuous provision and further development of water treatment chemicals follows regional, statutory requirements.

In the reporting period, Brenntag supported customers in the water treatment, industrial and environmental sectors in particular through the following targeted actions that enabled them to optimize water treatment and also comply with stringent environmental regulations:

- Assisting with the recycling and reuse of treated water in order to reduce freshwater consumption
- Providing effective technologies to remove heavy metals from wastewater, enabling safe discharge and reliable compliance with environmental regulations
- Providing a comprehensive activated carbon-based portfolio for the treatment and remediation of contaminated groundwater and soils in order to tackle the pollution caused by PFAS

- Implementing purification technologies to remove newly occurring micropollutants, such as pharmaceutical residues, from wastewater in order to ensure clean discharge and protect ecosystems from harmful substances
- Distributing an innovative membrane technology to improve water throughput and reduce energy consumption of reverse osmosis installations for drinking water and industrial water treatment

In addition, Brenntag's offering includes various services for water treatment, such as laboratory testing and on-site testing to select the most suitable product for the specific customer application. Furthermore, customized blends are provided, enabling the targeted development of product solutions for water treatment.

Brenntag plans to further expand the offering through its global network of regional innovation and application centers and local water treatment labs. In these centers of excellence, specialists with in-depth product and process knowledge develop tailor-made solutions to meet the growing requirements of water treatment. Beyond these efforts, Brenntag has no targets in accordance with ESRS requirements.

Resource use and circular economy

Material resource use and circular economy-related impacts, risks and opportunities

ESRS 2 SBM-3, ESRS 2 IRO-1

Brenntag recognizes the importance of a circular economy model as a key action for managing environmental

challenges and fostering responsible resource management. In the course of the materiality assessment, the following material resource use and circular economy-related impacts and opportunities were identified in the context of Brenntag's business activities:¹⁾

Material topic	Impacts, risks or opportunities	Value chain	Time horizon	Description
Resource inflows, including resource use; resource outflows related to products and services ¹⁾	Impact (positive)	Upstream and downstream	Constant	By proactively distributing a circular product portfolio and circular packaging, Brenntag helps to promote the circular economy and has a positive market impact (suppliers and customers).
Resource outflows related to products and services ¹⁾	Opportunity	Own operations	Constant	Sales opportunities as a result of the potential for differentiation offered by a circular product portfolio and circular packaging
Waste	Impact (negative)	Own operations	Constant	Waste partly disposed of in landfill

2.38 Material resource use and circular economy-related impacts and opportunities

¹⁾ Entity-specific metrics are reported in relation to the positive impact and opportunity to show how Brenntag steers its circular product portfolio, including recycled and reused products as well as products that enable a circular economy. Detailed information can be found in the following section.

Circular product portfolio

Policies and actions

E5-1, E5-2

Resource efficiency and the circular economy are elements of the sustainability vision Future Sustainable Brenntag, even though a specific circular economy policy has not yet been adopted in accordance with ESRS requirements.

In the context of the ESRS, the following graphic illustrates the materiality of the two key categories for the global and continuous promotion of the circular economy: circular procurement and circular services.

Aided by circular procurement, Brenntag is selectively extending its product portfolio to include products of circular origin and products that enable circular production. These products are actively promoted among customers and serve as a distinguishing feature of the Group.

In circular services, the focus is on fostering industrial symbiosis. As a leading merchant with close links with the chemical industry, Brenntag assumes an intermediary role with a view to connecting different industrial stakeholders and establish-

ing new, cross-sector product flows. This is intended to continuously optimize resource efficiency through by-products and recycled products. Moreover, Brenntag supports closed loop systems by developing processes to treat secondary flows and waste generated on a customer's site. These treated materials can then be reused as base materials in the same customer's processes.

Leveraging the expertise of Brenntag's global application and innovation centers, the Group also develops innovative circular economy concepts and formulations, referred to as enablers, from which customers benefit directly. This includes developing tailor-made formulations and advisory services to optimize product use and handling.

To measure the impact of its circular activities, including recycling and reuse, Brenntag has applied a TÜV Rheinland-certified methodology for calculating CO₂e emissions. This approach systematically incorporates secondary material loops, reuse systems (such as solvent recovery) and the allocation of recycled content, in alignment with the ISO 14067:2018 and ISO 14040/44:2006 standards.²⁾

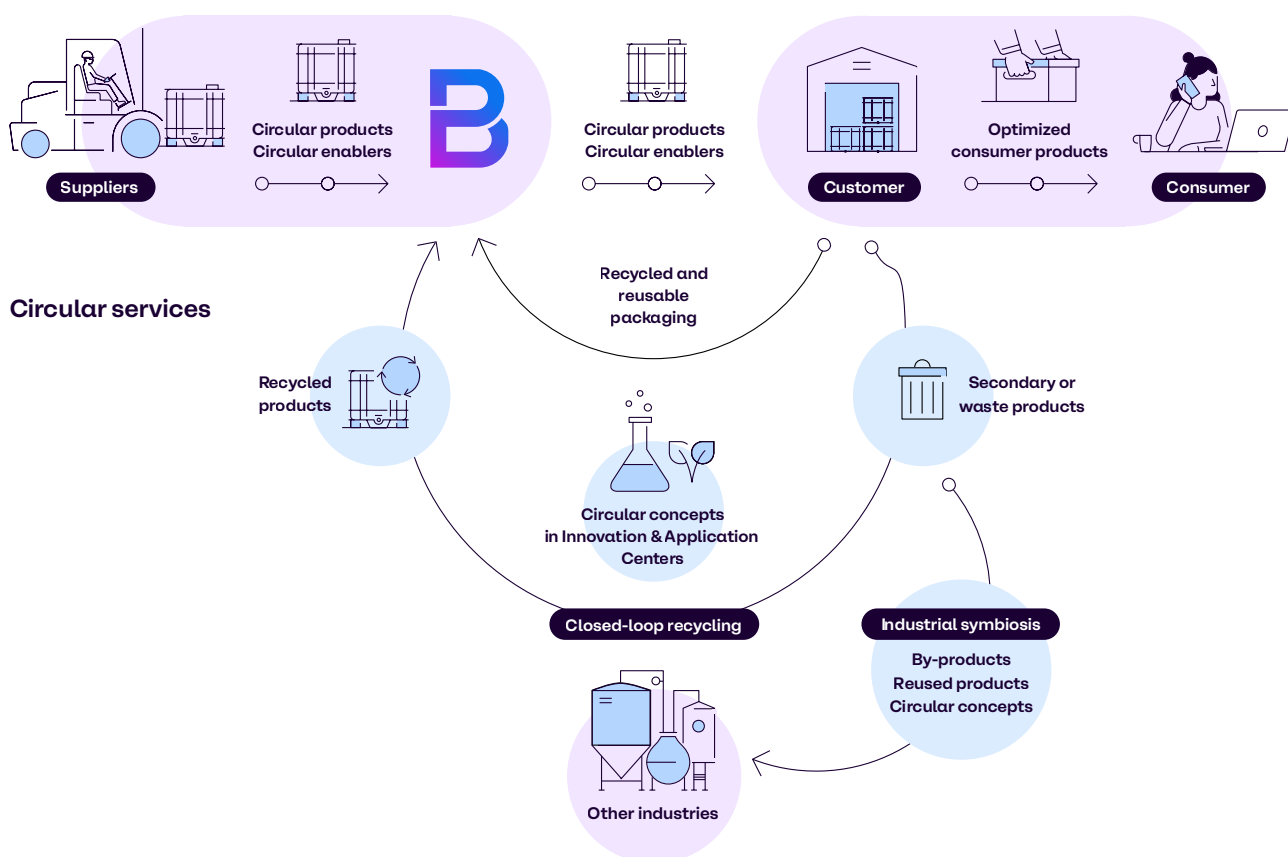
¹⁾ Further information on this is contained in the section "General disclosures", sub-section "Double materiality assessment".

²⁾ Further information can be found in the section "Climate change", sub-section "Policies and actions, Scope 3 emissions".

By enabling the calculation of product carbon footprints (PCFs) for materials derived from recycling processes, Brenntag provides a robust and credible tool to support and expand circular initiatives. The application of the methodology at the Antwerp Distillation Company (ADC) and the Lohn-Ammensegg sites clearly demonstrates its value for recycled products through quantifiable and reliable CO₂e reductions when compared with virgin alternatives. A practical

example of this are low-emission, high-purity upcycled glycols such as diethylene glycol (DEG) and triethylene glycol (TEG). These substances serve a wide range of industrial applications – from polymer production to use as plasticizers or solvents – while simultaneously advancing Brenntag's circular product portfolio and supporting customers in achieving their sustainability goals.

Circular procurement



2.39 Circular products

Targets and metrics

E5-3, E5-4, E5-5, ESRS 2 BP-2

Based on the circular economy model described, Brenntag successfully established ten business models aligned with circular economy principles by the end of 2025. Not individu-

ally but collectively, these models reached the targeted annual sales threshold, generating over EUR ten million in total. The target is therefore regarded as having been met. Consideration was given to projects from all Brenntag divisions and regions. Below is a table of the ten circular projects.

Division	Business unit / region	Project	Circular category
BSP	Nutrition	Ingredients for shelf life extension	Circular sourcing
BSP	Material Science	Bio-based raw materials	Circular sourcing
BSP	Material Science	Enhance recycling in the polymers industry	Circular sourcing
BSP	Beauty & Care	Upcycled ingredients	Circular sourcing
BSP	Pharma	Circular solvent services	Industrial symbiosis
BES	EMEA	Solvent regeneration	Recycling
BES	EMEA	Activated carbon reactivation	Recycling
BES	EMEA	Glycol recycling	Recycling
BES	North America	Rental Service Specialty (RSS) - circular services for pipeline business	Circular services
BES	EMEA	Direct sales of used products in reuse cases	Reuse

2.40 Ten circular business models

Brenntag has set up a suitable project tracking system to efficiently track results. Progress in achieving the target is reviewed by the Board of Management on a quarterly basis using an ESG scorecard. The target described is voluntary and is not based on any specific scientific evidence.

Information on the products and materials marketed during the reporting period is shown in the following table. Brenntag purchases industrial and specialty chemicals and ingredients from a large number of suppliers. The products are stored in distribution facilities, mixed and blended as needed – including by adding water – packaged as required and delivered to the processing industry, typically in less-than-truckloads. This also includes the distribution of products and services that take account of the features of the circular economy. Further detailed information on the business activities and Group structure can be found in the relevant section of the management report.

Circular products	2025	2024
Total weight of products (t)	13,856,047	14,262,914
Share of biological products (%)	5.8%	5.9%
Weight of secondary reused or recycled products (t)	27,034	25,746
Share of secondary reused or recycled products (%)	0.2%	0.2%
Weight of circular products (t) ¹⁾	61,471	51,136
Share of circular products (%) ¹⁾	0.4%	0.4%

2.41 Circular products

¹⁾ Entity-specific metric.

Accounting principles

As a chemical distributor, Brenntag's products leave the sites in the chemical state in which they were delivered. This means that the material inflow essentially corresponds to the material outflow. The total weight of the chemicals and ingredients is determined on the basis of sales data. The share of biological products is estimated using different factors: In the Brenntag Specialties division, the sales volumes of the Food & Nutrition unit are taken into account. For the Brenntag Essentials division, the sales volumes of the principal bio-based product categories are used, such as bioethanol and glycerin. In addition, the sales volumes of products labeled as 'bio-based accelerators' are included for both divisions. As described in more detail in the section on portfolio steering, 'accelerators' are defined as products that make a particular contribution to sustainability based on established methods such as the Framework for Portfolio Sustainability Assessments of the World Business Council for Sustainable Development (WBCSD). Of the biological products, 0% are sustainably sourced, since there are no sustainability certifications for the majority of these products yet.

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In determining the weight and the share of secondary reused or recycled products, products clearly labeled as 'accelerator' bearing the distinguishing feature 'recycled' or 'upcycled' (excluding food ingredients) are taken into account so that double counting is ruled out.

The weight and the share of the entity-specific circular products are calculated on the basis of the circular economy model described above, bearing in mind the following categories: bio-based accelerators, recycled products, by-products, products for direct reuse, circular enablers, products related to industrial symbiosis and closed circular economy model services. Thus, bio-based accelerators and secondary reused or recycled products are also included in the circular products category. Regional data gaps are closed through estimates based on data from other regions.

Circular packaging

Policies and actions

E5-1, E5-2

A global policy for the standardization and use of packaging is currently being planned with a view to consolidating the existing worldwide initiatives. Brenntag currently manages its packaging on a regional basis. Brenntag EMEA, for example, has introduced a guideline on the use of refurbished intermediate bulk containers (IBCs). This is aimed at promoting the reuse of IBCs and minimizing the use of new goods while at the same time cutting costs. It contains a binding list of product groups where the use of refurbished light duty (LD) IBCs is prescribed. The guideline was approved by the CEO of Brenntag EMEA and can be downloaded on the intranet.

Similarly, the Brenntag North America Poly and Stainless Steel IBC Use Protocol specifies the maximum lifespan of various IBC types for hazardous and non-hazardous products while ensuring compliance with safety standards. This supports the safe and resource-efficient use of IBCs. The guideline was approved by the Senior Director of Operations North America and is available to the Brenntag companies operating in the North America region.

In collaboration with suppliers and customers, Brenntag endeavors to ensure its packaging materials' further use and reuse worldwide. In 2024, Brenntag's template for a framework supply agreement for packaging was updated and extended to include a sustainability clause. This is intended to improve transparency with regard to packaging data. The clause will provide Brenntag with information on the packaging specifications, including information on whether the packaging is new or reused. Information on the percentage weight of recycled packaging materials and a report on the packaging's product carbon footprint (PCF) are also required. This packaging supply agreement template is used and serves as the standard contract format for regional or global packaging supply agreements.

Brenntag is continuously involved globally in taking back and reusing IBCs. These can be directly reused, provided they are continuously filled with the same chemical ('product-related container') and no cleaning is therefore required. In addition, rinsing, washing and drying facilities are available at selected Brenntag sites so that IBCs can be cleaned internally. Alternatively, cleaning can be outsourced to external service providers. After cleaning, the IBCs can be flexibly reused for different products. IBCs and other packaging are reused worldwide and this reuse is adapted in line with specific customer requirements and product specifications.

Targets and metrics

E5-3, E5-4, E5-5, ESRS 2 BP-2

Brenntag is still in the process of setting up a global system for capturing packaging data in order to optimize transparency with regard to reusability and recyclability. For this reason, no targets in relation to packaging have yet been set in accordance with ESRS requirements.

The following table contains an overview of the packaging used during the reporting period, including packaging in conformity with circular economy principles.

Circular packaging	2025	2024
Total weight of used packaging (t)	60,475	60,943
Share of biological packaging (%)	3.1%	3.1%
Weight of reused or recycled packaging parts (t)	23,991	23,765
Share of reused or recycled packaging parts (%)	39.7%	39.0%
Recyclable content of packaging (%)	99.9%	99.9%

2.42 Circular packaging

Accounting principles

The data given relate only to the purchased packaging types 'IBCs' and 'drums' as well as wooden pallets. The weight data for wooden pallets are being reported for the first time in the reporting period; data for the previous reporting period have been added accordingly. The data for IBCs and drums were extrapolated based on the previous year's metrics using regional, volume-based growth factors. The data used in the previous year come from the local ERP systems or were collected in supplier surveys. The wooden pallets' weight was also extrapolated. To this end, a wooden pallet-to-IBC ratio was first calculated based on supplier data from 2024 and then applied to all IBCs.

Waste

Policies and actions

E5-1, E5-2

Waste management at Brenntag is carried out as part of the management system of the QSHE (Quality, Safety, Health and Environment) department. The Global QSHE Policy specifies the Group's overarching objectives and standards. Building on this, the QSHE environmental management guideline sets out the specifications for an efficient waste management system in compliance with local statutory requirements at all Brenntag sites. The current environmental management guideline applies to all Brenntag companies, was approved by the Board of Management and can be viewed through the QSHE management platform on the intranet. As part of the organization's commitment to continuous improvement, this guideline is being updated to include new requirements regarding waste management as well as the systematic collection and sharing of best practices in waste management across regions to foster a culture of waste reduction and environmental protection.

Waste data are captured locally and consolidated globally, allowing Brenntag to identify sites and regions with higher waste volumes and target action where it matters most. For example, in Brazil, the Brenntag teams are already focusing on preventing materials from becoming obsolete and minimizing disposal through alternative distribution channels; through 'Slow Moving Avoidance' and 'Product Disposal Reduction' initiatives, fewer items reach end of life and can instead be reused in other applications. These measures shift our approach from reactive to preventive by aligning procurement, planning, sales, and quality to extend product use, conserve resources, and reduce waste generation. Similar efforts are advancing in EMEA, where product managers and the supply chain are joining efforts to repurpose slow movers together with other facilities or through partnerships with external suppliers, with the shared goal of reducing waste.

In order to avoid waste from the outset and minimize waste generation, Brenntag requires the employees concerned to undertake regular training on the handling of chemical products, including their storage and transportation. In some cases, Brenntag also goes beyond local statutory requirements in order to reduce the environmental impacts of waste. All sites in the Latin America region, for example, are required to systematically separate waste.

As part of its waste management, Brenntag has also implemented a global data collection policy that has standardized and improved waste monitoring globally. During the reporting period, a global review of waste data capture processes, standardized reporting functions and documented controls on the reported information was conducted so as to ensure consistent, reliable waste-management reporting. Additionally, this year, all regions reported data on waste at site level, improving data consistency and granularity.

Targets and metrics

E5-3, E5-5, ESRS 2 BP-2

Although no targets have yet been set for waste in accordance with ESRS requirements, Brenntag intends to monitor certain waste streams by continuously improving waste data collection in order to identify opportunities to reduce and recycle waste.

Waste generated	2025	2024
Total amount of non-hazardous waste (t)	28,435	36,415
Total amount of hazardous waste (t)	16,957	20,232
Total amount of waste generated (t)	45,392	56,647

2.43 Waste generated

Disposal operation	2025	2024
Recycling – non-hazardous waste (t)	5,674	4,773
Recycling – hazardous waste (t)	6,202	5,369
Total amount of recycled waste	11,876	10,142
Incineration – non-hazardous waste (t)	2,096	24,052
Incineration – hazardous waste (t)	4,024	2,769
Landfill – non-hazardous waste (t)	7,493	7,589
Landfill – hazardous waste (t)	658	317
Other disposal operation – non-hazardous waste (t)	13,172	-
Other disposal operation – hazardous waste (t)	6,073	11,777
Total amount of non-recycled waste	33,516	46,504
Share of non-recycled waste (%)	73.8%	82.1%

2.44 Disposal operations

Accounting principles

As a chemical distributor, Brenntag distinguishes between hazardous and non-hazardous waste, depending on the type of waste generated. Non-hazardous waste mainly comprises plastics, wood and paper. Hazardous waste is defined by ESR5 E5 as waste which displays one or more of the hazardous properties listed in Annex III to EU Directive 2008/98/EC. The waste data capture and validation process is carried out in accordance with the global policy governing the capture and validation of waste and water data, which sets out guidelines for the local companies on recording waste management at local level in accordance with local reporting requirements.

Data on waste generation at operating sites were collected using different methods. Some sites obtained this information from invoices and waste manifests, others from product databases, while some estimated waste generation by calculating an average weight per full waste container (e.g. 200 kg per container) and multiplying it by the total number of containers. Additional similar assumptions were also applied. The data for the fourth quarter are based on estimates. It is assumed that the first to third quarters account for 75% of the year, with the remaining 25% scaled accordingly. The extrapolation was performed at the site level and subsequently aggregated to produce the Brenntag Group's total value.

EU Taxonomy

The disclosures on the environmental objectives set out in the Taxonomy Regulation are presented together in the section EU Taxonomy.

Background to and scope of the reporting

By adopting the Action Plan on Financing Sustainable Growth, the European Union took a decisive step to extend its commitment to climate protection and sustainable business practice on the financial markets. One tool in the action plan presented in March 2018 is the EU Taxonomy Regulation (EU Taxonomy). This uniform and legally binding classification system sets out which economic activities are regarded as environmentally sustainable in accordance with the EU Taxonomy and how they should be reported. The aim is to steer financial flows toward green investments. Investors should thus be able to decide whether they wish to contribute to the EU's goals through their investments. All companies that are required to provide non-financial reporting pursuant to Section 315b et seq. of the German Commercial Code (HGB) have been obliged to disclose information on the implementation of the EU Taxonomy since financial year 2021.

Against this background, in the following section, Brenntag SE as a parent company presents the proportion of its consolidated turnover, capital expenditure (CapEx) and operating expenditure (OpEx) for the 2025 reporting period. These proportions were analyzed with regard to Taxonomy-eligible economic activities in relation to all six environmental objectives pursuant to Art. 8 of the EU Taxonomy and Taxonomy-eligible economic activities were identified for four environmental objectives. The scope of consolidation of the Brenntag Group comprises only non-financial subsidiaries.

Brenntag's Taxonomy-eligible economic activities

Brenntag, as a distributor, generates external turnover through the sale of chemicals and ingredients as well as the provision of services. The review of the economic activities in accordance with the Regulations relating to the EU Taxonomy in effect as at December 31, 2025 (see Delegated Regulations (EU) 2023/2486 (Environmental Delegated Act), (EU) 2021/2178), and (EU) 2023/2485 and (EU) 2021/2139) (Climate Delegated Act)) revealed that Annex II to Delegated Regulation (EU) 2023/2486 (transition to a circular economy) and Annex III to Delegated Regulation (EU) 2023/2486 (pollution prevention and control) are relevant to Brenntag for turnover. More specifically, this means that a small portion of the turnover is attributable to certain chemicals named in the Regulation which Brenntag recycles itself (which, in the context of the Regulation, is regarded as the "treatment of hazardous waste"). That means Brenntag receives hazardous waste and reprocesses it such that it can be reused by the business partners in question. Brenntag therefore presents both the turnover attributable to this Taxonomy-eligible economic activity and the capital and operating expenditure related to assets or processes that are associated with this activity ("category a" acc. to Section 1.1.2.2 of Annex I to the Art. 8 Delegated Act).

Description of the Brenntag activity	Annexes I to IV to the Environmental Delegated Act
Recycling of hazardous waste	Treatment of hazardous waste (CE2.4 / PPC 2.2.)

2.45 Relevant Brenntag activity and corresponding economic activity in the EU Taxonomy

Brenntag also discloses capital and operating expenditure related to the purchase of output from Taxonomy-eligible economic activities and certain individual measures to improve energy efficiency. These are economic activities and individual measures listed in Annex I to II to the Climate Delegated Act and in Annexes I to IV to the Environmental Delegated Act ("category c" Section 1.1.2.2. of Annex I to the Art. 8 Delegated Act). Brenntag has identified the following purchase of output and the following individual measures that correspond to economic activities pursuant to the EU Taxonomy and therefore result in Taxonomy-eligible CapEx/OpEx:

GROUP SUSTAINABILITY STATEMENT

Description of the Brenntag activity	Corresponding economic activity in the EU Taxonomy	
	Annexes I to II to the Climate Delegated Act	Annexes I to IV to the Environmental Delegated Act
Motor vehicles		
Purchase and leasing of heavy goods vehicles for freight transport	Freight transport services by road (CCM 6.6.)	
Purchase, leasing, repair and maintenance of industrial trucks	Manufacture of other low-carbon technologies (CCM 3.6.)	
Purchase and leasing of passenger cars as company vehicles	Transport by motorbikes, passenger cars and light commercial vehicles (CCM 6.5.)	
Renewable energy technologies		
Purchase, leasing and maintenance of renewable energy technologies for electricity and heat generation at Brenntag sites, e.g. solar panels, heat pumps and wind turbines	Installation, maintenance and repair of renewable energy technologies (CCM 7.6.)	
Buildings		
Construction of new buildings	Construction of new buildings (CCM 7.1.)	Construction of new buildings (CE 3.1.)
Acquisition and leasing of existing buildings	Acquisition and ownership of buildings (CCM 7.7.)	
Installation, maintenance and repair of energy efficiency equipment	Installation, maintenance and repair of energy efficiency equipment (CCM 7.3.)	
Installation and maintenance of charging stations for electric vehicles	Installation, maintenance and repair of charging stations for electric vehicles in buildings (and parking spaces attached to buildings) (CCM 7.4)	
Equipment		
Installation and maintenance of water treatment facilities		Urban waste water treatment (WTR 2.2.)
Environmental remediation		
Environmental remediation		Remediation of contaminated sites and areas (PPC 2.4.)

2.46 Relevant Brenntag activity and corresponding economic activity in the EU Taxonomy

For the allocation of turnover, CapEx and OpEx, Brenntag identified the relevant sales, purchases and measures, and then allocated these to the related economic activity in the Climate Delegated Act and the Environmental Delegated Act. In this way, Brenntag ensures that no turnover, CapEx or OpEx is included more than once. The turnover, CapEx or OpEx thus identified forms the numerator of the performance indicators reported below.

Brenntag's Taxonomy-aligned economic activities

The review for Taxonomy-alignment consists of multiple steps that must be followed individually, with the results documented by the Group companies. In addition to the economic activity's substantial contribution to at least one relevant environmental objective of the EU Taxonomy, the criteria on avoiding significant harm to one or more of the six environmental objectives, referred to as the 'do no significant harm' (DNSH) criteria, and compliance with the minimum requirements regarding human rights, anti-corruption, taxation and fair competition must also be checked. With regard to compliance with the minimum requirements, the review must also be carried out for Brenntag SE without reference to a specific economic activity.

Brenntag follows a top-down approach when reviewing Taxonomy alignment. First, it is assessed whether the minimum safeguards are met. Only then does the process provide for a detailed assessment of the technical screening criteria regarding a substantial contribution. Brenntag does not meet the minimum safeguards in full, as so far only direct suppliers have been taken into account with regard to fulfilling human rights due diligence obligations. As all of the above-mentioned criteria must be met, no Taxonomy-aligned turnover, CapEx or OpEx can be presented.

Brenntag therefore reports the following metrics:

Financial year 2025

	Code (2)	Turnover (3)	Proportion of turnover, year 2025 (4)	Substantial contribution criteria					
				Climate change mitigation (5)	Climate change adaptation (6)	Water (7)	Pollution (8)	Circular economy (9)	Biodiversity (10)
Economic activities (1)									
A. TAXONOMY-ELIGIBLE ACTIVITIES									
A.1 Environmentally sustainable activities (Taxonomy-aligned)									
none									
Turnover of environmentally sustainable activities (Taxonomy-aligned) (A.1)		EUR 0	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%
A.2 Taxonomy-eligible but not environmentally sustainable activities (not Taxonomy-aligned activities)									
Treatment of hazardous waste	CE 2.4.	EUR 2,685,002	0.02%	N/EL	N/EL	N/EL	N/EL	EL	N/EL
Treatment of hazardous waste	PPC 2.2.	EUR 3,101,238	0.02%	N/EL	N/EL	N/EL	EL	N/EL	N/EL
Turnover of Taxonomy-eligible but not environmentally sustainable activities (not Taxonomy-aligned activities) (A.2)		EUR 5,786,241	0.04%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.02%	0.02%	0.00%
A. Turnover of Taxonomy-eligible activities (A.1 + A.2)		EUR 5,786,241	0.04%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.02%	0.02%	0.00%
B. TAXONOMY-NON-ELIGIBLE ACTIVITIES									
Turnover of Taxonomy-non-eligible activities		EUR 15,165,686,337	99.96%						
Total		EUR 15,171,472,578	100.00%						

2.47a Turnover KPI

Proportion of turnover from products or services associated with Taxonomy-aligned economic activities – disclosure covering year 2025

GROUP SUSTAINABILITY STATEMENT

Financial year 2025	DNSH criteria (Does not significantly harm)									
	Climate change mitigation (11)	Climate change adaptation (12)	Water (13)	Pollution (14)	Circular economy (15)	Biodiversity (16)	Minimum safeguards (17)	Proportion of Taxonomy-aligned (A.1) or -eligible (A.2) turnover, year 2024 (18)	Category (enabling activity) (19)	Category (transitional activity) (20)
Economic activities (1)										
A. TAXONOMY-ELIGIBLE ACTIVITIES										
A.1 Environmentally sustainable activities (Taxonomy-aligned)										
none										
Turnover of environmentally sustainable activities (Taxonomy-aligned) (A.1)	N	N	N	N	N	N	N	0.00%		
A.2 Taxonomy-eligible but not environmentally sustainable activities (not Taxonomy-aligned activities)										
Treatment of hazardous waste								0.00%		
Treatment of hazardous waste								0.02%		
Turnover of Taxonomy-eligible but not environmentally sustainable activities (not Taxonomy-aligned activities) (A.2)								0.02%		
A. Turnover of Taxonomy-eligible activities (A.1 + A.2)								0.02%		
B. TAXONOMY-NON-ELIGIBLE ACTIVITIES										
Turnover of Taxonomy-non-eligible activities								99.98%		
Total								100.00%		

2.47b Turnover KPI

GROUP SUSTAINABILITY STATEMENT

Financial year 2025

Substantial contribution criteria

Economic activities (1)	Code (2)	CapEx (3)	Proportion of CapEx, year 2025 (4)	Climate change mitigation (5)	Climate change adaptation (6)	Water (7)	Pollution (8)	Circular economy (9)	Biodiversity (10)
A. TAXONOMY-ELIGIBLE ACTIVITIES									
A.1 Environmentally sustainable activities (Taxonomy-aligned)									
none									
CapEx of environmentally sustainable activities (Taxonomy-aligned) (A.1)		EUR 0	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%
A.2 Taxonomy-eligible but not environmentally sustainable activities (not Taxonomy-aligned activities)									
Freight transport services by road	CCM 6.6.	EUR 17,029,261	3.99%	EL	N/EL	N/EL	N/EL	N/EL	N/EL
Manufacture of other low-carbon technologies	CCM 3.6.	EUR 3,575,831	0.84%	EL	N/EL	N/EL	N/EL	N/EL	N/EL
Transport by motorbikes, passenger cars and light commercial vehicles	CCM 6.5.	EUR 20,250,112	4.75%	EL	N/EL	N/EL	N/EL	N/EL	N/EL
Installation, maintenance and repair of renewable energy technologies	CCM 7.6.	EUR 1,970,940	0.46%	EL	N/EL	N/EL	N/EL	N/EL	N/EL
Construction of new buildings	CCM 7.1.	EUR 9,418,453	2.21%	EL	N/EL	N/EL	N/EL	N/EL	N/EL
Construction of new buildings	CE 3.1.	EUR 0	0.00%	N/EL	N/EL	N/EL	N/EL	EL	N/EL
Acquisition and ownership of buildings	CCM 7.7.	EUR 81,862,123	19.19%	EL	N/EL	N/EL	N/EL	N/EL	N/EL
Installation, maintenance and repair of energy efficiency equipment	CCM 7.3.	EUR 8,719,090	2.04%	EL	N/EL	N/EL	N/EL	N/EL	N/EL
Installation, maintenance and repair of charging stations for electric vehicles in buildings (and parking spaces attached to buildings)	CCM 7.4.	EUR 186,860	0.04%	EL	N/EL	N/EL	N/EL	N/EL	N/EL
Urban waste water treatment	WTR 2.2.	EUR 218,947	0.05%	N/EL	N/EL	EL	N/EL	N/EL	N/EL
Treatment of hazardous waste	PPC 2.2.	EUR 28,934	0.01%	N/EL	N/EL	N/EL	EL	N/EL	N/EL
CapEx of Taxonomy-eligible but not environmentally sustainable activities (not Taxonomy-aligned activities) (A.2)		EUR 143,260,551	33.58%	33.52%	0.00%	0.05%	0.01%	0.00%	0.00%
A. CapEx of Taxonomy-eligible activities (A.1 + A.2)		EUR 143,260,551	33.58%	33.52%	0.00%	0.05%	0.01%	0.00%	0.00%
B. TAXONOMY-NON-ELIGIBLE ACTIVITIES									
CapEx of Taxonomy-non-eligible activities		EUR 283,363,221	66.42%						
Total		EUR 426,623,772	100.00%						

2.48a CapEx KPI¹³Proportion of CapEx from products or services associated with
Taxonomy-aligned economic activities – disclosure covering year 2025

GROUP SUSTAINABILITY STATEMENT

Financial year 2025	DNSH criteria (Does not significantly harm)							Proportion of Taxonomy-aligned (A.1) or -eligible (A.2) CapEx, year 2024 (18)	Category (enabling activity) (19)	Category (transitional activity) (20)
	Climate change mitigation (11)	Climate change adaptation (12)	Water (13)	Pollution (14)	Circular economy (15)	Biodiversity (16)	Minimum safeguards (17)			
Economic activities (1)										
A. TAXONOMY-ELIGIBLE ACTIVITIES										
A.1 Environmentally sustainable activities (Taxonomy-aligned)										
none										
CapEx of environmentally sustainable activities (Taxonomy-aligned) (A.1)	N	N	N	N	N	N	N	0.00%		
A.2 Taxonomy-eligible but not environmentally sustainable activities (not Taxonomy-aligned activities)										
Freight transport services by road								0.59%		
Manufacture of other low-carbon technologies								0.62%		
Transport by motorbikes, passenger cars and light commercial vehicles								3.45%		
Installation, maintenance and repair of renewable energy technologies								0.23%		
Construction of new buildings								0.59%		
Construction of new buildings								0.01%		
Acquisition and ownership of buildings								16.07%		
Installation, maintenance and repair of energy efficiency equipment								0.44%		
Installation, maintenance and repair of charging stations for electric vehicles in buildings (and parking spaces attached to buildings)								0.01%		
Urban waste water treatment								0.13%		
Treatment of hazardous waste								0.09%		
CapEx of Taxonomy-eligible but not environmentally sustainable activities (not Taxonomy-aligned activities) (A.2)								22.23%		
A. CapEx of Taxonomy-eligible activities (A.1 + A.2)								22.23%		
B. TAXONOMY-NON-ELIGIBLE ACTIVITIES										
CapEx of Taxonomy-non-eligible activities								77.77%		
Total								100.00%		

2.48b CapEx KPI¹⁾

¹⁾ The decrease in CapEx – for both Taxonomy-eligible and Taxonomy-non-eligible economic activities – was driven by lower additions from acquisitions in the reporting period.

GROUP SUSTAINABILITY STATEMENT

Financial year 2025

Substantial contribution criteria

Economic activities (1)	Code (2)	OpEx (3)	Proportion of OpEx, year 2025 (4)	Climate change mitigation (5)	Climate change adaptation (6)	Water (7)	Pollution (8)	Circular economy (9)	Biodiversity (10)
A. TAXONOMY-ELIGIBLE ACTIVITIES									
A.1 Environmentally sustainable activities (Taxonomy-aligned)									
none									
OpEx of environmentally sustainable activities (Taxonomy-aligned) (A.1)		EUR 0	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%
A.2 Taxonomy-eligible but not environmentally sustainable activities (not Taxonomy-aligned activities)									
Freight transport services by road	CCM 6.6.	EUR 4,583,512	2.39%	EL	N/EL	N/EL	N/EL	N/EL	N/EL
Manufacture of other low-carbon technologies	CCM 3.6.	EUR 1,134,916	0.59%	EL	N/EL	N/EL	N/EL	N/EL	N/EL
Transport by motorbikes, passenger cars and light commercial vehicles	CCM 6.5.	EUR 4,677,179	2.44%	EL	N/EL	N/EL	N/EL	N/EL	N/EL
Installation, maintenance and repair of renewable energy technologies	CCM 7.6.	EUR 29,515	0.02%	EL	N/EL	N/EL	N/EL	N/EL	N/EL
Construction of new buildings	CCM 7.1.	EUR 3,421,481	1.79%	EL	N/EL	N/EL	N/EL	N/EL	N/EL
Acquisition and ownership of buildings	CCM 7.7.	EUR 19,898,499	10.39%	EL	N/EL	N/EL	N/EL	N/EL	N/EL
Installation, maintenance and repair of energy efficiency equipment	CCM 7.3.	EUR 2,434,062	1.27%	EL	N/EL	N/EL	N/EL	N/EL	N/EL
Installation, maintenance and repair of charging stations for electric vehicles in buildings (and parking spaces attached to buildings)	CCM 7.4.	EUR 1,201,122	0.63%	EL	N/EL	N/EL	N/EL	N/EL	N/EL
Urban waste water treatment	WTR 2.2.	EUR 65,715	0.03%	N/EL	N/EL	EL	N/EL	N/EL	N/EL
Treatment of hazardous waste	PPC 2.2.	EUR 41,853	0.02%	N/EL	N/EL	N/EL	EL	N/EL	N/EL
Remediation of contaminated sites and areas	PPC 2.4.	EUR 11,636,898	6.08%	N/EL	N/EL	N/EL	EL	N/EL	N/EL
OpEx of Taxonomy-eligible but not environmentally sustainable activities (not Taxonomy-aligned activities) (A.2)		EUR 49,124,752	25.66%	19.53%	0.00%	0.03%	6.10%	0.00%	0.00%
A. OpEx of Taxonomy-eligible activities (A.1 + A.2)		EUR 49,124,752	25.66%	19.53%	0.00%	0.03%	6.10%	0.00%	0.00%
B. TAXONOMY-NON-ELIGIBLE ACTIVITIES									
OpEx of Taxonomy-non-eligible activities		EUR 142,306,039	74.34%						
Total		EUR 191,430,791	100.00%						

2.49a Proportion of OpEx from products or services associated with Taxonomy-aligned economic activities - disclosure covering year 2025

GROUP SUSTAINABILITY STATEMENT

Financial year 2025	DNSH criteria (Does not significantly harm)						Minimum safeguards (17)	Proportion of Taxonomy-aligned (A.1) or -eligible (A.2) OpEx, year 2024 (18)	Category (enabling activity) (19)	Category (transitional activity) (20)
	Climate change mitigation (11)	Climate change adaptation (12)	Water (13)	Pollution (14)	Circular economy (15)	Biodiversity (16)				
Economic activities (1)										
A. TAXONOMY-ELIGIBLE ACTIVITIES										
A.1 Environmentally sustainable activities (Taxonomy-aligned)										
none										
OpEx of environmentally sustainable activities (Taxonomy-aligned) (A.1)	N	N	N	N	N	N	N	0.00%		
A.2 Taxonomy-eligible but not environmentally sustainable activities (not Taxonomy-aligned activities)										
Freight transport services by road								1.88%		
Manufacture of other low-carbon technologies								0.43%		
Transport by motorbikes, passenger cars and light commercial vehicles								2.13%		
Installation, maintenance and repair of renewable energy technologies								0.00%		
Construction of new buildings								2.09%		
Acquisition and ownership of buildings								7.57%		
Installation, maintenance and repair of energy efficiency equipment								0.83%		
Installation, maintenance and repair of charging stations for electric vehicles in buildings (and parking spaces attached to buildings)								0.01%		
Urban waste water treatment								0.02%		
Treatment of hazardous waste								0.00%		
Remediation of contaminated sites and areas								5.41%		
OpEx of Taxonomy-eligible but not environmentally sustainable activities (not Taxonomy-aligned activities) (A.2)								20.36%		
A. OpEx of Taxonomy-eligible activities (A.1 + A.2)								20.36%		
B. TAXONOMY-NON-ELIGIBLE ACTIVITIES										
OpEx of Taxonomy-non-eligible activities								79.64%		
Total								100.00%		

2.49b OpEx KPI³⁾

³⁾ Brenntag does not carry out any nuclear power and gas activities and therefore does not disclose the specific tables relating to these activities. The increase in OpEx for Taxonomy-eligible economic activities is due mainly to higher expenses for the leasing of warehouse sites and for the remediation of contaminated sites and areas.

Accounting principles

Brenntag determines the Taxonomy KPIs in accordance with the legal requirements, including Annex I to the Art. 8 Delegated Act, and describes its accounting principles in this regard as follows:

Turnover KPI

The proportion of Taxonomy-eligible economic activities in the total turnover has been calculated as the part of net turnover derived from products and services associated with Taxonomy-eligible economic activities (numerator) divided by the net turnover (denominator). The denominator of the turnover KPI is based on the company's consolidated net turnover in accordance with International Accounting Standard (IAS) 1.82(a), which can be taken from the consolidated financial statements; see section "Consolidated income statement". Further details on Brenntag's accounting principles for consolidated net turnover can be found in the section Accounting and measurement policies.

With regard to the numerator, the company refers to the explanations above ("Brenntag's Taxonomy-eligible economic activities" section).

CapEx KPI

The CapEx KPI is defined as Taxonomy-eligible CapEx (numerator) divided by total CapEx (denominator) as specified in the EU Taxonomy. Total CapEx consists of additions to tangible and intangible fixed assets during the financial year, before depreciation, amortization and any remeasurements, including those resulting from revaluations and impairments, and excluding fair value changes.

It includes additions to property, plant and equipment (IAS 16), intangible assets (IAS 38) and right-of-use assets (International Financial Reporting Standards, IFRS 16). Additions resulting from business combinations are also included. Goodwill is not included in CapEx because it is not defined as an intangible asset in accordance with IAS 38. Further details on the accounting principles with regard to the company's CapEx can be found in the sections "Property, plant and equipment", "Intangible assets", and "Leases".

Brenntag's total CapEx can be derived from the consolidated financial statements from the statements of changes in property, plant and equipment, intangible assets (excluding goodwill) and right-of-use assets (see table 3.49 Property, plant and equipment, table 3.50 Intangible assets and table 3.54 Right-of-use assets). It is the sum total of the following transaction types:

- business combinations and
- other additions

for property, plant and equipment, intangible assets (excluding goodwill) and right-of-use assets.

With regard to the numerator, Brenntag refers to the explanations above ("Brenntag's Taxonomy-eligible economic activities" section).

OpEx KPI

The OpEx KPI is defined as Taxonomy-eligible OpEx (numerator) divided by total OpEx (denominator).

Total OpEx consists of direct uncapped costs that relate to research and development, building renovation measures, short-term leases, maintenance and repair, remediation and any other direct expenditures relating to the day-to-day servicing of assets of property, plant and equipment.

For the Brenntag Group, the following aspects must be taken into account in this regard:

- The Brenntag Group does not incur any research and development expenses.
- The volume of uncapped leases was determined in accordance with IFRS 16 and includes expenses for short-term leases, variable leases and low-value leases (see table 3.55 Lease expenses). Even though variable leases and low-value leases are not explicitly mentioned in the Art. 8 Delegated Act, Brenntag has interpreted the legislation as to include these leases.
- Maintenance and repair and other direct expenditures relating to the servicing of assets of property, plant and equipment were recorded in separate accounts. The related cost items can be found in the other operating expenses item in the consolidated income statement and are part of maintenance and energy costs (see table 3.28 Other operating expenses). This also includes building renovation measures. As a rule, these are costs for services and material costs.
- Expenses for the remediation of environmental damage, mainly for soil and groundwater for current and former, owned or leased sites. The related cost items are included in the other operating expenses item in the consolidated income statement and are part of miscellaneous operating expenses (see table 3.28 Other operating expenses).

With regard to the numerator, Brenntag refers to the explanations above ("Brenntag's Taxonomy-eligible economic activities" section).

GROUP SUSTAINABILITY STATEMENT

Social

Own workforce

Material impacts, risks and opportunities related to own workforce

ESRS 2 BP-2, ESRS 2 SBM-1, ESRS 2 SBM-3, ESRS 2 IRO-1, S1-1, S1-4, S1-5, S1-6

Through their expertise and dedication, Brenntag's employees play a key role in the Group's success and long-term

competitiveness. Brenntag sees it as its responsibility to offer fair working conditions and a safe, attractive and inspiring working environment while providing its employees with targeted support to promote their personal and professional development. In the course of the materiality assessment performed¹⁾, the following material impacts and opportunities arising from Brenntag's business activities were identified in relation to its own workforce:

Material topic	Impacts, risks or opportunities	Value chain	Time horizon	Description
Health and safety	Impact (negative)	Own operations	Constant	A lack of health and safety may lead to ill health (injuries, death, disability, mental health), e.g. as a result of accidents, exposure to chemicals, unsafe working conditions.
	Impact (positive)	Along the value chain	Constant	Involvement in industry associations enables higher health and safety standards to be set, including for the Group's own workforce (Responsible Care/Responsible Distribution).
Secure employment and adequate wages	Impact (positive)	Own operations	Constant	Adequate wages and secure employment create financial security.
Social dialog, freedom of association, existence of works councils and the information, consultation and participation rights of workers	Impact (negative)	Own operations	Constant	A lack of social dialog with employees and employee involvement in decision-making processes may lead to dissatisfaction, as employees' voices are not heard.
Working time, work-life balance	Impact (positive)	Own operations	Constant	A good work-life balance contributes to mental and physical health.
	Impact (negative)	Own operations	Constant	A lack of work-life balance and unreasonable working hours may lead to dissatisfaction, frustration or mental problems.
Training and skills development	Impact (negative)	Own operations	Constant	A lack of training and skills development leads to lower motivation and dissatisfaction among employees.
	Impact (negative)	Own operations	Constant	Missed career opportunities due to insufficient training and skills development.
	Impact (positive)	Own operations	Constant	Socioeconomic benefits: increased employability (attractiveness of employees to Brenntag and other potential employers) as a result of training and skills development.
	Impact (positive)	Own operations	Constant	Training and skills development keep employee motivation and satisfaction at a higher level.
	Opportunity	Own operations	Constant	More qualified and motivated employees increase sales revenues and lower costs through better quality and efficiency; sales and procurement are key areas.
Diversity	Impact (negative)	Own operations	Constant	A lack of diversity due to excessively low female representation in management positions may lead to lower productivity and discrimination in the workforce.

2.50 Material impacts and opportunity related to own workforce

¹⁾ Further information on this is contained in the section "General disclosures", sub-section "Double materiality assessment".

GROUP SUSTAINABILITY STATEMENT

The potential negative impacts listed are confined to individual incidents, such as accidents. If guidelines and regulations on social dialog or diversity have not been complied with, these are individual cases. As explained in more detail in the following sections, Brenntag has developed different policies and guidelines, taken actions and set targets in order to systematically address the impacts and opportunities identified. These sections also show which employees and external workers are addressed by the policies described and benefit from the actions taken. In this context, Brenntag employees include both permanent and temporary staff who are directly employed by the company under formal employment contracts. They work in production, warehousing, transportation, administration, or other operational areas and are subject to internal work policies as well as company-provided social benefits. In accordance with ESRS, external workers are explicitly included in occupational health and safety actions so as to ensure uniform standards and safeguards for all parties involved. This primarily includes temporary workers and freelancers who are integrated into the company organization.

The Group carries out a risk assessment with regard to possible human rights violations and environmental risks for its own operations. In this context, no activities were identified at significant risk of forced labor or child labor. Further information on human rights due diligence can be found in the section “Workers in the value chain”, sub-section “Policies and actions”.

The transition plan for climate change mitigation does not have a direct impact on Brenntag’s employees. Further information on this can be found in the section “Climate change”.

All policies and guidelines outlined in the following sections were developed by the functional departments responsible. Responsibility for their implementation lies with the Board of Management. The policies and guidelines are available to employees on the intranet. The targets formulated in the sections were developed by the respective specialists in close collaboration with other departments such as Group Sustainability and Change Management, and finalized with the involvement of the Board of Management. Progress in achieving the targets is reviewed by the Board of Management on a quarterly basis using an ESG scorecard.

The employee structure breaks down as follows. The number differs from the number of employees in section “4.) Personnel expenses” in the consolidated financial statements, as all metrics listed below are reported as at December 31, 2025, whereas the consolidated financial statements show average figures.

Gender	2025	2024 ¹⁾
Women	6,186	6,289
Men	11,049	11,704
Not specified	1	5
Brenntag Group	17,236	17,998

2.51 Number of employees by gender

¹⁾ The prior-year figures were adjusted (see also accounting principles below).

Region	2025	2024 ¹⁾
EMEA	7,800	7,998
North America	5,269	5,243
Latin America	1,834	2,000
Asia Pacific	2,333	2,757
Brenntag Group	17,236	17,998

2.52 Number of employees by region

¹⁾ The prior-year figures were adjusted (see also accounting principles below).

Country	2025	2024 ¹⁾
U.S.	4,668	4,648

2.53 Number of employees in countries with at least 50 employees and at least 10% of Brenntag's total workforce

¹⁾ The prior-year figures were adjusted (see also accounting principles below).

Accounting principles

Brenntag reports own workforce metrics based on the accounting definition set out in the German Commercial Code (HGB). This includes all individuals for whom Brenntag bears economic obligations and who are in an active employment relationship with Brenntag. This encompasses both full-time and part-time employees, with part-time employees reported as headcount figures rather than being converted into full-time equivalents. Conversely, individuals who are not considered employees within the meaning of the HGB are not included. This encompasses apprentices and employees in study programs, or employees whose employment relationship is suspended due to unpaid leave, such as parental leave. In addition, the company’s legal representatives, such as members of the Supervisory Board and the Board of Management, are not included in the reporting. The accounting-based definition of personnel metrics has been applied since financial year 2025, and the figures for 2024 were recalculated on this basis. The recalculation results in a variance of 439 employees in total.

Brenntag collects and analyzes human resources metrics using the global People platform “Workday Human Capital Management.” To ensure data quality, all local HR departments review employee structure data at the end of each quarter as part of an internally standardized audit process. Employees are assigned globally in a consistent manner according to the geographical region of the respective legal employer, with regions derived from the World Bank’s country classifications. In addition, Brenntag reports gender based on the gender identity stored in the People platform. Since only binary gender options are available in the People platform, the ‘Other’ category is not used in data collection. Employees for whom no gender information is available in the People platform are displayed with the status ‘Not specified’.

GROUP SUSTAINABILITY STATEMENT

In addition to the above workforce metrics, Brenntag voluntarily reports headcount by division. 90.5% of the workforce work outside Germany. In 2025, 224 employees joined through newly acquired companies and 433 employees left as a result of companies ceasing to be consolidated. Excluding the new acquisitions, the total number of people employed in the Brenntag Group declined by 1,007, or 5.6%, compared with the previous year.¹⁾

Division	2025		2024	
	abs.	in %	abs.	in %
Brenntag Specialties	3,504	20.2	3,594	19.8
Brenntag Essentials	11,602	66.9	12,237	67.5
Group and Regional Services	2,233	12.9	2,291	12.7
Brenntag Group	17,339	100.0	18,122	100.0

2.54 Number of employees per division

Accounting principles

Deviating from the aforementioned accounting definition under the German Commercial Code (HGB), workforce metrics by division also encompass apprentices, employees in study programs and members of the Board of Management.

Disclosures on the number of employees by contract type can be found in the section “Secure employment and adequate wages”, sub-section “Targets and metrics”. Disclosures on employee turnover are provided in the section “Working time and work-life balance”, sub-section “Targets and metrics”.

Occupational health and safety

Policies and actions

[S1-1](#), [S1-4](#), [S1-14](#)

Safety is one of Brenntag’s five core values and therefore the safe handling of chemicals takes top priority. Brenntag is aware of its own responsibility and combines the Group’s strategy and standards for quality, health, safety and the environment in its Global QSHE Policy (QSHE: Quality, Safety, Health, Environment). The Group strives for process safety, occupational health and safety, customer satisfaction, respect for the environment and continuous improvement. The Group undertakes to provide the resources required for this. The Global QSHE Policy applies to all employees at every level of the hierarchy and to all activities within the Group. It also includes responsibility for the safety of external partners and contractors if they are working at Brenntag sites or supplied by Brenntag.

To implement the QSHE Policy, Brenntag pursues a global QSHE strategy built on four pillars.

Management system

Brenntag operates an integrated QSHE management system focused on people, sites and their equipment and processes that encompasses 100% of the workforce. The aim is to harmonize the different regional and local approaches, requirements and features within one global QSHE system. Internally, the Group issued a global QSHE manual that combines its guidelines setting out company-wide minimum standards in QSHE. It describes all guidelines, procedures and responsibilities forming the backbone of the QSHE management system. It is based on industry standards such as ISO 9001, Responsible Care/Responsible Distribution and the CCPS model (CCPS: Center for Chemical Process Safety).

One significant element of QSHE management at Brenntag is its active participation in the international Responsible Care/Responsible Distribution (RC/RD) initiative of the International Chemical Trade Association (ICTA). Regardless of legal requirements, the initiative wishes to ensure that member companies continuously improve their environmental and health performance and report openly on this progress on a regular basis. The requirements are usually implemented in programs by the respective regional or local industry associations. In this context, industry associations frequently set their own priorities and define specific conditions for participation in the program. As specified in the QSHE manual, all Brenntag companies with operating sites or with direct sales are expected to participate if national associations offer a corresponding program. If no RC/RD program is available in a given country, Brenntag entities are encouraged to conduct an RC/RD self-assessment. For this purpose, the questionnaire of the ICTA or that of another relevant regional association may be used. The participating companies are defined on a case-by-case basis using established criteria. Among others, these criteria include transition periods after acquisition or a limited product portfolio. Its active involvement in the associations’ working groups enables Brenntag to have a positive influence on standard-setting and implementation.

¹⁾ All metrics mentioned in this paragraph and in the table are voluntary disclosures.

Not least of all, Brenntag aims for all operating sites to be continuously certified to ISO 9001 or alternative management systems with comparable elements so as to ensure quality. In some cases, this is supplemented by other product- or industry-related quality management systems. At the end of 2025, 352 of Brenntag's 355 relevant sites worldwide were certified to an international standard (2024: 367 of 369 relevant sites). Like RC/RD participation, the site's relevance is defined using similar established criteria.

Culture

At Brenntag, the "Safety First" principle applies throughout the Group and relies strongly on personal commitment and personal responsibility. The Group uses various methods to continuously raise employee awareness of occupational health and safety. Documented QSHE training tailored to the requirements of each activity provides the basis. This is supplemented by communication formats such as five-minute talks, Safety First Moments, lessons learned and best practices, which enable insights gained from incidents or examples of good working practices to be shared within the organization in a structured manner. The aim is to use these tools at the beginning of each shift or each (relatively large) meeting. Various platforms are available for this interaction. Lessons learned are incorporated into the forms used for the investigation of safety incidents. In the event of serious incidents or potentially serious incidents, Brenntag can also separately create additional documents on the insights gained and distribute them worldwide. Examples of best practices may emerge from audits, inspections or self-initiative. They are exchanged at various levels.

Brenntag addresses individual critical topics on worldwide campaigns with a view to raising employee awareness in a targeted manner and ensuring harmonized corrective and preventive actions. Topics stem from individual incidents or an accumulation of incidents that stand out in an overall assessment. The flagship campaign in the reporting period was the Campaign for safe operation of trucks, forklifts and other powered industrial equipment. The campaign explains how to minimize and control risks when operating these vehicles. This includes risks for the driver as well as for the surrounding environment, particularly pedestrians in work areas. To support this, training materials were developed and rolled out in four modules, each focusing on different key topics. In addition, two training videos on truck and forklift operation were produced at a Brenntag site.

The employee survey planned for the 2025 reporting period as part of the global Brenntag Enhanced Safety Thinking (BEST) program did not take place for internal reasons.

Once a year, Brenntag presents the Global Safety Awards in two categories: the Safety Excellence Award for the best safety record over the longer term and the Safety Phoenix Award for the strongest improvement in terms of safety. In 2025, the Cangzhou site in China (Safety Excellence Award) and the Guarulhos site in Brazil (Safety Phoenix Award) were honored for their safety achievements.

In addition, Brenntag holds an annual Global Health & Safety Week, in the course of which the aforementioned awards are also presented. Around World Day for Health and Safety at Work on April 28, all sites worldwide organize activities to raise awareness of health and safety. For this, there is a prescribed motto each year, but no fixed framework for the individual program. All units and sites organize activities appropriate to their own requirements, priorities and capabilities. Some companies also involve suppliers, customers or families. A selection of initiatives is then compiled and serves as inspiration for future Global Health & Safety Weeks. In the reporting period, the Week ran from April 21 to 25, 2025 under the motto 'Safety first - stronger together'.

Team

A multinational team made up of QSHE experts working centrally and the QSHE directors of the global regions implements the QSHE management system. These work closely together with the regional and local QSHE teams. Within the QSHE organization, Brenntag has also built up an international team of process safety management (PSM) experts that supports the sites and carries out PSM assessments.¹⁾ In the reporting period, the team was expanded to include the role of Security Director, which was filled by a security expert who had previously worked as an external consultant for Brenntag.

¹⁾ Further information on PSM can be found in the section "Pollution", sub-section "Accidental releases".

Monitoring and controlling

Brenntag has established an extensive monitoring and controlling system in order to continuously improve its safety measures. To this end, reports of incidents that meet the Brenntag Global Standard Reporting criteria are continuously gathered on central QSHE reporting systems. Investigation findings and related corrective and preventive actions are shared internally through various channels in order to prevent a reoccurrence. Brenntag also attaches considerable importance to monitoring and controlling as a preventive tool, for example in the case of indicators such as near misses, actions to reinforce positive behavior, site inspections, and safety inspections and certifications. A QSHE dashboard makes these indicators more visible and easier to track.

Targets and metrics

S1-5, S1-14, ESRS 2 BP-2

In 2021, Brenntag set the following target on the basis of the policies and actions described in relation to occupational health and safety: The TRIR (Total Recordable Injury Rate) should improve from 3.1 in base year 2021 to less than 2.0 in target year 2030. The TRIR is continuously monitored and regularly reported to various teams and levels throughout the Brenntag Group.

At 81, the number of recordable work-related incidents registered in the reporting period was well below the 103 incidents in the previous year. This also led to a significant improvement in the TRIR, which fell from 2.6 in the previous year to 2.1 in the reporting period. It was thus already close to the long-term target of a TRIR of 2.0 in 2030.

The number of days lost due to recordable work-related incidents totaled 1,757 days in the reporting period.

For 2025, Brenntag has no work-related fatalities to report, either among its employees or among other individuals at its sites.

Brenntag's aim is for all companies with operating sites or with direct sales to continuously participate in the industry initiative Responsible Care/Responsible Distribution (RC/RD) if national associations offer a corresponding program. Participation is recorded once a year. At the end of financial year 2025, 85 out of a total of 88 relevant Brenntag companies were participating in an RC/RD program (2024: 77 out of 81 relevant companies).

Accounting principles

The TRIR (Total Recordable Injury Rate) is a performance indicator widely used internationally in the industry, indicating how often employees sustain injuries in work-related incidents. It denotes the number of work-related injuries requiring medical treatment beyond first aid per one million hours worked. In defining 'work-related' and 'medical treatment beyond first aid', Brenntag follows the U.S. OSHA. Hours worked are determined based on a combination of direct time-recording and a U.S. OSHA estimation approach with predefined hours per full-time equivalent (FTE) and annum. Direct time-recording is applied for hourly-paid employees in North America and Latin America. An estimation approach using 2,000 working hours per FTE per year is applied for employees in the EMEA and APAC regions, and for employees on fixed salaries in Latin America. By way of exception, 2,250 working hours per year are applied for Brazil, Chile, Colombia, and the Indian entity Raj. For employees on fixed salaries in North America, working hours are calculated based on eight-hour working days, less documented absences. In the reporting on its safety performance, Brenntag includes all of its own employees along with temporary and contract employees deployed by temporary employment agencies to carry out standard Brenntag activities. All fatal accidents suffered by other persons are also reported if they occur at Brenntag sites.

All calendar days following the day of the incident up to the day before returning to work are considered days lost. Days on which the injured person works (partially) are not counted as days lost. Non-working days (e.g. weekends and public holidays) are included if workdays were also missed due to injury or if they are explicitly covered by certified sick leave. Consistent with U.S. OSHA guidelines, no days lost are recorded for fatalities. A maximum of 180 days lost are counted for long-term injuries. If days lost continue beyond year-end, the days are counted for the year in which they occur and not for the year in which the incident happened.

Secure employment and adequate wages

Policies and actions

S1-1, S1-4

At Brenntag, fair remuneration and clear employment contracts are an expression of a corporate strategy and a corporate culture geared to employment security. Among other things, good working conditions include employees receiving as standard a permanent employment contract that creates stability and a long-term outlook for both sides. Brenntag has therefore established a structured HR recruitment and selection process.

Brenntag also offers attractive additional benefits such as an occupational pension that supports a secure financial future in retirement. The occupational pension provision differs from country to country, as it is bound by a large number of country-specific provisions and laws, which Brenntag must follow in actually structuring the pension provision. Further benefits aimed at providing individual financial protection also foster long-term employee satisfaction. Benefits like this are country-specific and differ from country to country. In addition, Brenntag follows a remuneration policy based on the principles of fairness and transparency.

In 2022, Brenntag introduced the Brenntag Global Living Wage Policy in order to meet its aspiration to provide fair remuneration. This defines a 'living wage' as the remuneration that an employee in a particular place receives for a standard working week and that is sufficient to afford a decent standard of living for the employee and their family. Elements of a decent standard of living include nutrition, water, housing, education, health care, transportation, clothing and other essential needs including provision for unexpected events. This pay may go beyond the statutory minimum wage. It is intended to prevent forced labor or an excessive amount of overtime as well as the need to resort to further jobs or child labor to make the family income sufficient. By paying living wages, Brenntag is therefore contributing toward complying with the United Nations Universal Declaration of Human Rights and achieving the United Nations Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs).

To ensure adequate wages and permanently close any gaps, Brenntag works together with the WageIndicator Foundation, which provides living wage data for the countries in which Brenntag operates. In addition to wage data, the data provided by WageIndicator also include data on the hours in a standard local working week, which in no country is more than 48 working hours a week in accordance with the standards of the International Labour Organization (ILO).

The Global Living Wage Policy uses the guidance data recommended by WageIndicator when implementing living wages. These reflect typical household costs. The Global Living Wage Policy enables feasible adjustments to be implemented as soon as possible in exceptional situations. The policy also allows the employees' actual country of residence to be taken into account.

Targets and metrics

[S1-5, S1-6, S-10, ESRS 2 BP-2](#)

Brenntag has been meeting the target, that 100% of Brenntag employees receive a living wage in accordance with the Global Living Wage Policy, since as far back as the end of 2023. To ensure continued compliance with this target going forward, an annual process identifies and aims to close gaps between the remuneration of Brenntag employees and the WageIndicator data. Under the Global Living Wage Policy, interns, apprentices, freelancers and contractors are excluded from the gap analysis.

Fixed remuneration and allowances were generally used to compare employee remuneration with the WageIndicator data, provided that such allowances constitute monetary benefits and are normally freely available on a monthly basis. Variable remuneration or overtime pay, on the other hand, was disregarded. As a result of this comparison, the living wage gaps were identified in a gap analysis.

The gap analysis in the reporting period revealed 37 employees in six countries whose wage would have to be adjusted (2024: 114 cases in 15 countries). No adjustments can be made for an entity in Singapore (14 of the 37 cases; this equates to around 3% of employees in Singapore), as under the acquisition agreement this acquisition from 2023 is subject to legal restrictions on salary adjustments for three years. Adjustments were made for 22 employees. In one case, no adjustment could be made due to the termination of the employment relationship.

All gaps detected by the gap analysis and actually required to be closed following a local review were closed at the latest with effect from the end of the reporting period by making appropriate salary adjustments. Data on acquisitions and new hires recorded in the People platform after the database extraction for the gap analysis – i.e. after July 2, 2025 – will be included in the 2026 gap analysis.

Contract type	2025			2024 ¹⁾		
	Women	Men	Not specified	Women	Men	Not specified
Brenntag Group	6,186	11,049	1	6,289	11,704	5
Permanent employment contracts	6,114	10,964	1	6,212	11,601	4
Temporary employment contracts	72	85	0	77	103	1

2.55 Employees by contract type and gender

¹⁾ The prior-year figures were adjusted (see accounting principles below).

Accounting principles

Brenntag captures and analyzes HR metrics using the People platform. A distinction is made between permanent employment contracts, which are concluded for an indefinite period, and temporary employment contracts, which are limited to a specific period and terminate automatically. Since only binary gender options are available in the People platform, the 'Other' category is not used in data collection. Employees for whom no gender information is available in the People platform are shown as 'Not specified'. The HR metrics include employees with an employment contract with Brenntag at the reporting date. As described in the section "Material impacts, risks and opportunities related to own workforce", sub-section "Accounting principles", the accounting-based definition of personnel metrics has been applied since financial year 2025, and the figures for 2024 were adjusted retroactively. The recalculation results in a variance of 439 employees in total.

Social dialog and employee involvement**Policies and actions**

ESRS 2 SBM-2, S1-1, S1-2, S1-4

Brenntag believes that open communication and opportunities to participate are key factors contributing to employee motivation and employee loyalty to the Group. Providing employees with important information on a regular basis and in full is a significant element of the corporate culture. Social dialog and the involvement of employees and employee representatives in decision-making processes create transparency, appreciation and a feeling of shared responsibility. This results in various internal agreements and regulations. These factors play a decisive role in reducing dissatisfaction and fostering a productive, dedicated work culture. Depending on regional circumstances and regulations, the views of minorities are given particular consideration. For example, in Germany there is a representative body for severely disabled persons that employees can turn to.

Depending on country-specific legislation, employees can contact the persons representing their interests on elected codetermination bodies. Brenntag thus respects its employees' right to freedom of coalition and association, and does not take or tolerate any actions that could restrict those rights. This is set down both in the Code of Business Conduct and Ethics and in the Policy Statement on Human Rights.¹⁾

Instead of a global framework agreement with employee representatives, Brenntag follows a decentralized approach to ensure human rights and good working conditions. This is supported by various guidelines, such as the Code of Business Conduct and Ethics and the Policy Statement on Human Rights, as well as by international obligations.

To ensure that all employees are kept abreast of important developments and decisions, Brenntag organizes ad hoc and regular global management town hall meetings. These events offer the workforce the opportunity to communicate directly with the management, ask questions and keep up to date with the Group's strategic direction. This strengthens trust and reduces uncertainty, which often leads to dissatisfaction.

Annual, individual employee appraisals are also conducted and serve as a central element of organizational and cultural development. These appraisals improve the feedback culture and foster open interaction between employees and managers. Particular emphasis is placed on constructive feedback and setting individual development goals. The appraisals also enable problems to be identified and resolved at an early stage before they lead to dissatisfaction.

Cross-site information provision, communication and collaboration among Brenntag employees are actively supported and fostered by the internal online portal ShareON@Brenntag. The platform not only facilitates networking and knowledge transfer, but also offers myriad opportunities to share information, experiences and best practices across different units. In addition, at many levels, Brenntag has in place ideas management systems and platforms through which employees can actively contribute their suggestions for improving organizational aspects, processes and operations. Moreover, the content and responses from the global management town hall meetings are also made available afterwards on the internal intranet. This can increase identification with corporate objectives and reduce the likelihood of frustration.

¹⁾ Further information on the Code of Business Conduct and Ethics can be found in the section "Business conduct", and further information on the Policy Statement on Human Rights in the section "Workers in the value chain".

Targets

ESRS 2 SBM-2, S1-2, S1-5

Beyond the actions described above, Brenntag's target was to identify possible actions to influence employee satisfaction, engagement and motivation through annual employee surveys on the basis of the employee Net Promoter Score (eNPS). Brenntag achieved this target again in 2025. In addition, Brenntag further developed and successfully expanded its employee surveys in 2025. The quarterly "2 questions – 2 seconds" sentiment checks continued, enabling a quick assessment of company sentiment. The presentation of the findings was simplified and access to them improved for managers, while maintaining minimum response thresholds and aggregated analysis. This increased the use of the survey findings as a basis for team dialog after survey completion. In November 2025, the expanded eNPS & Engagement survey was conducted, offering deeper insights not only into satisfaction and motivation, but also employee engagement and business success through a broader range of questions. The continuous refinement of the survey underscores Brenntag's commitment to actively involve employees and provides a valuable foundation for addressing their needs.

Working time and work-life balance

Policies and actions

S1-1, S1-4

Brenntag places emphasis on agile and flexible working throughout the Group and is open to opportunities to make work more flexible around the globe. The framework 'New Work – Towards Greater Flex' was developed by Global HR together with the regional and local human resources departments at the international sites and provides the basis for this. It includes guiding principles for a flexible work environment in all Brenntag regions, business units and functions, bearing in mind local differences.

Various countries have implemented flexible working time models based on this framework. This includes introducing flextime and offering part-time jobs. Brenntag has also introduced arrangements for working from home and mobile working. Flexible working hours and home working promote mental health and improve work-life balance by reducing stress, enabling relaxation and strengthening autonomy. Employees are better able to tailor their daily routine to personal needs, which improves work-life balance and wellbeing. Time saved by not commuting and the opportunity to more easily fulfill private obligations promote satisfaction, health and productivity.

Targets and metrics

S1-5, S1-6, ESRS 2 BP-2

The actions to enhance flexibility are intended to help make working conditions at Brenntag as safe and fair as possible and counteract employee turnover. Beyond that, there are no further targets in accordance with ESRS requirements.

Departure category	2025		2024 ²⁾	
	abs.	%	abs.	%
Voluntary employee turnover ¹⁾	1,485	7.4	1,457	7.3
Involuntary employee turnover ¹⁾	847	4.2	782	3.9
Natural employee turnover ¹⁾	214	1.1	256	1.3
Total	2,546	12.7	2,495	12.6

2.56 Employee turnover rates

¹⁾ Voluntary disclosure.

²⁾ The prior-year figures were adjusted (see also accounting principles below).

Accounting principles

Based on the employee entry and exit dates recorded in the People Platform, the headcount and the number of hires and terminations are determined for the reporting period. The turnover rates are calculated based on the recorded termination reasons. Brenntag voluntarily classifies departures into three categories: Voluntary turnover includes resignations by employees. Involuntary turnover refers to terminations initiated by the employer. Natural turnover encompasses departures that are beyond the control of both the employee and the employer, such as retirement, disability, or death. These turnover rates are calculated using the Schlüter formula, where the total number of departures per category in the reporting period is expressed in relation to the number of employees at the beginning of the reporting period and the organic new hires during the reporting period. Turnover rates are recorded centrally for each Brenntag company on a monthly basis and reported to HR Management. Due to regional and country-specific differences, the figures are analyzed at a decentralized level to identify any areas requiring action. As described in the section "Material impacts, risks and opportunities related to own workforce", sub-section "Accounting principles", the accounting-based definition of personnel metrics has been applied since financial year 2025, and the figures for 2024 were adjusted retroactively. This results in a deviation in the total turnover rate of -0.2%.

Training and skills development

Policies and actions

S1-1, S1-3, S1-4

Training and skills development have positive impacts on employees and are also reflected in Brenntag's business success. At the same time, targeted continuing education and training options counteract decreasing motivation and increasing dissatisfaction. Brenntag therefore supports its employees' continuous personal and professional development. The Global Development Framework with its 70-20-10 development framework provides the structure for all internal and external development opportunities. This means that 70% of development comes from practical experience in the workplace, through daily tasks, challenges and problem-solving. Social learning contributes 20%; that is, collaboration with colleagues, which also includes coaching and mentoring. A further 10% of development takes the form of formal training, i.e. courses, seminars, online and hybrid learning programs.

Local policies and guidelines complement the Global Development Framework in line with applicable legal requirements. In addition, the Group-wide Learning and Development Policy was published in October 2025. It serves as an overarching framework for all learning and development activities and specifies clear roles, processes, and provisions for all stakeholders. This enhances transparency, supports investment decisions, and ensures verifiability of actions.

Brenntag supports its own employees' development regarding their own visibility, their skills and their career interests through regular interaction between employees and line managers. Feedback plays a significant role here. Managers and leaders are regularly trained in how to identify talent and succession candidates or make themselves visible as such.

At Brenntag, responsibility for personal development lies primarily with the employee. However, close communication with supervisors is crucial and encouraged. Via the People Portal, managers therefore have access to what are termed manager dashboards, providing reports on mandatory training courses, learning interests of direct reports, and talent data.

In addition, the company asks employees to put in place an individual development plan in accordance with the 70-20-10 approach on an annual basis in consultation with their direct superior. This is intended to prevent employees from missing out on development opportunities by helping them to set their professional goals and work toward them in a focused manner.

The following activities were implemented and scaled during the reporting period. All participant numbers stated in the following were captured on the basis of the global People platform.

The Global Sales Enablement Program is a three-year training program for all employees in the Brenntag Specialties division's sales department. In the reporting period, 1,365 employees had the opportunity to participate in training workshops and online learning programs, as well as coaching sessions specifically geared toward sales. In addition, the Brenntag Essentials EMEA division launched a sales enablement program for about 88 sales employees in the fourth quarter of the reporting period.

A comprehensive, one-and-a-half-year learning program was developed for the new target group of General Managers in the Essentials division. All employees in this target group (110 participants) received training from internal experts on topics including processes, new technologies, and leadership behavior. Best practice sharing and Q&A sessions complemented the program.

Brenntag offers Coaching on Demand through a global partner. The individual sessions in employees' native language support personal and professional development. Since coaching needs are determined in close consultation with the manager and HR, an approval process implemented in the Learning Portal applies.

Brenntag facilitates its employees' language training. A global language provider's learning portal offers exercises in listening and reading comprehension, grammar, vocabulary, and open conversation classes for all employees. Individual or small group sessions can also be requested via the approval process. To ease entry into language learning for employees, introductory webinars in local languages were provided during the reporting period.

In the 2025 reporting period, Brenntag offered employees Belt certifications in Lean Six Sigma to enable them to develop their skills in process optimization, data analysis, and continuous improvement strategies, and then apply this knowledge within Brenntag. White Belts, Yellow Belts, Green Belts, and Black Belts were certified in the reporting period.

In October 2025, the Brenntag Academy was launched for all employees. It consolidates all learning content into a central "one-stop shop", making access to training easier. Alongside onboarding programs and practical training, such as on the topic of crisis response, the Academy also features innovative formats such as podcasts for General Managers on applying company values in day-to-day work and one-pagers for team discussions. Since October 2025, learning casts have been made available to all employees to familiarize them with the Academy's content.

Through the learning portal, all employees have access to an e-learning catalog containing both externally sourced and internally developed content. Brenntag possesses specialized knowledge that is not available in standard market e-learning offerings. Therefore, an authoring tool is used to create internal e-learning modules and transform this expertise into accessible, easy-to-understand digital content. In the reporting period, 73 internal e-learning courses were created, focusing on topics such as business skills (e.g. container management – reusable packaging, battery materials and recycling), sales and service (e.g. use of the Customer Growth Engine), team and culture (e.g. SBI-D feedback model), and safety (e.g. office safety instructions).

To accommodate regional differences and distances, Brenntag provides online and virtual learning opportunities in several languages that can be accessed anytime, anywhere. To familiarize employees with the functionality and features of the learning portal, the learning team has offered virtual info sessions (in different languages) to all Brenntag employees in all regions. In addition, there is a regular Global Learning newsletter to draw attention to specific content on the company's own learning platform.

As part of the monthly learning time, employees can undertake self-directed learning. This further promotes a learning culture within the Group. During the workday, employees and managers can discuss and document their skills and professional interests in a structured manner. This leads to individual development needs that employees can formalize and focus on. Brenntag promotes a feedback culture through feedback and coordination meetings between managers and employees on development, performance, objectives, and career discussions.

The Individual Development Plan (IDP) was fundamentally professionalized in the reporting period and integrated into central HR processes. A new feature is the link to the GAPS (Goals, Abilities, Perceptions, Success Factors) model and its integration into two annual employee appraisals. The IDP has thus evolved from a voluntary tool to a structured component of personnel development, creating transparency and increasing the effectiveness of training measures.

Mandatory training courses such as compliance training are aimed at employees at all hierarchical levels.¹⁾ Regional resources are also developed and provided, e.g. special compliance training courses and manuals.

Conceptual development in talent management: To embed continuous change and transformation into the leadership framework, three global leadership principles have been defined in alignment with Brenntag's strategy, vision, and corporate values. These principles form the overarching leadership model and serve as the conceptual foundation for competency profiles, decision-making criteria, and development priorities. In parallel, the transparent provision of position-specific competency profiles has been further enhanced. The digital talent identification and succession planning process within the People platform has been expanded, data quality systematically improved, and new reporting introduced to provide robust, data-driven decision-making for strategic questions. Additional feedback tools are being gradually aligned with the competency architecture to ensure consistency, fairness, and transparency in talent management.

Talent development program: As part of a one-time initiative, the 'Symphony of Leadership: Elevating Presence through Orchestral Insights' program was implemented during the Shostakovich Festival in Leipzig 2025. This external event provided selected Brenntag talent with an experimental platform to observe and validate leadership competencies in a creative environment.

Targets and metrics

[S1-5, S1-13, ESRS 2 BP-2](#)

The training policies and skills development actions described have a positive impact on employee motivation and provide opportunities to build and expand individual skills. Beyond that, there are no additional targets in accordance with ESRS requirements.

All dedicated training actions were recorded in the learning portal and thus evaluated.

Training hours	2025
	Ø
Women	4.0
Men	2.7
Not specified	3.2
Brenntag Group	3.2

2.57 Average number of training hours per employee by gender

¹⁾ Further information on compliance training can be found in the section "Business conduct".

Accounting principles

All employees with access to the People platform can complete online courses via the learning portal. They are assigned mandatory training courses and also given the option to select individual training courses from an extensive range of available courses. Since Brenntag does not record the actual time spent on training courses on an individual employee basis, average training hours are calculated based on the standardized duration in minutes assigned to each course. Brenntag determines the total number of training minutes for all courses completed during the reporting period, based on employees who, as at the reporting date, have an employment contract with Brenntag. The analysis considers gender information stored in the People platform. Average training hours are calculated by dividing the total recorded training minutes by the number of employees per gender category as at the reporting date and converting the result into hours. For employees without gender information, the status 'Not specified' is displayed.

Diversity**Policies and actions**

ESRS 2 SBM-3, S1-1, S1-4

As a Group with operations worldwide, Brenntag employs staff from over 100 nations.¹⁾ Diversity at Brenntag encompasses several aspects, such as employees' different cultural backgrounds, ethnic origin, genders, age groups, skills, qualifications and needs. The exchange of knowledge, ideas and experience shows that diversity makes a decisive contribution to the company's success. The Group wishes to continuously foster this worldwide exchange so as to further increase the diversity of the workforce and create a cosmopolitan work culture and a dynamic work environment where all employees can learn from one another.

Brenntag also works to ensure equal opportunities for its employees and applicants. Ensuring equality of opportunity is a matter of course for Brenntag, as is acting to counter and prevent any form of discrimination and harassment. Employees are recruited, remunerated and developed solely on the basis of their qualifications and skills. Under no circumstances will Brenntag discriminate against employees, business partners or third parties on the basis of national or ethnic origin, nationality, gender, gender identity, marital or civil partner status, pregnancy or maternity, age, creed, religion or belief, color, ancestry, disability or sexual orientation. Equally, the Group expects all employees to embrace this principle, not discriminate against their colleagues and treat one another with respect. This is set down in Brenntag's Code of Business Conduct and Ethics.

The diversity policy for the Board of Management is also intended to continuously increase its diversity. Through this policy, Brenntag wishes to ensure targeted, diverse management development and successful long-term succession planning, bearing in mind age, gender, education, professional background and international experience. The Supervisory Board should also be diverse. The diversity policy for this body requires a line-up that is likewise as diverse as possible in terms of the age, gender, education, career path and international experience of the members. In January 2026, new targets were set for the Board of Management and the Supervisory Board. The aim is for at least one member of the Board of Management to be female by January 31, 2031 at the latest. In addition, a target of three female members out of a total of eight seats was set for the Supervisory Board.

Brenntag has implemented various actions to systematically identify possible cases of discrimination and foster diversity within the Group. The diversity management framework is continuously strengthened to further enhance diversity and inclusion throughout the workforce.

The support provided by Employee Resource Groups (ERGs) is an important element of this approach. Led by employees, these groups are intended to make a significant contribution to an integrative and inclusive workplace by offering networking opportunities for employees, raising awareness of diversity issues, giving feedback and playing a part in devising actions related to diversity, equity & inclusion (DE&I).

The ERGs at Brenntag provide employees with a platform for networking, knowledge sharing and fostering diversity and inclusion. They bring together employees with similar interests and backgrounds, foster an inclusive working environment, and contribute to the further development of diversity-sensitive HR policies and initiatives through feedback and input. For example, several women's networks have been established globally, providing a platform for interaction and networking and potentially increasing the proportion of women in management positions over the long term. Moreover, through events and communication, ERGs raise awareness of diversity, equity & inclusion (DE&I) and position Brenntag as an inclusive employer both internally and externally.

¹⁾ Voluntary disclosure.

On its career pages too, Brenntag emphasizes the fact that it sees diversity as a strength: In job advertisements, it is pointed out that Brenntag offers a fair, respectful and supportive work culture where all employees are able to develop and grow in line with their individual needs and skills. Job advertisements are also designed to be inclusive. Brenntag nurtures the strengths and potential of people with disabilities and integrates their skills so as to create a working environment that puts all employees on a level playing field. Since 2020, Brenntag has been a member of the Valuable 500 initiative. This brings together the leaders of 500 international companies who have undertaken to put the inclusion of people with disabilities on their management agenda.

Targets and metrics

S1-5, S1-9, ESRS 2 BP-2

Brenntag has set several targets in order to increase diversity and inclusion:

- The mandatory training to raise awareness of unconscious bias has been continuously implemented and was pursued in the reporting period. It targets all members of the Global Leadership Team, all managers with at least one direct report, and the entire HR organization. The original goal of fully training all managers and HR by the end of 2025 was only partially achieved. Therefore, the deadline has been extended to 2027. To expand the training portfolio, an additional training provider has been identified to offer further formats in the future.
- Brenntag aims to strengthen diversity at all levels of the Group and to increase the percentage of women in management positions over the long term. By 2030, the percentage of women at all management levels below the Board of Management should be at least 30%. The progress achieved is shown in the table below. This target does not apply in countries where setting targets is prohibited by law.

Management level	2025		2024 ¹⁾	
	abs.	in %	abs.	in %
Level L1	24	1.0	37	1.5
Women	10	41.7	14	37.8
Men	14	58.3	23	62.2
Level L2	139	5.8	160	6.6
Women	47	33.8	56	35.0
Men	92	66.2	104	65.0
Level L3	390	16.4	438	18.0
Women	172	44.1	173	39.5
Men	218	55.9	265	60.5
Level L4	701	29.4	752	30.9
Women	297	42.4	301	40.0
Men	404	57.6	451	60.0
Level L5+	1,130	47.4	1,047	43.0
Women	376	33.3	314	30.0
Men	754	66.7	733	70.0
Total	2,384	100.0	2,434	100.0
Women	902	37.8	858	35.3
Men	1,482	62.2	1,576	64.7

2.58 Employees in leadership positions according to management level and gender

¹⁾ The prior-year figures were adjusted (see accounting principles below).

In accordance with ESRS requirements, the number and the proportion of women in management positions are reported globally at levels L1 and L2. In the reporting period, the percentage of women on the first management level below the Board of Management L1 was 39.3%, which equates to eleven women (2024: 15 women, 36.6%). The share of women on the second management level below the Board of Management L2 was 33.3%, equating to 58 women (2024: 64 women, 33.9%).

Accounting principles

Management positions include all roles with at least one direct subordinate. Using position management in the People platform, the management levels are determined based on the global organizational chart, starting from the Board of Management of Brenntag. Management level L1 consists of employees who report directly to the Board of Management of Brenntag, while L2 includes employees who report directly to L1, and so on. The metrics for L5 and the following management levels are aggregated and reported under the designation L5+. Countries where setting targets is prohibited by law are not included in the calculation of the target set for women in management positions from 2025 onwards. To ensure periodic comparability, the metrics for 2024 were recalculated on this basis. The recalculation results in a decrease of 198 in the reported number of women in management positions, while the proportion increases by 2.9%. All countries are included in the calculation of the disclosure requirements in accordance with ESRS.

GROUP SUSTAINABILITY STATEMENT

Age group	2025		2024 ¹⁾	
	abs.	in %	abs.	in %
<30	1,518	8.8	1,696	9.4
30–50	10,013	58.1	10,515	58.4
>50	5,702	33.1	5,779	32.1
Not specified	3	0.0	8	0.1
Brenntag Group	17,236	100.0	17,998	100.0

2.59 Age structure

¹⁾ The prior-year figures were adjusted (see accounting principles below).

Accounting principles

The age of each employee at the reporting date is calculated in the People platform using their date of birth. Based on age, data are reported according to the age groups defined in the ESRS. Employees for whom no date of birth information is available in the People platform are reported as 'Not specified'. As described in the section "Material impacts, risks and opportunities related to own workforce", sub-section "Accounting principles", the accounting-based definition of personnel metrics has been applied since financial year 2025, and the figures for 2024 were adjusted retroactively. The recalculation results in a variance of 439 employees in total.

Incidents, complaints and severe human rights impacts

[S1-1, S1-3, S1-4, S1-17, ESRS 2 BP-2](#)

As described above, promoting diversity and inclusion is a significant element of the corporate culture at Brenntag. This dedication to diversity and gender equality goes hand in hand with the commitment to transparency and integrity in all its business activities.

Throughout the Group, Brenntag has established processes to put these values into practice and ensure that they are embedded in all areas of the company. These enable employees and external partners to confidentially report indications or suspicions of possible violations of laws, regulations or internal guidelines, especially the Code of Business Conduct and Ethics. Brenntag attaches particular importance to respect for human rights and has put in place specific procedures to receive and address possible complaints in this regard. Through these actions, Brenntag fosters an open culture of communication and ensures that ethical conduct and compliance are firmly embedded in day-to-day activities.¹⁾

	2025	2024
Total number of reported incidents of discrimination, including harassment	60	55 ¹⁾
Number of further complaints filed through channels for employees to raise concerns	10	7 ¹⁾
Total amount of fines, penalties and compensation (EUR)	–	–
Number of severe human rights incidents	–	–

2.60 Number of complaints related to discrimination and human rights

¹⁾ The prior-year figure was adjusted (see also accounting principles below).

Accounting principles

Brenntag operates a whistleblowing system that is available to both employees and external stakeholders (e.g. suppliers, customers, other business partners). This enables violations of statutory provisions and internal regulations to be reported, in particular violations of the Code of Conduct. This also includes human rights violations and incidents related to discrimination, including harassment. In the current reporting period, the recorded scope of discrimination cases was expanded to include reports of harassment. The prior-year figures were corrected retrospectively to ensure comparability across all reporting periods. Due to this reclassification, the total number of reported cases of discrimination including harassment increases by 49 cases, while the number of other complaints decreases by 55 cases. If reports are received through the electronic whistleblowing system, they are captured and documented centrally. In addition to this whistleblowing channel, employees can also report cases of discrimination, harassment or other human rights concerns through their line manager, the human resources (HR) department or the compliance function. This information is collected by the departments responsible, examined and forwarded to the central compliance function, where it is recorded. As part of the annual sustainability and non-financial reporting, Brenntag analyzes these data and publishes aggregated metrics in corresponding reports. In doing so, the Group transparently discloses how many reports relating to human rights violations were received, how they were addressed and what remedial and other preventive actions were taken.

¹⁾ Further information on the grievance/complaints mechanism and the protection of whistleblowers can be found in the section "Business conduct", and information on human rights due diligence in the section "Workers in the value chain".

Workers in the value chain

Material impacts, risks and opportunities related to value chain workers

[ESRS 2 SBM-2](#), [ESRS 2 SBM-3](#), [ESRS 2 IRO-1](#)

Brenntag actively works to design its operations such that the human rights of workers across the value chain – both upstream and downstream – are respected and protected. In doing so, potential impacts on employees are systematically integrated into company decision-making processes. The human rights risk analysis in accordance with the German Supply Chain Due Diligence Act (LkSG) is a central element. The results of this analysis play a decisive role in the strategic alignment of internal business units and in supplier selection and management. They also serve as a basis for optimizing internal and external guidelines, adapting training programs and optimizing company processes. As part of this analysis,

the topics of environmental protection, health and safety were identified as the main potential risks for workers in the chemical supply chain. For example, there are workers who handle potentially hazardous chemicals. The potential negative effects are confined to individual incidents, such as accidents. The risk assessment also includes industry and country risks, where certain combinations have an increased potential for child and forced labor. To ensure that human rights risks are taken systematically into account in procurement decisions, internal stakeholders receive comprehensive information on supplier risk assessments, both in direct and in indirect procurement.

In the course of the materiality assessment performed, the following impacts of Brenntag's business activities on value chain workers were identified as material:¹⁾

Material topic	Impacts, risks or opportunities	Value chain	Time horizon	Description
Working conditions; Other work-related rights	Impact (negative)	Upstream	Constant	Advancing negative impacts on human rights / accepting potential human rights violations in the event that risks are ignored or given insufficient consideration (in particular child labor / forced labor/inadequate wages/working time and working conditions)
Other work-related rights	Impact (positive)	Along the value chain	Constant	More transparency and therefore a greater probability of human rights compliance (raising awareness throughout the supply chain); TFS audits and EcoVadis assessments
Working conditions	Impact (positive)	Along the value chain	Constant	Involvement in industry associations enables higher health and safety standards to be set (Together for Sustainability) ¹⁾

2.61 Material impacts related to value chain workers

¹⁾ Further information on this can be found in the section "Own workforce", sub-section "Occupational health and safety".

Policies and actions

[ESRS 2 SBM-2](#), [S1-1](#), [S1-3](#), [S2-1](#), [S2-2](#), [S2-3](#), [S2-4](#)

Brenntag has developed comprehensive policies and targeted actions to specifically counteract the impacts described above. Even before establishing a business relationship, Brenntag communicates clear expectations to its suppliers. The Supplier Code of Conduct is a central element of this and requests that suppliers play an active part in protecting human rights within their organization and throughout their supply chains.

Moreover, in the Policy Statement on Human Rights, Brenntag confirms its commitment to complying with applicable laws and international human rights and environmental standards. These values and expectations apply equally to all Brenntag employees, suppliers and other business partners. The Policy Statement and the Code of Conduct were developed before the financial year on the basis of the human rights risk analysis conducted and have been adopted by the Board of Management. Both documents are publicly available on the company website.

¹⁾ Further information on this is contained in the section "General disclosures", sub-section "Double materiality assessment".

The Policy Statement and the Supplier Code of Conduct are based on internationally applicable standards and guidelines, such as the United Nations (UN) Universal Declaration of Human Rights, the UN Guiding Principles on Business and Human Rights (UNGPR), and the conventions and recommendations of the International Labour Organization (ILO) on labor and social standards. Derived from those, the Policy Statement includes core principles such as protecting freedom of association, the right to collective bargaining, ensuring adequate working conditions, and comprehensive health and safety measures in the workplace. The prohibition of human trafficking and child and forced labor is also a central element of the Policy Statement. In addition to human rights, working conditions and environmental protection, the Code of Conduct also addresses issues such as corruption, bribery, conflicts of interest and money laundering.

Brenntag has taken targeted actions to successfully implement and embed these policies aimed at preventing human rights violations and promoting work-related rights and working conditions throughout its operations and along the supply chain. Since as far back as 2016, Brenntag has been a member of Together for Sustainability (TfS), an industry initiative which, among other things, specializes in audits and online assessments of suppliers in the chemical industry. The aim is to create synergies and reduce the effort for suppliers by making the results of a conducted assessment available to all TfS members. This engagement promotes standardization with regard to determining the situation of value chain workers, while also contributing to transparency over working conditions. Here, Brenntag works together with EcoVadis, a leading provider of sustainability assessments. EcoVadis assesses companies on the environment, labor and human rights, ethics and sustainable procurement. The results, which are illustrated on a scale from 0 to 100, offer not only an evaluation of sustainability performance, but also specific suggestions for improvement. A high score indicates good performance, while an assessment with a low score or no assessment at all signals potential human rights or environmental risks. Based on these assessments, Brenntag specifically asks its suppliers to make improvements.

Brenntag gains a more detailed picture of sustainability performance by conducting on-site sustainability audits at suppliers selected by the responsible purchasers based on a catalog of requirements developed by TfS covering sustainability management, the environment, health and safety, employee and human rights, and corporate governance. As part of the process, employees of the supplier are also interviewed on-site. Brenntag also accepts audits conducted in accordance with SQAS, SMETA and PSCI standards. Depending on the audit results, corrective actions are agreed and their implementation is tracked.

Further preventive and remedial actions are derived from human rights risk management, which Brenntag has integrated into an innovative IT solution. Risk management is carried out continuously. This system captures all Tier 1 suppliers and classifies them into one of four risk categories – critical, high, medium or low – on the basis of various risk parameters, including site, sector, sales and AI-supported 360-degree media screening. Depending on the risk category, appropriate preventive actions are regularly initiated, such as training, assessments or audits, which suppliers are required to implement within a set period and which address any risks identified in the supply chain.

Risk management is the responsibility of the Human Rights Officer, who monitors it and refines it on an ad hoc basis. In the reporting period, Brenntag did not receive any reports of human rights violations within its upstream value chain that resulted in the need to specify and initiate remedial actions. For this reason, no remedial actions were initiated. However, two incidents involving suppliers are currently being investigated for potential human rights violations, and the investigation had not been completed by the end of the financial year.

Brenntag checks all implemented actions on both an annual and an ad hoc basis in order to ensure effectiveness. At the same time, employees from the HR, QSHE (Quality, Safety, Health, Environment) and Procurement departments who are closely involved in human rights due diligence processes have continuous access to specific training courses on the relevant processes and values at Brenntag. In future, suppliers are to receive more intense training on sustainability matters. For this, greater use will be made of resources such as the TfS Academy and e-learning platforms.

In order to detect possible irregularities at an early stage, Brenntag has also set up a whistleblowing channel that is available to both employees and external third parties on the Brenntag website.

Concerns and reports can be submitted anonymously through the whistleblowing channel.¹⁾ Concerns or reports regarding potential human rights violations can also be e-mailed to the department of the Human Rights Officer. Brenntag's suppliers are required to protect employees who submit reports in good faith against retaliation. The requirement to maintain and publicize a whistleblowing channel is stipulated in Brenntag's Supplier Code of Conduct and is therefore passed on within the supply chain.

¹⁾ Further information on the rights of complainants can be found in the section "Business conduct".

If violations, including negative impacts of child and forced labor, are thus reported or actually identified within Brenntag's supply chain, Brenntag undertakes to put in place adequate preventive and remedial measures. Brenntag has established an appropriate process for this purpose: First, all relevant information is gathered and examined by experts applying the dual control principle. Based on an assessment of the severity of the (potential) incident (severity assessment), a specific action plan is developed, implemented and tracked together with the business partner. This engagement follows the principle of 'enablement before withdrawal'. Following completion of the action plan, a check is carried out to determine whether the incident has been fully remedied. Only once attempts at correction have been unsuccessful does Brenntag reserve the right to terminate the business relationship.

In addition, in 2025, a comprehensive online training course on human rights in the business context was developed and made available to all employees. The aim is to raise awareness of human rights requirements in internal processes. The effectiveness of the online training is evaluated based on a survey of participant satisfaction after the training has been completed.

In the reporting period, Brenntag focused intensively on preparing for the implementation of the EU Regulation on deforestation-free supply chains (EUDR). To ensure strategic integration, a cross-functional project team was established, bringing together experts from the Supply Chain, Quality, Legal, IT and Group Sustainability units. This team coordinates the company-wide implementation of the regulatory requirements. In addition, training was provided to Procurement and Regulatory teams in order to integrate the new regulatory requirements into existing processes, raise awareness of the new provisions among relevant suppliers and verify their compliance. The dedicated IT system for risk analysis and risk mitigation mentioned above has been expanded to include a corresponding module. This module assesses risks at the product-supplier combination level and performs comprehensive 360-degree media screening. To validate results, the analysis is supplemented in defined cases by specific supplier questionnaires and satellite-based geodata monitoring to conclusively exclude deforestation.

Targets

S2-5

Derived from its successfully implemented human rights risk management, Brenntag's target is to systematically capture all active suppliers managed in the ERP systems and mitigate related risks from financial year 2024 onwards. This enables it to determine risks within the dedicated IT solution used for risk management. This target was achieved again in the 2025 reporting period and will be continuously pursued in the coming years. It had already been communicated, prepared and partially implemented in the previous years.

In addition, Brenntag is pursuing the target of ensuring that all suppliers share Brenntag's vision on human rights and environmental protection by 2027. To achieve this target, various actions and interim targets have been specified and were successfully implemented in 2025. These include developing a roadmap to further integrate sustainability criteria into procurement processes, contacting about 30% of all relevant suppliers in accordance with the internal risk definition regarding Brenntag's Code of Conduct, and specifying an approach to identifying challenging raw materials (such as palm oil, conflict minerals, mica, etc.) in Brenntag's product portfolio.

The targets were set out by the specialists responsible, including the Human Rights Officer, and established by them with the involvement of the Brenntag Board of Management and management. The specialists act as representatives of the interests of stakeholders along the value chain. Progress in achieving the targets is reviewed on a quarterly basis using an ESG scorecard. This scorecard is agreed with the Human Rights Officer on a regular basis and also reported to Brenntag's Board of Management.

Brenntag plans to further optimize the content of the targets over the medium term and expand it on a more detailed level.

Governance

Business conduct

Material business conduct-related impacts, risks and opportunities

ESRS 2 SBM-3, ESRS 2 IRO-1

Brenntag attaches great importance to responsible, future-oriented and sustainable business conduct. In the

context of the assessment to determine the material impacts, risks and opportunities relating to business conduct, Brenntag's global business activities as a chemical distributor were considered holistically, regardless of locations and divisions, and are summarized in the following overview:¹⁾

Material topic	Impacts, risks or opportunities	Value chain	Time horizon	Description
Corporate culture	Impact (positive)	Along the value chain	Constant	Positive influence on the distribution market through the corporate culture and business conduct, including beliefs, mission statements and values (care, trust, excellence, safety, clarity), and as a result of clearly communicating expectations and promoting ethical standards across the value chain
	Risk	Own operations	Constant	Failure to adhere to an ethical and legally compliant corporate culture/ethical and legally compliant business conduct poses reputational risks that could result in the loss of business, for example because business partners refuse to continue to work with the company
	Risk	Own operations	Constant	Fall in the share price (governance ratings, reputation, loss of investors) if an ethical and legally compliant corporate culture/ethical and legally compliant business conduct is not adhered to
Corruption and bribery	Impact (negative)	Along the value chain	Constant	Harm (price, lower demand, less competition) to important stakeholder groups such as customers and suppliers due to inadequate prevention and detection of corruption and bribery
	Risk	Own operations	Constant	Fines and penalties due to inadequate prevention and detection of corruption and bribery
Protection of whistleblowers	Risk	Own operations	Constant	Fines and penalties due to inadequate protection of whistleblowers; reputational damage if confidentiality is not maintained toward whistleblowers

2.62 Material business conduct-related impacts and risks

¹⁾ Further information on this is contained in the section "General disclosures", sub-section "Double materiality assessment".

Corporate culture and business conduct

Policies and actions

G1-1

Brenntag's business partners and other stakeholders expect the highest level of quality, reliability and efficient, innovative solutions. In order to meet this standard, Brenntag uses five core values to systematically guide its actions. These values – care, trust, clarity, excellence and safety – shape all business activities and business relationships, and support positive development across the value chain.

	Care We take responsibility for each other, our partners and the world.
	Trust We build relationships through authenticity and commitment.
	Clarity We work toward common goals with focus and determination.
	Excellence We go beyond expectations through excellence, innovation and collaboration.
	Safety We put safety first in everything we do.

2.63 Values of Brenntag SE

The Code of Business Conduct and Ethics reflects these values and sets out additional principles of conduct which are expected of all Brenntag employees. Managers are expected to set an example by living these values in their leadership role and to help their teams in the best possible way to implement them in their everyday working life. Through various digital and analog options, employees are encouraged to consciously engage with the corporate values and use them to guide their actions. This begins during the new employee recruitment process, which is shaped by the Brenntag values, and continues during human resources development. It encompasses interaction both among employees and with external partners. For example, meetings involving more than three people should always start with a 'Safety Moment' or 'Culture Moment', where different safety- or culture-related topics can be addressed.

In addition to the Code of Business Conduct and Ethics, of which all employees are reminded through annual training, there are other relevant compliance guidelines, (online) training courses and a whistleblowing system that serve to cement and further develop the corporate culture.

The comprehensive Code of Business Conduct and Ethics specifies that all employees are expected to adhere to laws, provisions and regulations. The Code also addresses topics such as the prevention of bribery and corruption, antitrust and competition law, and dealing with conflicts of interest, and provides information on data protection and information security. Additional Group compliance guidelines help to further strengthen legally compliant conduct. These include guidelines on anti-corruption, gifts and invitations, conflicts of interest, competition and antitrust law, and compliance with foreign trade provisions. These internal regulations offer employees guidance on legal and ethical issues in everyday working life and govern interaction with colleagues, business partners and the public. Any infringement of the rules of conduct may lead to disciplinary action and have further consequences under employment law or criminal law. The compliance-related guidelines – especially the Code of Business Conduct and Ethics – apply to all employees at every level of the company. The decision to implement these guidelines is the responsibility of the Board of Management. The internal audit department reviews compliance with these guidelines on a regular basis.

In addition, Brenntag uses a Supplier Code of Conduct. Among other things, this requires suppliers to adhere to all applicable laws and provisions, and to follow principles of responsible business conduct. Brenntag thus establishes a standard and a corporate culture across its own supply chain.¹⁾

The Group guidelines can be accessed by all employees on the intranet. The Code of Business Conduct and Ethics and the Supplier Code of Conduct are also published on the Brenntag Group's external website and are available in various languages.

¹⁾ Further information on this can be found in the section "Workers in the value chain", sub-section "Policies and actions".

Prevention and detection of corruption and bribery

Policies and actions

[S1-3, S2-3, G1-1, G1-3](#)

Brenntag has established a global compliance management system in order to prevent corruption and bribery. In particular, the guidelines mentioned in the section above, the established training courses, the processes for whistleblowers, regular compliance communications and internal reporting are actions designed to counter corruption and bribery risks.

Annual, mandatory compliance training ensures that employees' knowledge is always kept up to date. The Group-wide e-learning platform in particular is used for this. The online training course on the Code of Business Conduct and Ethics is mandatory for employees once a year. Also on an annual basis, Brenntag offers mandatory in-depth, target group-oriented training on topics such as anti-corruption.

Throughout the company, Brenntag has established processes to receive and handle internal and external complaints and compliance notifications. Brenntag employees can discuss such reports confidentially with their line manager, notify the compliance department or communicate them through central or regional whistleblowing systems and channels. Reports can also be submitted through the whistleblowing system anonymously and by external people. All reports or suspicions of possible violations of laws, regulations or internal guidelines, especially the Code of Business Conduct and Ethics, are registered by the compliance department and entered in the case management system. Relevant cases are forwarded to the internal audit department for investigation. The head of the compliance department reports directly to the Board of Management in this regard. In addition, Brenntag has set up an Investigation & Remediation Council to investigate significant reports. When investigating incoming reports, care is always taken to ensure that investigators are independent. The management chain involved in the matter is always separated from the investigating committee and does not function as the investigator.

The whistleblowing system can be reached through the Brenntag Group's website. The information received is always treated as strictly confidential. Relevant incoming reports are examined internally. In the event of a compliance violation, appropriate countermeasures are initiated.

Brenntag informs its employees about the existence of the various whistleblowing channels and the Whistleblowing Guideline. In addition, posters pointing out the various whistleblowing channels have been hung up at Brenntag sites around the globe. Among other things under the compliance department's year-round communication plan, Brenntag conducted an internal Tone-from-the-Top communication campaign on World Whistleblowers Day in the reporting period. In particular, this reiterated the importance of whistleblowing as well as the existence of the various whistleblowing channels. The commitment and support afforded to this topic by the Board of Management were outlined accordingly. Information on using whistleblowing channels is also provided in the regular training on the Code of Business Conduct and Ethics.

Brenntag regularly invites selected suppliers to a sustainability assessment or audit so as to ascertain that the values and principles set out in the Supplier Code are also being put into practice along the value chain.¹⁾

Targets and metrics

[ESRS 2 GOV-1, G1-3, G1-4, ESRS 2 BP-2](#)

Even though no targets are set in accordance with ESRS requirements, Brenntag monitors the actions and requirements in this field. Thus, the Senior Vice President (SVP) Compliance Brenntag Group of Brenntag SE provides the Board of Management and the Supervisory Board with information on compliance matters every quarter. Reports on compliance and whistleblowing cases and the development of the Group-wide compliance management system are also given in the regular meetings of the Supervisory Board's Audit and Compliance Committee.

Compliance training

As outlined in the section above, Brenntag offers regular and mandatory training to keep its employees' knowledge of compliance topics and guidelines up to date. Some training courses, in particular on corruption prevention and antitrust and competition law, are directed specifically at employees in at-risk functions, which are defined especially by their direct relation to the business and business partners, as well as at all managers. Regular compliance training and information sessions are also conducted for Board of Management members.

¹⁾ Further information on this can be found in the section "Workers in the value chain".

GROUP SUSTAINABILITY STATEMENT

Compliance training is delivered through an online training platform that also documents the number of participants.

Details of the different compliance courses in the 2025 reporting period are listed below:

	Code of Conduct training	Anti-corruption training	Antitrust training ¹⁾
Extent of employee training			
Note regarding extent of employee training	This training is directed at all relevant employees.	This training is directed specifically at relevant employees in at-risk functions.	This training is directed specifically at relevant employees in at-risk functions.
Completed training courses (%)	93% (2024: 95%)	97% (2024: 99%)	97% (2024: 98%)
Frequency of training			
How often is this training mandatory?	Annually	Annually	Annually
Delivery method and training content			
Delivery method	Online training	Online training	Online training
Duration of training	35 minutes	30 minutes	30 minutes
Training content	The course features information on the topics set out in the Code of Business Conduct and Ethics: corruption prevention; prevention of money laundering; correct bookkeeping and financial reporting; competition and antitrust law; conflicts of interest; confidentiality; data protection and information security; foreign trade compliance; fraud prevention; insider trading; handling and safeguarding of Brenntag property; health, safety and environmental protection; human rights and labor practices; discrimination and harassment.	The training provides practical, case-based insight into the basics of corruption prevention. Employees learn to recognize conduct that entails risk and how to respond appropriately in order to prevent it. In particular, the training covers practical situations related to gifts and invitations, avoiding facilitation payments and dealing with business partners in connection with these situations.	The training provides practical, case-based insight into the basics of antitrust law. Employees learn what conduct is prohibited, such as forming a cartel, and what sanctions might be imposed. They are also given guidance on how to deal carefully with competitors, suppliers and customers. Employees learn to recognize conduct that entails risk and how to respond appropriately in order to prevent it.

2.64 Training table

¹⁾ Voluntary disclosure.

Accounting principles

Brenntag collects and analyzes the metrics for completed online compliance training courses via the People platform. All active Brenntag employees with an e-mail address and PC access enroll on the online training courses via the platform during the enrollment cycle. The rate of completed compliance training courses is calculated on the basis of this population. The training on the Code of Conduct and Business Ethics is assigned to all employees in this population. In addition, employees in at-risk functions receive in-depth online training on anti-trust law and anti-corruption. For this purpose, a selection of these employees is made in the People platform based on their job profile and function. As described in the section "Material impacts, risks and opportunities related to own workforce", sub-section "Accounting principles", the accounting-based definition of personnel metrics has been applied since financial year 2025. This also results in a slightly adjusted population of training participants in 2024, which, however, does not represent any change in the percentage of completed training courses. Furthermore, Brenntag offers face-to-face training on the Code of Conduct for offline employees without an e-mail address and PC access at global level.

In 2025, the members of the Board of Management were regularly updated through personal meetings on relevant compliance topics, in particular with regard to the Code of Conduct and Business Ethics and anti-corruption matters.¹⁾

Confirmed incidents of corruption and bribery

In 2025, there were no convictions as a result of violations of anti-corruption and anti-bribery laws and therefore no fines.

¹⁾ Documentary evidence of courses of instruction and training taken by the Supervisory Board members can be found in the "Corporate governance statement", sub-section "Working practices of the Supervisory Board", and the "Report of the Supervisory Board".

Appendix

Statement on due diligence

ESRS 2 GOV-4

Core elements of due diligence	Reference to sustainability statement	Pages
Embedding due diligence in governance, strategy and business model	Corresponding information in the "Corporate governance statement" and in the section "General disclosures", sub-section "Business model, value chain and strategy"	75, 85, 97-100
Engaging with affected stakeholders in all key steps of the due diligence	Corresponding description in the section "General disclosures", sub-section "Interests and views of stakeholders", and in Own workforce, sub-section "Social dialog and employee involvement"	100, 144-145
Identifying and assessing adverse impacts	Description of the process to identify and assess material impacts, risks and opportunities in the section "General disclosures", sub-section "Double materiality assessment"	101-103
	Detailed list of material adverse impacts in the topic-specific sections	104, 109, 115, 120, 123, 138, 151, 154
Taking actions to address those adverse impacts	Description of actions in the respective topic-specific sections	104-108, 111, 115-118, 120, 127, 140-142, 144-149, 151-153, 156-157
Tracking the effectiveness of these efforts and communicating	Tracking of effectiveness through targets (ESG scorecard) and description of further management actions in the respective topic-specific sections	98, 109-111, 113, 117-118, 121, 125, 127, 142-143, 145, 147, 149, 153, 156-157

2.63 Statement on due diligence

Disclosure requirements covered by the sustainability statement

ESRS 2 IRO-2

ESRS	Title	Section	Pages
ESRS 2	General disclosures		
BP-1	General basis for preparation of the sustainability statement	GSS ¹⁾	94-95
BP-2	Disclosures in relation to specific circumstances		94-95, 114, 117, 119, 121, 125-128, 139-140, 142, 144-145, 147-148, 149-150, 157
GOV-1	The role of the administrative, management and supervisory bodies	GSS CGS ²⁾	95 74-77, 79-80, 83-85, 88-90, 92
GOV-2	Information provided to and sustainability matters addressed by Brenntag's administrative, management and supervisory bodies	GSS CGS	95 75, 79
GOV-3	Integration of sustainability-related performance in incentive schemes	GSS	95-96
GOV-4	Statement on due diligence	GSS	95, 158
GOV-5	Risk management and internal controls over sustainability reporting	GSS RR ³⁾	96 56, 58-61, 63-64, 66-67
SBM-1	Strategy, business model and value chain	GSS GO ⁴⁾	97-100, 139 34-35
SBM-2	Interests and views of stakeholders	GSS	100, 144-145, 151-152
SBM-3	Material impacts, risks and opportunities and their interaction with strategy and business model	GSS	101-102, 104, 108-109, 115, 120, 123, 138-139, 151, 154
IRO-1	Description of the process to identify and assess material impacts, risks and opportunities	GSS	101-103, 104, 109, 115, 120, 123, 138-139, 151, 154
IRO-2	Disclosure requirements in ESRS covered by the sustainability statement	GSS	101, 158-165

¹⁾ GSS – Group sustainability statement

²⁾ CGS – Corporate governance statement

³⁾ RR – Report on expected developments, opportunities and risks

⁴⁾ GO – Group overview

GROUP SUSTAINABILITY STATEMENT

E1 Climate change			
ESRS 2 GOV-3	Integration of sustainability-related performance in incentive schemes	GSS	95-96
E1-1	Transition plan for climate change mitigation	GSS	104-105
ESRS 2 SBM-3	Material impacts, risks and opportunities and their interaction with strategy and business model	GSS	101-102, 104, 108-109
ESRS 2 IRO-1	Description of the processes to identify and assess material climate-related impacts, risks and opportunities	GSS	102-103, 104, 108-109
E1-2	Policies related to climate change mitigation and adaptation	GSS	106
E1-3	Actions and resources in relation to climate change policies	GSS	106-108
E1-4	Targets related to climate change mitigation and adaptation	GSS	109-111, 113
E1-5	Energy consumption and mix	GSS	112, 114
E1-6	Gross Scopes 1, 2, 3 and Total GHG emissions	GSS	113-114
E1-7	GHG removals and GHG mitigation projects financed through carbon credits	GSS	107
E1-8	Internal carbon pricing	GSS	105
E2 Pollution			
ESRS 2 IRO-1	Description of the processes to identify and assess material pollution-related impacts, risks and opportunities	GSS	102-103, 115
E2-1	Policies related to pollution	GSS	115, 117
E2-2	Actions and resources related to pollution	GSS	115-118
E2-3	Targets related to pollution	GSS	117-118
E2-4	Pollution of air, water and soil	GSS	117
E2-5	Substances of concern and substances of very high concern	GSS	118-119
E2-6	Operating and capital expenditures incurred in the reporting period in conjunction with major incidents and deposits	GSS	117
E3 Water			
ESRS 2 IRO-1	Description of the processes to identify and assess material water resources-related impacts, risks and opportunities	GSS	102-103, 120
E3-1	Policies related to water resources	GSS	120-122
E3-2	Actions and resources related to water resources	GSS	120-122
E3-3	Targets related to water resources	GSS	121-122
E3-4	Water consumption	GSS	121
E4 Biodiversity and ecosystems			
ESRS 2 IRO-1	Description of processes to identify and assess material biodiversity and ecosystem-related impacts, risks and opportunities	GSS	102-103
E5 Resource use and circular economy			
ESRS 2 IRO-1	Description of the processes to identify and assess material resource use and circular economy-related impacts, risks and opportunities	GSS	102-103, 123
E5-1	Policies related to resource use and circular economy	GSS	123-124, 126-127
E5-2	Actions and resources related to resource use and circular economy	GSS	123-124, 126-127
E5-3	Targets related to resource use and circular economy	GSS	125-127
E5-4	Resource inflows	GSS	125-126
E5-5	Resource outflows	GSS	125-128

GROUP SUSTAINABILITY STATEMENT

S1	Own workforce	Section	Page
ESRS 2 SBM-2	Interests and views of stakeholders	GSS	100, 144-145, 151-152
ESRS 2 SBM-3	Material impacts, risks and opportunities and their interaction with strategy and business model	GSS	101-102, 138-139
S1-1	Policies related to own workforce	GSS	139-140, 142-146, 148-150
S1-2	Processes for engaging with own workers and workers' representatives about impacts	GSS	100, 144-145
S1-3	Processes to remediate negative impacts and channels for own workers to raise concerns	GSS	150, 152-153, 156
S1-4	Taking action on material impacts on own workforce, and approaches to managing material risks and pursuing material opportunities related to own workforce, and effectiveness of those actions	GSS	140-150
S1-5	Targets related to managing material negative impacts, advancing positive impacts, and managing material risks and opportunities	GSS	139, 142-143, 145, 147, 149
S1-6	Characteristics of the undertaking's employees	GSS	139, 143, 145
S1-9	Diversity metrics	GSS	149-150
S1-10	Adequate wages	GSS	143
S1-13	Training and skills development metrics	GSS	147-148
S1-14	Health and safety metrics	GSS	140, 142
S1-17	Incidents, complaints and severe human rights impacts	GSS	150
S2	Workers in the value chain		
ESRS 2 SBM-2	Interests and views of stakeholders	GSS	100, 144-145, 151-152
ESRS 2 SBM-3	Material impacts, risks and opportunities and their interaction with strategy and business model	GSS	101-102, 151
S2-1	Policies related to value chain workers	GSS	151-152
S2-2	Processes for engaging with value chain workers about impacts	GSS	100, 152
S2-3	Processes to remediate negative impacts and channels for value chain workers to raise concerns	GSS	152-153, 156
S2-4	Taking action on material impacts on value chain workers, and approaches to managing material risks and pursuing material opportunities related to value chain workers, and effectiveness of those actions	GSS	151-153
S2-5	Targets related to managing material negative impacts, advancing positive impacts, and managing material risks and opportunities	GSS	153
G1	Business conduct		
ESRS 2 GOV-1	The role of the administrative, management and supervisory bodies	GSS CGS	95, 157 74, 83-84
ESRS 2 IRO-1	Description of the processes to identify and assess material impacts, risks and opportunities	GSS	102-103, 154
G1-1	Business conduct policies and corporate culture	GSS	155-157
G1-3	Prevention and detection of corruption and bribery	GSS	156-157 83
G1-4	Incidents of corruption or bribery	GSS	157

2.65 Disclosure requirements covered by the Group sustainability statement

List of datapoints in cross-cutting and topical standards that derive from other EU legislation

ESRS 2 IRO-2

Disclosure requirement and related datapoint	SFDR reference	Pillar 3 reference	Benchmark Regulation reference	EU Climate Law reference	Section	Pages
ESRS 2 GOV-1 Board's gender diversity paragraph 21 (d)	Indicator no. 13 of Table #1 of Annex 1		Commission Delegated Regulation (EU) 2020/1816, Annex II		CGS	88
ESRS 2 GOV-1 Percentage of board members who are independent, paragraph 21 (e)			Delegated Regulation (EU) 2020/1816, Annex II		CGS	92
ESRS 2 GOV-4 Statement on due diligence paragraph 30	Indicator no. 10 Table #3 of Annex 1				GSS	158
ESRS 2 SBM-1 Involvement in activities related to fossil fuel activities paragraph 40 (d) i	Indicator no. 4 Table #1 of Annex 1	Article 449a Regulation (EU) No 575/2013; Commission Implementing Regulation (EU) 2022/2453, Table 1: Qualitative information on Environmental risk and Table 2: Qualitative information on Social risk	Delegated Regulation (EU) 2020/1816, Annex II		Non-material	
ESRS 2 SBM-1 Involvement in activities related to chemical production paragraph 40 (d) ii	Indicator no. 9 Table #2 of Annex 1		Delegated Regulation (EU) 2020/1816, Annex II		Non-material	
ESRS 2 SBM-1 Involvement in activities related to controversial weapons paragraph 40 (d) iii	Indicator no. 14 Table #1 of Annex 1		Delegated Regulation (EU) 2020/1818, Article 12(1) Delegated Regulation (EU) 2020/1816, Annex II		Non-material	
ESRS 2 SBM-1 Involvement in activities related to cultivation and production of tobacco paragraph 40 (d) iv			Delegated Regulation (EU) 2020/1818, Article 12(1) Delegated Regulation (EU) 2020/1816, Annex II		Non-material	
ESRS E1-1 Transition plan to reach climate neutrality by 2050 paragraph 14				Regulation (EU) 2021/1119, Article 2(1)	GSS	104-105
ESRS E1-1 Undertakings excluded from Paris-aligned Benchmarks paragraph 16 (g)		Article 449a Regulation (EU) No 575/2013; Commission Implementing Regulation (EU) 2022/2453, Template 1: Banking book – Climate change transition risk: Credit quality of exposures by sector, emissions and residual maturity		Delegated Regulation (EU) 2020/1818, Article 12.1 (d) to (g), and Article 12.2	GSS	105
ESRS E1-4 GHG emission reduction targets paragraph 34	Indicator no. 4 Table #2 of Annex 1	Article 449a Regulation (EU) No 575/2013; Commission Implementing Regulation (EU) 2022/2453, Template 3: Banking book – Climate change transition risk: alignment metrics	Delegated Regulation (EU) 2020/1818, Article 6		GSS	109-111, 113

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ESRS E1-5 Energy consumption from fossil sources disaggregated by sources (only high climate impact sectors) paragraph 38	Indicator no. 5 Table #1 and Indicator no. 5 Table #2 of Annex 1				GSS	112
ESRS E1-5 Energy consumption and mix paragraph 37	Indicator no. 5 Table #1 of Annex 1				GSS	112
ESRS E1-5 Energy intensity associated with activities in high climate impact sectors paragraphs 40 to 43	Indicator no. 6 Table #1 of Annex 1				GSS	112
ESRS E1-6 Gross Scope 1, 2, 3 and Total GHG emissions paragraph 44	Indicators no. 1 and 2 Table #1 of Annex 1	Article 449a Regulation (EU) No 575/2013; Commission Implementing Regulation (EU) 2022/2453, Template 1: Banking book – Climate change transition risk: Credit quality of exposures by sector, emissions and residual maturity	Delegated Regulation (EU) 2020/1818, Article 5(1), 6 and 8(1)		GSS	113
ESRS E1-6 Gross GHG emissions intensity paragraphs 53 to 55	Indicator no. 3 Table #1 of Annex 1	Article 449a Regulation (EU) No 575/2013; Commission Implementing Regulation (EU) 2022/2453, Template 3: Banking book – Climate change transition risk: alignment metrics	Delegated Regulation (EU) 2020/1818, Article 8(1)		GSS	114
ESRS E1-7 GHG removals and carbon credits paragraph 56				Regulation (EU) 2021/1119, Article 2(1)	GSS	107
ESRS E1-9 Exposure of the benchmark portfolio to climate-related physical risks paragraph 66			Delegated Regulation (EU) 2020/1818, Annex II Delegated Regulation (EU) 2020/1816, Annex II		Phase-in	
ESRS E1-9 Disaggregation of monetary amounts by acute and chronic physical risk paragraph 66 (a) ESRS E1-9 Location of significant assets at material physical risk paragraph 66 (c)		Article 449a Regulation (EU) No 575/2013; Commission Implementing Regulation (EU) 2022/2453, paragraphs 46 and 47; Template 5: Banking book – Climate change physical risk: Exposures subject to physical risk			Phase-in	
ESRS E1-9 Breakdown of the carrying value of its real estate assets by energy-efficiency classes paragraph 67 (c)		Article 449a Regulation (EU) No 575/2013; Commission Implementing Regulation (EU) 2022/2453, paragraph 34; Template 2: Banking book – Climate change transition risk: Loans collateralised by immovable property - Energy efficiency of the collateral			Phase-in	
ESRS E1-9 Degree of exposure of the portfolio to climate-related opportunities paragraph 69			Delegated Regulation (EU) 2020/1818, Annex II		Phase-in	
ESRS E2-4 Amount of each pollutant listed in Annex II of the E-PRTR Regulation (European Pollutant Release and Transfer Register) emitted to air, water and soil, paragraph 28	Indicator no. 8 Table #1 of Annex 1 Indicator no. 2 Table #2 of Annex 1 Indicator no. 1 Table #2 of Annex 1 Indicator no. 3 Table #2 of Annex 1				GSS	117

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ESRS E3-1 Water and marine resources paragraph 9	Indicator no. 7 Table #2 of Annex 1				GSS	120-122
ESRS E3-1 Dedicated policy paragraph 13	Indicator number 8 Table 2 of Annex 1				GSS	120
ESRS E3-1 Sustainable oceans and seas paragraph 14	Indicator no. 12 Table #2 of Annex 1				Non-material	
ESRS E3-4 Total water recycled and reused paragraph 28 (c)	Indicator no. 6.2 Table #2 of Annex 1				Non-material	
ESRS E3-4 Total water consumption in m³ per net revenue on own operations paragraph 29	Indicator no. 6.1 Table #2 of Annex 1				GSS	121
ESRS 2 – SBM-3 – E4 paragraph 16 (a) i	Indicator no. 7 Table #1 of Annex 1				Non-material	
ESRS 2 – SBM-3 – E4 paragraph 16 (b)	Indicator no. 10 Table #2 of Annex 1				Non-material	
ESRS 2 – SBM-3 – E4 paragraph 16(c)	Indicator no. 14 Table #2 of Annex 1				Non-material	
ESRS E4-2 Sustainable land/ agriculture practices or policies paragraph 24 (b)	Indicator no. 11 Table #2 of Annex 1				Non-material	
ESRS E4-2 Sustainable oceans/seas practices or policies paragraph 24 (c)	Indicator no. 12 Table #2 of Annex 1				Non-material	
ESRS E4-2 Policies to address deforestation paragraph 24 (d)	Indicator no. 15 Table #2 of Annex 1				Non-material	
ESRS E5-5 Non-recycled waste paragraph 37 (d)	Indicator no. 13 Table #2 of Annex 1				GSS	127
ESRS E5-5 Hazardous waste and radioactive waste paragraph 39	Indicator no. 9 Table #1 of Annex 1				GSS	127
ESRS 2 SBM3 – S1 Risk of incidents of forced labour paragraph 14 (f)	Indicator no. 13 Table #3 of Annex I				GSS	139
ESRS 2 SBM3 – S1 Risk of incidents of child labour paragraph 14 (g)	Indicator no. 12 Table #3 of Annex I				GSS	139
ESRS S1-1 Human rights policy commitments paragraph 20	Indicator no. 9 Table #3 and Indicator no. 11 Table #1 of Annex I				GSS	139, 151-152
ESRS S1-1 Due diligence policies on issues addressed by the fundamental International Labor Organisation Conventions 1 to 8, paragraph 21			Delegated Regulation (EU) 2020/1816, Annex II		GSS	151-152
ESRS S1-1 Processes and measures for preventing trafficking in human beings paragraph 22	Indicator no. 11 Table #3 of Annex I				Non-material	
ESRS S1-1 Workplace accident prevention policy or management system paragraph 23	Indicator no. 1 Table #3 of Annex I				GSS	140
ESRS S1-3 Grievance/ complaints handling mechanisms paragraph 32 (c)	Indicator no. 5 Table #3 of Annex I				GSS	150, 152-153, 156

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ESRS S1-14 Number of fatalities and number and rate of work-related accidents paragraph 88 (b) and (c)	Indicator no. 2 Table #3 of Annex I		Delegated Regulation (EU) 2020/1816, Annex II	GSS	142
ESRS S1-14 Number of days lost to injuries, accidents, fatalities or illness paragraph 88 (e)	Indicator no. 3 Table #3 of Annex I			GSS	142
ESRS S1-16 Unadjusted gender pay gap paragraph 97 (a)	Indicator no. 12 Table #1 of Annex I		Delegated Regulation (EU) 2020/1816, Annex II	Non-material	
ESRS S1-16 Excessive CEO pay ratio paragraph 97 (b)	Indicator no. 8 Table #3 of Annex I			Non-material	
ESRS S1-17 Incidents of discrimination paragraph 103 (a)	Indicator no. 7 Table #3 of Annex I			GSS	150
ESRS S1-17 Non-respect of UNGPs on Business and Human Rights and OECD guidelines paragraph 104 (a)	Indicator no. 10 Table #1 and Indicator no. 14 Table #3 of Annex I		Delegated Regulation (EU) 2020/1816, Annex II Dele- gated Regula- tion (EU) 2020/1818 Article 12(1)	GSS	150
ESRS 2 SBM3 – S2 Significant risk of child labour or forced labour in the value chain paragraph 11 (b)	Indicators no. 12 and 13 Table #3 of Annex I			GSS	151
ESRS S2-1 Human rights policy commitments paragraph 17	Indicator no. 9 Table #3 and Indicator no. 11 Table #1 of Annex 1			GSS	151-152
ESRS S2-1 Policies related to value chain workers paragraph 18	Indicator no. 11 and no. 4 Table #3 of Annex 1			GSS	151-152
ESRS S2-1 Non-respect of UNGPs on Business and Human Rights and OECD guidelines paragraph 19	Indicator no. 10 Table #1 of Annex 1		Delegated Regulation (EU) 2020/1816, Annex II Dele- gated Regula- tion (EU) 2020/1818 Article 12(1)	GSS	152
ESRS S2-1 Due diligence policies on issues addressed by the fundamental International Labor Organisation Conventions 1 to 8, paragraph 19			Delegated Regulation (EU) 2020/1816, Annex II	GSS	151-152
ESRS S2-4 Human rights issues and incidents connected to its upstream and downstream value chain paragraph 36	Indicator no. 14 Table #3 of Annex 1			GSS	152
ESRS S3-1 Human rights policy commitments paragraph 16	Indicator no. 9 Table #3 and Indicator no. 11 Table #1 of Annex 1			Non-material	
ESRS S3-1 Non-respect of UNGPs on Business and Human Rights, ILO principles or OECD guidelines paragraph 17	Indicator no. 10 Table #1 of Annex 1		Delegated Regulation (EU) 2020/1816, Annex II Dele- gated Regula- tion (EU) 2020/1818 Article 12(1)	Non-material	

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ESRS S3-4 Human rights issues and incidents paragraph 36	Indicator no. 14 Table #3 of Annex 1				Non-material	
ESRS S4-1 Policies related to consumers and end-users paragraph 1	Indicator no. 9 Table #3 and Indicator no. 11 Table #1 of Annex 1				Non-material	
ESRS S4-1 Non-respect of UNGPs on Business and Human Rights and OECD guidelines paragraph 17	Indicator no. 10 Table #1 of Annex 1		Delegated Regulation (EU) 2020/1816, Annex II Dele- gated Regula- tion (EU) 2020/1818 Article 12(1)		Non-material	
ESRS S4-4 Human rights issues and incidents paragraph 35	Indicator no. 14 Table #3 of Annex 1				Non-material	
ESRS G1-1 United Nations Convention against Corruption paragraph 10 (b)	Indicator no. 15 Table #3 of Annex 1				GSS	155-157
ESRS G1-1 Protection of whistleblowers paragraph 10 (d)	Indicator no. 6 Table #3 of Annex 1				GSS	156
ESRS G1-4 Fines for violation of anti-corruption and anti-bribery laws paragraph 24 (a)	Indicator no. 17 Table #3 of Annex 1		Delegated Regulation (EU) 2020/1816, Annex II		GSS	157
ESRS G1-4 Standards of anti-corruption and anti-bribery paragraph 24 (b)	Indicator no. 16 Table #3 of Annex 1				GSS	157

2.66 List of datapoints in cross-cutting and topical standards that derive from other EU legislation

Assurance Report

Assurance Report of the independent German Public Auditor on an assurance engagement to obtain limited and reasonable assurance in relation to the Group sustainability statement

To Brenntag SE, Essen/Germany

Assurance Conclusion

We have conducted a limited assurance engagement on the Group sustainability statement of Brenntag SE, Essen/Germany, for the financial year from January 1 to December 31, 2025, included in section “Group sustainability statement” of the combined management report for the parent and the group (hereafter referred to as “Group sustainability statement”). The Group sustainability statement was prepared to fulfill the requirements of Directive (EU) 2022/2464 of the European Parliament and of the Council of December 14, 2022 (Corporate Sustainability Reporting Directive, CSRD) and Article 8 of Regulation (EU) 2020/852 and Sections 315b and 315c German Commercial Code (HGB) for a Group sustainability statement.

Our assurance engagement did not cover the following references, which are contained in the Group sustainability statement:

- references to supplementary information of the Company outside the combined management report including the content of such information, and
- references to websites, including their contents.

Based on the procedures performed and the evidence obtained, nothing has come to our attention that causes us to believe that the accompanying Group sustainability statement is not prepared, in all material respects, in accordance with the requirements of the CSRD and Article 8 of Regulation (EU) 2020/852, Sections 315b and 315c HGB for a Group sustainability statement, and the specifying criteria presented by the executive directors of the Company. This assurance conclusion includes that nothing has come to our attention that causes us to believe

- that the Group sustainability statement does not comply, in all material respects, with the European Sustainability Reporting Standards (ESRS), including that the process carried out by the entity to identify information to be included in the Group sustainability statement (the materiality assessment) is not, in all material respects, in accordance with the description set out in section “Double materiality assessment” of the Group sustainability statement, or

- that the disclosures in the Group sustainability statement do not comply, in all material respects, with Article 8 of Regulation (EU) 2020/852.

We do not express an assurance conclusion on the above-mentioned parts of the Group sustainability statement that were not covered by our assurance engagement.

Basis for the Assurance Conclusion

We conducted our assurance engagement in accordance with the International Standard on Assurance Engagements (ISAE) 3000 (Revised): “Assurance Engagements Other Than Audits or Reviews of Historical Financial Information”, issued by the International Auditing and Assurance Standards Board (IAASB).

The procedures performed in a limited assurance engagement vary in nature and timing from, and are less in extent than for, a reasonable assurance engagement. Consequently, the level of assurance obtained is substantially lower than the assurance that would have been obtained had a reasonable assurance engagement been performed.

Our responsibilities under ISAE 3000 (Revised) are further described in section “German Public Auditor’s Responsibilities for the Assurance Engagement on the Group sustainability statement”.

We are independent of the entity in accordance with the requirements of European law and German commercial and professional law, and we have fulfilled our other German professional responsibilities in accordance with these requirements. Our audit firm has applied the requirements of the IDW Quality Management Standards. We believe that the evidence we have obtained is sufficient and appropriate to provide a basis for our assurance conclusion.

Responsibilities of the Executive Directors and the Supervisory Board for the Group Sustainability Statement

The executive directors are responsible for the preparation of the Group sustainability statement in accordance with the requirements of the CSRD and the applicable German legal and other European requirements as well as with the specifying criteria presented by the executive directors of the Company and for designing, implementing and maintaining such internal control as they have considered necessary to enable the preparation of a Group sustainability statement in accordance with these requirements that is free from material misstatement, whether due to fraud (i.e., fraudulent reporting in the Group sustainability statement) or error.

This responsibility of the executive directors includes establishing and maintaining the materiality assessment process, selecting and applying appropriate reporting policies for preparing the Group sustainability statement as well as making assumptions and estimates and ascertaining forward-looking information for individual sustainability-related disclosures.

The supervisory board is responsible for overseeing the process for the preparation of the Group sustainability statement.

Inherent Limitations in Preparing the Group Sustainability Statement

The CSRD and the applicable German legal and other European requirements contain wording and terms that are subject to considerable interpretation uncertainties and for which no authoritative comprehensive interpretations have yet been published. The executive directors have disclosed interpretations of such wording and terms in the Group sustainability statement. The executive directors are responsible for the reasonableness of these interpretations. As such wording and terms may be interpreted differently by regulators or courts, the legality of measurements or evaluations of the sustainability matters based on these interpretations is uncertain. The quantification of non-financial performance indicators disclosed in the Group sustainability statement is also subject to inherent uncertainties.

These inherent limitations also affect the assurance engagement on the Group sustainability statement.

German Public Auditor's Responsibilities for the Assurance Engagement on the Group Sustainability Statement

Our objective is to express a limited assurance conclusion based on the assurance engagement we have conducted on whether any matters have come to our attention that cause us to believe that the Group sustainability statement has not been prepared, in all material respects, in accordance with the CSRD, the applicable German legal and other European requirements and the specifying criteria presented by the executive directors of the Company and to issue an assurance report that includes our assurance conclusion on the Group sustainability statement.

As part of a limited assurance engagement in accordance with ISAE 3000 (Revised), we exercise professional judgment and maintain professional skepticism. We also

- obtain an understanding of the process used to prepare the Group sustainability statement, including the materiality assessment process carried out by the entity to identify the disclosures to be reported in the Group sustainability statement.
- identify disclosures where a material misstatement due to fraud or error is likely to arise, design and perform procedures to address these disclosures and obtain limited assurance to support the assurance conclusion. The risk of not detecting a material misstatement resulting from fraud is higher than the risk of not detecting a material misstatement resulting from error, as fraud may involve collusion, forgery, intentional omissions, misrepresentations or the override of internal control. In addition, the risk of not detecting a material misstatement in information obtained from sources not within the entity's control (value chain information) is ordinarily higher than the risk of not detecting a material misstatement in information obtained from sources within the entity's control, as both the entity's executive directors and we as practitioners are ordinarily subject to restrictions on direct access to the sources of the value chain information.
- consider the forward-looking information, including the appropriateness of the underlying assumptions. There is a substantial unavoidable risk that future events will differ materially from the forward-looking information.

Summary of the Procedures Performed by the German Public Auditor

A limited assurance engagement involves the performance of procedures to obtain evidence about the sustainability information. The nature, timing and extent of the selected procedures are subject to our professional judgment.

In performing our limited assurance engagement, we

- evaluated the suitability of the criteria as a whole presented by the executive directors in the Group sustainability statement.
- inquired of the executive directors and relevant employees involved in the preparation of the Group sustainability statement about the preparation process, including the materiality assessment process carried out by the entity to identify the disclosures to be reported in the Group sustainability statement, and about the internal controls related to this process.
- evaluated the reporting policies used by the executive directors to prepare the Group sustainability statement.
- evaluated the reasonableness of the estimates and related information provided by the executive directors. If, in accordance with the ESRS, the executive directors estimate the value chain information to be reported for a case in which the executive directors are unable to obtain the information from the value chain despite making reasonable efforts, our assurance engagement is limited to evaluating whether the executive directors have undertaken these estimates in accordance with the ESRS and assessing the reasonableness of these estimates, but does not include identifying information in the value chain that the executive directors were unable to obtain.
- performed analytical procedures or tests of details and made inquiries in relation to selected information in the Group sustainability statement.
- conducted site visits.
- considered the presentation of the information in the Group sustainability statement.
- considered the process for identifying taxonomy-eligible and taxonomy-aligned economic activities and the corresponding disclosures in the Group sustainability statement.

Restriction of Use

We issue this report as stipulated in the engagement letter agreed with the Company (including the “General Engagement Terms for Wirtschaftsprüferinnen, Wirtschaftsprüfer and Wirtschaftsprüfungsgesellschaften (German Public Auditors and Public Audit Firms)” dated January 1, 2024 of the Institut der Wirtschaftsprüfer (IDW)). We draw attention to the fact that the assurance engagement was conducted for the Company’s purposes and that the report is intended solely to inform the Company about the result of the assurance engagement. Consequently, it may not be suitable for any other than the aforementioned purpose. Accordingly, the report is not intended to be used by third parties as a basis for making (financial) decisions.

Our responsibility is to the Company alone. We do not accept any responsibility to third parties. Our assurance conclusion is not modified in this respect.

Düsseldorf/Germany, March 5, 2026

Deloitte GmbH

Wirtschaftsprüfungsgesellschaft

André Bedenbecker
Wirtschaftsprüfer
(German Public Auditor)

Daniel Oehlmann
Wirtschaftsprüfer
(German Public Auditor)

Consolidated

3 Financial Statements

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CONSOLIDATED INCOME
STATEMENT

Consolidated income statement

in EUR m	Note	2025	2024
Sales	1.)	15,171.5	16,237.4
Cost of materials	2.)	-11,339.8	-12,210.9
Gross profit		3,831.7	4,026.5
Other operating income	3.)	81.5	102.9
Personnel expenses	4.)	-1,448.5	-1,446.4
Depreciation and impairment of property, plant and equipment, and amortization and impairment of intangible assets	18.) / 19.) / 20.)	-589.3	-444.1
Impairment losses on trade receivables and other receivables	13.)	-6.3	-1.6
Other operating expenses	5.)	-1,251.5	-1,321.9
Operating profit		617.6	915.4
Share of profit or loss of equity-accounted investments	21.)	1.1	-0.1
Interest income		14.6	19.0
Interest expense	6.)	-152.6	-152.7
Change in liabilities relating to acquisition of non-controlling interests recognized in profit or loss	7.)	13.3	-14.0
Loss on the net monetary position	8.)	-8.1	-4.2
Other net finance costs	9.)	-0.5	-20.8
Net finance costs		-132.2	-172.8
Profit before tax		485.4	742.6
Income tax expense	10.)	-215.7	-198.9
Profit after tax		269.7	543.7
Attributable to:			
Shareholders of Brenntag SE		264.6	536.2
Non-controlling interests		5.1	7.5
Basic earnings per share in euro	11.)	1.83	3.71
Diluted earnings per share in euro	11.)	1.83	3.71

3.01 Consolidated income statement

CONSOLIDATED STATEMENT OF
COMPREHENSIVE INCOME

Consolidated statement of comprehensive income

in EUR m	Note	2025	2024
Profit after tax		269.7	543.7
Remeasurements of defined benefit pension plans	26.)	10.9	3.3
Deferred tax relating to remeasurements of defined benefit pension plans		-3.1	-1.3
Items that will not be reclassified to profit or loss		7.8	2.0
Change in exchange rate differences on translation of consolidated companies	28.)	-382.3	162.8
Change in exchange rate differences on translation of equity-accounted investments		-	0.1
Change in net investment hedge reserve	32.)	1.8	-4.9
Remeasurement of cross-currency interest rate swaps	32.)	30.1	-20.3
Reclassification to profit or loss of hedging losses	32.)	-48.5	36.9
Costs of hedging	32.)	1.2	-3.6
Reclassification to profit or loss of costs of hedging	32.)	-0.8	-0.8
Deferred tax relating to those items		4.6	-3.1
Items that may be reclassified subsequently to profit or loss		-393.9	167.1
Other comprehensive income, net of tax		-386.1	169.1
Total comprehensive income		-116.4	712.8
Attributable to:			
Shareholders of Brenntag SE		-117.5	704.8
Non-controlling interests	28.)	1.1	8.0

3.02 Consolidated statement of comprehensive income

CONSOLIDATED BALANCE SHEET

Consolidated balance sheet

Assets

in EUR m	Note	Dec. 31, 2025	Dec. 31, 2024
Current assets			
Cash and cash equivalents	12.)	797.9	763.3
Trade receivables	13.)	2,039.9	2,282.5
Other receivables	14.)	237.2	222.9
Other financial assets	15.)	13.2	20.7
Current tax assets		143.0	174.0
Inventories	16.)	1,351.0	1,518.4
		4,582.2	4,981.8
Non-current assets held for sale	17.)	8.2	107.1
		4,590.4	5,088.9
Non-current assets			
Property, plant and equipment	18.)	1,641.2	1,695.1
Intangible assets	19.)	3,666.4	4,044.8
Right-of-use assets	20.)	510.1	596.2
Equity-accounted investments	21.)	5.3	5.0
Other receivables	14.)	58.2	67.5
Other financial assets	15.)	17.5	21.3
Deferred tax assets	10.)	136.7	149.2
		6,035.4	6,579.1
Total assets		10,625.8	11,668.0

CONSOLIDATED BALANCE SHEET

Liabilities and equity

in EUR m	Note	Dec. 31, 2025	Dec. 31, 2024
Current liabilities			
Trade payables	22.)	1,498.3	1,661.6
Financial liabilities	23.)	139.6	812.5
Lease liabilities	20.)	121.2	136.9
Other liabilities	24.)	493.8	567.4
Other provisions	25.)	89.0	94.8
Liabilities relating to acquisition of non-controlling interests	27.)	19.1	–
Current tax liabilities		98.5	120.7
		2,459.5	3,393.9
Liabilities associated with assets held for sale	17.)	–	84.3
		2,459.5	3,478.2
Non-current liabilities			
Financial liabilities	23.)	2,644.8	2,126.5
Lease liabilities	20.)	420.2	480.4
Other liabilities	24.)	2.3	2.3
Other provisions	25.)	244.7	260.2
Provisions for pensions and other post-employment benefits	26.)	124.3	135.1
Liabilities relating to acquisition of non-controlling interests	27.)	23.3	64.5
Deferred tax liabilities	10.)	358.1	358.8
		3,817.7	3,427.8
Equity	28.)		
Subscribed capital		144.4	144.4
Additional paid-in capital		755.2	755.2
Retained earnings		3,645.0	3,675.8
Accumulated other comprehensive income		–230.5	151.3
Equity attributable to shareholders of Brenntag SE		4,314.1	4,726.7
Equity attributable to non-controlling interests		34.5	35.3
		4,348.6	4,762.0
Total liabilities and equity		10,625.8	11,668.0

3.03 Consolidated balance sheet

CONSOLIDATED STATEMENT
OF CHANGES IN EQUITY

Consolidated statement of changes in equity

in EUR m	Subscribed capital	Additional paid-in capital	Retained earnings	Exchange rate differ- ences	Net invest- ment hedge reserve
Dec. 31, 2023	147.5	1,002.2	3,419.0	-15.5	1.7
Dividends	-	-	-303.2	-	-
Business combinations	-	-	-	-	-
Transactions with owners	-	-	21.8	-1.3	-
Treasury shares canceled / acquired	-3.1	-247.0	-	-	-
Profit after tax	-	-	536.2	-	-
Other comprehensive income, net of tax	-	-	2.0	162.4	-4.9
Total comprehensive income for the period	-	-	538.2	162.4	-4.9
Dec. 31, 2024	144.4	755.2	3,675.8	145.6	-3.2
Dividends	-	-	-303.2	-	-
Reclassification to profit or loss	-	-	-	8.1	-
Profit after tax	-	-	264.6	-	-
Other comprehensive income, net of tax	-	-	7.8	-378.3	1.8
Total comprehensive income for the period	-	-	272.4	-378.3	1.8
Dec. 31, 2025	144.4	755.2	3,645.0	-224.6	-1.4

CONSOLIDATED STATEMENT
OF CHANGES IN EQUITY

in EUR m	Cash flow hedge reserve	Treasury shares	Deferred tax relating to cash flow hedge reserve	Equity attributable to share- holders of Brenntag SE	Equity attributable to non- controlling interests	Equity
Dec. 31, 2023	-0.2	-250.0	-	4,304.7	52.0	4,356.7
Dividends	-	-	-	-303.2	-1.8	-305.0
Business combinations	-	-	-	-	-2.4	-2.4
Transactions with owners	-	-	-	20.5	-20.5	-
Treasury shares canceled/acquired	-	250.0	-	-0.1	-	-0.1
Profit after tax	-	-	-	536.2	7.5	543.7
Other comprehensive income, net of tax	12.2	-	-3.1	168.6	0.5	169.1
Total comprehensive income for the period	12.2	-	-3.1	704.8	8.0	712.8
Dec. 31, 2024	12.0	-	-3.1	4,726.7	35.3	4,762.0
Dividends	-	-	-	-303.2	-1.9	-305.1
Reclassification to profit or loss	-	-	-	8.1	-	8.1
Profit after tax	-	-	-	264.6	5.1	269.7
Other comprehensive income, net of tax	-18.0	-	4.6	-382.1	-4.0	-386.1
Total comprehensive income for the period	-18.0	-	4.6	-117.5	1.1	-116.4
Dec. 31, 2025	-6.0	-	1.5	4,314.1	34.5	4,348.6

3.04 Consolidated statement of changes in equity

CONSOLIDATED CASH FLOW
STATEMENT

Consolidated cash flow statement

in EUR m	Note	2025	2024
	29.)		
Profit after tax		269.7	543.7
Loss on the net monetary position		8.1	4.2
Depreciation, amortization and impairment	18.) / 19.) / 20.)	589.3	444.1
Income tax expense	10.)	215.7	198.9
Income taxes paid		-174.7	-229.6
Net interest expense	6.)	138.0	133.7
Interest paid		-143.4	-118.0
(of which interest paid for leases)	20.)	(-26.2)	(-23.4)
Interest received		14.6	18.8
Dividends received		0.7	1.0
Inventories		76.2	-78.4
Trade receivables		110.4	76.9
Trade payables		-65.0	-44.3
Changes in working capital		121.6	-45.8
Changes in other operating assets and liabilities		-77.7	-33.4
Changes in provisions		-4.9	-29.5
Non-cash change in liabilities relating to acquisition of non-controlling interests	7.)	-13.3	14.0
Other non-cash items and reclassifications		23.0	4.5
Net cash provided by operating activities		966.7	906.6
Proceeds from the disposal of consolidated subsidiaries and other business units		19.5	-
Proceeds from the disposal of other financial assets		1.4	0.4
Proceeds from the disposal of intangible assets and property, plant and equipment		17.6	29.2
Payments to acquire consolidated subsidiaries and other business units	29.)	-155.2	-436.1
Payments to acquire other financial assets		-0.5	-0.3
Payments to acquire intangible assets and property, plant and equipment		-293.0	-342.2
Net cash used in investing activities		-410.2	-749.0
Payments to acquire treasury shares		-	-250.1
Payments to settle liabilities relating to acquisition of non-controlling interests		-	-76.1
Dividends paid to Brenntag shareholders		-303.2	-303.2
Dividends paid to non-controlling interests		-3.6	-4.1
Proceeds from borrowings	29.)	1,175.3	1,262.5
Repayments of lease liabilities		-149.1	-152.8
Repayments of borrowings		-1,208.5	-453.2
Net cash used in / provided by financing activities		-489.1	23.0
Change in cash and cash equivalents		67.4	180.6
Effect of exchange rate changes on cash and cash equivalents		-32.8	11.5
Reclassification into non-current assets held for sale		-	-5.7
Cash and cash equivalents at beginning of period	12.)	763.3	576.9
Cash and cash equivalents at end of period	12.)	797.9	763.3

3.05 Consolidated cash flow statement

Notes

General information

As one of the world's leading chemical distributors, Brenntag offers its customers and suppliers an extensive range of services, global supply chain management and a chemical distribution network in EMEA, North and Latin America as well as in Asia Pacific.

Brenntag SE has its registered office at Messeallee 11, 45131 Essen, Germany, and is entered in the commercial register at the Essen Local Court under commercial register number HRB 31943.

These consolidated financial statements of Brenntag SE were prepared by the Board of Management of Brenntag SE on March 5, 2026, authorized for publication and submitted to the Supervisory Board for approval at its meeting on March 10, 2026.

The consolidated financial statements of Brenntag SE are denominated in euros (EUR). Unless stated otherwise, the amounts are in millions of euros (EUR million). For arithmetic reasons, rounding differences of $\pm$ one unit after the decimal point (EUR, %, etc.) may occur.

Consolidation policies and methods

Standards applied

The consolidated financial statements have been prepared in accordance with IFRS® Accounting Standards, as adopted in the EU.

The IFRS Accounting Standards comprise the standards (International Financial Reporting Standards and International Accounting Standards) issued by the International Accounting Standards Board (IASB) and the IFRS® Interpretations by the IFRS Interpretations Committee (IFRS IC) and the former Standing Interpretations Committee (SIC).

The accounting policies applied comply with all the standards and interpretations existing and adopted by the EU as at December 31, 2025 whose application is mandatory. In addition, the German commercial law provisions to be applied in accordance with Section 315e, para. 1 of the German Commercial Code (HGB) were taken into account.

The following revised standard issued by the International Accounting Standards Board (IASB) has been applied by the Brenntag Group for the first time:

First-time adoption in 2025

■ Amendments to IAS 21: Lack of Exchangeability

The amendments to IAS 21 issued by the IASB specify whether a currency is exchangeable or not, and set out how an entity determines the exchange rate to be applied when a currency is not exchangeable. Moreover, IAS 21 is extended to include a provision requiring the disclosure of additional information when a currency is not exchangeable.

The aforementioned revised standard does not have a material impact on the presentation of the Group's net assets, financial position and results of operations.

First-time adoption in 2026

■ Amendments to IFRS 9 and IFRS 7: Classification and Measurement of Financial Instruments

The amendments clarify that a financial liability is generally derecognized on the settlement date. If the liability is settled using an electronic payment system, it may in certain circumstances be derecognized before the settlement date.

In addition, the application guidance on how an entity assesses the contractual cash flow characteristics criterion in determining the measurement categories of financial assets has been extended, and further disclosures have been introduced for financial instruments with contingent cash flows and equity instruments measured at fair value through other comprehensive income.

■ Amendments to IFRS 9 and IFRS 7: Contracts Referencing Nature-dependent Electricity

The changes affect the following:

Own use exemption: The exemption will be extended for contracts for the physical delivery of nature-dependent electricity, provided certain conditions are met, particularly in relation to sales of unused electricity.

NOTES

Hedge accounting: It will also be possible to include variable volumes of expected purchases and sales of nature-dependent electricity in the hedged item, provided certain conditions are met.

Disclosures: Extended disclosure requirements are provided for contracts within the scope of these amendments.

■ Annual Improvements to IFRSs Volume 11

The annual improvements to IFRSs contain a number of minor amendments to various standards that are intended to clarify the content of the standards and eliminate any existing inconsistencies.

First-time adoption in 2027

■ IFRS 18: Presentation and Disclosure in Financial Statements

IFRS 18 replaces IAS 1, the standard required to be applied thus far, and amends IAS 7. The objective in developing IFRS 18 was to improve the reporting on an entity's financial performance with a focus on the income statement. The main changes include the introduction of predefined subtotals (operating profit and profit before financing and income taxes) and the classification of income and expenses in the income statement (operating, investing and financing categories). In addition, in the notes to the financial statements, IFRS 18 will require an entity to disclose information about management-defined performance measures and provide reconciliations to the most directly comparable subtotal in accordance with IFRSs. IFRS 18 also sets out principles for aggregating and disaggregating items.

The amendments to IAS 7 that accompany IFRS 18 introduce operating profit as the mandatory starting point for the cash flow statement when cash flows from operating activities are presented using the indirect method.

■ IFRS 19: Subsidiaries without Public Accountability: Disclosures and Amendments to IFRS 19

IFRS 19 enables subsidiaries without public accountability to apply the full IFRSs, but with reduced disclosure requirements.

■ IAS 21: The Effects of Changes in Foreign Exchange Rates regarding translation to a hyperinflationary presentation currency

The amendments to IAS 21 require a non-hyperinflationary functional currency to be translated into a hyperinflationary presentation currency using the exchange rate at the end of the current reporting period. The standard amendments also contain additional disclosure requirements and rules on currency translation once an economy ceases to be hyperinflationary.

Brenntag is currently examining the effects of the amended standards on the presentation of the net assets, financial position and results of operations. Based on the current status of analysis, the application of IFRS 18 is expected to affect the structure of the consolidated income statement in particular, with the Group's comprehensive income remaining unchanged. No specified main business activities were identified within the Brenntag Group, as a result of which the IFRS 18 requirements in this regard will not be applied if circumstances remain unchanged at the date when IFRS 18 becomes effective.

IFRS 18 will also affect the consolidated cash flow statement. The newly introduced "operating profit" subtotal in the income statement will in future provide the starting point for calculating cash flows from operating activities under the indirect method, rather than the profit after tax subtotal used thus far. In addition, the removal of presentation alternatives will result in the following changes in the Brenntag Group's cash flow statement: Interest and dividends received will in future be presented within cash flows from investing activities, and interest paid within cash flows from financing activities. These items are currently presented within cash flows from operating activities.

The effects of the additional disclosure requirements for management-defined performance measures and the provisions governing the aggregation and disaggregation of information contained in the consolidated financial statements are also being examined.

From a present perspective, the standard amendments outlined further above do not have a material impact on the presentation of the Group's net assets, financial position and results of operations.

NOTES

Scope of consolidation

As at December 31, 2025, the consolidated financial statements include Brenntag SE and in addition 26 (Dec. 31, 2024: 25) domestic and 209 (Dec. 31, 2024: 216) foreign consolidated subsidiaries including structured entities.

The table below shows the changes in the number of consolidated companies including structured entities:

	Dec. 31, 2024	Additions	Disposals	Dec. 31, 2025
Domestic consolidated companies	26	1	-	27
Foreign consolidated companies	216	3	10	209
Total consolidated companies	242	4	10	236

3.06 Changes in scope of consolidation

The additions relate to entities acquired in business combinations under IFRS 3. The disposals are the result of mergers of companies no longer operating, liquidations and sales.

Four (Dec. 31, 2024: four) associates are accounted for using the equity method.

A full list of shareholdings for the Brenntag Group in accordance with Section 313, para. 2 of the German Commercial Code (HGB) can be found in the Annex to the Notes.

In the case of two (Dec. 31, 2024: two) subsidiaries where Brenntag does not hold the majority of the voting rights, it nevertheless exercises its power to direct the relevant activities. The structured entities individually listed in the list of shareholdings in accordance with Section 313, para. 2 of the German Commercial Code (HGB) are a leasing company and a sales company.

In financial year 2022, the Board of Management of Brenntag SE decided to halt the business operations of all Brenntag companies in Russia and Belarus until further notice due to the war in Ukraine. As at December 31, 2025, Brenntag still reported cash and cash equivalents of EUR 6.1 million in Russia (of which EUR 0.3 million in rubles and EUR 5.8 million in U.S. dollars) which were only available to Brenntag for cross-border transfers subject to the applicable restrictions on foreign exchange transactions. As at December 31, 2024, the cash and cash equivalents of the Brenntag companies in Russia amounted to EUR 7.3 million.

Business combinations in accordance with IFRS 3

In November 2025, Brenntag acquired 100% of the shares in Chem Tech Services, Inc., based in Levelland, Texas, U.S. The company provides professional oilfield chemical solutions in Texas and New Mexico. Chem Tech's expertise and network are intended to add to Brenntag's energy services business in North America and strengthen its market presence in the region, which is critical to global energy supply.

In addition, Brenntag made the following smaller acquisitions:

At the beginning of June, Brenntag acquired all shares in mcePharma a.s. headquartered in Bílovec, Czech Republic, and a subsidiary. The acquisition and additional investments in mcePharma's site will strengthen Brenntag's capabilities across the entire pharmaceutical and biopharmaceutical value chain.

At the end of June, all shares were acquired in Gefahrstoffzentrum (GSZ) Kaiserslautern GmbH, Kaiserslautern, Germany, thereby significantly expanding Brenntag's mixing and blending capacity in Germany.

NOTES

The purchase price, net assets and goodwill relating to these business combinations break down as follows:

in EUR m	Chem Tech	Other entities	Total
Purchase price	77.9	20.5	98.4
of which consideration contingent on earnings targets	-	-	-
Assets			
Cash and cash equivalents	2.1	-	2.1
Trade receivables, other financial assets and other receivables	10.2	1.5	11.7
Other current assets	7.1	1.3	8.4
Non-current assets	6.9	13.9	20.8
Liabilities			
Current liabilities	9.4	0.9	10.3
Non-current liabilities	4.1	10.3	14.4
Net assets	12.8	5.5	18.3
of which Brenntag's share	12.8	5.5	18.3
of which non-controlling interests	-	-	-
Goodwill	65.1	15.0	80.1
of which deductible for tax purposes	-	-	-

3.07 Net assets acquired in 2025

Assets acquired and liabilities assumed in business combinations are normally recognized at their fair value at the date of acquisition. The multi-period excess earnings method was used to measure customer relationships. In particular, the estimate of the useful lives of customer relationships can affect their fair value.

For reasons of time, measurement of the assets acquired and liabilities assumed (among others customer relationships and deferred taxes) of the entities acquired in financial year 2025 has not yet been completed. There are no material differences between the gross amount and the carrying amount

of the receivables. The main factors determining the goodwill are the above-mentioned reasons for the acquisitions where not included in other assets (e.g. customer relationships and similar rights).

Acquisition-related costs in the amount of EUR 1.8 million were recognized under other operating expenses.

Since their acquisition by Brenntag, the business units acquired in financial year 2025 have generated the following sales and the following loss after tax:

in EUR m	Chem Tech	Other entities	2025
Sales	7.0	4.4	11.4
Loss after tax	- 1.1	-1.1	-2.2

3.08 Sales and loss after tax of the businesses acquired since acquisition

If the above-mentioned business combinations had taken place with effect from January 1, 2025, sales of about EUR 15,250 million would have been reported for the Brenntag Group in the reporting period. Profit after tax would have been about EUR 269 million.

NOTES

Measurement of the assets and liabilities from the acquisition in financial year 2024 of the Solventis Group based in Antwerp, Belgium, and other locations in the UK has been completed.

The purchase price, net assets acquired and goodwill were adjusted as follows in the measurement period:

in EUR m	Provisional fair value	Adjustments	Final fair value
Purchase price	224.0	-	224.0
of which consideration contingent on earnings targets	-	-	-
Assets			
Cash and cash equivalents	37.1	-	37.1
Trade receivables, other financial assets and other receivables	36.2	-	36.2
Other current assets	37.1	3.0	40.1
Non-current assets	160.2	-6.7	153.5
Liabilities			
Current liabilities	31.9	-	31.9
Non-current liabilities	85.4	-1.5	83.9
Net assets	153.3	-2.2	151.1
of which Brenntag's share	153.3	-2.2	151.1
of which non-controlling interests	-	-	-
Goodwill	70.7	2.2	72.9
of which deductible for tax purposes	-	-	-

3.09 Net assets acquired in 2024: Solventis Group

Measurement of the assets and liabilities from the acquisition in financial year 2024 of Química Delta based in Teoloyucan, Mexico, has been completed.

The purchase price, net assets acquired and goodwill were adjusted as follows in the measurement period:

in EUR m	Provisional fair value	Adjustments	Final fair value
Purchase price	216.0	-	216.0
of which consideration contingent on earnings targets	-	-	-
Assets			
Cash and cash equivalents	33.7	-	33.7
Trade receivables, other financial assets and other receivables	72.7	-	72.7
Other current assets	24.6	2.2	26.8
Non-current assets	125.0	-14.9	110.1
Liabilities			
Current liabilities	56.0	-	56.0
Non-current liabilities	61.2	-5.2	56.0
Net assets	138.8	-7.5	131.3
of which Brenntag's share	138.8	-7.5	131.3
of which non-controlling interests	-	-	-
Goodwill	77.2	7.5	84.7
of which deductible for tax purposes	-	-	-

3.10 Net assets acquired in 2024: Química Delta

NOTES

Measurement of the assets and liabilities of the other entities and businesses acquired in financial year 2024 (Lawrence Industries Ltd. based in Tamworth, UK, site and business operations of Industrial Chemicals Corporation (ICC) in Denver, Colorado, U.S., Monarch Chemicals based in Sheerness, UK, and PIC Química e Farmacêutica Ltda. (PIC) and Pharma-

Special Especialidades Químicas e Farmacêuticas Ltda. (PharmaSpecial) in Brazil has also been completed.

The purchase price, net assets acquired and goodwill were adjusted as follows in the measurement period:

in EUR m	Provisional fair value	Adjustments	Final fair value
Purchase price	141.5	1.1	142.6
of which consideration contingent on earnings targets	0.6	-	0.6
Assets			
Cash and cash equivalents	8.6	-	8.6
Trade receivables, other financial assets and other receivables	19.5	-0.1	19.4
Other current assets	16.7	-	16.7
Non-current assets	81.3	-4.0	77.3
Liabilities			
Current liabilities	11.9	0.8	12.7
Non-current liabilities	15.9	-1.4	14.5
Net assets	98.3	-3.5	94.8
of which Brenntag's share	98.3	-3.5	94.8
of which non-controlling interests	-	-	-
Goodwill	43.2	4.6	47.8
of which deductible for tax purposes	8.3	1.1	9.4

3.11 Net assets acquired in 2024: Other business combinations

Goodwill from the business combinations carried out in financial years 2024 and 2025 changed as follows:

in EUR m	Solventis Group	Química Delta	Chem Tech	Other	Goodwill
Dec. 31, 2024	70.7	78.1	-	43.2	192.0
Exchange rate differences	-	-6.1	-0.6	0.1	-6.6
Business combinations in 2025	-	-	65.1	15.0	80.1
Adjustments in the measurement period	2.2	7.5	-	4.6	14.3
Impairment	-	-79.5	-	-	-
Dec. 31, 2025	72.9	-	64.5	62.9	279.8

3.12 Change in goodwill

Consolidation methods

The consolidated financial statements include the single-entity financial statements – prepared according to uniform accounting policies – of Brenntag SE and all entities controlled by Brenntag. This is the case when the following conditions are met:

- Brenntag has decision-making power over the relevant activities of the other entity.
- Brenntag has exposure, or rights, to variable returns from its involvement with the other entity.
- Brenntag has the ability to use its decision-making power over the relevant activities of the other entity to affect the amount of the variable returns of the other entity.

Control may be based on voting rights or arise from other contractual arrangements. Accordingly, the scope of consolidation includes, in addition to entities in which Brenntag SE directly or indirectly controls the majority of voting rights, structured entities which are controlled as a result of contractual arrangements.

Inclusion in the consolidated financial statements commences at the date on which control is obtained and ends when control is lost.

Acquisitions are accounted for using the acquisition method in accordance with IFRS 3. The cost of an acquired business unit is considered to be the fair value of the assets given. Acquisition-related costs are recognized as an expense. Contingent consideration is recognized as a liability at the acquisition-date fair value when determining the cost. If Brenntag gains control but does not acquire 100% of the shares, the corresponding non-controlling interest is recognized.

Identifiable assets, liabilities and contingent liabilities of an acquiree that are eligible for recognition are generally measured at their fair value at the transaction date, irrespective of the share of any non-controlling interests. Any remaining differences between cost and the share of the net assets acquired are recognized as goodwill.

In the event of an acquisition in stages which leads to control of a company being obtained, or in the event of a share sale involving a loss of control, the shares already held in the first case or the remaining shares in the second case are measured at fair value through profit or loss. Acquisitions or disposals of shares which have no effect on existing control are recognized in equity.

Receivables, liabilities, expenses, income and intercompany profits or losses within the Brenntag Group are eliminated.

Associates of the Brenntag Group where Brenntag has significant influence are accounted for using the equity method. Significant influence is generally considered to exist when Brenntag SE holds between 20% and 50% of the voting rights either directly or indirectly. The same consolidation policies apply to companies accounted for using the equity method as to consolidated companies, whereby recognized goodwill is contained in the carrying amount of investments accounted for using the equity method. Brenntag's share of the profit/loss after tax of the companies accounted for using the equity method is recognized in the income statement. The accounting policies of the companies accounted for using the equity method were, as far as necessary, adjusted in line with the accounting policies of Brenntag.

Currency translation

Foreign currency receivables and liabilities in the single-entity financial statements are stated on initial recognition at the spot exchange rate at the date of the transaction. At the reporting or settlement date, foreign currency receivables and liabilities are translated at the closing rate. The resulting differences are recognized in profit or loss.

The items contained in the financial statements of a Group company are measured on the basis of the currency of the relevant primary economic environment in which the company operates (functional currency). The presentation currency of the Brenntag Group is the euro.

The single-entity financial statements of the companies whose functional currency is not the euro are translated into euros as follows:

Assets and liabilities are translated at the closing rate, income and expense at the annual average rate. This notwithstanding, income and expense of Brenntag Kimya Ticaret Limited Sirketi are also translated at the closing rate due to the classification of Türkiye as a hyperinflationary economy. Any differences resulting from currency translation are recognized in other comprehensive income. Goodwill and fair value adjustments resulting from the acquisition of foreign companies are assigned to the foreign company and also translated at the closing rate.

For some companies in Latin America and in the Asia Pacific region, the functional currency is the U.S. dollar and not the local currency. Non-monetary items, primarily property, plant and equipment, goodwill and other intangible assets as well as environmental provisions, are translated from the local

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currency into U.S. dollars using the exchange rate at the transaction date. Monetary items are translated at the closing rate. All income and expenses are translated at the average exchange rate for the reporting period with the exception of depreciation and amortization, impairment losses and reversals of impairment losses as well as income and expenses incurred in connection with environmental provisions. These are translated at the same exchange rates as the underlying assets and liabilities. The resulting foreign currency differences are recognized in profit or loss. After translation of the items in the single-entity financial statements into the func-

tional currency, the U.S. dollar, the same method is used for translation from U.S. dollars into the Group currency, the euro, as for companies whose functional currency is the local currency.

The single-entity financial statements of foreign companies accounted for using the equity method are translated using the same principles.

The euro exchange rates of major currencies changed as follows:

	Closing rate		Average rate	
	Dec. 31, 2025	Dec. 31, 2024	2025	2024
EUR 1 = currencies				
Brazilian real (BRL)	6.4364	6.4253	6.3072	5.8283
Canadian dollar (CAD)	1.6088	1.4948	1.5787	1.4821
Swiss franc (CHF)	0.9314	0.9412	0.9370	0.9526
Chinese yuan renminbi (CNY)	8.2262	7.5833	8.1185	7.7875
Danish krone (DKK)	7.4689	7.4578	7.4634	7.4589
Pound sterling (GBP)	0.8726	0.8292	0.8568	0.8466
Polish zloty (PLN)	4.2210	4.2750	4.2397	4.3058
Russian ruble (RUB)	92.7118	113.8116	94.3867	100.3354
Swedish krona (SEK)	10.8215	11.4590	11.0663	11.4325
Turkish lira (TRY)	50.4838	36.7372	44.8161	35.5734
U.S. dollar (USD)	1.1750	1.0389	1.1300	1.0824

3.13 Exchange rates of major currencies

Accounting and measurement policies

Revenue recognition

Revenue from contracts with customers is recognized using a five-step model in accordance with IFRS 15:

1. Identify the contract(s) with a customer
2. Identify the separate performance obligations
3. Determine the transaction price
4. Allocate the transaction price to the separate performance obligations
5. Recognize revenue when (or as) the entity satisfies a performance obligation.

Revenue is recognized in the amount of consideration to which Brenntag expects to be entitled in exchange for goods or services. Variable consideration, such as cash discounts, discounts and rebates, is estimated and taken into account when determining the transaction price.

Revenue from the sale of goods or services is recognized when control of the goods or services transfers to the customer. Control transfers when the customer obtains control of the agreed goods or services and can obtain benefits from them. In a sale of goods, control usually transfers when the goods are collected by the customer or dispatched by Brenntag or a third party. In this case, revenue is recognized at a point in time. Revenue from services is recognized over time.

There are currently no significant financing components in the Brenntag Group. Payment terms are negotiated locally and reflect standard market practice. As there are no long-term performance obligations, the amount and timing of allocated transaction prices are not required to be disclosed for performance obligations that are unsatisfied as of the reporting date (practical expedient in IFRS 15.121).

Interest income is recognized as the interest accrues using the effective interest method.

Dividend income is recognized when the right to receive payment is established.

Cash and cash equivalents

Cash and cash equivalents include cash on hand, cheques and deposits held with banks with an original term of three months or less. They are measured at amortized cost.

Trade receivables, other receivables and other financial assets

Trade receivables that do not contain a significant financing component are initially recognized at the transaction price in accordance with IFRS 15. All other financial assets are measured on initial recognition at fair value (if applicable, including transaction costs). Fair value is defined as the price that would be received to sell an asset or paid to transfer a liability in an orderly transaction between market participants at the measurement date.

For the purpose of subsequent measurement, financial assets are classified into one of three categories, depending on the business model for managing the financial assets and the contractual cash flow characteristics:

- Measured at amortized cost: Assets held in order to collect contractual cash flows, where those cash flows are solely payments of principal and interest
- Measured at fair value through other comprehensive income: Assets held in order to collect contractual cash flows and sell the assets, where those cash flows are solely payments of principal and interest
- Measured at fair value through profit or loss: Assets that do not meet the criteria of the two aforementioned categories

Trade receivables, other receivables and receivables included in other financial assets are measured at amortized cost. There are no financial instruments measured at fair value through other comprehensive income. Securities and shares in entities where Brenntag does not have at least significant influence are measured at fair value through profit or loss, as are derivative financial instruments.

For fair value measurement, IFRS 13 provides a three-level hierarchy that reflects the extent to which the inputs used to determine fair value are market-based:

- Level 1: Fair value determined using quoted or market prices in an active market
- Level 2: Fair value determined using quoted or market prices in an active market for similar financial assets or liabilities, or other measurement methods for which significant inputs used are based on observable market data
- Level 3: Fair value determined using measurement methods for which significant inputs used are not based on observable market data.

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Trade receivables are subsequently measured using provision matrices under the simplified impairment model. Based on historical credit losses and forward-looking estimates, the country-specific valuation allowances expected over the lifetime of the trade receivables are determined for receivables in the same credit risk class (e.g. customer industries) (stage 2 of the impairment model). In this context, credit risk is assessed primarily on the basis of the extent to which the receivables are past due.

For other receivables and financial assets subsequently measured at amortized cost, the lifetime expected losses resulting from default events within the next twelve months are recognized in profit or loss on initial recognition and subsequent measurement (stage 1 of the impairment model). In the event of a significant increase in credit risk, the total losses expected over the lifetime of the assets are reflected (stage 2 of the impairment model).

If there is objective evidence that trade receivables or other financial assets measured at amortized cost should be considered impaired, e.g. because they are more than 180 days past due or because insolvency or similar proceedings are opened, a specific valuation allowance reflecting the credit risk in question is recognized in profit or loss. The valuation allowances are posted to an allowance account in the balance sheet. If a receivable is uncollectible, the gross amount and the valuation allowance are both derecognized. Uncollectibility is determined on a case-by-case basis, based on appropriate indicators.

A regular way purchase or sale of non-derivative financial assets is recognized at the settlement date. Derivative financial instruments are recognized in the balance sheet when Brenntag becomes a party to the contractual provisions of that instrument.

Financial assets are derecognized if the contractual rights to the cash flows from the financial asset have expired or Brenntag has transferred substantially all the risks and rewards of ownership of the financial asset.

Inventories

Inventories mainly comprise merchandise. They are initially recognized at cost. Production costs for the inventories produced through further processing are also capitalized.

Inventories are subsequently measured in accordance with IAS 2 at the lower of cost (on the basis of the average cost formula) and net realizable value. Net realizable value is the estimated selling price in the ordinary course of business less the estimated costs of completion and the estimated costs necessary to make the sale. Net realizable value also reflects effects of obsolescence or reduced marketability. Earlier valuation allowances on inventories are reversed if the net realizable value of the inventories increases again.

Property, plant and equipment

Property, plant and equipment is carried at cost of acquisition or construction and, except for land, depreciated over its estimated useful life on a straight-line basis. If major components of an item of property, plant and equipment have different useful lives, these components are accounted for separately and depreciated over their respective useful lives.

Acquisition costs include all expenditure directly attributable to the acquisition.

In accordance with IAS 16, future costs for any restoration obligation are recognized as an increase in the cost of acquisition or construction of the respective asset and a corresponding provision is established at the time of acquisition or construction of the item of property, plant and equipment.

In accordance with IAS 20, government grants and assistance for investments are deducted from the related asset.

The charges on property, plant and equipment include both depreciation charges and impairment losses.

When items of property, plant and equipment are sold, the difference between the net proceeds and the carrying amount of the respective asset is recognized as a gain or loss in other operating income or expenses.

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Assets are depreciated over the following useful lives:

	Useful life
Land rights	40 to 50 years
Buildings	15 to 50 years
Installations and building improvements	8 to 20 years
Technical equipment and machinery	3 to 20 years
Vehicles	5 to 8 years
Other equipment, operating and office equipment	2 to 10 years

3.14 Useful lives of property, plant and equipment

Intangible assets

Intangible assets include customer relationships and similar rights purchased, the “Brenntag” trademark, other trademarks, software, concessions and similar rights as well as goodwill from the acquisition of consolidated subsidiaries.

Intangible assets acquired through business combinations are measured on initial recognition at their acquisition-date fair value.

Separately acquired intangible assets are carried at cost.

Acquired software licenses are recognized at cost plus directly attributable costs incurred to acquire and bring to use the specific software.

For the purposes of accounting for cloud computing arrangements, the individual contract components, such as the software used in the context of such arrangements, are assessed separately. Software applications provided by cloud service providers are assessed as to whether they are an intangible asset under IAS 38. This assessment considers the following aspects among others:

- hosting is performed by an independent third party engaged by the user,
- the user has substantive rights to download the software and run it locally on its own hardware or on that of a third-party provider, and
- the user has an exclusive right to use the software or owns the intellectual property in the software.

The accounting for implementation costs arising in cloud computing arrangements follows the accounting for the related software component. If the related software component is an intangible asset under IAS 38, the criteria for recognizing acquisition-related costs as part of the cost of an intangible asset apply. If, on the other hand, the software component is a service contract, the implementation costs are accounted for based on the IFRS IC’s 2021 agenda decision “Configuration or Customization Costs in a Cloud Computing Arrangement”.

In addition to goodwill, the “Brenntag” trademark also has an indefinite useful life as, based on an analysis of all of the relevant factors, there is no foreseeable limit to the period over which the asset is expected to generate net cash inflows for the entity. The other intangible assets are amortized on a straight-line basis over their estimated useful lives. The following useful lives are assumed:

	Useful life
Concessions, industrial and similar rights as well as software and trademarks with definite useful lives	3 to 10 years
Customer relationships and similar rights	3 to 15 years

3.15 Useful lives of intangible assets

The charges on intangible assets include both amortization charges and impairment losses.

Leases

The leases at Brenntag relate mainly to land and buildings (warehouse and office space), vehicles and other plant and equipment. Leases are entered into for fixed terms of more than one year to 70 years in limited cases, but may also contain extension options.

For leases where Brenntag is lessee, a lease liability is generally recognized along with a corresponding right-of-use asset, if applicable taking into account any further cost components. This excludes short-term leases with a term of one year or less and leases of low-value and intangible assets, for which expenditure is recognized as an expense over the term.

On initial recognition, the lease liability is measured at the present value of the lease payments not yet paid at that date, discounted using the interest rate implicit in the lease. If that rate cannot be readily determined, Brenntag uses the incremental borrowing rate. The incremental borrowing rates were determined on the basis of a base rate plus a risk premium. The base rates in major currencies and countries were derived from interest rate swaps (if available) or government bond yields for a period of up to twenty years. For countries or currencies for which there were no reliable data available on which to base the determination, the euro base rate was adjusted to reflect a country risk premium.

Lease payments are not separated into payments for lease components and payments for non-lease components (e.g. payments for maintenance or servicing costs).

In subsequent periods, the right-of-use asset is generally depreciated on a straight-line basis. The lease liability is adjusted using the effective interest method.

Impairment testing of non-current non-financial assets

In accordance with IAS 36, non-current non-financial assets (property, plant and equipment, intangible assets and right-of-use assets) are tested for impairment whenever there is an objective indication that the carrying amount may not be recoverable.

Intangible assets that have an indefinite useful life and are, therefore, not subject to amortization are also tested for impairment at least annually.

Impairment exists when the carrying amount of an asset exceeds the estimated recoverable amount. Recoverable amount is the higher of fair value less costs of disposal and value in use. Value in use is the present value of the future cash flows expected to be derived from an asset. If the carrying amount is higher than the recoverable amount, the asset is written down to the recoverable amount.

If the recoverable amount of an individual asset cannot be determined, the recoverable amount of the cash-generating unit (CGU) or group of cash-generating units to which this asset belongs is determined and compared with the carrying amount of the CGU or group of CGUs.

Impairments, except for impairments of goodwill, are reversed as soon as the reasons for the impairment no longer exist.

Goodwill is tested for impairment annually, after completion of the annual budget process as at December 31, or upon the occurrence of a triggering event. The test compares the carrying amount of the relevant group of CGUs with its recoverable amount.

If the carrying amount of a group of CGUs exceeds the recoverable amount, an impairment exists in the amount of the difference. In this case, the goodwill of the relevant group of CGUs would first be written down. Any remaining impairment would be allocated to the assets of the group of CGUs in proportion to the net carrying amounts of the assets at the reporting date. The carrying amount of an individual asset must not be less than the highest of fair value less costs of disposal, value in use (in each case in as far as they can be determined) and zero.

Other provisions

In accordance with IAS 37, other provisions are recognized when the Group has a present legal or constructive obligation towards third parties as a result of past events, it is more likely than not that an outflow of resources will be required to settle the obligation, and the amount can be reliably estimated.

Non-current provisions are recognized at the present value of the expected outflow and their discounting is unwound over the period until their expected utilization. For provisions for long-service anniversary bonuses and pre-retirement part-time working arrangements, this is carried out bearing in mind actuarial principles or by obtaining external appraisals.

If the amount of an obligation declines as a result of a change in an estimate, the provision is reversed by the corresponding amount. Reversals of provisions for personnel expenses are recognized in personnel expenses. Provisions recognized as other operating expenses are reversed as other operating income.

Provisions are recognized for share-based payments in accordance with IFRS 2. The long-term incentive programs and the expiring long-term, virtual share-based remuneration program for the members of the Board of Management and the Long-Term Incentive Plans for executives and senior managers are classified as cash-settled share-based payments. Provisions are established for the resulting obligations. The obligations are measured at fair value. They are recognized as personnel expenses over the vesting period during which the beneficiaries acquire a vested right (unconditional right). The fair value is remeasured at each reporting date and at the settlement date.

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Provisions for pensions and other post-employment benefits

The Group's pension obligations comprise both defined contribution and defined benefit pension plans.

The contributions to be paid into defined contribution pension plans are recognized directly as expense. Provisions for pension obligations are not established as, in these cases, Brenntag has no additional obligation apart from the obligation to pay the premiums.

In accordance with IAS 19, provisions are established for defined benefit plans, unless the plans are multi-employer pension funds for which insufficient information is available. The obligations arising from these defined benefit plans are determined using the projected unit credit method, under which the expected benefits to be paid after retirement are determined taking dynamic measurement inputs into account and spread over the entire length of service of the employees participating in the plan. For this purpose, an

actuarial valuation is obtained every year. The actuarial assumptions for the discount rate, salary increase rate, pension trend, life expectancy and cost increases for medical care used to calculate the defined benefit obligation are established on the basis of the respective economic circumstances. The plan assets measured at fair value are deducted from the present value of the defined benefit obligation (gross pension obligation). Plan assets are assets where the claim to said assets has, in principle, been assigned to the beneficiaries. This results in the net liability required to be recognized or the net asset required to be recognized.

The discount rate is determined by reference to market yields at the end of the reporting period on fixed-rate senior corporate bonds. The currency and term of the corporate bonds taken as a basis are consistent with the currency and estimated term of the post-employment benefit obligations.

Life expectancy is determined using the latest mortality tables. Pension costs are made up of three components:

Component	Constituents	Recognized in
Service cost	– Current service cost – Past service cost incl. gains and losses from plan curtailments – Gains and losses from plan settlements	Personnel expenses
Net interest expense	– Unwinding of discounting of defined pension obligation (DBO) – Interest income from plan assets	Interest expense
Remeasurements	– Actuarial gains and losses on DBO from experience adjustments and from changes in measurement inputs – Changes in value of plan assets not already contained in net interest expense	Other comprehensive income, net of tax

3.16 Pension cost components

As a result of the recognition of the remeasurement components in other comprehensive income, the balance sheet shows the full extent of the net obligation avoiding volatility in profit or loss that may result in particular from changes in the measurement inputs.

Multi-employer defined benefit plans are treated as defined contribution plans when insufficient information is available.

Trade payables, financial liabilities and other liabilities

Trade payables, financial liabilities (excluding derivative financial instruments and contingent purchase prices payable in business combinations) and other liabilities are classified as at amortized cost. They are initially recognized at their fair value net of transaction costs incurred and subsequently carried at amortized cost using the effective interest method.

Derivative financial instruments and contingent purchase prices payable in business combinations are initially recognized at fair value and subsequently measured at fair value through profit or loss.

Liabilities relating to acquisition of non-controlling interests

Liabilities relating to the acquisition of non-controlling interests include forwards and combined call/put options relating to the acquisition of non-controlling interests as well as liabilities arising from limited partners' rights to repayment of contributions.

On initial recognition, forwards, symmetric call/put options, written put options and liabilities arising from limited partners' rights to repayment of contributions are recognized outside profit or loss as a synthetic liability at the present value of the settlement amount. Until the forwards and options are exercised, non-controlling interests are presented in consolidated equity. These items are subsequently measured at amortized cost. Unwinding of discounting and changes in estimates are recognized in profit or loss. Liabilities arising from limited partners' rights to repayment of contributions are recognized in profit or loss at amortized cost, in the amount of the expected right to repayment of contributions.

Exchange rate effects are recognized in profit or loss or, in the case of net investment hedges, directly in equity.

Call options without a symmetric put option are initially recognized at fair value outside profit or loss and subsequently measured at fair value through profit or loss.

Deferred taxes and current income taxes

Current income taxes for current and prior periods are recognized at the amount expected to be paid to or recovered from the taxation authorities.

Deferred taxes are determined in accordance with IAS 12 (Income Taxes). They arise from temporary differences between the carrying amounts of assets and liabilities in the IFRS balance sheet and their tax base, from consolidation adjustments and from tax loss carryforwards that are expected to be utilized.

Deferred tax assets are recognized to the extent that there are sufficient taxable differences available for utilization and it is likely that future taxable profit will be available against which the temporary differences and unutilized loss carryforwards can be utilized.

No deferred taxes are recognized for the difference between the net assets and the tax base of subsidiaries (outside basis differences) provided Brenntag is able to control the timing of the reversal of the temporary difference and it is unlikely that the temporary difference will reverse in the foreseeable future.

Deferred taxes for domestic companies are calculated on the basis of the combined income tax rate of the German consolidated tax group of Brenntag SE of 27% to 32% (2024: 32%) for corporate income tax, solidarity surcharge and trade income tax, and for foreign companies, at local tax rates. These are tax rates which can be expected to apply on the basis of laws in the different countries that have been enacted or substantially enacted at the reporting date.

Deferred tax assets and liabilities are netted against each other if they relate to the same taxation authority, the company has a legally enforceable right to set them off against each other and they mature in the same period.

Through the Act on an Immediate Tax Investment Program to Enhance Germany's Attractiveness as a Business Location, Germany resolved to gradually lower the corporate income tax rate as of the 2028 assessment period. The rate will fall by one percentage point a year, from 15% to 10% in 2032. In measuring deferred taxes as at the reporting date, the future tax rate was taken into account, bearing in mind the expected timing of the reversal of the temporary differences. This remeasurement resulted in deferred tax income of EUR 4.0 million.

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Brenntag falls within the scope of the OECD's Pillar Two model rules. As the Pillar Two legislation became applicable on January 1, 2024, the Group will be exposed to a higher tax liability under Pillar Two. The legislation requires the Group to pay a top-up tax per country in the amount of the difference between the GloBE effective tax rate and the minimum tax rate of 15%. The OECD model rules provide for simplifications (safe harbors) to enable compliance with Pillar Two. Brenntag has made use of the safe harbors where relevant.

Taking into account the safe harbors, Brenntag concludes that only a very small number of countries fall below the average effective tax rate of 15% based on the IFRS results.

Additional tax of EUR 0.4 million for the countries identified was included in the consolidated financial statements in the form of a provision. The Group has applied the temporary exception issued by the IASB in May 2023 to the accounting requirements for deferred taxes in IAS 12. Accordingly, the Group neither recognizes nor discloses information about deferred tax assets and liabilities related to Pillar Two income taxes.

The final Pillar Two tax liability will only be fully determined upon submission of the respective GloBE Information Return (GIR) for the relevant assessment year. The GIR for 2024 must be submitted to the Federal Central Tax Office by June 30, 2026, and the GIR for the year 2025 by March 31, 2027. The total tax liability for both years is approximately EUR 0.7 million.

Subscribed capital

The subscribed capital is carried at its nominal value.

Assumptions and estimates

Preparation of the consolidated financial statements requires the use of assumptions and estimates which may affect the amount and presentation of assets and liabilities and income and expenses. These assumptions and estimates mainly relate to the following:

- the calculation and discounting of cash flows when impairment tests are performed;
- probability of occurrence, interest rates and other measurement inputs used to measure provisions, particularly for environmental risks and defined benefit pension obligations;
- the amount of liabilities relating to the acquisition of non-controlling interests and the determination of interest rates;
- the assessment of whether purchase and extension options will be exercised when accounting for right-of-use assets in accordance with IFRS 16 (Leases);
- assumptions as to the realization of future tax benefits from tax loss carryforwards and to the useful lives of intangible assets and property, plant and equipment;
- measurement of deferred taxes due to the gradual reduction in the corporate income tax rate in Germany. The future dates at which temporary differences will reverse span multiple financial years and must be allocated to the respective, period-specific tax rates. Any differences between the expected and the actual timing of reversal may affect the amount of deferred tax items.
- Deferred tax liabilities have been recognized for outside basis differences that are expected to reverse through distributions, applying the relevant withholding tax rates. The underlying assumptions regarding the Group's distribution policy and future tax environment involve judgement and are subject to estimation uncertainty. No deferred taxes have been recognized for outside basis differences relating to potential disposals, as no such disposals are planned.

The global economic environment is affected by continuing and widening geopolitical tensions in various regions around the globe – including Eastern Europe, Northeast Asia and the Middle East – and by increasing protectionist measures on the part of individual countries. The possible effects of these developments on the Brenntag Group's main sales markets cannot be fully predicted at the present time and result in a heightened degree of uncertainty over growth expectations for the global economy. This uncertainty is affecting the assessment of future cash flow performance and may affect the recognition and measurement of assets and liabilities. This applies especially to impairment testing of intangible assets with an indefinite useful life, including goodwill.

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The following tables present the amount of additional impairment that would have arisen from an adverse change in the key assumptions in the groups of CGUs:

in EUR m	Free cash flow -10%	Growth rate -20%	WACC +1.0 pc point
Essentials Latin America	-1.4	-17.4	-7.6
Essentials APAC	-26.7	-62.6	-39.9
Specialties Beauty & Care	-	-	-9.1
Other groups of CGUs	-	-	-

3.17 Sensitivity analysis by group of CGUs / 2025

in EUR m	Free cash flow -10%	Growth rate -20%	WACC +1.0 pc point
Essentials Latin America	-28.0	-8.6	-26.8
Other groups of CGUs	-	-	-

3.18 Sensitivity analysis by group of CGUs / 2024

If the discount rates used to determine the environmental provisions had been one percentage point higher or lower and all other conditions had remained the same, the provision would have decreased by EUR 4.8 million (Dec. 31, 2024: EUR 5.8 million) or increased by EUR 5.3 million (Dec. 31, 2024: EUR 6.6 million), respectively.

Sensitivity analyses of defined benefit pension obligations are described in the section "Provisions for pensions and other post-employment benefits".

Due to purchase prices being contingent on earnings, liabilities relating to the acquisition of non-controlling interests are subject to estimation uncertainty over the amount of the purchase prices payable.

In the case of right-of-use assets under IFRS 16 (Leases), purchase and extension options are recognized if they are reasonably certain to be exercised. In this respect, the assessment is subject to a high degree of judgment. If circumstances change, the assessment of whether an option is reasonably certain to be exercised must be made anew.

When measuring deferred tax assets for tax loss carryforwards, the future taxable profit available is based on a planning horizon of five years. The useful lives of items of property, plant and equipment and intangible assets are shown in the sections "Property, plant and equipment" and "Intangible assets". The actual amounts may differ from the assumptions and estimates in individual cases. Adjustments are recognized when estimates are revised.

The global fight against climate change will lead not only to structural, regulatory and technological changes, but also to increased costs as a result of preventive technologies or government carbon taxes. Climate change mitigation plays a particularly important role within Brenntag's sustainability strategy, as the entire value chain is affected. Moreover, climate change mitigation is important to many of Brenntag's customers. The climate change mitigation targets cover Scope 1, Scope 2 and Scope 3 emissions. Both climate change and Brenntag's climate change mitigation actions could potentially impact on Brenntag's net assets, financial position and results of operations. In financial year 2025, no indications of impairment of non-current assets or of any material adjustments to their useful lives were identified. Likewise, no effects on existing or potential new environmental or restoration obligations were observed. Furthermore, no material changes to the underlying assumptions and estimates were identified.

Cash flow statement

The cash flow statement classifies cash flows by operating, investing and financing activities. The cash provided by operating activities is determined using the indirect method on the basis of the profit / loss after tax. Interest payments made and received, tax payments and dividends received are presented as components of cash provided by operating activities. The effects of acquisitions of consolidated subsidiaries and other business units as defined by IFRS 3 (Business Combinations) are eliminated from the individual items of the cash flow statement and combined under cash flow from investing activities. Under IFRS 16 (Leases), lease payments made are included in cash used in financing activities as repayments of borrowings and in cash provided by operating activities as interest paid. Payments under short-term leases or leases of low-value assets are a component of cash flow from operating activities. Cash and cash equivalents in the cash flow statement correspond to the cash and cash equivalents in the balance sheet. The effect of exchange rate changes on cash and cash equivalents is shown separately.

Hyperinflation

Since June 30, 2022, Türkiye has been required to be classified as a hyperinflationary economy in accordance with IAS 29 (Financial Reporting in Hyperinflationary Economies). This standard requires non-monetary assets and liabilities, the statement of comprehensive income and equity to be restated at the end of each reporting period by applying the price index applicable at the end of the reporting period. The balance of those adjustments is presented in profit or loss as a loss on the net monetary position. IAS 29 must be applied as if Türkiye had always been hyperinflationary. Brenntag used the consumer price index published by the Turkish Statistical Institute (Dec. 31, 2024: 2,685 index points; Dec. 31, 2025: 3,514 index points). All items are translated at the closing rate due to hyperinflation. Inflation resulted in a loss on the net monetary position of EUR 8.1 million for 2025 (2024: EUR 4.2 million).

NOTES

Segment reporting

The Brenntag Group is managed through two global divisions, Brenntag Specialties and Brenntag Essentials.

Brenntag Specialties is managed globally through the Life Science, Material Science and Specialties Other segments. The Life Science segment focuses on selling ingredients and value-added services in the global focus industries Nutrition, Pharma and Beauty & Care. The Material Science segment mainly encompasses business activities in the CASE (Coatings, Adhesives, Sealants, Elastomers), Construction, Polymers and Rubber industries. To a small extent, the Brenntag Specialties portfolio is also augmented by other business activities outside Life Science and Material Science.

Brenntag Essentials markets a broad portfolio of process chemicals across a wide range of industries and applications. The global Brenntag Essentials division comprises the reportable segments EMEA, North America, Latin America and APAC, plus the “Transregional” segment comprising the international operations of BRENNTAG International Chemicals GmbH (BIC), which buys and sells chemicals in bulk on an international scale.

“Group and Regional Services” mainly include the central functions for the entire Group, the regional service functions and the activities with regard to the digitalization of our business.

The following table shows the reconciliation of the global divisions to the Group:

Period from January 1 to December 31 in EUR m	Brenntag Specialties	Brenntag Essentials	Group and Regional Services	Group
External sales				
2025	4,801.2	10,370.3	-	15,171.5
2024	5,229.7	11,007.7	-	16,237.4
fx. adj. change in %	-5.5	-2.9	-	-3.7
Cost of materials				
2025	-3,702.9	-7,636.9	-	-11,339.8
2024	-4,056.5	-8,155.5	-	-12,212.0
fx. adj. change in %	-6.0	-3.4	-	-4.3
Operating gross profit				
2025	1,098.3	2,733.4	-	3,831.7
2024	1,173.2	2,852.2	-	4,025.4
fx. adj. change in %	-3.6	-1.2	-	-1.9
Depreciation and impairment of property, plant and equipment and right-of-use assets				
2025	-33.3	-314.7	-10.2	-358.2
2024	-33.6	-310.8	-10.5	-354.9
fx. adj. change in %	2.5	4.0	-1.0	3.7
Operating EBITA (segment result)				
2025	387.0	658.7	-116.4	929.3
2024	446.9	780.7	-125.7	1,101.9
fx. adj. change in %	-10.4	-13.4	-9.7	-12.6

3.19 Reconciliation of the global divisions to the Group 2025/2024

NOTES

The following table shows the segment information for the reportable segments of the global **Brenntag Specialties** division:

Period from January 1 to December 31 in EUR m	Life Science	Material Science	Specialties Other	Central activities ¹⁾	Brenntag Specialties
External sales					
2025	3,192.7	1,561.8	46.7	–	4,801.2
2024	3,482.9	1,687.9	58.9	–	5,229.7
fx. adj. change in %	–5.4	–5.2	–20.8	–	–5.5
Cost of materials					
2025	–2,416.9	–1,254.3	–31.7	–	–3,702.9
2024	–2,653.0	–1,362.5	–41.0	–	–4,056.5
fx. adj. change in %	–5.9	–5.6	–23.1	–	–6.0
Operating gross profit					
2025	775.8	307.5	15.0	–	1,098.3
2024	829.9	325.4	17.9	–	1,173.2
fx. adj. change in %	–3.5	–3.1	–15.7	–	–3.6
Depreciation and impairment of property, plant and equipment and right-of-use assets²⁾					
2025	–6.7	–4.8	–21.8	–	–33.3
2024	–4.6	–4.2	–24.8	–	–33.6
fx. adj. change in %	48.9	14.3	–8.4	–	2.5
Operating EBITA (segment result)^{3/4)}					
2025	293.8	99.2	–4.7	–1.3	387.0
2024	338.3	114.4	–1.7	–4.1	446.9
fx. adj. change in %	–9.8	–10.9	291.7	–68.3	–10.4

3.20 Segment reporting on the global Specialties division 2025/2024

¹⁾ Central activities which are part of Brenntag Specialties but not directly attributable to any one segment.

²⁾ Certain items of property, plant and equipment and right-of-use assets are not separable and support both divisions jointly. They have been allocated to a division (depending on the region) and are depreciated there. They are charged to the other division on the basis of fixed and variable monthly amounts.

³⁾ Segment operating EBITA is calculated as segment EBITA adjusted for holding charges and special items.

⁴⁾ The prior-year figures were adjusted to reflect the current portfolio allocation.

NOTES

The following table shows the segment information for the reportable segments of the global **Brenntag Essentials** division:

Period from January 1 to December 31 in EUR m	EMEA ¹⁾	North America	Latin America	APAC	Trans- regional	Central activities ²⁾	Brenntag Essentials
External sales							
2025	3,607.6	4,694.1	968.4	823.8	276.4	-	10,370.3
2024	3,741.2	5,162.6	763.4	1,005.5	335.0	-	11,007.7
fx. adj. change in %	-3.2	-4.9	33.6	-13.7	-17.5	-	-2.9
Cost of materials							
2025	-2,649.9	-3,250.5	-776.5	-694.7	-265.3	-	-7,636.9
2024	-2,746.5	-3,625.8	-596.8	-863.9	-322.5	-	-8,155.5
fx. adj. change in %	-3.7	-6.9	27.6	-11.9	-17.6	-	-3.4
Operating gross profit							
2025	957.7	1,443.6	191.9	129.1	11.1	-	2,733.4
2024	994.7	1,536.8	166.6	141.6	12.5	-	2,852.2
fx. adj. change in %	-3.5	-1.7	21.4	-4.3	-11.2	-	-1.2
Depreciation and impairment of property, plant and equipment and right-of-use assets³⁾							
2025	-121.6	-157.8	-21.0	-11.1	-3.1	-0.1	-314.7
2024	-123.7	-154.3	-19.1	-10.5	-3.2	-	-310.8
fx. adj. change in %	-1.5	6.9	15.4	7.8	-3.1	-	4.0
Operating EBITA (segment result)⁴⁾							
2025	225.1	393.8	26.7	12.2	5.3	-4.4	658.7
2024	276.5	469.3	14.1	17.3	6.4	-2.9	780.7
fx. adj. change in %	-19.3	-12.2	100.8	-26.1	-17.2	51.7	-13.4

3.21 Segment reporting on the global Essentials division 2025/2024

¹⁾ Europe, Middle East & Africa.

²⁾ Central activities which are part of Brenntag Essentials but not directly attributable to any one segment.

³⁾ Certain items of property, plant and equipment and right-of-use assets are not separable and support both divisions jointly. They have been allocated to a division (depending on the region) and are depreciated there. They are charged to the other division on the basis of fixed and variable monthly amounts.

⁴⁾ Segment operating EBITA is calculated as segment EBITA adjusted for holding charges and special items.

NOTES

The following table shows the reconciliation to profit before tax:

in EUR m	2025	2024
Operating EBITA (segment result)¹⁾	929.3	1,101.9
Net expense from special items	-106.5	-111.4
(of which expenses for strategy projects)	(-40.5)	(-49.7)
(of which expenses for legal risks)	(-32.2)	(-42.6)
(of which impairment losses)	(-26.6)	(-)
(of which loss on the disposal of Raj Petro)	(-11.3)	(-42.1)
(of which other special items)	(4.1)	(23.0)
EBITA	822.8	990.5
Amortization of intangible assets ²⁾	-62.5	-63.8
Impairment of intangible assets	-142.7	-11.3
EBIT	617.6	915.4
Net finance costs	-132.2	-172.8
Profit before tax	485.4	742.6

3.2.2 Reconciliation of operating EBITA to profit before tax

¹⁾ Operating EBITA of the reportable segments amounts to EUR 1,051.4 million (2024: EUR 1,227.6 million) and operating EBITA of the central activities of Brenntag Specialties and Brenntag Essentials, as well as Group and Regional Services to EUR -122.1 million (2024: EUR -125.7 million).

²⁾ This figure includes amortization of customer relationships in the amount of EUR 36.6 million (2024: EUR 37.8 million).

Special items are income and expenses outside ordinary activities that have a special and material effect on the results of operations.

Expenses for strategy projects amounted to EUR 40.5 million in financial year 2025. They mainly include severance and advisory expenses which will help to achieve the cost-reduction targets.

In financial year 2025, expenses of EUR 32.2 million were recognized for legal risks in connection with the sale of talc and similar products in North America.

Impairment losses of EUR 26.6 million were recognized in the reporting period. Of this total, property, plant and equipment at a site in the Brenntag Essentials APAC segment accounted for EUR 13.1 million due to the unfavorable earnings prospects expected in the region, partly in light of the ongoing geopolitical uncertainty between the U.S. and China and the related deterioration in the earnings outlook.

In addition, impairment losses of EUR 11.5 million were recognized on property, plant and equipment in the context of realigning the site network, and impairment losses of EUR 2.0 million on right-of-use assets from leases in connection with goodwill impairment at Brenntag Essentials Latin America.

The deconsolidation of Raj Petro resulted in a loss of EUR 11.3 million in financial year 2025.

Other special items amounted to EUR 4.1 million in financial year 2025. This includes insurance payouts in connection with the major fire at the warehouse site in Canada in 2023.

NOTES

Geographical information

Non-current assets comprise property, plant and equipment, right-of-use assets and intangible assets. Non-current assets are allocated to the different countries as follows:

	Property, plant and equipment		Right-of-use assets		Intangible assets ¹⁾	
in EUR m	Dec. 31, 2025	Dec. 31, 2024	Dec. 31, 2025	Dec. 31, 2024	Dec. 31, 2025	Dec. 31, 2024
Germany	102.4	105.5	36.4	50.8	36.5	31.9
U.S.	591.8	632.3	155.0	214.4	60.4	80.8
France	115.9	101.1	8.0	9.0	1.3	0.3
Canada	90.7	97.9	27.3	18.4	0.3	0.5
United Kingdom	85.7	86.7	38.7	42.8	45.6	102.4
Italy	79.0	73.0	23.2	28.0	0.1	0.1
Singapore	68.0	80.1	15.6	19.4	11.0	13.3
China	56.5	78.7	8.6	6.8	24.2	29.7
Spain	55.5	51.7	8.8	9.5	0.4	0.3
Poland	54.5	47.3	8.4	8.9	-	0.1
Belgium	30.9	31.4	57.6	61.2	46.2	1.7
Mexico	12.8	15.6	33.1	38.6	51.2	69.9
Others	297.5	293.8	89.4	88.4	17.2	30.3
Total	1,641.2	1,695.1	510.1	596.2	294.4	361.3

3.23 Non-current assets by country

¹⁾ Intangible assets excluding goodwill and "Brenntag" trademark.

The allocation of external sales to the different countries, based on the registered office of the respective entities, is shown in the following table:

	External sales	
in EUR m	2025	2024
Germany	1,078.7	1,198.3
U.S.	5,165.4	5,793.8
United Kingdom	822.9	825.6
China	675.0	736.8
Canada	584.8	633.8
Italy	579.2	593.8
Poland	521.8	550.6
France	501.1	522.8
Others	5,242.6	5,381.9
Total	15,171.5	16,237.4

3.24 External sales by country

NOTES

Consolidated income statement disclosures

1.) Sales

Sales of EUR 15,171.5 million (2024: EUR 16,237.4 million) are almost entirely attributable to contracts with customers as defined by IFRS 15. Sales of EUR 1.8 million (2024: EUR 1.8 million) were generated with related parties.

Sales of EUR 15,098.9 million (2024: EUR 16,158.4 million) relate to the sale of goods and sales of EUR 72.6 million (2024: EUR 79.2 million) to the provision of services.

Of the sales revenues from the sale of goods, EUR 14,914.6 million (2024: EUR 16,076.5 million) are attributable to warehousing or direct business. Of the other revenues from the sale of goods in the amount of EUR 184.3 million (2024: EUR 81.9 million), EUR 183.4 million (2024: EUR 81.0 million) relate to consignment business.

For a breakdown of sales by operating segment, please refer to the "Segment reporting" section of these notes to the consolidated financial statements.

Trade receivables reported in the amount of EUR 2,039.9 million (Dec. 31, 2024: EUR 2,282.5 million) are entirely attributable to contracts with customers. No contract assets are currently recognized in the Brenntag Group.

Liabilities from contracts with customers break down as follows:

in EUR m	Dec. 31, 2025	Dec. 31, 2024
Contract liabilities under credit notes	14.7	12.3
Refund liabilities	22.2	24.8
Prepayments received	10.0	7.0
Total	46.9	44.1

3.25 Current contract liabilities from contracts with customers

2.) Cost of materials

Cost of materials amounts to EUR 11,339.8 million (2024: EUR 12,210.9 million) and comprises the cost of purchased goods and services. It includes expenses in the amount of EUR 6.1 million (2024: EUR 0.6 million) from valuation allowances on inventories.

3.) Other operating income

in EUR m	2025	2024
Income from the reversal of liabilities and provisions no longer required	25.6	29.1
Income from compensation	14.5	15.0
Income from the disposal of property, plant and equipment	8.4	21.2
Income from other taxes	3.1	0.2
Income from divestments	0.8	5.3
Miscellaneous operating income	29.1	32.1
Total	81.5	102.9

3.26 Other operating income

4.) Personnel expenses

Personnel expenses amount to EUR 1,448.5 million in total (2024: EUR 1,446.4 million). This line item includes wages and salaries totaling EUR 1,129.7 million (2024: EUR 1,142.9 million), social security costs of EUR 184.1 million (2024: EUR 176.2 million) and pension costs of EUR 134.7 million (2024: EUR 127.3 million). Net interest expense from defined benefit plans is not included in personnel expenses but presented within net finance costs under interest expense.

The average number of employees breaks down as follows:

	2025	2024
Brenntag Specialties	3,515	3,539
Brenntag Essentials	11,695	12,072
Group and Regional Services	2,232	2,319
Total	17,442	17,930

3.27 Employees by division

As at December 31, 2025, the Brenntag Group had a workforce of 17,339 (Dec. 31, 2024: 18,122). Of this figure, 1,646 (Dec. 31, 2024: 1,685) were employed in Germany.

NOTES

5.) Other operating expenses

in EUR m	2025	2024
Carriage outwards	-332.4	-329.8
Property-related and other taxes	-50.5	-39.5
Maintenance and energy costs	-214.0	-220.8
Expenses for advisory, auditing and other services (including IT)	-214.2	-239.4
Lease expenses	-102.3	-98.3
Insurance expenses	-51.9	-50.4
Legal risks arising from the sale of talc	-32.2	-42.6
Miscellaneous operating expenses	-254.0	-301.1
Total	-1,251.5	-1,321.9

3.28 Other operating expenses

6.) Interest expense

in EUR m	2025	2024
Interest expense on liabilities to third parties	-111.2	-112.7
Expense from the fair value measurement of the cross-currency interest rate swap	-6.4	-7.3
Net interest expense on defined benefit pension plans	-4.4	-4.1
Interest expense on other provisions	-4.1	-4.0
Interest expense on leases	-26.5	-24.6
Total	-152.6	-152.7

3.29 Interest expense

7.) Change in liabilities relating to acquisition of non-controlling interests recognized in profit or loss

in EUR m	2025	2024
Change in call option and liabilities relating to acquisition of non-controlling interests recognized in profit or loss	14.6	-12.0
Change in liabilities recognized in profit or loss arising from limited partners' rights to repayment of contributions	-1.3	-2.0
Total	13.3	-14.0

3.30 Change in liabilities relating to acquisition of non-controlling interests recognized in profit or loss

For further information, please refer to Note 27.).

8.) Loss on the net monetary position

The inflation effect on non-monetary items, the statement of comprehensive income and equity resulted in a loss on the net monetary position of EUR 8.1 million for financial year 2025 (2024: EUR 4.2 million).

9.) Other net finance costs

in EUR m	2025	2024
Exchange rate loss on foreign currency receivables and liabilities	-21.7	-26.0
Exchange rate gain on foreign currency derivatives	20.4	10.5
Miscellaneous other net finance income/costs	0.8	-5.3
Total	-0.5	-20.8

3.31 Other net finance costs

NOTES

10.) Income tax expense

in EUR m	2025	2024
Current income taxes	-183.2	-220.7
(of which BEPS Pillar Two)	(1.9)	(-2.7)
Deferred taxes	-32.5	21.8
(of which for temporary differences)	(-14.2)	(-21.9)
(of which for tax loss carryforwards)	(-18.3)	(43.7)
Total	-215.7	-198.9

3.32 Income tax expense

The effective tax expense of EUR 215.7 million (2024: EUR 198.9 million) differs by EUR 60.4 million (2024: EUR -38.8 million) from the expected tax expense of EUR 155.3 million (2024: EUR 237.7 million). The expected tax expense results from applying Brenntag SE's tax rate of 32% (Dec. 31, 2024: 32%) to profit before tax.

The reasons for the difference between the expected and the effective tax expense are as follows:

in EUR m	2025	2024
Profit before tax	485.4	742.6
Expected income tax expense (32%, 2024: 32%)	-155.3	-237.7
Difference due to tax base (trade tax adjustments in Germany)	-4.1	-4.4
Effect of different tax rates arising on the inclusion of foreign and domestic subsidiaries	47.6	62.7
Changes in valuation allowances on deferred tax assets / losses for which deferred taxes are not recognized / utilization of loss carryforwards	-24.9	37.0
Changes in the tax rate and tax laws	4.0	0.3
Expenses not deductible for tax purposes	-26.8	-28.7
Impairment Latin America and Asia	-43.6	
Loss on the disposal of Raj Petro and Bangladesh	-3.4	-13.3
Tax-free income	2.6	1.5
Share of profit or loss of equity-accounted investments	-0.4	-0.6
Prior-period tax expense	-8.1	1.8
Deferred taxes for temporary differences from investments in subsidiaries	5.0	-6.6
Change in liabilities relating to acquisition of non-controlling interests recognized in profit or loss	2.7	-3.5
Effects of BEPS Pillar Two	1.9	-2.7
Withholding taxes	-9.9	-9.8
Other effects	-3.0	5.1
Effective tax expense	-215.7	-198.9

3.33 Tax expense reconciliation

NOTES

Deferred taxes result from the individual balance sheet items and other items as follows:

in EUR m	Dec. 31, 2025		Dec. 31, 2024	
	Deferred tax assets	Deferred tax liabilities	Deferred tax assets	Deferred tax liabilities
Current assets				
Financial assets	24.7	18.0	18.4	12.4
Inventories	21.3	1.8	23.8	1.0
Non-current assets				
Property, plant and equipment and right-of-use assets	4.9	243.5	7.8	262.6
Intangible assets	13.9	251.9	18.9	273.6
Financial assets	9.7	6.7	11.2	20.6
Current liabilities				
Other provisions	8.4	1.3	16.6	1.1
Liabilities	102.3	12.1	89.3	6.4
Non-current liabilities				
Provisions for pensions	13.5	8.0	16.9	7.2
Other provisions	16.8	2.2	14.7	2.4
Liabilities	93.7	10.0	127.0	5.9
Local tax reserves	-	6.0	-	5.7
Loss carryforwards	40.9	-	58.6	-
Valuation allowances on balance sheet items	-1.4	-	-	-
Outside basis differences	-	8.6	-	13.9
Offsetting	-212.0	-212.0	-254.0	-254.0
Deferred taxes	136.7	358.1	149.2	358.8
Deferred tax liabilities (net)	-	221.4	-	209.6

3.34 Deferred tax assets and liabilities

Deferred tax assets and liabilities break down by maturity as follows:

in EUR m	Dec. 31, 2025	Dec. 31, 2024
Deferred tax assets to be recovered after more than 12 months	7.3	14.2
Deferred tax assets to be recovered within 12 months	129.4	135.0
Deferred tax assets	136.7	149.2
Deferred tax liabilities to be recovered after more than 12 months	354.0	354.7
Deferred tax liabilities to be recovered within 12 months	4.1	4.1
Deferred tax liabilities	358.1	358.8
Deferred tax liabilities (net)	221.4	209.6

3.35 Deferred tax by maturity

Deferred tax liabilities (net) changed as follows:

in EUR m	2025	2024
Deferred tax liabilities (net) at Jan. 1	209.6	164.3
Exchange rate differences	-13.6	7.6
Income/expense in profit or loss	32.5	-21.8
Income taxes recognized in other comprehensive income	-1.5	4.4
Business combinations	-5.6	55.2
Reclassification of deferred tax liabilities into non-current assets held for sale	-	-0.1
Deferred tax liabilities (net) at Dec. 31	221.4	209.6

3.36 Change in deferred tax liabilities (net)

NOTES

The existing tax loss carryforwards can be utilized as follows:

in EUR m	Dec. 31, 2025		Dec. 31, 2024	
	Loss carryforwards	of which loss carryforwards for which deferred taxes are not recognized	Loss carryforwards	of which loss carryforwards for which deferred taxes are not recognized
Within one year	9.0	(8.4)	8.3	(7.1)
2 to 5 years	58.7	(48.4)	61.1	(48.0)
6 to 9 years ¹⁾	4.4	(3.7)	14.3	(11.4)
More than 9 years	238.2	(207.9)	274.3	(232.0)
Unlimited	534.2	(341.3)	514.6	(241.8)
Total	844.5	609.7	872.6	540.3

3.37 Tax loss carryforwards

When measuring deferred tax on loss carryforwards, deferred tax assets are recognized to the extent that sufficient taxable differences are available for utilization and it is probable that future taxable profit will be available against which the temporary differences and unused tax loss carryforwards can be utilized. The expected taxable income is derived from the current mid-term planning, allowing for restrictions on loss carryforwards and their utilization (minimum taxation). Based on the current tax planning, and in particular in light of the effects of the comprehensive cost-out program, we conclude that sufficient taxable profit will be available in the future to utilize the recognized deferred tax assets.

Deferred taxes of EUR 40.9 million (Dec. 31, 2024: EUR 58.6 million) were recognized for loss carryforwards of EUR 234.8 million (Dec. 31, 2024: EUR 332.3 million) which are likely to be utilized. They include deferred taxes of EUR 3.1 million (Dec. 31, 2024: EUR 8.2 million) from current-period tax losses. Loss carryforwards which are likely to be utilized also include German corporate income tax and trade tax loss carryforwards and interest carryforwards totaling EUR 165.0 million (Dec. 31, 2024: EUR 243.5 million) and U.S. subsidiaries' loss carryforwards for state taxes totaling EUR 29.7 million (tax rate between 6% and 8%) (Dec. 31, 2024: EUR 36.3 million) and for federal taxes (tax rate 21%) totaling EUR 0.0 million (Dec. 31, 2024: EUR 5.3 million). The decrease in loss carryforwards which are likely to be utilized is due mainly due to the reversal of deferred tax assets in Germany.

No deferred taxes were recognized for loss carryforwards of EUR 609.7 million (Dec. 31, 2024: EUR 540.3 million) which are not likely to be utilized. This equates to a tax value of EUR 92.5 million. Loss carryforwards which are likely to be utilized include domestic corporation tax and trade tax loss carryforwards totaling EUR 264.1 million (Dec. 31, 2024: EUR 181.8 million) as well as U.S. subsidiaries' loss carryforwards for state taxes totaling EUR 203.1 million (tax rate between 6% and 8%) (Dec. 31, 2024: EUR 229.5 million).

No deferred taxes were recognized for interest carryforwards of EUR 42.2 million (Dec. 31, 2024: EUR 42.8 million) which are not likely to be utilized.

Temporary differences in connection with investments in subsidiaries for which no deferred tax liabilities were recognized amount to EUR 573.6 million (Dec. 31, 2024: EUR 613.5 million). No deferred taxes are recognized because the Group can control the timing of the reversal of the temporary differences and it is assumed that the temporary differences will not reverse in the foreseeable future.

11.) Earnings per share

Basic earnings per share in the amount of EUR 1.83 (2024: EUR 3.71) are determined by dividing the share of profit after tax of EUR 264.6 million (2024: EUR 536.2 million) attributable to the shareholders of Brenntag SE by the number of shares outstanding (2025: 144.4 million; 2024: 144.7 million shares).

Diluted earnings per share are the same as basic earnings per share.

in EUR m	2025	2024
Share of profit after tax attributable to Brenntag SE shareholders	264.6	536.2
Number of Brenntag SE shares	144.4	144.7
Basic earnings per share	1.83	3.71
Diluted earnings per share	1.83	3.71

3.38 Diluted earnings per share

NOTES

Consolidated balance sheet disclosures

12.) Cash and cash equivalents

in EUR m	Dec. 31, 2025	Dec. 31, 2024
Bank deposits	778.9	721.1
Cheques and cash on hand	19.0	42.2
Total	797.9	763.3

3.39 Cash and cash equivalents

For further information, please refer to the section “Scope of consolidation” and the section “Liquidity risk” in Note 32.).

13.) Trade receivables

in EUR m	Dec. 31, 2025	Dec. 31, 2024
Trade receivables from third parties	2,039.9	2,282.5
Trade receivables from related parties	–	–
Total	2,039.9	2,282.5

3.40 Trade receivables

Trade receivables at the reporting date were past due and impaired within the following time bands:

in EUR m	not past due	1 to 30 days	31 to 60 days	61 to 90 days	91 to 180 days	more than 180 days	Dec. 31, 2025
Loss given default (%)	0.6	0.8	2.4	6.2	23.0	94.7	
Gross amount of trade receivables	1,822.0	168.4	33.2	19.3	12.2	24.6	2,079.7
Valuation allowance	10.4	1.3	0.8	1.2	2.8	23.3	39.8

3.41 Loss given default on trade receivables / Dec. 31, 2025

in EUR m	not past due	1 to 30 days	31 to 60 days	61 to 90 days	91 to 180 days	more than 180 days	Dec. 31, 2024
Loss given default (%)	0.4	1.1	6.7	11.5	11.7	84.3	
Gross amount of trade receivables	2,023.7	210.8	36.0	11.3	10.3	37.5	2,329.6
Valuation allowance	8.2	2.4	2.4	1.3	1.2	31.6	47.1

3.42 Loss given default on trade receivables / Dec. 31, 2024

Of the trade receivables, EUR 499.5 million (Dec. 31, 2024: EUR 725.5 million) are secured by trade credit insurance.

In EMEA, most of the trade receivables are secured by trade credit insurance. In Asia Pacific and Latin America, there is trade credit insurance for most of the receivables in certain countries. In North America as well as in some countries in EMEA, Latin America and Asia Pacific, either there is no trade credit insurance or only a relatively small proportion of the trade receivables are secured by trade credit insurance.

Impairment losses on trade receivables changed as follows:

	Accumulated impairment losses on trade receivables	
in EUR m	2025	2024
Jan. 1	47.1	50.2
Exchange rate differences / other	–3.6	–0.8
Added	11.6	7.9
Reversed	–6.4	–5.3
Utilized	–8.9	–4.9
Dec. 31	39.8	47.1

3.43 Change in impairment losses on trade receivables

NOTES

14.) Other receivables

	Dec. 31, 2025		Dec. 31, 2024	
in EUR m		of which current		of which current
Other receivables in scope of IFRS 7:				
Receivables from packaging	8.1	(8.1)	8.0	(8.0)
Reimbursement claims – environment	8.9	(–)	7.9	(–)
Suppliers with debit balances	12.9	(12.9)	10.6	(10.6)
Receivables from insurance claims	1.6	(1.6)	4.9	(4.9)
Deposits	6.9	(6.9)	7.2	(7.2)
Receivables from commissions and rebates	19.0	(19.0)	13.1	(13.1)
Miscellaneous other receivables	48.1	(26.3)	50.1	(27.4)
Other receivables in scope of IFRS 7 total	105.5	(74.8)	101.8	(71.2)
Other receivables out of scope of IFRS 7:				
Prepayments	22.2	(22.2)	25.5	(25.5)
Value-added tax receivables	100.3	(79.0)	93.3	(66.8)
Receivables from other taxes	8.7	(8.7)	8.1	(8.0)
Non-current income tax receivables	0.8	(–)	3.1	(–)
Plan assets not netted with provisions for pensions	4.7	(–)	5.4	(–)
Prepaid expenses	53.2	(52.5)	53.2	(51.4)
Other receivables out of scope of IFRS 7 total	189.9	(162.4)	188.6	(151.7)
Total other receivables	295.4	(237.2)	290.4	(222.9)

3.44 Other receivables

15.) Other financial assets

	Remaining term		
in EUR m	1 year or less	more than 1 year	Dec. 31, 2025
Financial receivables from third parties	12.1	6.1	18.2
Derivative financial instruments at fair value through profit or loss	1.1	10.0	11.1
Debt instruments at fair value through profit or loss	–	1.4	1.4
Total	13.2	17.5	30.7

3.45 Other financial assets / Dec. 31, 2025

	Remaining term		
in EUR m	1 year or less	more than 1 year	Dec. 31, 2024
Financial receivables from third parties	15.2	5.6	20.8
Derivative financial instruments at fair value through profit or loss	5.5	14.3	19.8
Debt instruments at fair value through profit or loss	–	1.4	1.4
Total	20.7	21.3	42.0

3.46 Other financial assets / Dec. 31, 2024

Financial receivables from third parties of EUR 14.0 million (Dec. 31, 2024: EUR 20.8 million) consist mainly of funds deposited in trustee accounts in connection with business combinations.

NOTES

16.) Inventories

Inventories break down as follows:

in EUR m	Dec. 31, 2025	Dec. 31, 2024
Merchandise	1,275.1	1,418.5
Finished goods	52.2	60.1
Work in progress	0.1	0.2
Raw materials and supplies	23.6	39.6
Total	1,351.0	1,518.4

3.47 Inventories

17.) Assets held for sale and liabilities associated with those assets

On June 30, 2025, Brenntag disposed of Raj Petro Specialties Pvt. Ltd. and its subsidiary Raj Petro Specialties DMCC based in Dubai (Raj Petro), United Arab Emirates.

The disposal led to an overall loss of EUR 64.7 million, of which EUR 11.3 million is attributable to financial year 2025 and was recognized in other operating expenses.

Non-current assets held for sale include property, plant and equipment held for sale at other Brenntag companies totaling EUR 8.2 million (Dec. 31, 2024: EUR 1.5 million).

The assets and liabilities break down as follows:

in EUR m	Dec. 31, 2025	Dec. 31, 2024
Cash and cash equivalents	–	5.0
Trade receivables and other receivables	–	81.4
Current tax assets and deferred tax assets	–	2.2
Inventories	–	46.3
Property, plant and equipment and intangible assets	8.2	14.5
Impairment	–	– 42.3
Assets held for sale	8.2	107.1
Trade payables, other liabilities and provisions	–	82.6
Current tax liabilities and deferred tax liabilities	–	1.7
Liabilities associated with assets held for sale	–	84.3

3.48 Assets held for sale and liabilities associated with those assets

NOTES

18.) Property, plant and equipment

in EUR m	Land, land rights and buildings	Technical equipment and machinery	Other equipment, operating and office equipment	Prepayments and assets under construction	Total
Cost					
Dec. 31, 2023	1,232.0	1,016.6	519.8	153.7	2,922.1
Exchange rate differences	27.4	34.9	13.8	2.3	78.4
Business combinations	22.6	20.3	3.7	-	46.6
Other additions	16.5	46.6	75.5	184.6	323.2
Reclassification into non-current assets held for sale	-6.6	-10.8	-1.1	-0.7	-19.2
Disposals	-8.5	-23.8	-33.6	-2.5	-68.4
Transfers	59.5	109.8	20.7	-181.7	8.3
Dec. 31, 2024	1,342.9	1,193.6	598.8	155.7	3,291.0
Exchange rate differences	-73.6	-83.7	-35.9	-8.4	-201.6
Business combinations	11.6	1.9	2.9	0.4	16.8
Other additions	17.0	35.4	40.6	180.6	273.6
Reclassification into non-current assets held for sale	-9.6	-2.3	-0.2	-	-12.1
Disposals	-5.0	-15.2	-46.3	-0.7	-67.2
Transfers	55.3	89.6	69.0	-202.5	11.4
Dec. 31, 2025	1,338.6	1,219.3	628.9	125.1	3,311.9
Accumulated depreciation and impairment					
Dec. 31, 2023	427.5	658.1	331.3	-	1,416.9
Exchange rate differences	9.7	22.7	8.4	-	40.8
Depreciation	41.1	91.6	65.1	-	197.8
Impairment	6.5	4.8	0.4	0.2	11.9
Reclassification into non-current assets held for sale	-6.6	-10.8	-1.1	-0.2	-18.7
Disposals	-7.1	-19.5	-29.3	-	-55.9
Transfers	-0.3	3.7	-0.3	-	3.1
Dec. 31, 2024	470.8	750.6	374.5	-	1,595.9
Exchange rate differences	-23.1	-53.7	-20.1	0.1	-96.8
Depreciation	45.4	95.7	63.7	-	204.8
Impairment/ reversal of impairment	9.4	3.3	-	8.7	21.4
Reclassification into non-current assets held for sale	-3.1	-2.1	-0.2	-	-5.4
Disposals	-5.5	-13.3	-36.6	-	-55.4
Transfers	1.1	9.0	-3.9	-	6.2
Dec. 31, 2025	495.0	789.5	377.4	8.8	1,670.7
Carrying amounts at Dec. 31, 2024	872.1	443.0	224.3	155.7	1,695.1
Carrying amounts at Dec. 31, 2025	843.6	429.8	251.5	116.3	1,641.2

3.49 Property, plant and equipment

Impairment losses of EUR 22.1 million were recognized in the reporting period. Of this total, property, plant and equipment at a site in the Brenntag Essentials APAC segment accounted for EUR 13.1 million due to the unfavorable earnings prospects expected in the region. In addition, impairment losses of EUR 9.0 million were recognized on property, plant and equipment in the context of realigning the site network. In the previous year, impairment losses of EUR 10.8 million related to the property, plant and equipment of Raj Petro Specialties Pvt. Ltd. an Indian entity disposed of in the BES APAC segment.

Assets under construction decreased by EUR 37.3 million to EUR 113.9 million (Dec. 31, 2024: EUR 151.2 million). The change in assets under construction is due mainly to transfers of EUR 199.1 million (Dec. 31, 2024: EUR 175.5 million), impairment losses of EUR 8.7 million (Dec. 31, 2024: EUR 0.1 million) and foreign exchange losses of EUR 8.2 million (Dec. 31, 2024: foreign exchange gains of EUR 2.4 million), which were set against investments of EUR 179.5 million made in the financial year (Dec. 31, 2024: EUR 179.9 million).

NOTES

19.) Intangible assets

in EUR m	Goodwill	Trademarks	Customer relationships and similar rights	Software, licenses and similar rights	Total
Cost					
Dec. 31, 2023	3,250.4	241.6	169.9	233.6	3,895.5
Exchange rate differences	114.9	2.2	9.5	3.9	130.5
Business combinations	130.2	36.3	234.6	1.5	402.6
Other additions	-	-	2.8	18.8	21.6
Reclassification into non-current assets held for sale	-	-4.1	-	-0.8	-4.9
Disposals	-2.4	-	-39.5	-1.2	-43.1
Transfers	-	-	-	-	-
Dec. 31, 2024	3,493.1	276.0	377.3	255.8	4,402.2
Exchange rate differences	-249.1	-5.5	-23.4	-8.0	-286.0
Business combinations	94.5	-17.5	-6.9	0.2	70.3
Other additions	-	-	-	23.0	23.0
Reclassification into non-current assets held for sale	-	-	-	-	-
Disposals	-11.4	-7.6	-33.4	-39.5	-91.9
Transfers	-	-0.1	-	-0.6	-0.7
Dec. 31, 2025	3,327.1	245.3	313.6	230.9	4,116.9
Accumulated amortization and impairment					
Dec. 31, 2023	39.6	34.5	70.6	177.8	322.5
Exchange rate differences	-3.6	1.6	3.3	3.1	4.4
Amortization	-	6.5	37.8	19.5	63.8
Impairment	11.1	-	-	0.2	11.3
Reclassification into non-current assets held for sale	-	-4.1	-	-0.8	-4.9
Disposals	-	-	-39.5	-0.2	-39.7
Transfers	-	-	-	-	-
Dec. 31, 2024	47.1	38.5	72.2	199.6	357.4
Exchange rate differences	-4.3	-3.6	-5.7	-6.7	-20.3
Amortization	-	3.1	36.6	22.8	62.5
Impairment	138.4	-	3.1	1.2	142.7
Reclassification into non-current assets held for sale	-	-	-	-	-
Disposals	-11.1	-7.5	-33.4	-39.2	-91.2
Transfers	-0.1	-0.1	-	-0.4	-0.6
Dec. 31, 2025	170.0	30.4	72.8	177.3	450.5
Carrying amounts at Dec. 31, 2024	3,446.0	237.5	305.1	56.2	4,044.8
Carrying amounts at Dec. 31, 2025	3,157.1	214.9	240.8	53.6	3,666.4

3.50 Intangible assets

NOTES

The goodwill and the “Brenntag” trademark are assets with an indefinite useful life. They are tested regularly, at least annually, for impairment after completion of the annual budget process. The carrying amount of the “Brenntag” trademark is EUR 196.9 million as in the previous year.

The Brenntag Group is managed through two global divisions, Brenntag Specialties (BSP) and Brenntag Essentials (BES). Nutrition, Pharma, Beauty & Care, Material Science and Specialties Other were identified as groups of CGUs for the goodwill impairment test. Brenntag Essentials comprises the EMEA, North America, Latin America and APAC groups of CGUs, plus the “Transregional” segment comprising the international operations of BRENNTAG International Chemicals GmbH (BIC), which buys and sells chemicals in bulk on an international scale.

in EUR m	Dec. 31, 2025	Dec. 31, 2024
Essentials EMEA	436.4	454.5
Essentials North America	1,059.5	1,071.2
Essentials Latin America	–	77.4
Essentials APAC	7.3	59.1
Essentials Transregional	24.8	26.7
Specialties Nutrition	681.0	733.0
Specialties Pharma	244.4	254.0
Specialties Beauty & Care	275.2	308.9
Specialties Material Science	413.8	445.4
Specialties Other	14.7	15.8
Group	3,157.1	3,446.0

3.51 Goodwill by group of CGUs

Fair value less costs of disposal is taken as the recoverable amount. This amount is determined on the basis of a recognized company valuation model. The company valuation model is based on euro cash flow plans, which are in turn based on the five-year plan applicable at the date of the performance of the impairment test. The fair value thus determined is required to be classified into Level 3 of the IFRS 13 measurement hierarchy.

The cash flow forecasts for the impairment test of the financial year ended December 31, 2025 were derived from the budget for 2026 and the plan years 2027 to 2030. The growth rates are based on management’s past experience, supplemented by external market data, Brenntag-specific changes in quantities and sales prices, the resulting gross profit and the trend in costs based on external macroeconomic data. These forecasts are in each case based on country-specific assumptions about the trend in key macroeconomic variables, such as gross domestic product, consumer prices, interest rate levels and nominal wages, and are derived or verified on the basis of external studies.

Due to the significant weakness in earnings and the reduction in long-term growth forecasts, an impairment test was performed for the cash-generating unit Essentials Latin America as at June 30, 2025. The fair value less costs of disposal determined was EUR 434.1 million (Level 3 of the fair value hierarchy).

The test resulted in an impairment loss of EUR 84.6 million in total. Of this, goodwill impairment losses accounted for EUR 79.5 million, impairment losses on customer relationships for EUR 3.1 million and impairment losses on right-of-use assets arising from leases for EUR 2.0 million.

In the course of the impairment test for the cash-generating unit Essentials APAC, a fair value less costs of disposal of EUR 268.0 million (Level 3 of the fair value hierarchy) was determined. As this is below the carrying amount of this cash-generating unit, a goodwill impairment loss was recognized in the amount of EUR 58.9 million. The impairment loss is due to the unfavorable earnings prospects expected in the region, partly in light of the ongoing geopolitical uncertainty between the U.S. and China.

In the detailed planning period from 2026 to 2030, the average gross profit growth rates (CAGR) of the cash-generating units of Brenntag Specialties and Brenntag Essentials are between 2.2% and 2.8% (Dec. 31, 2024: between 2.1% and 11.0%).

NOTES

After the, in some cases, much higher growth rates in the years 2026 to 2030 (detailed planning period), the planned growth rates for the period from 2031 (2024: from 2030) onwards are as follows:

Growth rates in %	2025	2024
Essentials EMEA	1.25	1.25
Essentials North America	1.25	1.25
Essentials Latin America	1.25	1.75
Essentials APAC	1.25	1.75
Essentials Transregional	1.25	1.25
Specialties Nutrition	1.25	1.25
Specialties Pharma	1.25	1.25
Specialties Beauty & Care	1.25	1.25
Specialties Material Science	1.25	1.25
Specialties Other	1.25	1.25

3.52 Growth rates by group of CGUs

The WACC of the groups of CGUs used to discount the cash flows thus determined is based on a risk-free interest rate of 3.25% (2024: 2.60%) and a market risk premium of 6.00% (2024: 6.75%). The beta factor used and the capital structure are derived from a peer group. Furthermore, region-specific tax rates and country risk premiums are used.

WACC in %	2025	2024
Essentials EMEA	7.8	8.1
Essentials North America	7.8	8.0
Essentials Latin America	9.7	10.2
Essentials APAC	8.1	8.2
Essentials Transregional	7.6	7.9
Specialties Nutrition	8.1	8.3
Specialties Pharma	7.9	8.1
Specialties Beauty & Care	8.2	8.3
Specialties Material Science	8.1	8.3
Specialties Other	7.9	8.2
Group	8.0	8.1

3.53 WACC by group of CGUs

Sensitivity analyses for cash flow forecasts, growth rates and the WACC taken as a basis are outlined in the section "Assumptions and estimates".

NOTES

20.) Leases

Right-of-use assets arising from leases changed as follows:

in EUR m	Rights to use land and buildings	Rights to use vehicles	Other right-of-use assets	Total
Cost				
Dec. 31, 2023	477.8	263.7	88.0	829.5
Exchange rate differences	17.6	13.2	1.1	31.9
Business combinations	42.2	1.0	61.4	104.6
Other additions	91.3	111.8	18.5	221.6
Reclassification into non-current assets held for sale	-2.2	-	-2.5	-4.7
Disposals	-38.3	-69.1	-9.6	-117.0
Transfers	13.0	0.3	-21.6	-8.3
Dec. 31, 2024	601.4	320.9	135.3	1,057.6
Exchange rate differences	-40.9	-23.7	-4.4	-69.0
Business combinations	3.1	-	-	3.1
Other additions	62.4	40.6	31.2	134.2
Disposals	-66.9	-67.1	-29.0	-163.0
Transfers	-17.7	-20.8	16.5	-22.0
Dec. 31, 2025	541.4	249.9	149.6	940.9
Accumulated depreciation and impairment				
Dec. 31, 2023	205.3	143.8	42.2	391.3
Exchange rate differences	8.9	6.0	0.4	15.3
Depreciation	73.7	62.5	21.0	157.2
Impairment	0.2	-	1.8	2.0
Disposals	-27.9	-60.0	-8.7	-96.6
Transfers	2.3	-2.5	-2.9	-3.1
Dec. 31, 2024	260.3	149.8	51.3	461.4
Exchange rate differences	-20.5	-10.8	-1.8	-33.1
Depreciation	76.4	58.0	21.0	155.4
Impairment	2.5	-	-	2.5
Disposals	-51.9	-63.4	-25.6	-140.9
Transfers	-4.1	-14.3	3.9	-14.5
Dec. 31, 2025	262.7	119.3	48.8	430.8
Carrying amounts at Dec. 31, 2024	341.1	171.1	84.0	596.2
Carrying amounts at Dec. 31, 2025	278.7	130.6	100.8	510.1

3.54 Right-of-use assets

Extension options in the amount of EUR 73.9 million (Dec. 31, 2024: EUR 83.9 million) were not included in the measurement of the right-of-use assets and lease liabilities, as it is not reasonably certain at the present time that they will be exercised. There were no purchase options as at December 31, 2025 (Dec. 31, 2024: EUR 1.3 million). The extension options relate mainly to rights to use land and buildings, while the purchase options related mainly to rights to use vehicles.

In connection with goodwill impairment at Brenntag Essentials Latin America, right-of-use assets from leases were written down for impairment by EUR 2.0 million.

NOTES

The following lease expenses were recognized in profit or loss:

in EUR m	2025	2024
Lease expense relating to short-term leases	-36.6	-38.7
Lease expense relating to variable lease payments	-19.3	-13.4
Lease expense relating to leases of low-value assets	-1.4	-1.4
Lease expense – not within the scope of IFRS 16	-12.0	-15.7
Lease expense – intangible assets	-33.0	-29.1
Total	-102.3	-98.3

3.55 Lease expenses

As at December 31, 2025, future lease commitments for short-term leases amounted to EUR 18.2 million (Dec. 31, 2024: EUR 18.0 million), for variable lease payments to EUR 12.8 million (Dec. 31, 2024: EUR 13.9 million) and for leases entered into but not yet commenced to EUR 10.3 million (Dec. 31, 2024: EUR 3.7 million).

Interest expense on lease liabilities amounts to EUR 26.5 million (Dec. 31, 2024: EUR 24.6 million). Total payments for leases amounted to EUR 279.4 million in 2025 (Dec. 31, 2024: EUR 229.6 million). Further information on lease liabilities is provided in the sections “Financial liabilities” and “Reporting of financial instruments”.

Impairment losses of EUR 2.0 million relate to property, plant and equipment in the BES Latin America segment. In the previous year, impairment losses of EUR 2.0 million related to the property, plant and equipment of Raj Petro Specialties Pvt. Ltd, an Indian entity disposed of in the BES APAC segment.

21.) Equity-accounted investments

Equity-accounted investments changed as follows:

in EUR m	Investments in associates
Dec. 31, 2023	6.0
Exchange rate differences	-0.1
Net income from equity-accounted investments	0.1
Total comprehensive income	-
Dividends received	-1.0
Dec. 31, 2024	5.0
Exchange rate differences	-0.1
Net income from equity-accounted investments	1.1
Total comprehensive income	1.0
Dividends received	-0.7
Dec. 31, 2025	5.3

3.56 Change in equity-accounted investments

The financial year of the investments accounted for using the equity method is the calendar year.

22.) Trade payables

Trade payables of EUR 1,498.3 million (Dec. 31, 2024: EUR 1,661.6 million) include accruals of EUR 245.4 million (Dec. 31, 2024: EUR 255.4 million) for outstanding invoices.

NOTES

23.) Financial liabilities

in EUR m	Remaining term		Dec. 31, 2025
	1 year or less	more than 1 year	
Liabilities under syndicated loan	–	–	–
Other liabilities to banks	81.8	31.8	113.6
Promissory notes (Schuldschein)	4.2	482.7	486.9
Bond 2028	12.9	498.2	511.1
Bond 2029	0.6	498.4	499.0
Bond 2031	5.0	594.4	599.4
Bond 2032	13.3	495.3	508.6
Derivative financial instruments	5.2	3.4	8.6
Other financial liabilities	16.6	40.6	57.2
Total	139.6	2,644.8	2,784.4
Lease liabilities	121.2	420.2	541.4
Cash and cash equivalents			797.9
Net financial liabilities			2,527.9

3.57 Financial liabilities / Dec. 31, 2025

in EUR m	Remaining term		Dec. 31, 2024
	1 year or less	more than 1 year	
Liabilities under syndicated loan	–	–	–
Other liabilities to banks	91.1	41.7	132.8
Promissory notes (Schuldschein)	5.4	502.7	508.1
Bond 2025	601.1	–	601.1
Bond 2028	12.9	497.5	510.4
Bond 2029	0.6	497.8	498.4
Bond 2032	13.3	494.5	507.8
Derivative financial instruments	3.1	41.3	44.4
Other financial liabilities	85.0	51.0	136.0
Total	812.5	2,126.5	2,939.0
Lease liabilities	136.9	480.4	617.3
Cash and cash equivalents			763.3
Net financial liabilities			2,793.0

3.58 Financial liabilities / Dec. 31, 2024

The most important component in Brenntag's financing structure is the Group-wide syndicated loan agreement. As at December 31, 2025, the euro equivalent of the credit facility was EUR 1.4 billion. The syndicated loan originally had a term running until February 2028, which has now been extended until February 2030 through two extension options.

It is based on variable interest rates with margins depending on the credit rating, and is divided into two revolving credit facilities – one credit facility in the amount of EUR 1.0 billion and a USD credit facility in the amount of USD 525.0 million (equivalent in euros as at Dec. 31, 2025: EUR 446.8 million). To a small extent, the margin is also linked to the achievement of certain Brenntag Group sustainability targets.

As at December 31, 2025, Brenntag had no outstanding liabilities under the syndicated loan. A very small amount of the EUR 1 billion credit facility had been drawn down for bank guarantees. The USD credit facility was entirely unutilized as at December 31, 2025. Both credit facilities are available for further drawdowns at any time. Other liabilities to banks included accrued transaction costs on the syndicated loan amounting to EUR 3.1 million as at December 31, 2025 (Dec. 31, 2024: EUR 3.9 million).

While some subsidiaries are direct borrowers under the loan, others obtain their financing from intra-Group loans. The syndicated loan is guaranteed by Brenntag SE.

NOTES

At the end of August 2022, Brenntag SE placed promissory notes with a nominal value of around EUR 640.0 million. These were issued at the nominal amount. Alongside five euro-denominated tranches with a total nominal value of EUR 390.0 million, the company also issued two U.S. dollar-denominated tranches with a total nominal value of around EUR 250.0 million. The seven tranches have original tenors of three, five and seven years and are due for repayment on August 29 and 30 of the respective year.

The two floating-rate tranches in the amount of EUR 60.0 million and USD 70.0 million (equivalent in euros at the repay-

ment date: EUR 64.5 million) maturing in 2025 were repaid ahead of schedule in 2024.

Three tranches carry floating interest rates, while two (euro) tranches have a fixed interest rate over the respective term. Interest payments are made quarterly for the floating-rate tranches in U.S. dollars, semi-annually for the floating-rate euro-denominated tranches, and annually for the fixed-rate euro-denominated tranches.

The liabilities under the promissory notes break down as follows:

in EUR m	Remaining term	Interest rate p.a. above EURIBOR / SOFR or fixed rate	Dec. 31, 2025
Currency			
EUR	Aug. 30, 2027	+1.000 pc points	175.0
	Aug. 30, 2027	2.648%	75.0
	Aug. 30, 2029	+1.150 pc points	50.0
	Aug. 30, 2029	2.889%	30.0
Total			330.0
USD	Aug. 30, 2027	+1.50 pc points	153.2
Total			153.2
Accrued interest			4.2
Transaction costs			-0.5
Liabilities under promissory notes			486.9

3.59 Liabilities under promissory notes / Dec. 31, 2025

in EUR m	Remaining term	Interest rate p.a. above EURIBOR / SOFR or fixed rate	Dec. 31, 2024
Currency			
EUR	Aug. 29, 2025	+0.75 pc points	-
	Aug. 30, 2027	+1.00 pc points	175.0
	Aug. 30, 2027	2.648%	75.0
	Aug. 30, 2029	+1.15 pc points	50.0
	Aug. 30, 2029	2.889%	30.0
Total			330.0
USD	Aug. 29, 2025	+1.25 pc points	-
	Aug. 30, 2027	+1.50 pc points	173.2
Total			173.2
Accrued interest			5.4
Transaction costs			-0.5
Liabilities under promissory notes			508.1

3.60 Liabilities under promissory notes / Dec. 31, 2024

NOTES

The Bond 2028 issued in April 2024 in the amount of EUR 500.0 million matures in 2028 and carries an annual coupon of 3.750%.

The Bond 2029 issued in October 2021 in the amount of EUR 500.0 million matures in 2029 and carries an annual coupon of 0.50%.

The Bond 2031 issued in October 2025 in the amount of EUR 600.0 million matures in 2031 and carries an annual coupon of 3.375%.

The Bond 2032 also issued in April 2024 in the amount of EUR 500.0 million matures in 2032 and carries an annual coupon of 3.875%.

All bonds were issued by the Group company Brenntag Finance B.V., Amsterdam, Netherlands.

The four above-mentioned bonds were all issued under the debt issuance program newly established in 2021.

The Bond 2025 was repaid in financial year 2025.

Other financial liabilities of EUR 55.1 million (Dec. 31, 2024: EUR 136.0 million) consist mainly of liabilities in connection with business combinations.

24.) Other liabilities

in EUR m	Dec. 31, 2025		Dec. 31, 2024	
		of which current		of which current
Other liabilities in scope of IFRS 7:				
Liabilities from packaging	63.0	(63.0)	65.4	(65.4)
Customers with credit balances	28.4	(28.4)	32.3	(32.3)
Liabilities to insurance companies	1.7	(1.7)	3.3	(3.3)
Liabilities from sales deductions, rebates	22.2	(22.2)	24.8	(24.8)
Liabilities from the acquisition of assets	18.3	(18.3)	14.9	(14.9)
Miscellaneous other liabilities	81.9	(79.6)	113.4	(111.1)
Other liabilities in scope of IFRS 7 total	215.5	(213.2)	254.1	(251.8)
Other liabilities out of scope of IFRS 7:				
Liabilities to employees	137.8	(137.8)	170.6	(170.6)
Liabilities from value-added tax	88.4	(88.4)	85.7	(85.7)
Liabilities from other taxes	28.6	(28.6)	35.2	(35.2)
Deferred income	4.6	(4.6)	3.9	(3.9)
Liabilities from social insurance contributions	15.3	(15.3)	17.5	(17.5)
Miscellaneous other liabilities	5.9	(5.9)	2.7	(2.7)
Other liabilities out of scope of IFRS 7 total	280.6	(280.6)	315.6	(315.6)
Total other liabilities	496.1	(493.8)	569.7	(567.4)

3.61 Other liabilities

Other liabilities include accruals of EUR 95.1 million (Dec. 31, 2024: EUR 74.1 million).

NOTES

25.) Other provisions

Other provisions changed as follows in financial year 2025:

in EUR m	Environmental provisions	Provisions for personnel expenses	Provisions for compensation payable, and for legal proceedings and disputes	Miscellaneous provisions	Total
Jan. 1, 2025	114.2	42.1	162.4	36.3	355.0
Exchange rate differences	-6.8	-1.5	-13.3	-1.8	-23.4
Additions from business combinations	-	-	0.4	0.1	0.5
Unwinding of discounting	3.3	0.1	-	0.3	3.7
Utilized	-8.0	-27.7	-26.4	-11.5	-73.6
Reversed	-7.9	-1.5	-3.0	-1.3	-13.7
Added	10.8	23.2	39.5	11.8	85.3
Disposals	-	-	-	-0.1	-0.1
Transferred	-	-	-	-	-
Dec. 31, 2025	105.6	34.7	159.6	33.8	333.7

3.62 Change in other provisions

Other provisions have the following maturities:

in EUR m	Environmental provisions	Provisions for personnel expenses	Provisions for compensation payable, and for legal proceedings and disputes	Miscellaneous provisions	Dec. 31, 2025	Environmental provisions	Provisions for personnel expenses	Provisions for compensation payable, and for legal proceedings and disputes	Miscellaneous provisions	Dec. 31, 2024
1 year or less	15.0	14.1	40.9	19.0	89.0	13.5	27.5	33.4	20.4	94.8
1 to 5 years	43.5	16.3	63.0	8.7	131.5	41.7	8.2	109.8	6.9	166.6
more than 5 years	47.1	4.3	55.7	6.1	113.2	59.0	6.4	19.2	9.0	93.6
Total	105.6	34.7	159.6	33.8	333.7	114.2	42.1	162.4	36.3	355.0

3.63 Maturity of other provisions

Environmental provisions

The recognition and measurement of environmental provisions are coordinated centrally by external independent experts. The provision amounts are determined on the basis of individual cost estimates for each case. Allowance is made not only for the nature and severity of pollution but also for the conditions at the respective sites and the sovereign territories in which these sites are located.

Environmental provisions are stated at their present values. They are discounted at maturity-dependent, risk-free interest rates for the respective functional currencies. Increases in the future expenditure due to inflation are allowed for. The discount rates for environmental provisions range from 0.1% to 13.6%, depending on the currency (Dec. 31, 2024: from 0.2% to 14.1%).

As at December 31, 2025, environmental provisions total EUR 105.6 million (Dec. 31, 2024: EUR 114.2 million). They mainly relate to the rehabilitation of soil and ground water for current and former, owned and leased sites but also cover costs for further and accompanying measures such as necessary environmental inspections and observations. The provisions include EUR 20.2 million (Dec. 31, 2024: EUR 22.2 million) for contingencies for which a cash outflow is not likely but nevertheless possible. In line with the requirements of IFRS 3, these contingencies have entered the balance sheet largely through the purchase price allocation in connection with the acquisition of the Brenntag Group by funds advised by BC Partners Limited, Bain Capital, Ltd. and subsidiaries of Goldman Sachs International at the end of the third quarter of 2006.

NOTES

Due to the nature and the large number of parameters which have to be considered when determining environmental provisions, there are uncertainties in their measurement. This applies both to the amount and the timing of future expenditure. However, based on the information available at the time of preparation of the financial statements, it can be assumed that the environmental provisions are reasonable and any additional amounts incurred would not have any material effect on the net assets, financial position and results of operations of the Group.

In some cases, special agreements have been reached which ensure that the cost of any future environmental work necessary will be borne by third parties. If receipt of payment from the third party is virtually certain provided Brenntag meets its obligations, these claims to reimbursement are recognized. They are generally measured in the same way as the corresponding provisions. The amount recognized does not exceed the amount of the provision. The claims to reimbursement recognized as at December 31, 2025 amount to EUR 8.9 million (Dec. 31, 2024: EUR 7.9 million).

Provisions for personnel expenses

Provisions for personnel expenses primarily contain obligations arising from future variable and individual one-time payments, payments in connection with employee long-service anniversary bonuses, early retirement regulations and pre-retirement part-time work compensation. Provisions for virtual share-based remuneration programs are also presented under this item. These programs are long-term bonus systems for members of the Board of Management of Brenntag SE, on the one hand, and for executives and senior managers of the Brenntag Group, on the other.

Long-term virtual share-based remuneration programs for the members of the Board of Management and Long-Term Incentive Plans for Executives and Senior Managers (LTI Plans)

Details of the long-term, variable remuneration for the members of the Board of Management are provided in the section "Related parties".

In 2024, an LTI Plan was set up for selected executives and senior managers of the Brenntag Group. This comprises long-term variable remuneration in the form of virtual shares (performance share units). The number of virtual shares may increase or decrease, depending on Brenntag's long-term performance measured over a three-year performance period. The performance share plan is structured as described in the following.

The number of virtual shares initially awarded is calculated by dividing the individual and contractually agreed target amount by the arithmetic mean of the Brenntag share closing prices in the Xetra trading system during the last three months before the start of the performance period. If the service agreement begins or ends during a financial year, the target amount for that financial year is calculated on a pro rata temporis basis.

The number of virtual shares finally awarded to the plan member is linked to three financial performance criteria and, via an ESG multiplier, to ESG targets. The three financial performance criteria are Brenntag's total shareholder return (TSR) compared with a global peer group (weighting: 50%), return on capital employed (ROCE) (weighting: 25%) and organic operating EBITA (25%). The sum total of the weighted share awards for each performance criterion is multiplied by the achievement figure of specific ESG targets using an ESG multiplier that may be between 0.8 and 1.2. The resulting total share award is then multiplied by the number of virtual shares initially awarded, giving the number of virtual shares finally awarded to the plan member at the end of the three-year performance period. The number of virtual shares finally awarded is capped at 200%. The payout amount depends on Brenntag's absolute share price performance in the three-year performance period and is calculated by multiplying the number of virtual shares finally awarded by the arithmetic mean of the Brenntag share closing prices in the Xetra trading system during the last three months before the end of the performance period, plus dividend payments during the performance period. The payout amount is capped at a maximum of 250% of the individual and contractually agreed target amount (Cap).

Personnel expenses of EUR 7.0 million were recognized for the virtual share-based remuneration programs (2024: income within personnel expenses of EUR 0.9 million).

Provisions for share-based remuneration total EUR 9.6 million as at December 31, 2025 (Dec. 31, 2024: EUR 21.1 million) and disaggregate into the following maturities:

in EUR m	Dec. 31, 2025	Dec. 31, 2024
1 year or less	–	18.7
1 to 5 years	9.6	2.4
Total	9.6	21.1

3.64 Provisions for share-based remuneration

NOTES

Provisions for compensation payable and for legal proceedings and disputes

Provisions for current and likely litigation are established in those cases where reasonable estimates are possible. These provisions contain all estimated legal costs as well as the possible settlement costs. The amounts are based on information and cost estimates provided by lawyers (for details, please see the section “Legal proceedings and disputes”).

Miscellaneous provisions

Miscellaneous provisions primarily include provisions for dismantling obligations in the amount of EUR 16.7 million (Dec. 31, 2024: EUR 16.7 million).

26.) Provisions for pensions and other post-employment benefits

There are both defined contribution and defined benefit pension plans for the employees of the Brenntag Group. The pension obligations vary depending on the legal, tax and economic circumstances in the respective country and the employee's years of service with the company and pay grade.

Defined contribution plans

A large number of the employees of the Brenntag Group will receive benefits from the statutory social insurance fund, into which the contributions are paid as part of their salary. In addition, various other pension fund commitments exist at the companies of the Brenntag Group. As the company has no further obligations after payment of the retirement pension contributions to the state social insurance fund and private insurance companies, these plans are treated as defined contribution plans. Current pension contribution payments are recognized as expense for the relevant period. In financial year 2025, pension expenses in the Brenntag Group for employer contributions to the statutory pension insurance fund and for non-statutory defined contribution plans amounted to a total of EUR 125.1 million (2024: EUR 116.6 million).

In the U.S., subsidiaries of the Brenntag Group pay into defined benefit plans maintained by more than one employer (termed multi-employer plans). These multi-employer defined benefit plans are accounted for in the consolidated financial statements as defined contribution plans because the information required to use defined benefit accounting is not available in a timely manner and in sufficient detail. Furthermore, there is no consistent and reliable basis for allocating the obligation, plan assets and cost to individual participating employers, which is necessary for accounting for defined benefit plans in accordance with IAS 19.

If other participating employers do not meet their payment obligations, Brenntag may be liable for the obligations of those employers. Any potential withdrawal from the plans by an entity may lead to that entity having to offset the potential shortfall relating to its share of the plan. The funding level of the individual plans ranged from about 15% to 96% as at December 31, 2025 (about 15% to 100% as at December 31, 2024). Brenntag Group subsidiaries account for approximately 0.05% to 2.23% of the total contributions (2024: approximately 0.05% to 2.39%), depending on the plan. Withdrawal from all plans at the present time would lead to an estimated one-time expense of approximately EUR 44 million or approximately USD 50 million (2024: approximately EUR 49 million or approximately USD 53 million). It is not intended to withdraw from any of these plans at this time.

In financial year 2025, contributions of EUR 2.8 million or USD 3.2 million (2024: EUR 2.9 million or USD 3.1 million) were paid. The contributions are included in the above-mentioned contributions for non-statutory defined contribution plans. In 2026, the contributions are expected to amount to approximately EUR 2.9 million.

Defined benefit plans

The defined benefit plans of the Brenntag Group are funded by provisions and largely covered by assets. The principal obligations (over 90% of the total volume) are in Switzerland, Germany, Canada and the Netherlands. The remaining obligations are spread over another eleven countries in the EMEA, Latin America and Asia Pacific segments.

Switzerland

In Switzerland, every employer is obliged by national law to set up a company retirement pension scheme. When determining the pension benefits, the minimum requirements of the Federal Law on Occupational Retirement, Surviving Dependents' and Disability Pensions (Bundesgesetz über die beruflichen Alters-, Hinterlassenen- und Invalidenvorsorge (BVG)) and the corresponding regulations are required to be observed.

The Swiss group company maintains a funded pension plan for its employees. The assets of this plan are held in two autonomous foundations. The foundation board is made up of equal numbers of employer and employee representatives. It is responsible for setting the investment strategy, for changes in the plan rules and in particular also for determining the financing of the pension benefits.

NOTES

The pension benefits are based on the retirement assets accrued. The annual retirement credits and interest are credited to these retirement assets. On retirement, the insured person is obliged to take 30% of the accrued retirement assets in the form of a lump-sum payment and may choose whether to take the remaining 70% of the accrued retirement assets in the form of a life-long pension or another lump-sum payment. In addition to the retirement benefits, the pension benefits also include disability and surviving dependents' pensions. The insured person may also dispose of parts of their accrued retirement assets prematurely if this serves to improve their pension situation (for owner-occupied residential property). If there is a change of employer, the retirement assets are transferred to the pension scheme of the new employer.

The employee and employer contributions are set by the foundation board. According to the BVG, the employer pays at least 50% of the necessary contributions. In the case of Brenntag Schweizerhall AG, the employer pays some 70% of the contributions in accordance with the rules of the plan.

As the contributions to the pension plan that the employees in Switzerland pay are based on formal rules, the risk distribution between employee and employer is taken into account when measuring the obligation. In the case of Brenntag Schweizerhall AG, this leads to an only minor reduction in the present value of the benefit obligation.

Germany

The German group companies have retirement pension plans which are based on contractual provisions or works agreements.

The Employee Pension Plan 2000/2012 (Mitarbeiter Vorsorgeplan 2000/2012) is a pension plan funded by the employer. The employer awards an annual pension contribution of between EUR 250 and EUR 500 depending on length of service, which is converted into pension modules. The amount of the benefits depends on the pension modules accrued before retirement.

The Pension Scheme 2000/2012 for Executives (Leistungsordnung 2000/2012 für Führungskräfte) of the German Brenntag companies is a pension plan for executives funded by the employer in the form of individual commitments. The annual pension contribution depends on the pensionable remuneration (basis of assessment). The annual basis of assessment is the sum total of the fixed remuneration, Christmas and vacation allowances and bonuses but no more than three times the contribution assessment limit for the statutory pension system. The pension contribution is a maximum of 4% of the basis of assessment up to the contribution assessment limit plus a maximum of 10% for parts exceeding the contribution assessment limit. The annual pension contributions are converted into pension modules. The amount

of the benefits depends on the pension modules accrued before retirement.

All employees have the option to convert pay components into an entitlement to pension benefits within the meaning of the German Company Pension Act (Betriebsrentengesetz (BetrAVG)) by participating in the Pension Plan Through Employee-funded Pension Commitments (Vorsorgeplan über mitarbeiterfinanzierte Versorgungszusagen). The annual pension contribution for participating employees is between at least EUR 250 and a maximum of 4% of the contribution assessment limit for the statutory pension system (Section 1a BetrAVG). The company also pays an additional pension allowance of 15% to the converted amount provided that the pension contribution comes from remuneration subject to statutory pension insurance contributions. Furthermore, through the Deferred Compensation Plan (DCP), employees have the option to convert pay components into an entitlement to pension benefits. The converted employee contributions are protected by pension liability insurance pledged to the employee who is entitled to the pension. With both employee-funded plans, the employees must decide every year on the pension contribution they wish to make.

In addition to the retirement benefits, the pension benefits also include surviving dependents' pensions and – except in the case of the Deferred Compensation Plan (DCP) – disability benefits.

The Pension Scheme 2000/2012 for Executives (Leistungsordnung 2000/2012 für Führungskräfte) is a pure retirement pension plan with a monthly life-long pension. With the other pension plans, the pension benefit is paid out as a lump sum or as an annual capital instalment spread over a maximum of five years or as a life-long pension.

Furthermore, in Germany, Brenntag still has isolated retirement and disability pension commitments under pension plans set up in the past. These commitments depend on the years of service and the pay grades of the respective employees. They are mainly commitments involving monthly pension payments.

Canada

In Canada, Brenntag maintains an employer-funded pension plan with a life-long monthly pension for employees who joined the company before December 31, 2011. The basis of assessment for calculating the annual pension is 1% of the average salary of the three highest annual salaries of the beneficiary multiplied by the number of years of service. In addition to the retirement benefits, the pension benefits include disability and surviving dependents' pensions.

NOTES

The plan participants in the employer-funded pension plan who are under 50 or who have less than 15 years of service or less than 55 points (sum of age and years of service) must pay into a defined contribution plan newly set up in 2014 in order to continue to build up their retirement pension. Employer and employee pay equal portions of the contributions. The entitlements accrued up to the date of transition remain in place.

For employees in Canada who joined the company up to and including May 31, 2013, there is an employer-funded supplementary medical cost plan in retirement as well as a life insurance payout of CAD 5,000 on retirement. As this plan has the characteristics of a pension, it is classified under pensions and other post-employment benefits.

Netherlands

Company pension systems play a prominent role in the Netherlands as the pay-as-you-go statutory pension scheme only provides a basic pension.

The companies maintain a funded retirement plan for their employees. When there is a change of employer, the credit balance from the plan assets can be transferred to the pension scheme of the new employer or remains in the previous company's pension scheme. About 20% of the retirement pension plan is funded by the employee and about 80% by the employer. Depending on the employer's commitment, the basis of assessment for calculating the annual pension is the last salary before the employee reaches retirement age or the average salary over the employee's active career before reaching retirement age. The amount calculated from the

basis of assessment is multiplied by the years of service. The retirement pension plan is a pure pension plan with a life-long monthly pension. In addition to the retirement benefits, the pension benefits include disability and surviving dependents' pensions.

Risks arising from defined benefit pension plans

Brenntag is exposed to risks arising from the plans. An increase in life expectancy, an increase in salaries and the adjustment of pensions in line with inflation as required by law in Germany, or an increase in medical costs in Canada, would lead to higher cash outflows and, in combination with falling discount rates, in each case to higher present values of the defined benefit obligation.

There is investment risk in Switzerland primarily with regard to the proportion of the plan assets invested in shares. There is no investment risk in Germany or the Netherlands as the plan assets consist solely of insurance policies. In Canada, the plan assets consisting of external fund shares are in principle exposed to investment risk. In order to minimize this risk, the plan assets in Canada are subject by law to an audit every three years to establish whether the assets invested are sufficient to fund the pension obligations.

Actuarial parameters applied

The plan assets are measured at fair value. The calculation of the present value of the benefit obligations is based on the following main actuarial parameters. When several countries are grouped together, the values are average values weighted by the present value of the respective benefit obligation:

in %		Switzerland	Germany	Canada	Netherlands	Other countries	Weighted
Discount rate	2025	1.30	4.00	4.90	4.00	4.21	3.27
	2024	0.95	3.40	4.70	3.40	4.11	2.85
Expected salary trend	2025	1.35	2.50	3.25	2.00	3.74	2.25
	2024	1.35	2.50	3.25	2.00	3.93	2.27
Expected pension trend	2025	0.35	2.00	-	-	2.21	0.92
	2024	0.35	2.00	2.00	2.00	2.61	1.51
Medical cost trend	2025			5.12			5.12
	2024			5.21			5.21

3.65 Actuarial parameters applied

NOTES

Due to the fall in inflation, an additional valuation premium was no longer recognized in connection with future pension adjustments in Germany as at December 31, 2025 (Dec. 31, 2024: 2.32%). Pension obligations are again being measured under the method applied before the period of heightened inflation, assuming an annual pension adjustment of 2.00% as at July 1 of each year. Therefore, there were no material effects of reflecting the pension adjustment status as at December 31, 2025 (Dec. 31, 2024: EUR 0.2 million).

With respect to life expectancy, the Heubeck 2018 G mortality tables (generational tables) are taken as a basis in Germany. The BVG 2020 generational mortality tables are used in Switzerland. We use the "Prognosetafel AG2024" table in the Netherlands and the "CPM-2014Priv generational mortality table" in Canada.

Provisions for pensions and other post-employment benefits by country

in EUR m	Switzerland	Germany	Canada	Netherlands	Other countries	Dec. 31, 2025
Present value of the defined benefit obligation	116.7	119.1	51.9	47.8	24.0	359.5
Fair value of plan assets	-131.9	-26.4	-47.3	-44.4	-5.1	-255.1
Effect of the asset ceiling	15.2	-	-	-	-	15.2
Provisions for pensions and other post-employment benefits - net	-0.0	92.7	4.6	3.4	18.9	119.6
of which assets recognized	-	-	4.4	-	0.3	4.7
Provisions for pensions and other post-employment benefits recognized in the balance sheet	-0.0	92.7	9.0	3.4	19.2	124.3

3.66 Provisions for pensions and other post-employment benefits by country / Dec. 31, 2025

in EUR m	Switzerland	Germany	Canada	Netherlands	Other countries	Dec. 31, 2024
Present value of the defined benefit obligation	124.7	124.4	57.5	53.2	26.6	386.4
Fair value of plan assets	-134.7	-26.4	-52.2	-47.9	-5.5	-266.7
Effect of asset ceiling	10.0	-	-	-	-	10.0
Provisions for pensions and other post-employment benefits - net	0.0	98.0	5.3	5.3	21.1	129.7
of which assets recognized	-	-	5.4	-	-	5.4
Provisions for pensions and other post-employment benefits recognized in the balance sheet	0.0	98.0	10.7	5.3	21.1	135.1

3.67 Provisions for pensions and other post-employment benefits by country / Dec. 31, 2024

NOTES

Pension obligations, plan assets and provisions for pensions and other post-employment benefits recognized in the balance sheet changed as follows:

Change in the present value of the defined benefit obligations

in EUR m	2025	2024
Present value of pension obligations at the beginning of the period	386.4	379.8
Exchange rate differences	-4.0	-2.4
Business combinations	-	1.8
Transfers	-	-1.1
Utilized	-24.5	-15.4
Service cost		
Current service cost	9.3	10.3
Past service cost	-0.1	-0.1
Employee contributions	1.7	1.7
Interest expense on the present value of the obligation	10.6	10.8
Settlements	-	-0.1
Remeasurement components		
Change in economic assumptions	-20.7	2.5
Experience adjustments	0.8	-1.4
Present value of pension obligations at the end of the period	359.5	386.4

3.68 Change in the present value of the defined benefit obligations

The present value of pension obligations totaling EUR 359.5 million (Dec. 31, 2024: EUR 386.4 million) includes pension obligations for members of the Board of Management amounting to EUR 0.0 million (Dec. 31, 2024: EUR 0.0 million) and for former members of the Board of Management amounting to EUR 13.6 million (Dec. 31, 2024: EUR 8.0 million).

The decrease in pension obligations attributable to the change in economic assumptions of EUR -20.7 million is due mainly to the discount rates being higher than at December 31, 2024 in all currency areas. The rates can be found in the table "Actuarial parameters applied".

Change in the fair value of plan assets

in EUR m	2025	2024
Fair value of plan assets at the beginning of the period	266.7	266.9
Exchange rate differences	-2.7	-3.0
Transfers	-	-0.8
Utilized	-18.2	-10.1
Employer contributions	5.9	6.0
Administrative costs for plan assets	-0.4	-0.4
Employee contributions	1.7	1.7
Interest income on plan assets	6.2	6.7
Settlements	-	-0.2
Remeasurement components	-4.1	-0.1
Fair value of plan assets at the end of the period	255.1	266.7

3.69 Change in the fair value of plan assets

Change in the effect of the asset ceiling

in EUR m	2025	2024
Asset ceiling at the beginning of the period	10.0	14.7
Exchange rate differences	0.2	-0.2
Remeasurement components	5.0	-4.5
Asset ceiling at the end of the period	15.2	10.0

3.70 Change in the effect of the asset ceiling

The asset ceiling is the result of a surplus in the plans in Switzerland, which does not give rise to any economic benefits in the form of refunds or reductions in future contributions.

NOTES

Change in provisions for pensions and other post-employment benefits recognized in the balance sheet

in EUR m	2025	2024
Provisions for pensions and other post-employment benefits at the beginning of the period	129.8	127.6
Exchange rate differences	-1.1	0.4
Business combinations	-	1.8
Transfers	-	-0.3
Utilized	-6.3	-5.3
Employer contributions	-5.9	-6.0
Current service cost	9.3	10.3
Past service cost	-0.1	-0.1
Administrative costs for plan assets	0.4	0.4
Net interest expense	4.4	4.1
Settlements	-	0.1
Remeasurement components	-10.9	-3.3
Provisions for pensions and other post-employment benefits at the end of the period - net	119.6	129.7
of which assets recognized	4.7	5.4
Provisions for pensions and other post-employment benefits recognized in the balance sheet at the end of the period	124.3	135.1

3.71 Change in provisions for pensions and other post-employment benefits recognized in the balance sheet

Recognized provisions for pensions include EUR 8.5 million (Dec. 31, 2024: EUR 10.7 million) for the supplemental medical cost plan in Canada. Pension costs recognized in the income statement for obligations under defined benefit plans total EUR 14.0 million (2024: EUR 14.7 million). Net interest expense is presented within net finance costs. Current service cost and administrative costs for plan assets are presented within personnel expenses, where the amounts of past service cost and the amounts from settlements are also recognized.

The present values of the defined benefit obligations break down as follows into active members, former employees with vested rights and pensioners, split according to the payout method, resulting in the following weighted average duration of the defined benefit obligations:

in EUR m	2025	2024
Present value of the pension obligations funded by plan assets, of which:	257.0	277.8
Active members with lump-sum payment	15.0	15.5
Active members with monthly pension	81.1	97.8
Active members with option to choose	15.9	10.3
Former employees with vested rights to lump-sum payment	6.9	9.7
Former employees with vested rights to monthly pension	2.7	3.2
Former employees with vested rights with option to choose	5.3	14.9
Pensioners with monthly pension	130.1	126.4
Present value of the pension obligations not funded by plan assets, of which:	94.0	97.9
Active members with lump-sum payment	24.4	29.5
Active members with monthly pension	18.3	15.5
Former employees with vested rights to lump-sum payment	8.5	8.5
Former employees with vested rights to monthly pension	8.7	10.8
Pensioners with lump-sum payment	0.3	-
Pensioners with monthly pension	33.8	33.6
Medical cost plan	8.5	10.7
Present value of the pension obligations at the end of the period	359.5	386.4
Weighted average duration of the pension obligations in years	13	14

3.72 Breakdown of the present values of defined benefit obligations by members

The pension payments to be made by the company directly amount to EUR 6.3 million in 2025 (2024: EUR 5.3 million). From a present perspective, the cash outflow resulting from pension payments made by the company directly will remain at a level of EUR 10 to 11 million over the long term. The pension payments expected to be made by the company directly in 2026 total EUR 11.9 million.

NOTES

The fair value of the plan assets disaggregates into the following asset classes:

in EUR m	Switzerland	Germany	Canada	Netherlands	Other countries	Dec. 31, 2025
Shares	19.9	–	4.5	–	4.5	28.9
Fixed-interest securities	14.8	–	42.5	–	0.4	57.7
Insurance policies	97.2	26.4	–	44.4	0.2	168.2
Cash and cash equivalents	–	–	0.3	–	–	0.3
Fair value of plan assets	131.9	26.4	47.3	44.4	5.1	255.1

3.73 Fair value of the plan assets by asset class / Dec. 31, 2025

in EUR m	Switzerland	Germany	Canada	Netherlands	Other countries	Dec. 31, 2024
Shares	22.0	–	8.0	–	4.5	34.5
Fixed-interest securities	14.2	–	43.8	–	0.7	58.7
Insurance policies	98.6	26.4	–	47.9	0.2	173.1
Cash and cash equivalents	–	–	0.4	–	–	0.4
Fair value of plan assets	134.8	26.4	52.2	47.9	5.4	266.7

3.74 Fair value of the plan assets by asset class / Dec. 31, 2024

The plan assets are solely for fulfilling the defined benefit obligations and constitute protection for pension entitlements, which is a legal requirement in some countries and is voluntary in other countries.

The structure of the plan assets is reviewed at regular intervals. All assets, which, in Brenntag's case, mainly consist of insurance policies, are tailored long-term to the amount and maturity of the pension commitments, taking investment risks and statutory regulations governing the investment of retirement assets into account.

Owing to the composition of the plan assets, investment risk at Brenntag is limited to securities traded in active markets (shares and fixed-interest securities). This part (2025: 33.6% of plan assets; 2024: 34.9% of plan assets) is subject to market fluctuations. All other assets are not traded in an active market.

The annual payments made into the plan assets, which, according to the plan rules, consist almost exclusively of obligatory payments, amount to EUR 5.9 million (2024: EUR 6.0 million). From a present perspective, the cash outflow resulting from contributions made by the company will remain at a level of EUR 6 million to EUR 7 million over the long term. Payments into plan assets for financial year 2026 are expected to total EUR 6.5 million.

The sensitivity analysis of the present value of the defined benefit obligation takes into account in each case the change in an assumption and the resulting effects on the defined

benefit obligations, the other assumptions remaining the same as in the original calculation.

in EUR m	2025	2024
Discount rate		
Increase by 0.5 percentage points	–24.1	–27.2
Decrease by 0.5 percentage points	26.6	29.7
Expected salary trend		
Increase by 0.5 percentage points	4.3	4.5
Decrease by 0.5 percentage points	–4.1	–4.3
Expected pension trend		
Increase by 0.5 percentage points	9.8	11.3
Decrease by 0.5 percentage points	–6.3	–10.7
Medical cost trend		
Increase by 0.5 percentage points	0.6	0.7
Decrease by 0.5 percentage points	–0.5	–0.7

3.75 Sensitivity analysis of the present value of the defined benefit obligation

A 10% decrease in the mortality rates leads to an increase in life expectancy, depending on the individual age of each beneficiary. That means, for example, that the life expectancy of a 63-year-old employee as at December 31, 2025 increases by about one year. In order to determine the sensitivity of longevity, the mortality rates for the beneficiaries were reduced by 10%. If the mortality rates decreased by 10%, the present value of the defined benefit obligation would increase by EUR 8.4 million (2024: EUR 9.8 million).

NOTES

27.) Liabilities relating to acquisition of non-controlling interests

Liabilities relating to the acquisition of non-controlling interests break down as follows:

in EUR m	Dec. 31, 2025	Dec. 31, 2024
Liabilities relating to acquisition of non-controlling interests	40.8	62.4
Liabilities arising from limited partners' rights to repayment of contributions	1.6	2.1
Total	42.4	64.5

3.76 Liabilities relating to acquisition of non-controlling interests

Liabilities relating to the acquisition of non-controlling interests consist mainly of liabilities of EUR 19.1 million (Dec. 31, 2024: EUR 24.7 million) relating to the acquisition of the remaining 30% of the shares in Shanghai Saifu Chemical Development Co., Ltd., which was acquired in financial year 2023, and liabilities of EUR 18.2 million (Dec. 31, 2024: EUR 28.9 million) relating to the acquisition of the remaining 49% of the shares in Trychem FZE.

EUR 19.1 million (Dec. 31, 2024: EUR 24.7 million) of liabilities relating to the acquisition of non-controlling interests have been included in net investment hedge accounting. Exchange rate-related changes in the liabilities included in net investment hedge accounting are recognized within equity in the net investment hedge reserve. Of the liabilities relating to the acquisition of non-controlling interests, EUR 19.1 million (Dec. 31, 2024: EUR 0.0 million) are current.

The effects of the change in liabilities relating to the acquisition of non-controlling interests recognized in profit or loss are presented in Note 7.).

28.) Equity

Capital management

The aim of capital management at Brenntag is to optimally deploy the resources used to ensure the company's continued existence and, at the same time, to generate a reasonable return on capital – measured by ROCE – for the shareholders in line with market conditions.

In 2025, the Group generated ROCE of 12.9% (2024: 15.6%).

in EUR m	2025	2024
Operating EBITA	929.3	1,101.9
Average carrying amount of equity	4,491.9	4,499.1
Average carrying amount of financial liabilities and lease liabilities	3,403.2	3,211.1
Average carrying amount of cash and cash equivalents	- 681.9	- 648.4
ROCE¹⁾	12.9%	15.6%
ROCE¹⁾ after special items	11.4%	14.0%

3.77 Determination of ROCE

¹⁾ ROCE stands for return on capital employed and is defined as EBITA / (the average carrying amount of equity plus the average carrying amount of financial liabilities less the average carrying amount of cash and cash equivalents). The average carrying amounts in the denominator are defined for a particular year as the arithmetic average of the amounts at each of the following five dates: the beginning of the year, the end of each of the first, second and third quarters, and the end of the year.

Brenntag monitors the appropriateness of borrowings inter alia through the ratio of net financial liabilities to operating EBITDA (leverage). Brenntag generally considers leverage of approximately 2x to be appropriate. As at December 31, 2025, the ratio was exactly at the target level of 2.0x. The marginal year-on-year increase in leverage is attributable to two opposite effects: On the one hand, Brenntag posted lower operating EBITDA compared with the previous year. On the other, the negative effect of this decline on leverage was almost fully offset by lower net debt.

in EUR m	2025	2024
Non-current financial liabilities and lease liabilities	3,065.0	2,606.9
Current financial liabilities and lease liabilities	260.8	949.4
Cash and cash equivalents	- 797.9	- 763.3
Net financial liabilities	2,527.9	2,793.0
Operating EBITDA	1,287.5	1,456.8
Net financial liabilities / operating EBITDA	2.0x	1.9x

3.78 Net financial liabilities / operating EBITDA

NOTES

Subscribed capital

As at December 31, 2025, the subscribed capital of Brenntag SE totaled EUR 144,385,372. The share capital is divided into 144,385,372 no-par value registered shares, each with a notional value of EUR 1.00.

According to article 7, para. 3 of the Articles of Association of Brenntag SE, any right of shareholders to certification of their shares is excluded to the extent permitted by law and that certification is not required under the rules of any stock exchange on which the share is admitted to trading. The company is entitled to issue share certificates embodying several shares (consolidated certificates). Pursuant to Section 67, para. 2 of the German Stock Corporation Act (AktG) in conjunction with Article 9, para. 1 (c) (ii) of Council Regulation (EC) No 2157/2001 on the Statute for a European company ("the SE Regulation"), only those persons recorded in the company's share register will be recognized as shareholders of Brenntag SE. For purposes of recording the shares in the company's share register, shareholders are required to submit to Brenntag SE the number of shares held by them, and, in the case of individuals, their name, address and date of birth, or in the case of legal entities, their company name, business address and registered offices. All shares confer the same rights and obligations. At the Annual General Meeting, each share has one vote and accounts for the shareholders' proportionate share in the net income of Brenntag SE. Excepted from this rule are any treasury shares held by Brenntag SE that do not entitle Brenntag SE to any membership rights. Brenntag SE does not currently have any treasury shares. The shareholders' rights and obligations are governed by the provisions of the German Stock Corporation Act (which apply to an SE as a European stock corporation by way of the reference to other relevant provisions contained in Article 9 of the SE Regulation), in particular by Sections 12, 53a ff., 118 ff. and 186 of the German Stock Corporation Act.

Additional paid-in capital

The additional paid-in capital amounted to EUR 755.2 million as at December 31, 2025 (Dec. 31, 2024: EUR 755.2 million).

Retained earnings

Retained earnings include cumulative profit after tax and the remeasurement component of the defined benefit pension plans including deferred taxes. Transactions with owners are also recognized here. The latter are effects of share purchases and sales which have no influence on existing control and are recognized in retained earnings.

As proposed by the Board of Management and the Supervisory Board, the Annual General Meeting of Brenntag SE on May 22, 2025 passed a resolution to pay a dividend of EUR 303,209,281.20 (2024: EUR 303,209,281.20). Based on 144.4 million shares, that is a dividend of EUR 2.10 (2024: EUR 2.10) per no-par value share entitled to a dividend.

The net income of Brenntag SE as at December 31, 2025 was EUR 200,716,766.75. After allowing for a withdrawal of EUR 73,615,440.05 from retained earnings, the distributable profit is EUR 274,332,206.80. At the Annual General Meeting on May 20, 2026, the Board of Management and the Supervisory Board will propose that the distributable profit of Brenntag SE amounting to EUR 274,332,206.80 be used to pay a dividend of EUR 1.90 per no-par value share entitled to a dividend.

Other components of equity / non-controlling interests

Exchange rate differences include the inflation effect on equity of EUR 8.3 million in financial year 2025 (2024: EUR 9.1 million) arising on the application of IAS 29 (hyperinflation) in Türkiye.

Other components of equity comprise the cumulative gain / loss from exchange rate differences, the net investment hedge reserve and the cash flow hedge reserve.

The cumulative gain / loss from exchange rate differences contains the differences from the translation of the financial statements of foreign companies into the Group currency (euro), which are recognized in other comprehensive income. The foreign exchange losses of EUR 378.9 million recognized here in financial year 2025 (2024: foreign exchange gains of EUR 161.5 million) resulted primarily from the depreciation of the U.S. dollar against the euro.

Exchange rate differences from liabilities included in net investment hedge accounting are recognized within equity in the net investment hedge reserve.

The cash flow hedge reserve contains the effective portion of the cumulative fair value changes in derivative financial instruments included in cash flow hedge accounting.

NOTES

Non-controlling interests comprise the shares of non-Group shareholders in the equity of consolidated entities. Non-controlling interests changed as follows:

in EUR m	Subscribed capital, retained earnings and additional paid-in capital	Exchange rate differences	Non-controlling interests
Dec. 31, 2023	53.8	-1.8	52.0
Dividends	-1.8	-	-1.8
Business combinations	-2.4	-	-2.4
Transactions with owners	-21.8	1.3	-20.5
Profit after tax	7.5	-	7.5
Other comprehensive income, net of tax	-	0.5	0.5
Total comprehensive income for the period	7.5	0.5	8.0
Dec. 31, 2024	35.3	-	35.3
Dividends	-1.9	-	-1.9
Profit after tax	5.1	-	5.1
Other comprehensive income, net of tax	-	-4.0	-4.0
Total comprehensive income for the period	5.1	-4.0	1.1
Dec. 31, 2025	38.5	-4.0	34.5

3.79 Change in non-controlling interests

Non-controlling interests consist mainly of non-controlling interests in Shanghai Saifu Chemical Development Co., Ltd (30%). Non-controlling interests decreased by EUR 20.5 million in the previous year due to the acquisition of the remaining shares in Zhongbai Xingye (33%) at the end of financial year 2024.

The assets, liabilities, sales and profit after tax (100%) are shown below:

in EUR m	Saifu
Assets	
Current assets	35.8
Non-current assets	54.8
Liabilities	
Current liabilities	8.9
Non-current liabilities	7.6
Net assets	74.1
Income statement	
Sales	69.2
Profit after tax	1.3

3.80 Subsidiaries with non-controlling interests / 2025

in EUR m	Saifu
Assets	
Current assets	34.7
Non-current assets	60.3
Liabilities	
Current liabilities	7.4
Non-current liabilities	8.6
Net assets	79.0
Income statement	
Sales	63.4
Profit after tax	2.3

3.81 Subsidiaries with non-controlling interests / 2024

Powers of the Board of Management to issue or repurchase shares

Authorization to create authorized capital

By resolution of the Annual General Meeting on June 9, 2022, the Board of Management was authorized, with the approval of the Supervisory Board, to increase the share capital of Brenntag SE on one or more occasions in the period to June 8, 2027 by a total of up to EUR 35,000,000 by issuing up to 35,000,000 new registered ordinary shares in return for cash contributions or contributions in kind. The shareholders shall generally be granted a subscription right. However, in certain cases the Board of Management is authorized, with the approval of the Supervisory Board, to exclude the shareholders' statutory subscription rights for one or more capital increases under the authorized capital. This shall apply, for example, if the capital increase is effected against cash contributions and the issue price of the new shares is not significantly lower than the stock market price of the shares of the same class and carrying the same rights already traded on the stock market at the time of final determination of the issue price within the meaning of Section 203, para. 1 and para. 2 and Section 186, para. 3, sentence 4 of the German Stock Corporation Act and the total pro rata amount of registered share capital represented by the new shares issued in accordance with this paragraph with exclusion of subscription rights pursuant to Section 186, para. 3, sentence 4 of the German Stock Corporation Act is not less than 10% of the registered share capital (simplified exclusion of subscription rights). The 10% threshold will be determined based on the share capital at the time the authorization becomes effective. If the share capital is lower at the time this authorization is exercised, that lower amount will apply.

The Board of Management shall decide on the further content of the share rights and the conditions of the issuance of shares with the approval of the Supervisory Board.

Authorization to acquire and use treasury shares in accordance with Section 71, para. 1, no. 8 of the German Stock Corporation Act

By resolution of the Annual General Meeting on May 23, 2024, the Board of Management was authorized, with the approval of the Supervisory Board, to acquire treasury shares up to a total of 10% of the share capital. The shares acquired on the basis of this authorization, together with other shares in the company which Brenntag SE has already acquired and still holds, may at no time account for more than 10% of the respective registered share capital. The authorization may be exercised in whole or in part, once or several times. It took effect at the close of the Annual General Meeting on May 23, 2024 and shall be valid until May 22, 2029. If the shares are purchased on the stock exchange or through a multilateral trading facility within the meaning of Section 2, para. 6 of the German Stock Exchange Act (MTF), the purchase price (excluding incidental costs) may not be more than 10% higher or lower than the arithmetic mean of the share prices (closing auction prices of Brenntag SE shares in Xetra trading or a comparable successor system) on the Frankfurt Stock Exchange on the last five trading days prior to the purchase or the entering into an obligation to purchase. In the case of acquisition by means of a public purchase offer, Brenntag SE may either publish a formal offer or issue a public invitation to submit offers for sale. The purchase price offered (excluding incidental costs) or the limits of the purchase price range per share determined by Brenntag SE (excluding incidental costs) may not exceed or fall below the arithmetic mean of the share prices on the Frankfurt Stock Exchange on the last five trading days prior to the publication of the purchase offer or the invitation to submit offers by more than 10%. The authorization may be exercised for any purpose permitted by law. The Board of Management was authorized, with the approval of the Supervisory Board, to cancel the treasury shares acquired on the basis of the authorization pursuant to Section 71, para. 1, no. 8 of the German Stock Corporation Act without any further resolution by the Annual General Meeting. The cancellation may be limited to a portion of the shares acquired. The authorization to cancel shares may be exercised more than once. The cancellation of shares generally leads to a reduction in registered share capital. In derogation of this, the Board of Management may determine that the registered share capital shall remain unchanged and that instead the cancellation shall increase the proportion of the registered share capital represented by the remaining shares in accordance with Section 8, para. 3 of the German Stock Corporation Act. In this case, the Board of Management is authorized to adjust the indication of the corresponding number in the Articles of Association. Treasury shares may, under certain circumstances, also be used subject to exclusion of the shareholders' subscription rights existing in principle and in particular by way of simplified exclusion of subscription rights as specified above.

Authorization to issue bonds and to create conditional capital

By resolution of the Annual General Meeting on June 9, 2022, the Board of Management was authorized ("Authorization 2022"), with the approval of the Supervisory Board, to issue holder or registered convertible bonds or bonds with warrants as well as profit participation rights or profit participating bonds with option or conversion rights on one or more occasions up to June 8, 2027 for a total nominal amount of up to EUR 2,000,000,000 with or without limited term ("Bonds") and to grant the holders or creditors of the Bonds option or conversion rights to up to 15,450,000 new Brenntag SE shares with a pro rata total amount of the registered share capital of up to EUR 15,450,000 in accordance with the respective option or convertible bond conditions or profit participation right or participating bond conditions ("Conditions") to be determined by the Board of Management. In order to grant shares to the holders or creditors of Bonds, the registered share capital was conditionally increased at the Annual General Meeting on June 9, 2022 by up to 15,450,000 no-par value registered shares conferring profit-sharing rights from the beginning of the financial year in which they were issued ("Conditional Capital 2022"); this equates to an increase in the registered share capital of up to EUR 15,450,000. The Bonds may, in addition to euros, also be issued in a foreign legal currency, subject to a limit of the corresponding equivalent value in euros, and by companies dependent on Brenntag SE or in which it holds a majority interest; in this case, the Board of Management was authorized, with the approval of the Supervisory Board, to assume the guarantee for the Bonds on behalf of Brenntag SE and to grant the holders of such Bonds option or conversion rights to Brenntag SE shares and to make other declarations and take other actions necessary for a successful issue. The issues of Bonds may be divided into partial Bonds each having equal rights. Bonds may only be issued against contribution in kind, provided that the value of the contribution in kind corresponds to the issue price and that this price is not significantly lower than the theoretical market value of the Bonds determined in accordance with recognized methods of financial mathematics.

The Board of Management is authorized, under certain circumstances and with the approval of the Supervisory Board, to exclude shareholders' subscription rights to the Bonds. However, with regard to the exclusion of subscription rights against cash payment, this authorization shall apply only provided that the shares issued to fulfil the option or conversion rights and / or in the case of fulfilment of the conversion obligation represent no more than 10% of the registered share capital (simplified exclusion of subscription rights). The 10% threshold will be determined based on the share capital at the time the authorization becomes effective. If the share capital is lower at the time this authorization is exercised, that lower amount will apply.

When convertible bonds, profit participation rights or profit participating bonds with conversion rights are issued, the holders are granted the right to exchange their Bonds for new Brenntag SE shares in accordance with the more detailed Conditions.

When bonds with warrants, profit participation rights or profit participating bonds with option rights are issued, one or more warrants shall be attached to each partial bond or each profit participation right or each participating bond, entitling the holder to subscribe for Brenntag SE shares in accordance with the more detailed Conditions.

New shares are issued at the option or conversion price to be set in accordance with the aforementioned resolution granting authorization.

NOTES

29.) Consolidated cash flow statement disclosures

Net cash provided by operating activities of EUR 966.7 million (2024: EUR 906.6 million) was influenced by the decrease in working capital of EUR 121.6 million (2024: increase of EUR 45.8 million).

Of the net cash of EUR 410.2 million used in investing activities (2024: EUR 749.0 million), EUR 293.0 million comprised payments to acquire intangible assets and property, plant and equipment. Payments to acquire consolidated subsidiaries and other business units, in the amount of EUR 155.2 million, consisted mainly of payments to acquire all shares in Chem Tech Services, Inc., based in Levelland, Texas, U.S., and Química Delta S.A. de C.V. based in Teoloyucan, Mexico, which had already been acquired in the previous year.

Proceeds from the disposal of consolidated subsidiaries and other business units mainly include the proceeds from the divestment of Raj Petro. The assets and liabilities of Raj Petro were presented as assets held for sale and liabilities associated with those assets as at December 31, 2024.

The net cash outflow in 2025 resulting from business combinations has been determined as follows:

in EUR m	
Purchase price	98.4
Less cash and cash equivalents acquired	- 2.1
Plus purchase price payments related to prior-year acquisitions	58.9
Payments to acquire consolidated subsidiaries and other business units	155.2

3.82 Reconciliation of acquisition costs to payments to acquire consolidated subsidiaries and other business units

Net cash used in financing activities amounted to EUR 489.1 million (2024: net cash provided by financing activities of EUR 23.0 million). In addition to the EUR 303.2 million dividend payment to Brenntag shareholders, the main drivers were bank loans taken out and repaid as well as lease liabilities repaid. The net cash inflow and outflow arising on the repayment of the Bond 2025 and the placement of the Bond 2031, each in the amount of EUR 600 million, largely offset one another.

NOTES

Financial liabilities changed as follows:

in EUR m	Dec. 31, 2024	Net cash used in financing activities	Non-cash changes in lease liabilities	Business combina- tions in accordance with IFRS 3	Exchange rate differences	Other	Dec. 31, 2025
Other liabilities to banks	132.8	-17.5	-	10.2	-15.5	3.6	113.6
Promissory notes (Schuldschein)	508.1	-	-	-	-20.1	-1.1	486.9
Bond 2025	601.1	-595.4	-	-	-	-5.7	-
Bond 2028	510.4	-	-	-	-	0.7	511.1
Bond 2029	498.4	-	-	-	-	0.6	499.0
Bond 2031	-	596.6	-	-	-	2.8	599.4
Bond 2032	507.8	-	-	-	-	0.8	508.6
Derivative financial instruments	44.4	-	-	-	-0.2	-35.6	8.6
Other financial liabilities	136.0	-16.9	-	-54.7	-4.1	-3.1	57.2
Financial liabilities	2,939.0	-33.2	-	-44.5	-39.9	-37.0	2,784.4
Lease liabilities	617.3	-149.1	111.4	3.1	-38.6	-2.7	541.4
Total	3,556.3	-182.3	111.4	-41.4	-78.5	-39.7	3,325.8
Dividends paid to Brenntag shareholders		-303.2					
Profits distributed to non-controlling interests		-3.6					
Net cash used in financing activities		-489.1					

3.83 Change in financial liabilities in 2025

NOTES

in EUR m	Dec. 31, 2023	Net cash provided by financing activities	Recog- nized in equity	Non-cash changes in lease liabilities	Business combina- tions in accor- dance with IFRS 3	Exchange rate differ- ences	Other	Dec. 31, 2024
Liabilities under syndicated loan	45.6	- 50.0	-	-	-	-	4.4	0.0
Other liabilities to banks	182.1	0.1	-	-	-	-3.5	-45.9	132.8
Liabilities under promissory notes	622.5	- 124.5	-	-	-	11.5	-1.4	508.1
Bond 2025	600.1	-	-	-	-	-	1.0	601.1
Bond 2028	-	498.9	-	-	-	-	11.5	510.4
Bond 2029	498.0	-	-	-	-	-	0.4	498.4
Bond 2032	-	496.0	-	-	-	-	11.8	507.8
Liabilities relating to acquisition of treasury shares	250.0	- 250.1	0.1	-	-	-	-	-
Derivative financial instruments	29.0	-	-	-	-	-	15.4	44.4
Other financial liabilities	86.6	- 11.2	-	-	60.1	-3.5	4.0	136.0
Financial liabilities	2,313.9	559.2	0.1	-	60.1	4.5	1.2	2,939.0
Lease liabilities	449.8	- 152.8	-	201.3	107.1	13.0	- 1.1	617.3
Total	2,763.7	406.4	0.1	201.3	167.2	17.5	0.1	3,556.3
Dividends paid to Brenntag shareholders		- 303.2						
Profits distributed to non-controlling interests		- 4.1						
Payments to acquire non-controlling interests		- 76.1						
Net cash provided by financing activities		23.0						

3.84 Change in financial liabilities in 2024

30.) Other financial obligations and contingent liabilities

As at December 31, 2025, purchase commitments in respect of property, plant and equipment amounted to EUR 7.4 million (Dec. 31, 2024: EUR 3.1 million) and, as in the previous year, had a remaining term of one year or less. Information on lease obligations as at December 31, 2025 can be found in the sections "Leases" and "Reporting of financial instruments".

In connection with the elimination of environmental damage, as at December 31, 2025, there were contingent liabilities with a fair value of EUR 5.6 million (Dec. 31, 2024: EUR 6.4 million).

31.) Legal proceedings and disputes

Brenntag SE and individual subsidiaries have been named as defendants in various legal actions and proceedings arising in connection with their activities as a global group. In some cases, Brenntag is also the subject of investigations by the authorities. Brenntag cooperates with the relevant authorities and, where appropriate, conducts internal investigations regarding alleged wrongdoings with the assistance of in-house and external counsel.

NOTES

The decision issued by the French Competition Authority in 2013 in relation to the allocation of customers and coordination of prices was set aside by a court of appeal due to procedural errors at the request of the French subsidiary BRENNTAG SA in February 2017. In December 2020, the court imposed a fine of EUR 47 million, which was payable immediately. BRENNTAG SA lodged an appeal against the decision, whereupon the paid fine was reimbursed in November 2023 and the proceedings referred back by the Cour de cassation (Court of cassation) for a further decision. With further steps expected to be taken by the French authorities responsible, a provision was recognized in the amount of the EUR 47 million reimbursement. In December 2025, after more than 20 years of investigation, the French Competition Authority dismissed complaints concerning whether BRENNTAG SA made illegal use of its market position. The decision is not yet final and non-appealable, and can be contested by the original complainants during the first quarter of 2026. Two civil liability actions that had been filed in connection with these investigations were rejected on the basis of this decision.

Given the number of legal disputes and other proceedings that Brenntag is involved in, it is possible that a ruling may be made against Brenntag in some of these proceedings. The company contests actions and proceedings where it considers it appropriate. Provisions are established for ongoing legal disputes on the basis of the estimated risk and, if necessary, with the help of external consultants. Predicting the outcome of such matters, particularly in cases in which claimants seek indeterminate compensation, entails considerable uncertainties. Any adverse decisions rendered in such cases could have a substantial impact on Brenntag's net assets, financial position and results of operations for a reporting period. However, Brenntag currently does not expect its net assets, financial position and results of operations to be materially affected.

In connection with the sale of talc and similar products, North American subsidiaries of the Brenntag Group are involved in court and out-of-court proceedings with end consumers and other parties. The resulting legal risks pertain in particular to product liability. In the lawsuits, the plaintiffs claim to have suffered damage to health as a result of contact with the products sold. In these proceedings, Brenntag has reached settlement agreements with some of the plaintiffs and their attorneys to resolve the legal disputes. In addition, compensation claims arising from product liability are being asserted against the Group in relation to the talc business of a U.S. company that was acquired as part of corporate transactions. Moreover, there are legal risks associated with potential, as-yet unknown cases, which the executive directors have commissioned an external assessor to investigate. The number of pending cases was approaching the prior-year level. Taking into account legal advisory costs, the expense amounted to EUR 32.2 million in financial year 2025. The underlying cases are continuously monitored and the provisions adjusted as and when necessary. In addition, Brenntag has taken measures to mitigate the risk and is asserting claims for compensation from third parties. Nevertheless, the possibility that these legal disputes will result in further significant adverse effects on the results of operations cannot be ruled out.

As a global company, Brenntag has to comply with the country-specific tax laws and regulations in each jurisdiction. Tax exposures could result in particular from current and future tax audits of German and foreign subsidiaries. We counter these risks by continuously improving the tax compliance management system in accordance with the criteria in auditing standard IDW PS 980 and gradually rolling out this system to other Group companies in Germany and abroad. Tax exposures are generally reflected in the balance sheet by recognizing provisions. We currently see nothing to indicate that we should expect significant new findings from the tax authorities or customs authorities that could lead to additional tax expenses.

NOTES

32.) Reporting of financial instruments

Carrying amounts and fair values by measurement category

The financial assets recognized in the balance sheet were allocated to the IFRS 9 measurement categories as follows:

in EUR m	Dec. 31, 2025			
Classes of financial assets:	At amortized cost	FVTPL ¹⁾	Total carrying amount	Fair value
Cash and cash equivalents	797.9	-	797.9	797.9
Trade receivables	2,039.9	-	2,039.9	2,039.9
Other receivables	105.0	-	105.0	105.0
Other financial assets	18.2	12.5	30.7	30.7
Total	2,961.0	12.5	2,973.5	2,973.5

3.85 Classification of financial assets by measurement category / Dec. 31, 2025

¹⁾ Financial assets at fair value through profit or loss.

in EUR m	Dec. 31, 2024			
Classes of financial assets:	At amortized cost	FVTPL ¹⁾	Total carrying amount	Fair value
Cash and cash equivalents	763.3	-	763.3	763.3
Trade receivables	2,282.5	-	2,282.5	2,282.5
Other receivables	101.0	-	101.0	101.0
Other financial assets	20.8	21.2	42.0	42.0
Total	3,167.6	21.2	3,188.8	3,188.8

3.86 Classification of financial assets by measurement category / Dec. 31, 2024

¹⁾ Financial assets at fair value through profit or loss.

The majority of the financial assets measured at amortized cost have remaining terms of one year or less. Their carrying amounts at the reporting date approximate their fair values.

Of the other receivables recognized in the balance sheet, EUR 190.4 million (Dec. 31, 2024: EUR 188.7 million) are excluded from the scope of IFRS 7. They are mainly receivables from value-added tax and other taxes, prepaid expenses and prepayments.

NOTES

The classification and measurement of the financial liabilities recognized in the balance sheet are shown in the table below:

in EUR m

Dec. 31, 2025

Classes of financial liabilities:	At amortized cost	FVTPL ¹⁾	Total carrying amount	Fair value
Trade payables	1,498.3	-	1,498.3	1,498.3
Other liabilities	215.4	-	215.4	215.4
Liabilities relating to acquisition of non-controlling interests	42.4	-	42.4	42.7
Financial liabilities	2,773.9	10.5	2,784.4	2,726.0
Total	4,530.0	10.5	4,540.5	4,482.4

3.87 Classification of financial liabilities by measurement category / Dec. 31, 2025

¹⁾ Financial liabilities at fair value through profit or loss.

in EUR m

Dec. 31, 2024

Classes of financial liabilities:	At amortized cost	FVTPL ¹⁾	Total carrying amount	Fair value
Trade payables	1,661.6	-	1,661.6	1,661.6
Other liabilities	254.0	-	254.0	254.0
Liabilities relating to acquisition of non-controlling interests	64.5	-	64.5	70.3
Financial liabilities	2,893.1	45.9	2,939.0	2,874.7
Total	4,873.2	45.9	4,919.1	4,860.6

3.88 Classification of financial liabilities by measurement category / Dec. 31, 2024

¹⁾ Financial liabilities at fair value through profit or loss.

The majority of the trade payables and other liabilities measured at amortized cost have remaining terms of less than one year. Their carrying amounts at the reporting date therefore approximate their fair values. The fair values of the bonds measured at amortized cost under financial liabilities were determined using quoted or market prices in an active market (Level 1 of the fair value hierarchy). The fair values of the other financial liabilities measured at amortized cost were determined using the discounted cash flow method on the basis of inputs observable on the market (Level 2 of the fair value hierarchy). The fair values of the synthetic liabilities relating to the acquisition of non-controlling interests carried at amortized cost were determined on the basis of recognized company valuation models. The company valuation models are based on cash flow plans (Level 3 of the fair value hierarchy). The fair values of foreign exchange forwards and foreign exchange swaps are determined by comparing forward rates and discounted to present value (Level 2 of the fair value hierarchy).

The fair value of the cross-currency interest rate swaps is determined in two steps. First, the expected future cash flows are discounted using maturity-matched market interest rates according to the currency. In the second step, the cash flows discounted in foreign currency (U.S. dollar) are then translated into the reporting currency (EUR) at market exchange rates (Level 2 of the fair value hierarchy).

The fair value of a call option to acquire non-controlling interests is calculated from the intrinsic value and the time value of the option. The intrinsic value of the call option is calculated as the difference between the enterprise value and the strike price. The time value reflects the optionality of movements in the future strike price and the future enterprise value of the non-controlling interests. This is illustrated by way of a Monte Carlo simulation and the fair value of the option then determined (Level 3 of the fair value hierarchy).

Of the other liabilities recognized in the balance sheet, EUR 280.7 million (Dec. 31, 2024: EUR 315.7 million) are excluded from the scope of IFRS 7. They are mainly liabilities to employees, liabilities from value-added tax and other taxes, as well as deferred income.

NOTES

The allocation of the financial assets and liabilities recognized in the balance sheet at fair value to the levels of the IFRS 13 fair value hierarchy is shown in the table below:

in EUR m				
Hierarchy level	Level 1	Level 2	Level 3	Dec. 31, 2025
Financial assets at fair value through profit or loss	1.4	1.1	10.0	12.5
Financial liabilities at fair value through profit or loss	-	8.6	1.9	10.5

3.89 Financial instruments according to fair value hierarchy / Dec. 31, 2025

in EUR m				
Hierarchy level	Level 1	Level 2	Level 3	Dec. 31, 2024
Financial assets at fair value through profit or loss	1.4	5.5	14.3	21.2
Financial liabilities at fair value through profit or loss	-	44.5	1.4	45.9

3.90 Financial instruments according to fair value hierarchy / Dec. 31, 2024

Liabilities resulting from contingent consideration arrangements of EUR 1.9 million (Dec. 31, 2024: EUR 1.4 million) relate to liabilities for contingent purchase prices payable in business combinations. The amount of the contingent purchase price component required to be recognized at fair value is contingent on the earnings achieved by the acquired business and is limited in both the lower (EUR 0.0 million) and the upper (EUR 10.6 million) range.

The call option to acquire non-controlling interests was recognized in the amount of EUR 10.0 million (Dec. 31, 2024: EUR 14.3 million) on the basis of the mean of the Monte Carlo simulations. The minimum is EUR 0.0 million (Dec. 31, 2024: EUR 0.0 million) and the maximum EUR 34.6 million (Dec. 31, 2024: EUR 51.8 million).

Liabilities resulting from contingent consideration arrangements changed as follows:

in EUR m		
	2025	2024
Jan. 1	1.4	5.4
Exchange rate differences	0.5	-0.1
Business combinations	-	1.4
Purchase price payments	-	-5.3
Dec. 31	1.9	1.4

3.91 Change in liabilities resulting from contingent consideration arrangements

NOTES

The net gains / losses from financial assets and liabilities broken down into measurement categories are as follows:

in EUR m		2025							
Measurement category:	Interest		Change in liabilities relating to acquisition of non-controlling interests and call option recognized in profit or loss	At fair value		Currency translation		Impairments, net	Net gain / loss
	Income	Expense		Gains	Losses	Gains	Losses		
Financial assets measured at amortized cost	14.6	-	-	-	-	89.8	-107.6	-6.3	-9.5
Financial liabilities measured at amortized cost	-	-109.2	17.6	-	-	51.6	-55.5	-	-95.5
FVTPL ¹⁾	-	-6.4	-4.3	66.0	-45.6	-	-	-	9.7
Total	14.6	-115.6	13.3	66.0	-45.6	141.4	-163.1	-6.3	-95.3

3.92 Net gains / losses from financial assets and liabilities / 2025

¹⁾ Financial assets and liabilities at fair value through profit or loss.

in EUR m		2024							
Measurement category:	Interest		Change in liabilities relating to acquisition of non-controlling interests and call option recognized in profit or loss	At fair value		Currency translation		Impairments, net	Net gain / loss
	Income	Expense		Gains	Losses	Gains	Losses		
Financial assets measured at amortized cost	19.0	-	-	-	-	125.2	-108.2	-1.6	34.4
Financial liabilities measured at amortized cost	-	-110.8	-21.0	-	-	64.0	-107.1	-	-174.9
FVTPL ¹⁾	-	-7.3	7.0	51.5	-41.1	-	-	-	10.1
Total	19.0	-118.1	-14.0	51.5	-41.1	189.2	-215.3	-1.6	-130.4

3.93 Net gains / losses from financial assets and liabilities / 2024

¹⁾ Financial assets and liabilities at fair value through profit or loss.

NOTES

Of the interest expense on liabilities to third parties contained in interest expense, EUR 1.9 million (2024: EUR 2.0 million) is interest expense which is not part of the effective interest on financial liabilities measured at amortized cost.

With the exception of valuation allowances on trade receivables and other receivables, net gains and losses on subsequent measurement are presented within net finance costs.

Offsetting of financial assets and liabilities

The gross amounts of financial assets and liabilities are offset on the basis of netting arrangements in the balance sheet as follows or they are subject to enforceable master netting arrangements or similar agreements that do not meet the requirements for offsetting in the balance sheet:

in EUR m	Gross amounts of financial assets and liabilities	Offsetting	Carrying amounts in the balance sheet	Enforceable master netting arrangements and similar arrangements	Dec. 31, 2025 Net amount
Trade receivables	2,041.8	-1.9	2,039.9	-2.4	2,037.5
Other financial assets	30.7	-	30.7	-0.8	29.9
Trade payables	1,500.2	-1.9	1,498.3	-2.1	1,496.2
Other liabilities	496.1	-	496.1	-0.3	495.8
Financial liabilities	2,784.4	-	2,784.4	-0.8	2,783.6

3.94 Offsetting of financial assets and liabilities / Dec. 31, 2025

in EUR m	Gross amounts of financial assets and liabilities	Offsetting	Carrying amounts in the balance sheet	Enforceable master netting arrangements and similar arrangements	Dec. 31, 2024 Net amount
Trade receivables	2,290.8	-8.3	2,282.5	-3.3	2,279.2
Other financial assets	42.2	-0.2	42.0	-0.8	41.2
Trade payables	1,665.8	-4.2	1,661.6	-3.3	1,658.3
Other liabilities	574.0	-4.3	569.7	-	569.7
Financial liabilities	2,939.0	-	2,939.0	-0.8	2,938.2

3.95 Offsetting of financial assets and liabilities / Dec. 31, 2024

NOTES

Nature and extent of risks arising from financial instruments

According to IFRS 7, risks arising from financial instruments can typically be divided into currency risk, interest rate risk, credit risk and liquidity risk.

Currency risk

Currency risks arise particularly when monetary items or contracted future transactions are in a currency other than the functional currency of a company. Overall, this results in a surplus of (partly intra-Group) monetary assets over liabilities of EUR 374.3 million as at December 31, 2025 (Dec. 31, 2024: EUR 431.5 million). Foreign exchange forwards, foreign exchange swaps and cross-currency interest rate swaps are used as hedging instruments. The notional amount of the hedges used was EUR – 307.0 million as at December 31, 2025 (Dec. 31, 2024: EUR – 350.5 million). The foreign exchange forwards and foreign exchange swaps used have maturities of less than one year and are not included in hedge accounting.

If the euro had been worth 10% more or less against all currencies as at December 31, 2025, translation of monetary items in foreign currency into the Group currency, the euro, allowing for the foreign exchange forward transactions and foreign exchange swaps still open on December 31, 2025, would have resulted in the following changes in net finance costs:

	2025		2024	
	+10%	-10%	+10%	-10%
in EUR m				
USD	-6.3	7.7	-5.1	6.3
GBP	-0.9	1.1	0.4	-0.5
PLN	1.9	-2.3	-1.5	1.8
Other currencies	-1.0	1.2	1.1	-1.4
Total	-6.3	7.7	-5.1	6.2

3.96 Sensitivity analysis currency risk

The liability relating to the acquisition of non-controlling interests in Saifu is included in a net investment hedge in accordance with IFRS 9.6.5.2 (c). The hedged item is the share of the net assets of Saifu attributable to Brenntag. Exchange rate-related changes in the liabilities are recognized within equity in the net investment hedge reserve. An economic relationship exists in each case, as the hedging instrument and the hedged item have values that move in the opposite direction because of a change in the hedged currency risk. Any increase (decrease) in the Chinese yuan renminbi (CNY) against the euro leads to an increase (decrease) in the net assets and an increase (decrease) in the CNY-denominated liabilities. The effectiveness of the hedging relationships was

determined at inception of the hedging relationships and is regularly determined on a retrospective basis to ensure that there is an economic relationship between the hedged item and the hedging instrument. There was no hedge ineffectiveness as at December 31, 2025. If the euro had been worth 10% more or less against the Chinese yuan renminbi (CNY) as at December 31, 2025, the net investment hedge reserve would have increased by EUR 1.9 million (Dec. 31, 2024: EUR 2.5 million) or decreased by EUR 1.9 million (Dec. 31, 2024: EUR 2.5 million).

Net investment hedges at Dec. 31, 2025	Saifu
Carrying amount of the portion of the liability relating to the acquisition of non-controlling interests included in the net investment hedge in EUR m	19.1
Carrying amount of the portion of the liability relating to the acquisition of non-controlling interests included in the net investment hedge in local currency (CNY m)	157.4
Hedge ratio	1:1
Hedge rate EUR / CNY	7.5833
Change in carrying amount (in net investment hedge reserve)	1.9
Change in value of hedged item used to determine hedge effectiveness	-1.9

3.97 Net investment hedges Dec. 31, 2025

Net investment hedges at Dec. 31, 2024	Saifu
Carrying amount of the portion of the liability relating to the acquisition of non-controlling interests included in the net investment hedge in EUR m	24.7
Carrying amount of the portion of the liability relating to the acquisition of non-controlling interests included in the net investment hedge in local currency (CNY m)	187.0
Hedge ratio	1:1
Hedge rate EUR / CNY	7.8509
Change in carrying amount (in net investment hedge reserve)	-0.9
Change in value of hedged item used to determine hedge effectiveness	0.9

3.98 Net investment hedges Dec. 31, 2024

In October 2021, Brenntag Finance B.V., Amsterdam, Netherlands, issued a EUR 500 million bond (Bond 2029). Brenntag Finance B.V. swapped most of the proceeds from the Bond 2029 for U.S. dollars by way of cross-currency interest rate swaps and passed them on to Brenntag North America, Inc., Reading, U.S., as an intra-Group loan. The intra-Group loan and the cross-currency interest rate swaps were included in cash flow hedge accounting so as to limit currency and interest rate risk in the consolidated financial statements.

NOTES

Critical terms matching is used to assess the effectiveness of the hedging relationship. The economic relationship between hedged items and hedging instruments results from closely aligned terms. The cross-currency basis is not part of the hedging relationship and is recognized in a separate component of equity as a reserve for costs of hedging. The ineffective portions of the hedging relationship are determined using the hypothetical derivative method. They result mainly from

counterparty risk and, if necessary, are recognized in profit or loss within net interest expense. In financial year 2025, this did not give rise to any effects in profit or loss (2024: no effects in profit or loss).

The following table shows the changes in equity resulting from the hedging relationship:

in EUR m	Cash flow hedge reserve	Reserve for costs of hedging	Total	Deferred tax	Total cash flow hedge reserve
Dec. 31, 2023	-4.5	4.3	-0.2	-	-0.2
Changes in the fair value of hedging instruments and hedging costs	-20.3	-3.6	-23.9	-	-23.9
Reclassification to profit or loss	36.9	-0.8	36.1	-	36.1
Deferred tax relating to those items	-	-	-	-3.1	-3.1
Dec. 31, 2024	12.1	-0.1	12.0	-3.1	8.9
Changes in the fair value of hedging instruments and hedging costs	30.1	1.2	31.3	-	31.3
Reclassification to profit or loss	-48.5	-0.8	-49.3	-	-49.3
Deferred tax relating to those items	-	-	-	4.6	4.6
Dec. 31, 2025	-6.3	0.3	-6.0	1.5	-4.5

3.99 Change in cash flow hedge reserve

One significant component in the fair value measurement of the cross-currency interest rate swaps is the exchange rate of the underlying currencies (EUR/USD). As the exchange rate component – moving in the opposite direction to the hedged item – is designated as part of the hedging relationship, ceteris paribus, an assumed change in the exchange rate leads only to a change in the cash flow hedge reserve. If the euro had been worth 10% more or less against the U.S. dollar as at December 31, 2025, the cash flow hedge reserve would have decreased by EUR 1.7 million or increased by EUR 2.1 million (Dec. 31, 2024: decreased by EUR 3.6 million or EUR 0.9 million).

Interest rate risk

Interest rate risks can occur due to changes in market interest rates. The risks result from changes in the fair values of fixed-rate financial instruments or from changes in the cash flows of variable-rate financial instruments.

Due to the four fixed-rate bonds and the partly fixed-rate promissory notes, approximately 84% of the Brenntag Group's financial liabilities were hedged against the risk of interest rate increases as at December 31, 2025 (Dec. 31, 2024: 80%).

If the market interest rate as at December 31, 2025 had been 300 basis points (2024: 300 basis points) higher or lower (relative to the total amount of variable-rate financial liabilities as at December 31, 2025), the negative impact on net finance costs would have been EUR 14.8 million or the positive impact EUR 12.7 million (2024: negative impact of EUR 16.0 million or positive impact of EUR 16.0 million).

Interest rate-related fair value changes in the cross-currency interest rate swaps have no impact on net income for the financial year due to the agreed swap rates and hedge accounting. Conversely, the current difference between the euro market interest rate and the U.S. dollar market interest rate has a significant impact on the amount of the cash flow hedge reserve; as at December 31, 2025, the USD market interest rate was above the euro market interest rate. If the euro market interest rate as at December 31, 2025 had been 25 basis points higher or lower with the U.S. dollar market interest rate remaining unchanged, the cash flow hedge reserve would have decreased by EUR 3.7 million to EUR -9.7 million or increased by EUR 3.8 million to EUR -2.2 million (December 31, 2024: decreased by EUR 4.7 million to EUR 7.4 million or increased by EUR 4.7 million to EUR 16.8 million).

Credit risk

Credit risk on non-derivative financial instruments is the risk that the contracting parties concerned will fail to make contractually agreed payments. The maximum credit risk on non-derivative financial instruments is their carrying amount. The expected credit risk from individual receivables is allowed for by recognizing write-downs of the assets (see also Note 13.).

With the derivative financial instruments used, the maximum credit risk is the total of all positive fair values of these instruments as, in the event of non-performance by the contracting parties, losses on assets would be restricted to this amount.

Liquidity risk

Liquidity risk is the risk that the Brenntag Group may in future not be able to meet its contractual payment obligations. Due to the fact that the Brenntag Group's business is not subject to any pronounced seasonal fluctuations, there is relatively little fluctuation in liquidity during the financial year.

To ensure that the Brenntag Group can pay at all times, it not only has appropriate liquidity reserves in the form of cash and cash equivalents but also credit lines under the syndicated loan which can be utilized as needed.

In order to identify the liquidity risks, the Group has a multi-annual liquidity plan which is regularly reviewed and adjusted if necessary.

Of the other liabilities to banks, EUR 43.0 million (Dec. 31, 2024: EUR 60.1 million) are secured by non-current assets totaling EUR 37.8 million (Dec. 31, 2024: EUR 59.4 million).

In certain countries (e.g. China EUR 12.9 million (2024: EUR 18.9 million), Russia EUR 6.1 million (2024: EUR 7.3 million), South Africa EUR 8.9 million (2024: EUR 3.3 million) and India EUR 6.1 million (2024: EUR 2.5 million), Brenntag has local cash and cash equivalents at its disposal for cross-border transfers only subject to the applicable restrictions on foreign exchange transactions.

NOTES

The undiscounted cash flows resulting from financial liabilities are shown in the following table:

Cash flows 2026–2031 ff.							
in EUR m	Carrying amount Dec. 31, 2025	2026	2027	2028	2029	2030	2031 ff.
Trade payables	1,498.3	1,498.3	-	-	-	-	-
Other liabilities	496.1	493.8	2.1	-	-	-	0.2
Liabilities relating to acquisition of non-controlling interests	42.4	19.1	-	-	21.8	-	6.7
Other liabilities to banks	113.6	78.6	15.0	14.6	4.6	0.8	-
Promissory notes (Schuldschein)	486.9	18.2	421.4	2.5	82.5	-	-
Bond 2028	511.1	18.8	18.8	518.8	-	-	-
Bond 2029	499.0	2.5	2.5	2.5	502.5	-	-
Bond 2031	599.4	20.3	20.3	20.3	20.3	20.3	620.3
Bond 2032	508.6	19.4	19.4	19.4	19.4	19.4	538.8
Lease liabilities	541.4	143.0	115.9	85.5	69.8	56.7	175.3
Derivative financial instruments	8.6						-
of which cash inflows		484.4	2.1	2.1	431.8	-	-
of which cash outflows		497.6	8.7	8.7	434.3	-	-
Other financial liabilities	57.2	16.6	23.5	14.1	-	-	3.0
Total	5,362.6	2,341.8	645.5	684.3	723.4	97.2	1,344.3

3.100 Future cash flows from financial liabilities / Dec. 31, 2025

Cash flows 2025–2030 ff.							
in EUR m	Carrying amount Dec. 31, 2024	2025	2026	2027	2028	2029	2030 ff.
Trade payables	1,661.6	1,661.6	-	-	-	-	-
Other liabilities	569.7	561.4	-	0.2	-	0.3	1.8
Liabilities relating to acquisition of non-controlling interests	64.5	-	26.3	-	35.4	-	12.0
Other liabilities to banks	132.8	91.1	12.1	7.3	6.7	16.3	-
Promissory notes (Schuldschein)	508.1	22.5	21.4	407.3	2.8	77.2	-
Bond 2025	601.1	606.8	-	-	-	-	-
Bond 2028	510.4	18.8	18.8	18.8	518.8	-	-
Bond 2029	498.4	2.5	2.5	2.5	2.5	502.5	-
Bond 2032	507.8	19.4	19.4	19.4	19.4	19.4	558.1
Lease liabilities	617.3	161.8	125.6	96.4	70.8	58.9	233.9
Derivative financial instruments	44.4						-
of which cash inflows		678.8	-	-	-	-	-
of which cash outflows		684.4	-	-	-	-	41.3
Other financial liabilities	136.0	85.1	26.9	16.0	5.1	1.1	1.9
Total	5,852.1	3,236.6	253.0	567.9	661.5	675.7	849.0

3.101 Future cash flows from financial liabilities / Dec. 31, 2024

NOTES

Derivative financial instruments

The notional amount and fair values of derivative financial instruments are shown in the table below:

in EUR m	Dec. 31, 2025			Dec. 31, 2024		
	Notional amount	Positive fair value	Negative fair value	Notional amount	Positive fair value	Negative fair value
Foreign exchange forward transactions and foreign exchange swaps not included in hedge accounting	901.7	1.1	5.2	1,204.6	5.5	3.2
Cross-currency interest rate swaps included in hedge accounting	429.7	-	3.4	429.7	-	41.3
Call option	26.5	10.0	-	43.5	14.3	-

3.102 Derivative financial instruments

33.) Related parties

In the course of its normal business activities, Brenntag SE also obtains services from and provides services for related entities. These related entities are the subsidiaries included in the consolidated financial statements as well as associates accounted for using the equity method and their subsidiaries. Transactions with related entities are performed on arm's length terms. The transactions of Brenntag SE with subsidiaries included in the consolidated financial statements as well as between included subsidiaries have been eliminated.

Transactions with associates and their subsidiaries were as follows:

in EUR m	2025	2024
Sales from transactions with associates	1.8	1.8
Goods delivered and services rendered by associates	0.5	0.6

3.103 Transactions with related parties

in EUR m	Dec. 31, 2025	Dec. 31, 2024
Trade receivables from associates	0.2	0.2
Trade payables to associates	-	-

3.104 Receivables from and payables to related parties

Related persons are the members of the Board of Management and the Supervisory Board of Brenntag SE and members of their families.

Remuneration of the Board of Management

The total remuneration of the Board of Management consists of three components: a fixed annual base salary, short-term, capped variable cash remuneration (annual bonus) and long-term, capped variable remuneration (long-term incentive bonus). In addition to the above-mentioned remuneration components, the members of the Board of Management receive pension benefits, contractually agreed benefits in kind and other benefits.

The annual base salary is payable in twelve equal monthly instalments. If the service agreement begins or ends during a financial year, the Annual Base Salary for that financial year is payable on a pro rata temporis basis.

The annual bonus depends on Brenntag's business success in the past financial year. It is calculated based on achievement of the targets set for specific key performance indicators for the financial year. Under the Remuneration System 2023, the key performance indicators are organic EBITA (60%), working capital turnover (20%) and earnings per share (20%). An individual performance multiplier is also used to assess the performance of the Board of Management members. The individual performance multiplier for the Remuneration System 2023 is set by the Supervisory Board after each financial year within a range from 0.8 to 1.2. In doing so, the Supervisory Board takes into account the individual financial and non-financial performance. The individual performance aspects may be based on three dimensions: growth, people and risk management. They may include not only strategic and operational, but also non-financial aspects. The final payout amount is capped at a maximum of 200% of the individual and contractually agreed target amount (Cap).

NOTES

The Board of Management members also receive long-term variable remuneration. Different remuneration systems apply, depending on the year of award and individual contractual arrangements.

The Remuneration System 2023 applies to serving Board of Management members Jens Birgersson (CEO) and Thomas Reisten. Among other components, this includes long-term variable remuneration in the form of virtual shares (Performance Share Units). The number of virtual shares may increase or decrease, depending on Brenntag's long-term performance measured over a four-year performance period. The performance share plan is structured as follows.

The number of virtual shares initially awarded is calculated by dividing the individual and contractually agreed target amount by the arithmetic mean of the Brenntag share closing prices in the Xetra trading system during the last three months before the start of the performance period. If the service agreement begins or ends during a financial year, the target amount for that financial year is calculated on a pro rata temporis basis.

The number of virtual shares finally awarded to the Board of Management member is linked to two financial performance criteria and, via an ESG multiplier, to ESG targets. The two financial performance criteria are Brenntag's total shareholder return (TSR) compared with a global peer group (weighting: 70%) and return on capital employed (ROCE) (weighting: 30%). The sum total of the weighted share awards for each performance criterion is multiplied by the achievement figure of specific ESG targets using an ESG multiplier that may be between 0.8 and 1.2. The resulting total share award is then multiplied by the number of virtual shares initially awarded, giving the number of virtual shares finally awarded to the Board of Management member at the end of the four-year performance period. The number of virtual shares finally awarded is capped at 200%.

The payout amount depends on Brenntag's absolute share price performance over the four-year performance period and is calculated by multiplying the number of virtual shares finally awarded by the arithmetic mean of the Brenntag share closing prices in the Xetra trading system during the last three months before the end of the performance period, plus dividend payments during the performance period. The payout amount is capped at a maximum of 250% of the individual and contractually agreed target amount (Cap).

The Remuneration System 2023 also applies to Dr. Christian Kohlpaintner, Kristin Neumann, Michael Friede and Ewout van Jarwaarde, who stepped down as Board of Management members in 2025.

The Remuneration System 2020 still applies to Henri Nejade and Steven Terwindt, who stepped down as Board of Management members in 2023. It is also applied to the tranches that were awarded to the serving Board of Management members in previous years and for which the performance period has not yet ended.

The amount of the payout for long-term variable remuneration under the Remuneration System 2020 depends on the relative performance of the Brenntag share compared with two peer groups and the absolute change in the Brenntag share price over a four-year performance period. The virtual shares are awarded in annual tranches. Payout is made following completion of the performance period.

The annual virtual shares are awarded on January 1 of each financial year. The number of shares to be awarded initially is calculated by dividing the individual and contractually agreed grant amount by the arithmetic mean of the Brenntag share closing prices in the Xetra trading system during the last three months before the start of the performance period. If the service agreement begins or ends during a financial year, the grant amount for that financial year shall be calculated on a pro rata temporis basis.

The number of virtual shares finally awarded at the end of the four-year performance period depends on two performance criteria that are each weighted at 50%: the outperformance of the total shareholder return (TSR) of the Brenntag share compared with the performance of the MDAX, or, since the 2022 tranche, compared with the performance of the DAX, and the average TSR of a selectively compiled peer group of global competitors.

Target achievement of each performance criterion is calculated by subtracting the performance of the MDAX / DAX or the average TSR of the selected peer group from the TSR of the Brenntag share. If the performance of the MDAX / DAX or the average TSR of the selected peer group equals the TSR of the Brenntag share, target achievement is 100%. If the TSR of the Brenntag share outperforms the MDAX / DAX or the average TSR of the selected peer group by 25% or more percentage points, target achievement is 150%. If the TSR of the Brenntag share underperforms the MDAX / DAX or the average TSR of the selected peer group by 25% or more percentage points, target achievement is 0%. Values in-between are determined by linear interpolation. Overall target achievement is calculated by multiplying the target achievement figures of the two performance criteria by their respective weightings and then adding together these two weighted target achievement figures.

NOTES

The number of virtual shares finally awarded at the end of the four-year performance period is calculated by multiplying the number of virtual shares initially awarded by the overall target achievement.

The payout amount is determined by multiplying the number of virtual shares finally awarded by the arithmetic mean of the Brenntag share closing prices in the Xetra trading system during the last three months prior to the end of the performance period, plus dividend payments during the performance period. The payout amount is capped at a maximum of 200% of the individual and contractually set target grant amount (Cap).

The members of the Board of Management receive a fixed annual amount for the purpose of building up pension entitlements. The annual amount made available is paid in twelve equal monthly instalments, in each case at the end of the month. If the service agreement begins or ends during a financial year, the annual amount for that financial year will be granted on a pro rata temporis basis. The Board of Management members may decide at their own discretion how to use the corresponding amount for the purpose of building up pension entitlements.

The members of the Board of Management also receive benefits in kind and other benefits, such as a flat-rate mobility allowance.

The following table shows the recognition of the Board of Management remuneration for the Board of Management members serving in each financial year:

in EUR m	Dec. 31, 2025	Dec. 31, 2024
Short-term benefits	-	0.6
Termination benefits	0.3	-
Share-based remuneration	5.8	4.3
Total	6.1	4.9

3.105 Liabilities recognized for Board of Management remuneration in accordance with IFRSs

There are no defined benefit obligations for the Board of Management members serving in financial year 2025.

The service agreements of the Board of Management members end automatically on specified dates without any notice of termination being required. The employment of Board of Management members may only be terminated prematurely for good cause or by mutual agreement. If employment is terminated prematurely, the service agreement limits any severance pay to the value of twice the total annual remuneration, but no more than the amount of remuneration that would be paid until the end of the term of the service agreement. As at December 31, 2025, the maximum amount of severance payable would have been EUR 23.7 million (Dec. 31, 2024: EUR 19.4 million). A post-contractual non-compete clause has been agreed with the Board of Management members who are incentivized under the Remuneration System 2023. The post-contractual non-compete clause generally applies for a period of 24 months after the termination of the service agreement. During this period, these Board of Management members receive a continuous payment amounting to 75% of their annual base salary. Any earnings pursuant to Section 74c of the German Commercial Code (HGB) are deducted from this payment. There are no separate change-of-control arrangements.

For former members of the Board of Management, the present value of defined benefit obligations is EUR 13.3 million (Dec. 31, 2024: EUR 14.2 million) and the fair value of plan assets EUR 10.7 million (Dec. 31, 2024: EUR 10.7 million). In this context, the capitalized surrender value of pension liability insurance is EUR 10.7 million (Dec. 31, 2024: EUR 10.7 million). In financial year 2025, expenses recognized for pension commitments (defined benefit plans) to former members of the Board of Management amounted to EUR 0.0 million (2024: EUR 0.0 million).

In accordance with the German Commercial Code (HGB), the total remuneration of the Board of Management members serving in financial year 2025 amounts to EUR 7.3 million (2024: EUR 7.1 million).

Of the total remuneration, an amount of EUR 3.3 million (2024: EUR 2.9 million, in each case the fair value at the grant date) is attributable to share-based remuneration programs. The number of virtual shares in this context is 64,928.

The total remuneration recognized for former members of the Board of Management in financial year 2025 amounted to EUR 3.6 million (2024: EUR 0.2 million) in accordance with the German Commercial Code (HGB).

NOTES

Remuneration of the Supervisory Board

The remuneration of the Supervisory Board comprises purely fixed remuneration.

The members of the Supervisory Board each receive annual fixed remuneration in the amount of EUR 130.0k (Dec. 31, 2024: EUR 130.0k) in addition to reimbursement of their expenses. The Chair of the Supervisory Board receives base remuneration of EUR 325.0k (Dec. 31, 2024: EUR 325.0k) and the Deputy Chair EUR 162.5k (Dec. 31, 2024: EUR 162.5k) per year. The Chair of each of the committees established receives an additional EUR 125.0k per year and every other member an additional EUR 50.0k per year.

The total remuneration of the members of the Supervisory Board due in the short term amounts to EUR 1.8 million for financial year 2025 (2024: EUR 1.7 million).

The Supervisory Board remuneration system and the remuneration of each member of the Supervisory Board are detailed in the remuneration report.

The following table contains the remuneration of the Board of Management and Supervisory Board members serving in financial year 2025:

in EUR m	2025	2024
Short-term benefits	6.2	5.8
Termination benefits	3.0	-
Share-based remuneration	3.8	-0.4
Total	13.0	5.4

3.106 Board of Management and Supervisory Board remuneration expense in accordance with IFRSs

Apart from the aforementioned, there were no significant transactions with related persons.

34.) Fees for the auditors of the consolidated financial statements

The following fees for the services of the auditors of the consolidated financial statements, Deloitte GmbH Wirtschaftsprüfungsgesellschaft, Düsseldorf, and companies in Deloitte's global network were recognized as expenses:

in EUR m	2025	2024
Financial statement audit services	8.5	9.4
(of which in Germany)	(2.3)	(2.3)
Other assurance services	0.5	0.6
(of which in Germany)	(0.5)	(0.6)
Tax advisory services	-	-
(of which in Germany)	(-)	(-)
Other services	-	-
(of which in Germany)	(-)	(-)
Total	9.0	10.0
(of which in Germany)	(2.8)	(2.9)

3.107 Fees for the auditors of the consolidated financial statements

Fees for financial statement audit services for financial year 2025 consist mainly of payments for the statutory audit of the consolidated financial statements, the review of the quarterly reporting and the statutory audit of the annual financial statements of Brenntag SE and its domestic and foreign subsidiaries.

Fees for other assurance services in financial year 2025 relate in particular to the engagement to provide assurance on the Group sustainability statement, assurance services related to Brenntag SE's Board of Management remuneration and the comfort letter related to the extension of the debt issuance program (DIP).

NOTES

35.) Exemptions pursuant to Section 264, para. 3 / Section 264b of the German Commercial Code

For financial year 2025, the following subsidiaries of Brenntag SE are making use of the exemptions pursuant to Section 264, para. 3 and Section 264b of the German Commercial Code:

- Brenntag Holding GmbH, Essen
- Brenntag Germany Holding GmbH, Essen
- Brenntag Foreign Holding GmbH, Essen
- Brenntag Beteiligungs GmbH, Essen
- BRENNTAG GmbH, Duisburg
- BRENNTAG International Chemicals GmbH, Essen
- Brenntag Real Estate GmbH, Essen
- BCD Chemie GmbH, Hamburg
- CLG Lagerhaus GmbH & Co. KG, Essen
- CM Komplementär 03-018 GmbH & Co. KG, Essen
- CM Komplementär 03-019 GmbH & Co. KG, Essen
- CM Komplementär 03-020 GmbH & Co. KG, Essen
- ACU PHARMA und CHEMIE GmbH, Apolda
- Brenntag Global Services GmbH, Zossen

36.) Declaration of conformity with the German Corporate Governance Code

On December 17, 2025, the Board of Management and Supervisory Board issued the declaration of conformity with the recommendations of the Government Commission "German Corporate Governance Code" for financial year 2025 as required by Section 161 of the German Stock Corporation Act. The declaration of conformity can be found in the corporate governance statement of the combined management report in Brenntag SE's annual report and can also be viewed at any time on the Brenntag SE website:

<https://corporate.brenntag.com/en/about/corporate-governance/corporate-governance-code/>

37.) Events after the reporting period

At the end of February 2026, Brenntag closed the acquisition of 100% of the shares in Airedale Group, a UK-based chemical distributor and added-value services provider. The acquisition is expected to complement and develop Brenntag UK's service offering and expertise, including blending, formulation and dilution capabilities. Airedale Group operates a facility in the UK which will complement Brenntag's British infrastructure and enhance its portfolio and service offering within the UK and beyond.

The provisional amounts for the purchase price and net assets (excluding acquired goodwill in the amount of EUR 80.4 million) break down as follows:

in EUR m	Provisional fair value
Purchase price	97.6
of which consideration contingent on earnings targets	2.3
Assets	
Cash and cash equivalents	2.6
Trade receivables, other financial assets and other receivables	14.1
Other current assets	4.1
Non-current assets	24.7
Liabilities	
Current liabilities	22.3
Non-current liabilities	54.8
Net assets	-31.6
Goodwill	129.2
of which deductible for tax purposes	-

3.108 Net assets acquired after the reporting period

Measurement of the assets acquired and liabilities assumed has not yet been completed for reasons of time. The main factors determining the goodwill are the above-mentioned reasons for the acquisition.

The potential effects of the recent escalation of the conflict in the Middle East on our supply chains and procurement markets cannot yet be conclusively determined.

Essen, March 5, 2026

Brenntag SE
BOARD OF MANAGEMENT

Jens Birgersson

Thomas Reisten

Annex

List of shareholdings in accordance with Section 313, para. 2 of the German Commercial Code as at December 31, 2025

No.	Company	Domicile	Held directly % ¹⁾	Held indirectly % ¹⁾	Effective net holding % ¹⁾	Via no.
1	Brenntag SE	Essen				

Consolidated subsidiaries

Algeria						
2	Alliance Chimie Algerie SPA	Algiers	0.00	100.00	99.94	73
3	SARL ALLIANCE INGREDIENTS	Rouiba (Algiers)	0.00	100.00	99.94	2
4	SARL ALLIANCE PHYTOSANITAIRE	Rouiba (Algiers)	0.00	100.00	99.94	2
Argentina						
5	Brenntag Argentina S.A.	Buenos Aires	0.00	90.00	100.00	120
				10.00		128
Australia						
6	Brenntag Australia Pty. Ltd.	Mulgrave	0.00	100.00	100.00	156
7	RAVENSWOOD INGREDIENTS PTY. LTD.	Mulgrave	0.00	100.00	100.00	6
Belgium						
8	Antwerp Distillation Company NV	Beveren	0.00	75.00	100.00	9
				25.00		11
9	BRENNTAG NV	Deerlijk	0.00	99.99	100.00	71
				0.01		49
10	European Polymers and Chemicals Distribution BVBA	Deerlijk	0.00	100.00	100.00	135
11	Industrial Investment Company BV	Zoersel	0.00	100.00	100.00	9
12	Kilfrost Europe NV	Antwerp	0.00	100.00	100.00	9
13	Solventis BV	Antwerp	0.00	100.00	100.00	9
14	Solventis Europe NV	Antwerp	0.00	100.00	100.00	9
Bolivia						
15	Brenntag Bolivia S.R.L.	Santa Cruz	0.00	90.00	100.00	120
				10.00		127
Brazil						
16	Brenntag Quimica Brasil Ltda.	Guarulhos, Estado de Sao Paulo	0.00	100.00	100.00	120
				0.00		127
17	Brenntag Specialties Brasil Ltda.	Itapevi, State of Sao Paulo	0.00	100.00	100.00	120
18	Brenntag Specialties Brasil Nutra Ltda.	Itapevi, State of Sao Paulo	0.00	100.00	100.00	120
19	PHARMASPECIAL ESPECIALIDADES QUIMICAS E FARMACEUTICAS LTDA.	Itapevi, State of Sao Paulo	0.00	100.00	100.00	120
Bulgaria						
20	BRENNTAG BULGARIA EOOD	Sofia	0.00	100.00	100.00	120
Chile						
21	Brenntag Chile Comercial e Industrial Limitada	Santiago	0.00	95.00	100.00	120
				5.00		127

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China							
22	Brenntag (Shanghai) Enterprise Management Co., Ltd.	Shanghai	0.00	100.00	100.00	120	
23	Brenntag (Zhangjiagang) Chemical Co., Ltd	Zhangjiagang	0.00	100.00	100.00	85	
24	Brenntag Cangzhou Chemical Co., Ltd	Cangzhou	0.00	79.40	100.00	33	
				20.60		85	
25	Guangzhou Fan Ya Jia Rong Trading Co., Ltd.	Guangzhou	0.00	60.00	100.00	28	
				40.00		32	
26	Guangzhou Saifu Chemical Co., Ltd.	Guangzhou	0.00	100.00	70.00	29	
27	Guangzhou Wellstar Trading Co., Ltd.	Guangzhou	0.00	100.00	100.00	84	
28	Shanghai Jia Rong Trading Co., Ltd.	Shanghai	0.00	100.00	100.00	33	
29	Shanghai Saifu Chemical Development Co., Ltd.	Shanghai	0.00	70.00	70.00	120	
30	Shanghai Wellstar Trading Co., Ltd.	Shanghai	0.00	100.00	100.00	84	
31	Shenzhen Wellstar Trading Co., Ltd.	Shenzhen	0.00	100.00	100.00	84	
32	Tianjin Tai Rong Chemical Trading Co., Ltd.	Tianjin	0.00	100.00	100.00	28	
33	Tianjin Zhong Yung Chemical Warehousing Co., Ltd.	Tianjin	0.00	100.00	100.00	85	
34	ZhongYung (GuangDong) Chemical Distribution Service Co., Ltd	Dongguan	0.00	100.00	100.00	83	
35	Zhongbai Food Technology (Shanghai) Co., Ltd	Shanghai	0.00	100.00	100.00	36	
36	Zhongbai Xingye Food Technology (Beijing) Co., Ltd	Beijing	0.00	100.00	100.00	120	
Costa Rica							
37	Brenntag Business Services Sociedad de Responsabilidad Limit	La Ribera, Belén, Heredia	0.00	100.00	100.00	120	
38	Quimicos Holanda Costa Rica S.A.	San José	0.00	100.00	100.00	120	
Denmark							
39	Aktieselskabet af 1. Januar 1987	Ballerup	0.00	100.00	100.00	40	
40	Brenntag Nordic A/S	Ballerup	0.00	100.00	100.00	120	
Germany							
41	ACU PHARMA und CHEMIE GmbH	Apolda	0.00	100.00	100.00	51	
42	BBG Berlin-Brandenburger Lager- u. Distributionsgesellschaft Biesterfeld Brenntag mbH	Hoppegarten	0.00	50.00	100.00	51	
				50.00		43	
43	BCD Chemie GmbH	Hamburg	0.00	100.00	100.00	51	
44	BRENTNAG GmbH	Duisburg	0.00	80.14	100.00	51	
				19.86		43	
45	BRENTNAG International Chemicals GmbH	Essen	0.00	100.00	100.00	51	
46	Blitz 03-1161 GmbH	Mülheim an der Ruhr	0.00	100.00	100.00	50	
47	Blitz 03-1162 GmbH	Mülheim an der Ruhr	0.00	100.00	100.00	57	
48	Blitz 03-1163 GmbH	Mülheim an der Ruhr	0.00	100.00	100.00	58	
49	Brenntag Beteiligungs GmbH	Essen	0.00	100.00	100.00	53	
50	Brenntag Foreign Holding GmbH	Essen	0.00	100.00	100.00	49	
51	Brenntag Germany Holding GmbH	Essen	0.00	100.00	100.00	49	
52	Brenntag Global Services GmbH	Zossen	0.00	100.00	100.00	49	
53	Brenntag Holding GmbH	Essen	100.00	0.00	100.00	1	
54	Brenntag Real Estate GmbH	Essen	0.00	100.00	100.00	49	
55	CLG Lagerhaus GmbH	Duisburg	0.00	100.00	100.00	51	
56	CLG Lagerhaus GmbH & Co. KG	Essen	0.00	100.00	100.00	51	
				0.00		55	
57	CM Komplementär 03-018 GmbH & Co. KG	Essen	0.00	100.00	100.00	46	
				0.00		50	
58	CM Komplementär 03-019 GmbH & Co. KG	Essen	0.00	100.00	100.00	47	
				0.00		57	
59	CM Komplementär 03-020 GmbH & Co. KG	Essen	0.00	100.00	100.00	48	
				0.00		58	
60	CVB Albert Carl GmbH & Co. KG Berlin	Berlin	0.00	100.00	51.00	61	
				0.00		64	

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61	CVH Chemie-Vertrieb GmbH & Co. Hannover KG	Hanover	0.00	51.00	51.00	51
				0.00		62
62	CVH Chemie-Vertrieb Verwaltungsgesellschaft mbH	Hanover	0.00	51.00	51.00	51
63	CVM Chemie-Vertrieb Magdeburg GmbH & Co. KG	Magdeburg	0.00	100.00	51.00	61
				0.00		64
64	CVP Chemie-Vertrieb Berlin GmbH	Berlin	0.00	100.00	51.00	61
65	Gefahrstoffzentrum (GSZ) Kaiserslautern GmbH	Kaiserslautern	0.00	100.00	100.00 ²⁾	44
66	ROSEA Grundstücks-Vermietungsgesellschaft mbH & Co. Objekt Hüttenheim KG	Düsseldorf	0.00	94.00	94.00 ³⁾	51
Dominican Republic						
67	BRENNTAG CARIBE S.R.L.	Santo Domingo	0.00	100.00	100.00	120
				0.00		128
Ecuador						
68	BRENNTAG ECUADOR S.A.	Guayaquil	0.00	100.00	100.00	120
				0.00		128
El Salvador						
69	BRENNTAG EL SALVADOR, S.A. DE C.V.	Soyapango	0.00	100.00	100.00	120
				0.00		127
Finland						
70	Brenntag Nordic OY	Vantaa	0.00	100.00	100.00	120
France						
71	BRACHEM FRANCE HOLDING SAS	Chassieu	0.00	100.00	100.00	53
72	BRENNTAG EXPORT SARL	Vitrolles	0.00	100.00	99.94	74
73	BRENNTAG MAGHREB SAS	Vitrolles	0.00	100.00	99.94	72
74	BRENNTAG SA	Chassieu	0.00	99.94	99.94	71
75	Multisol France SAS	Villebon sur Yvette	0.00	100.00	100.00	71
76	Multisol International Services SAS	Sotteville Les Rouen	0.00	80.00	100.00	71
				20.00		75
Ghana						
77	Brenntag Ghana Limited	Tema	0.00	100.00	100.00	120
Greece						
78	Brenntag Hellas Chimika Monoprosopi EPE	Penteli	0.00	100.00	100.00	133
Guatemala						
79	BRENNTAG GUATEMALA S.A.	Guatemala City	0.00	100.00	100.00	120
				0.00		128
Guyana						
80	ALPHA CHEMICAL GUYANA INC.	Georgetown	0.00	100.00	100.00	120
Honduras						
81	BRENNTAG HONDURAS, S.A.	San Pedro Sula	0.00	98.51	100.00	120
				1.49		128
Hong Kong						
82	Brenntag Chemicals (HK) Pte Limited	Hong Kong	0.00	100.00	100.00	156
83	Hong Kong Dongguan Zhongrong Investment Co Limited	Hong Kong	0.00	100.00	100.00	85
84	WELLSTAR ENTERPRISES (HONG KONG) COMPANY LIMITED	Hong Kong	0.00	100.00	100.00	120
85	Zhong Yung (International) Chemical Co., Limited	Hong Kong	0.00	100.00	100.00	120
India						
86	Brenntag Ingredients (India) Private Limited	Mumbai	0.00	100.00	100.00	156
Indonesia						
87	PT Aik Moh Chemicals Indonesia	Batam	0.00	99.93	100.00	154
				0.07		155
88	PT Staris Chemicals	Tangerang Selatan	0.00	100.00	100.00	154
				0.00		155

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89	PT. Brenntag	Jakarta Selatan	0.00	100.00	100.00	156
90	PT. Dharmala HCl i. L.	Jakarta	0.00	91.14	91.14	120
Ireland						
91	Brenntag Chemicals Distribution (Ireland) Limited	Dublin	0.00	100.00	100.00	217
Israel						
92	Biochem Trading 2011 Ltd.	Be'er Ya'akov	0.00	100.00	100.00	93
93	Brenntag Israel Ltd.	Be'er Ya'akov	0.00	100.00	100.00	120
Italy						
94	AQUADEPUR SRL	Cogliate	0.00	100.00	100.00	95
95	BRENNTAG S.P.A.	Assago	0.00	100.00	100.00	120
Japan						
96	Brenntag Japan Godo Kaisha	Tokyo	0.00	100.00	100.00	120
Canada						
97	BRENNTAG CANADA INC.	Toronto	0.00	100.00	100.00	130
Kenya						
98	Brenntag Kenya Limited	Nairobi	0.00	100.00	100.00	120
Colombia						
99	BRENNTAG COLOMBIA S.A.	Bogotá D.C.	0.00	94.87	100.00	120
				4.15		127
				0.41		130
				0.38		128
				0.19		126
100	BRENNTAG COLOMBIA ZONA FRANCA S.A.S.	Barranquilla	0.00	100.00	100.00	99
101	CONQUIMICA SAS	Itagui	0.00	100.00	100.00	99
Croatia						
102	BRENNTAG HRVATSKA d.o.o.	Zagreb	0.00	100.00	100.00	133
Latvia						
103	SIA BRENNTAG LATVIA	Riga	0.00	100.00	100.00	143
104	SIA DIPOL BALTIJA	Riga	0.00	100.00	100.00	206
Lithuania						
105	UAB BRENNTAG LIETUVA	Kaunas	0.00	100.00	100.00	143
Malaysia						
106	BRENNTAG BUSINESS SERVICES SDN. BHD.	Kuala Lumpur	0.00	100.00	100.00	120
107	BRENNTAG MALAYSIA SDN. BHD.	Petaling Jaya	0.00	100.00	100.00	120
108	BRENNTAG SDN. BHD.	Kuala Lumpur	0.00	100.00	100.00	156
109	Brenntag Chemicals Malaysia Sdn. Bhd.	Kuala Lumpur	0.00	30.00	30.00	120
Morocco						
110	ALCOCHIM MAROC S.A.R.L.	Casablanca	0.00	100.00	99.94	73
111	BRENNTAG MAROC S.A.R.L associé unique	Casablanca	0.00	100.00	99.94	73
Mauritius						
112	Brenntag Chemicals Mauritius Limited	Moka	0.00	100.00	100.00	120
113	Multisol Mauritius Limited	Moka	0.00	100.00	100.00	228
Mexico						
114	AMCO INTERNACIONAL S.A. DE C.V.	Mexico City	0.00	100.00	100.00	115
				0.00		116
115	BRENNTAG MÉXICO, S.A. DE C.V.	Cuautitlan Izcalli	0.00	100.00	100.00	120
				0.00		127
116	BRENNTAG PACIFIC, S. DE R.L. DE C.V.	Tijuana	0.00	99.00	100.00	199
				1.00		197
117	Química Delta S.A. de C.V.	Teoloyucan	0.00	99.91	100.00	115
				0.09		116
New Zealand						
118	BRENNTAG NEW ZEALAND LIMITED	Wellington	0.00	100.00	100.00	156

TO OUR SHAREHOLDERS		MANAGEMENT REPORT	CONSOLIDATED FINANCIAL STATEMENTS		REMUNERATION REPORT		FURTHER INFORMATION
ANNEX							

TO OUR SHAREHOLDERS		MANAGEMENT REPORT	CONSOLIDATED FINANCIAL STATEMENTS	REMUNERATION REPORT		FURTHER INFORMATION
ANNEX						

TO OUR SHAREHOLDERS		MANAGEMENT REPORT	CONSOLIDATED FINANCIAL STATEMENTS	REMUNERATION REPORT		FURTHER INFORMATION
ANNEX						

ANNEX

United Kingdom						
215	Brenntag Colours Limited	Leeds	0.00	100.00	100.00	217
216	Brenntag Inorganic Chemicals Limited	Leeds	0.00	100.00	100.00	217
217	Brenntag UK Holding Limited	Leeds	0.00	100.00	100.00	71
218	Brenntag UK Limited	Leeds	0.00	100.00	100.00	217
219	FCL Organisation Ltd	Leeds	0.00	100.00	100.00	220
220	FCSL Holdco Ltd	Leeds	0.00	100.00	100.00	233
221	Kilfrost Europe Ltd	Leeds	0.00	100.00	100.00	233
222	Kluman and Balter Limited	Leeds	0.00	100.00	100.00	217
223	Lawrence Industries Limited	Tamworth	0.00	100.00	100.00	217
224	Monarch Chemicals (Holdings) Limited	Leeds	0.00	100.00	100.00	226
225	Monarch Chemicals Limited	Leeds	0.00	100.00	100.00	224
226	Monarch Group Limited	Leeds	0.00	100.00	100.00	217
227	Multisol Europe Limited	Leeds	0.00	100.00	100.00	228
228	Multisol Group Limited	Leeds	0.00	100.00	100.00	229
229	Multisol Limited	Leeds	0.00	100.00	100.00	217
230	Murgatroyd's Salt & Chemical Company Limited	Leeds	0.00	100.00	100.00	216
231	Solvenox Ltd	Leeds	0.00	100.00	100.00	233
232	Solventis Holdings Ltd	Leeds	0.00	100.00	100.00	217
233	Solventis Ltd	Leeds	0.00	100.00	100.00	217
234	Solventis Solutions Ltd	Leeds	0.00	100.00	100.00	219
Vietnam						
235	BRENTAG VIETNAM COMPANY LIMITED	Ho Chi Minh City	0.00	100.00	100.00	156
236	NAM GIANG COMMERCIAL SERVICE CO., LTD	Ho Chi Minh City	0.00	0.00	0.00 ³⁾	1

Associated subsidiaries

Denmark						
237	Borup Kemi I/S	Borup	0.00	33.33	33.33	39
Germany						
238	SOFT CHEM GmbH	Laatzen	0.00	33.40	17.03	62
Thailand						
239	Berli Asiatic Soda Co., Ltd.	Bangkok	0.00	50.00	50.00	170
United Kingdom						
240	PURE SODIUM HYPOCHLORITE BIOCIDAL PRODUCTS GROUP LTD.	London	0.00	25.00	25.00	218

¹⁾ Share in the capital of the company²⁾ Business combination in accordance with IFRS 3³⁾ Structured entity

4 Remuneration Report

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Introduction

The remuneration report of Brenntag SE was prepared jointly by the company's Board of Management and the Supervisory Board and reports on the remuneration awarded and due to the current and former members of the Board of Management and the Supervisory Board in financial year 2025.

The remuneration report is intended to comply with the regulatory requirements of Section 162 of the German Stock Corporation Act (AktG) and the recommendations and

suggestions of the German Corporate Governance Code (GCGC) as amended on April 28, 2022.

The remuneration report has been audited by Deloitte GmbH Wirtschaftsprüfungsgesellschaft. This audit went beyond the requirements of Section 162, para. 3 of the German Stock Corporation Act (AktG). The Report of the Independent Auditor is attached to the remuneration report.

Remuneration of the Board of Management

Business performance and target achievement in financial year 2025

In a general market environment marked by a high degree of economic uncertainty, the financial results for financial year 2025 remain below the company's own targets. The Brenntag Group's profit after tax fell by 50.4% to EUR 269.7 million, compared with the previous year's figure of EUR 543.7 million.

The payout amount of the annual bonus under the Remuneration System 2023, which is based on the philosophy of "Pay for Performance", reflects this development. For financial year 2025, the average annual bonus for the members of the Board of Management is 0% of the target amount, reflecting the Brenntag Group's results, which were below expectations.

2025 also marked the end of the performance period for the third tranche of the long-term variable remuneration under the Remuneration System 2020. A total payout amount of 0% of the target amount was reached over the four-year performance period. This is based on measurement of the relative shareholder return and the change in the share price, which reflects the change in shareholder return between 2022 and 2025, both in absolute terms and in comparison to relevant global competitors and the German stock market. Further details are to be found in the section "Performance criteria for the variable remuneration".

Composition of the Board of Management

At the end of financial year 2025, the Board of Management of Brenntag SE consisted of two members: Jens Birgersson (CEO Brenntag Group) and Thomas Reisten (CFO Brenntag Group).

Jens Birgersson was appointed as the new Chief Executive Officer and member of the Board of Management with effect from September 1, 2025. Dr. Christian Kohlpaintner stepped down as CEO on August 31, 2025. His service agreement ended on December 31, 2025.

Thomas Reisten was appointed to the Board of Management with effect from April 1, 2025. His service agreement already came into effect on March 1, 2025. He assumed responsibility as Chief Financial Officer, succeeding Dr. Kristin Neumann, who left the Board of Management on March 31, 2025.

Ewout van Jarwaarde left the Board of Management by mutual agreement with effect from September 8, 2025. His service agreement, which was originally due to run until December 31, 2028, will now end on March 31, 2026.

Michael Friede stepped down from the Board of Management by mutual agreement with effect from November 30, 2025. His service agreement, which was originally due to run until March 31, 2026, was terminated by mutual agreement on the same date.

Consideration of the resolution of the Annual General Meeting 2025

The remuneration report of Brenntag SE for financial year 2024 was approved by the Annual General Meeting on May 22, 2025 with a 97.03% share of the votes cast.

During preparation of the remuneration report, feedback from investors and proxy advisors received in connection with the approval of the previous year's remuneration report is taken into account, where available.

Board of Management remuneration systems

The Supervisory Board is responsible for determining the remuneration of the Board of Management members. The Nomination and Remuneration Committee of the Supervisory Board discusses and reviews the remuneration system for the Board of Management at regular intervals and prepares resolutions on any changes thereto. In its decisions on the setting of the remuneration system, the Supervisory Board takes into account the remuneration and employment conditions of the employees of Brenntag SE, in particular the senior managers.

In setting the remuneration, the Supervisory Board pays attention to an appropriate relationship between the tasks and performance of the Board of Management members and the situation of the company. In order to assess the appropriateness of the remuneration system and the individual remuneration of the members of the Board of Management, the Supervisory Board conducts a horizontal review of the remuneration levels and structure. Horizontal benchmarking is performed with companies of comparable size at national level. In 2025, the Supervisory Board referred to a remuneration study conducted by an independent remuneration consultancy when carrying out the horizontal review of the remuneration levels of Jens Birgersson and Thomas Reisten. In addition to Brenntag, 28 DAX companies, four MDAX companies, one SDAX company and one unlisted company of comparable size were surveyed in this study, which was conducted in 2024. The companies included in the comparison were: adidas, Allianz, BASF, Bayer, Beiersdorf, Commerzbank, Continental, Covestro, Daimler Truck, Deutsche Bank, Deutsche Börse, Deutsche Lufthansa, Deutsche Post, Deutsche Telekom, E.ON, Evonik, Fresenius, Fresenius Medical Care, Heidelberg Materials, Henkel, Infineon, Lanxess, Mercedes-Benz, Merck, Metro, Munich Re, Porsche Automobil Holding, RWE, SAP, Siemens, Siemens Energy, Siemens Healthineers, thyssenkrupp, Volkswagen and ZF Friedrichshafen. As Brenntag was in the 17th percentile of the peer group based on the size criteria used in the study, the 17th percentile was used as the benchmark for the horizontal review.

The Board of Management remuneration systems, in particular the Board of Management remuneration system that was introduced in 2023, are designed to be in line with the German Corporate Governance Code in the version of April 28, 2022 and the requirements of the amended German Stock Corporation Act. These systems are designed to be clear and comprehensible and support the Group's long-term performance by creating effective incentives for growth and increasing profitability. The aim of the remuneration systems is to create an incentive for successful and sustainable corporate development. The systems are therefore geared to transparent, performance-based remuneration that is strongly focused on the company's success and that depends, in particular, on long-term, but also operational targets, the performance of the Brenntag share price as well as sustainability targets.

Two different remuneration systems were applied in 2025. The Board of Management Remuneration System 2023 was resolved by the Supervisory Board on April 18, 2023 and approved by 94.11% of the votes cast at the Annual General Meeting on June 15, 2023. The Remuneration System 2023 applies to all Board of Management members of Brenntag SE currently in office and to all members of the Board of Management serving in financial year 2025. The Board of Management Remuneration System 2020 was adopted by the Supervisory Board on December 23, 2020 and approved by 91.62% of the votes cast at the Annual General Meeting on June 10, 2021. The Remuneration System 2020 applies to the tranches of long-term variable remuneration granted under its framework.

The annual base salary and the variable remuneration components are shown separately in the following. There then follows a description of benefits in kind and other contractual provisions that are structured in a comparable manner in both remuneration systems.

REMUNERATION OF THE BOARD OF MANAGEMENT

Fixed remuneration	■ Base salary ■ Benefits in kind ■ Pension allowance
Short-term variable remuneration	■ Plan type: Target bonus model ■ Financial performance criteria: - 60% organic operating EBITA - 20% working capital turnover - 20% earnings per share - Individual performance multiplier (0.8–1.2) ■ Cap: max. 200% of the target amount
Long-term variable remuneration	■ Plan type: Virtual Performance Share Plan ■ Performance period: Four years ■ Financial performance criteria: - 70% percentile ranking of the total shareholder return (TSR) of the Brenntag share vs. peer group of global competitors - 30% ROCE - ESG multiplier (0.8–1.2) ■ Cap: max. 250% of the target amount
Other remuneration components and contractual provisions	■ Malus & Clawback: The Supervisory Board is contractually entitled - to retain variable remuneration (malus) - to reclaim variable remuneration (clawback) ■ Share Ownership Guideline in the amount of the annual base salary: - Chair of the Board of Management: 200% - Other members of the Board of Management: 100% ■ Maximum remuneration pursuant to the German Stock Corporation Act - Chair of the Board of Management: EUR 7,500,000 - Other members of the Board of Management: EUR 5,000,000

4.01 Remuneration components – Remuneration System 2023

Board of Management Remuneration System 2023

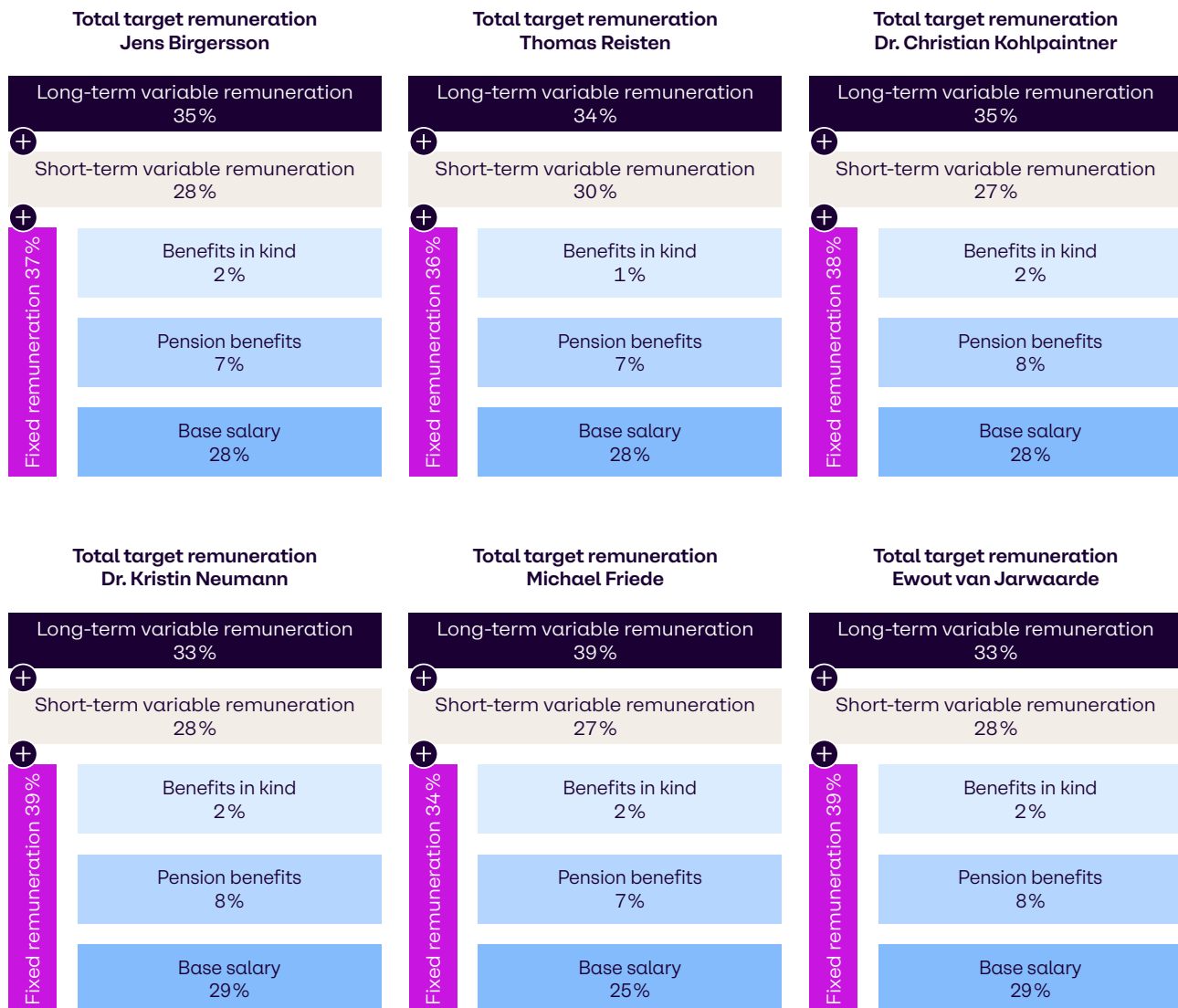
The Board of Management Remuneration System 2023 applies to the following current and former Board of Management members in 2025: Jens Birgersson, Thomas Reisten, Dr. Christian Kohlpaintner, Dr. Kristin Neumann, Michael Friede and Ewout van Jarwaarde.

In connection with the appointment of the CEO, a one-off sign-up bonus was granted in the first financial year instead of the short-term variable remuneration provided for under the Remuneration System 2023. This is a departure from the standard treatment of individual remuneration components, which was necessary to ensure competitive total remuneration in order to secure the appointment of the Board of Management member.

All other components are applied exactly within the framework of the Board of Management remuneration system adopted by the Supervisory Board and approved by the Annual General Meeting 2023.

The remuneration comprises fixed remuneration and variable remuneration. The fixed remuneration consists of a base salary, pension allowance and benefits in kind. The variable remuneration is made up of short-term and long-term variable remuneration components. Of the target total remuneration of the Board of Management members, fixed remuneration accounts for between 34% and 39%, short-term variable remuneration components for between 27% and 30% and long-term variable remuneration components for between 33% and 39%.

REMUNERATION OF THE BOARD OF MANAGEMENT



4.02 Remuneration structure – Remuneration System 2023

In addition to the above-mentioned remuneration components, the Board of Management members receive benefits in kind under their service agreements, such as a mobility allowance, accident insurance cover, and benefits for health care and long-term care insurance.

The annual base salary is paid in twelve equal instalments at the end of each month. If the service agreement begins or ends during a financial year, the annual base salary for that financial year is payable on a pro rata temporis basis.

The variable remuneration consists of two components that support the performance of the Group by creating effective incentives for growth and increased profitability to ensure the successful and sustainable development of the company: short-term variable remuneration in the form of an annual

bonus payment (annual bonus) and long-term variable remuneration in the form of virtual shares (performance share plan). The annual bonus provides an incentive to achieve the operational business objectives of the financial year, which in turn are derived from the business strategy and the annual budget plans. The performance share plan provides an incentive to ensure the long-term performance of the company.

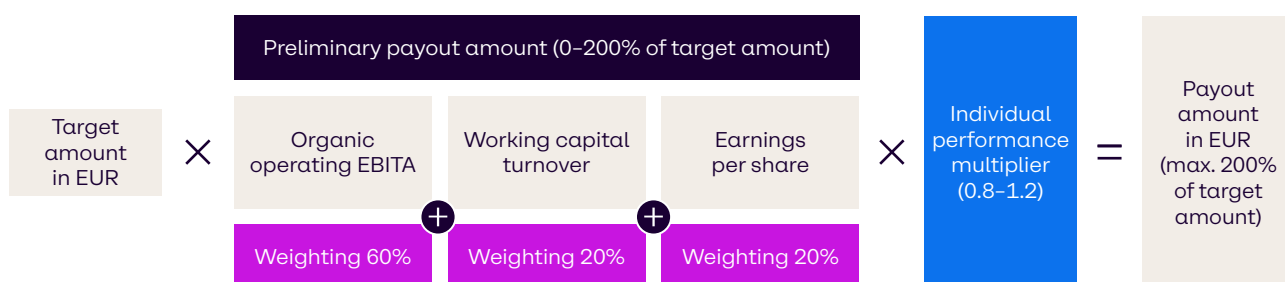
Annual bonus under the Remuneration System 2023

The annual bonus depends both on Brenntag's overall performance and on the specific responsibilities and challenges of the Board of Management members. It is determined based on the achievement of certain targets set for the financial year, which include organic operating EBITA, working capital turnover and earnings per share.

REMUNERATION OF THE BOARD OF MANAGEMENT

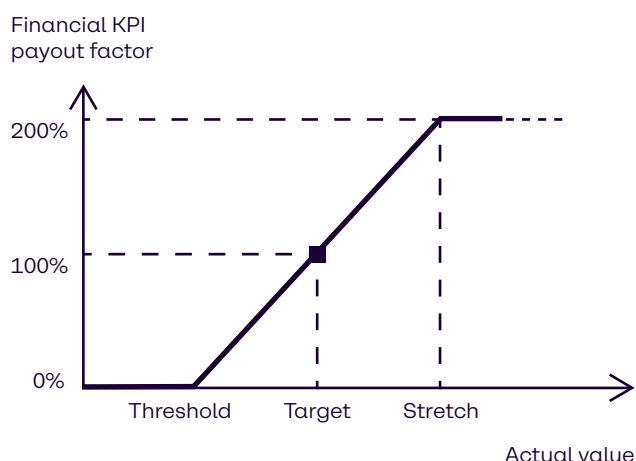
In 2025, the targets set for working capital turnover and earnings per share relate to Group level for all members of the Board of Management. For Thomas Reisten, Dr. Christian Kohlpaintner and Dr. Kristin Neumann, the target for organic operating EBITA related to Group level. For Michael Friede and

Ewout van Jarwaarde, 75% of the target for organic operating EBITA related to Group level and the remaining 25% to divisional level in order to align the targets with their particular divisional responsibilities.



4.03 Structure of the annual bonus – Remuneration System 2023

Organic operating EBITA is the key performance indicator for the implementation of Brenntag's strategy. It can take into account different depreciation profiles and enable the differentiated strategic steering of Brenntag's divisions; this KPI is weighted at 60% in the bonus calculation. Working capital turnover is a key performance indicator for Brenntag to ensure efficient deployment of capital; the weighting is 20%. Earnings per share, as a parameter for measuring Brenntag's shareholder value, is also weighted at 20%. The payout factor for each key performance indicator lies within a range of 0% to 200%. Target, threshold and stretch values for the three key performance indicators are derived from the annual budget plans and are set annually by the Supervisory Board. If the defined target value for each performance criterion is achieved, this results in a payout factor of 100%. If the actual value for each performance criterion is equal to or below the threshold, this results in a payout factor of 0%. If the actual value for each performance criterion is equal to or above the stretch, this results in a maximum payout factor of 200%. If the actual values are between the respective target and threshold values or between the respective target and stretch values, the payout factor is determined by linear interpolation. The following is an example of a payout factor curve which is defined for each financial performance criterion:



4.04 Annual bonus payout factor curve – Remuneration System 2023

The overall payout factor is calculated by multiplying the payout factors of the three performance criteria by their respective weightings and then adding together these three weighted payout factors.

In order to determine the final payout amount, the overall payout factor is multiplied by the individual performance multiplier and by the target amount. The individual performance multiplier is set by the Supervisory Board after each financial year in a range between 0.8 and 1.2. In doing so, the Supervisory Board takes into account the individual financial and non-financial performance.

To measure the individual performance, the Supervisory Board defines individual performance aspects to evaluate the personal contribution of each member of the Board of Management. The individual performance aspects may be based on the three dimensions growth, people and risk management. They may include strategic and operational aspects as well as non-financial aspects as the Supervisory Board also sees these aspects as being important for the strategy and success of Brenntag and wishes to reward them.

The final payout amount is capped at max. 200% of the individual and contractually agreed target amount (Cap). If the overall payout factor for the financial performance criteria is already 200%, the individual performance multiplier cannot increase the annual bonus further.

If the service agreement begins or ends during a financial year, the target amount for that financial year applies on a pro rata temporis basis.

The annual bonus should be paid out within three months from approval of the consolidated financial statements by

the Supervisory Board, but at the latest twelve months after the end of the financial year for which the annual bonus has been determined.

Long-term variable remuneration under the Remuneration System 2023

The long-term variable remuneration is granted in the form of virtual shares (performance share units). The number of virtual shares may increase or decrease depending on the long-term performance of Brenntag measured using specified performance criteria over a four-year performance period.

The number of virtual shares to be granted initially is calculated by dividing the individual and contractually agreed target amount by the arithmetic mean of the Brenntag share closing prices in the Xetra trading system during the last three months before the start of the performance period. If the service agreement begins or ends during a financial year, the target amount for that financial year is calculated on a pro rata temporis basis.



4.05 Structure of the performance share plan – Remuneration System 2023

The number of virtual shares finally awarded to the member of the Board of Management is linked to two financial performance criteria and to ESG targets by way of an ESG multiplier. The two financial performance criteria are Brenntag's total shareholder return (TSR) compared with a global peer group (weighting: 70%) and the return on capital employed (ROCE) (weighting: 30%). The sum of the respective weighted share awards for each performance criterion is then multi-

plied by the achievement of certain ESG targets by means of an ESG multiplier, which can range from 0.8 to 1.2. The resulting overall share award is then multiplied by the number of virtual shares initially granted, resulting in the number of virtual shares finally awarded to the member of the Board of Management at the end of the four-year performance period. The number of virtual shares finally awarded is limited to 200%.

REMUNERATION OF THE BOARD OF MANAGEMENT

The respective payout amount depends on the absolute change in the Brenntag share price over the four-year performance period and is determined by multiplying the number of virtual shares finally awarded by the arithmetic mean of the Brenntag share closing prices in the Xetra trading system during the last three months prior to the end of the performance period plus dividend payments during the performance period. The payout amount is capped at maximum 250% of the individual and contractually set target amount (Cap).

The payout amount is to be paid within three months from approval of the consolidated financial statements by the Supervisory Board, but at the latest twelve months after the end of the financial year in which the performance period ends.

The TSR is a key performance indicator for our shareholders. The TSR reflects the change in the share price and dividend distributions, i.e. the return of the Brenntag share. In addition to changes in share price and dividends, other capital measures are also considered. When comparing the TSR of the

Brenntag share with the shareholder return of other companies, the advantages of an investment in the Brenntag share are measured compared with alternative investments in shares of other companies. It is of central importance for the long-term stability of the company that shareholders receive an attractive return on their investment in Brenntag shares.

The relative TSR is defined as the ranking of Brenntag's TSR performance compared with the TSR performance of a group of global peer companies. When selecting global peer companies, the Supervisory Board considers the chemical distribution market as well as the distribution business model and the underlying market of Brenntag. The global peer group can be adjusted by the Supervisory Board, if necessary, to maintain a meaningful composition of the peer group (e.g. mergers, acquisitions and delisting of companies in the peer group).

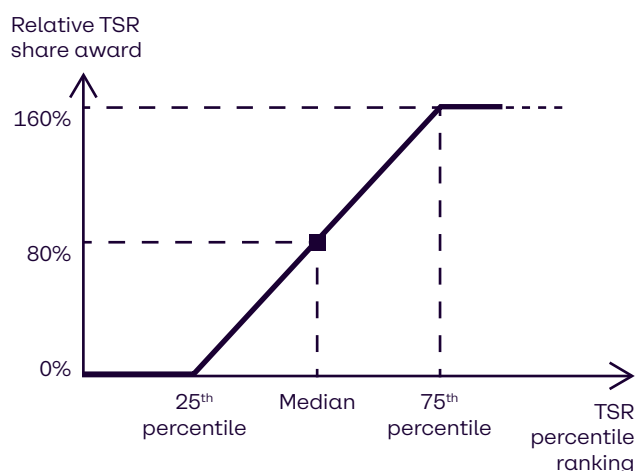
Univar Inc. was delisted on August 1, 2023 and the company is therefore no longer part of the peer group. The global peer group therefore now consists of the following companies:

Chemical distributors	Other distributors	Chemical producers
Azelis Group N.V.	Bossard Holding AG	Ashland Global Holdings Inc.
DKSH Holding AG	Bunzl plc	Croda International plc
IMCD N.V.	Rexel S.A.	Evonik Industries AG
	RS Group plc	DSM-Firmenich AG ¹⁾
	WW Grainger Inc.	LANXESS AG
		Solvay S.A.

4.06 Peer group of global competitors – Remuneration System 2023

¹⁾ Koninklijke DSM (DSM) was delisted on May 31, 2023 owing to its merger with Firmenich; it was therefore removed from the peer group. The shares of the merged company, DSM-Firmenich AG, were listed on the stock exchange on April 18, 2023. Koninklijke DSM N.V. is not part of the peer group for the LTIP tranche 2023-2026. DSM-Firmenich AG has been included in the peer group as of January 1, 2024.

The share award for the relative TSR is determined based on the percentile ranking method. If Brenntag's TSR percentile ranking is equal to the median (50th percentile), the share award for the relative TSR is 80%. If Brenntag's TSR percentile ranking is equal to or below the 25th percentile, the share award for the relative TSR is 0%. If Brenntag's TSR percentile ranking is equal to or exceeds the 75th percentile, the share award for the relative TSR is 160%. The range for relative TSR is defined as 0-160%, in contrast to the range for ROCE, to create a balanced risk-reward profile around the median through symmetry. Values in-between are determined by linear interpolation. This results in a share award curve as follows:



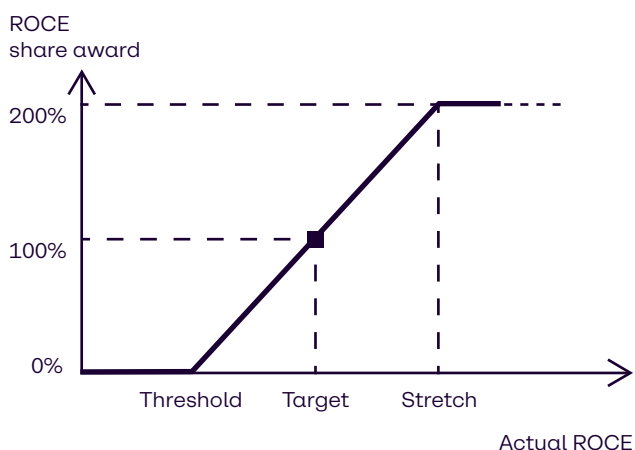
4.07 Relative TSR share award curve

In the Brenntag Group, return on capital is measured using return on capital employed (ROCE) that is defined as:

$$\text{ROCE} = \frac{\text{Operating EBITA}}{\begin{aligned} &(\text{average carrying amount of equity} \\ &+ \text{average carrying amount of financial} \\ &\text{and lease liabilities} \\ &- \text{average carrying amount of cash} \\ &\text{and cash equivalents}) \end{aligned}}$$

The average carrying amounts in the denominator are defined for a particular year as the arithmetic average of the amounts at each of the following five dates: the beginning of the year, the end of each of the first, second and third quarters, and the end of the year.

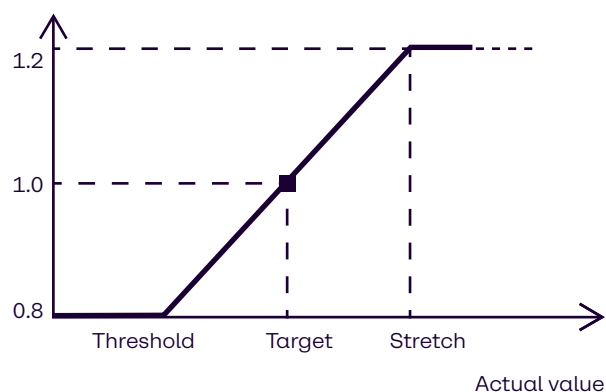
The Supervisory Board sets a threshold, target and stretch value for ROCE in the final year of the four-year performance period. If the defined target value for ROCE is achieved, this results in a share award of 100%. If the actual value for ROCE is equal to or below the threshold, this results in a share award of 0%. If the actual value for ROCE is equal to or above the stretch, this results in a maximum share award of 200%. If the actual values are between the respective target and threshold values or between the respective target and stretch values, the share award is determined by linear interpolation. The following is an example of a share award curve defined for ROCE:



4.08 ROCE share award curve

To ensure the sustainable and long-term success of Brenntag and its commitment to sustainable solutions in its own sector and the industries served, the Supervisory Board is required to define ambitious ESG targets based on Brenntag's sustainability strategy. Based on the relevance of the strategic ESG key areas which are subject to continuous evolution, the Supervisory Board selects up to three performance criteria and defines target values which are to be achieved at the end of the performance period of the respective tranche and translate into a multiplier between 0.8 and 1.2 for each ESG target. The multipliers for each ESG target are weighted equally resulting in an overall ESG multiplier between 0.8 and 1.2. An example of an ESG multiplier curve, defined for each ESG target, is as follows:

ESG multiplier



4.09 ESG multiplier curve per ESG target

The specific ESG targets for the 2023–2026, 2024–2027 and 2025–2028 tranches of the performance share plan are as follows:

- Reduction of greenhouse gas emissions (Scope 1 and Scope 2)
- Further increase in occupational safety (reduction in the Total Recordable Injury Frequency Rate (TRIR))
- Increase in the proportion of female employees at various management levels

For the 2023–2026, 2024–2027 and 2025–2028 tranches, the target values for the TRIR and the increase in the proportion of female employees are aligned with the ESG targets for a syndicated credit facility. For the 2023–2026 and 2024–2027 tranches, the target values for the reduction in greenhouse gas emissions (Scope 1 and Scope 2) are likewise aligned with the ESG targets for a syndicated credit facility. For the 2025–2028 tranche, the target value for the reduction in greenhouse gas emissions (Scope 1 and Scope 2) is derived from the Group-wide reduction targets, which were successfully validated by the Science Based Targets initiative (SBTi) in January 2025.

The ESG targets of the performance share plan can be aligned with the topics of climate change, health and safety, and diversity, in line with the double materiality assessment as outlined by the CSRD. Further information, including details on strategies and actions, can be found in the Group sustainability statement.

A forecast for the tranche of long-term variable remuneration to be granted in 2026 is not provided as this is currently under review.

Malus and clawback

The company is contractually entitled to withhold variable remuneration ("malus") in whole or in part if the members of the Board of Management breach their obligations under Section 93 of the German Stock Corporation Act or in case of breaches of duty which would justify a termination for cause (Section 626 German Civil Code (BGB)). Equally, the company is contractually entitled to correct the amount of variable remuneration determined if that determination was based on incorrect data. In addition, the company is contractually entitled to demand partial or complete repayment ("clawback") of variable remuneration if members of the Board of Management breach their obligations under Section 93 of the German Stock Corporation Act, or in case of breaches of duty which would justify a termination for cause (Section 626 German Civil Code), or payout of the variable remuneration was made on the basis of incorrect data. Malus and clawback events generally only have an effect on variable remuneration components for those financial years during which they actually occurred. Variable remuneration can be clawed back for a period of three years following payout.

In financial year 2025, no variable remuneration was retained or clawed back.

Caps and maximum remuneration

The Board of Management members' total remuneration is limited by a cap applying to each variable remuneration component and by maximum remuneration. Exceptional performance is required to achieve the cap of each variable remuneration component.

If the upper threshold for the financial key performance indicators of the annual bonus is achieved, a maximum preliminary payout amount of 200% of the target amount is reached. Even the application of the individual performance multiplier cannot increase the payout amount above this cap of 200%.

Under the performance share plan, the number of final virtual shares achievable is limited to 200% of the number of initial virtual shares granted. This maximum number of shares can only be reached if the Brenntag share performs better than 75% of the companies in the global peer group and if the upper thresholds for both ROCE and the ESG multiplier are reached. In addition, the payout amount depends on the performance of the Brenntag share price and dividend payments. The total payout under the performance share plan is limited to 250% of the initial target amount.

The maximum total remuneration comprises the annual base salary, maximum annual bonus remuneration, maximum performance share plan remuneration, the pension allowance and benefits in kind. The maximum total remuneration has been set at EUR 7,500,000 for Jens Birgersson, at EUR 4,350,000 for Thomas Reisten, at EUR 6,800,000 for Dr. Christian Kohlpaintner, at EUR 3,300,000 for Dr. Kristin Neumann and Ewout van Jarwaarde, and at EUR 3,900,000 for Michael Friede. If the service agreement begins or ends during a financial year, the remuneration cap for that financial year is adjusted on a pro rata temporis basis.

Share Ownership Guideline

In order to bring the interests of the Board of Management and shareholders more closely into line and to strengthen the Board of Management members' ownership in the company, there is an obligation to accumulate and hold Brenntag shares (Share Ownership Guideline). The chair of the Board of Management is obliged to accumulate and continue to hold shares to the value of 200% of his/her annual base salary for two years after the end of his/her service. Thomas Reisten, Dr. Kristin Neumann, Michael Friede and Ewout van Jarwaarde are obliged to accumulate and continue to hold shares to the value of 100% of their annual base salaries for two years after the end of their service. They must accumulate the shares within four years at the latest. In each of these four years, shares equivalent to 25% of the holding obligation must be acquired. Compliance with the obligation to hold shares is checked once a year, as at December 31.

The last check as at December 31, 2024 showed that all Board of Management members subject to the obligation had met their obligation to hold shares in full. The next check as at December 31, 2025 is expected to take place in March 2026.

Board of Management Remuneration System 2020

The Board of Management Remuneration System 2020 applied to the 2022–2025 tranche of the performance share plan granted under this system, the performance period of which ended in the reporting period.

Long-term variable remuneration under the Remuneration System 2020

The long-term variable remuneration is in the form of virtual shares (performance share units). The payout depends on the relative performance of the Brenntag share compared with two peer groups and the absolute change in the Brenntag share price over a four-year performance period.

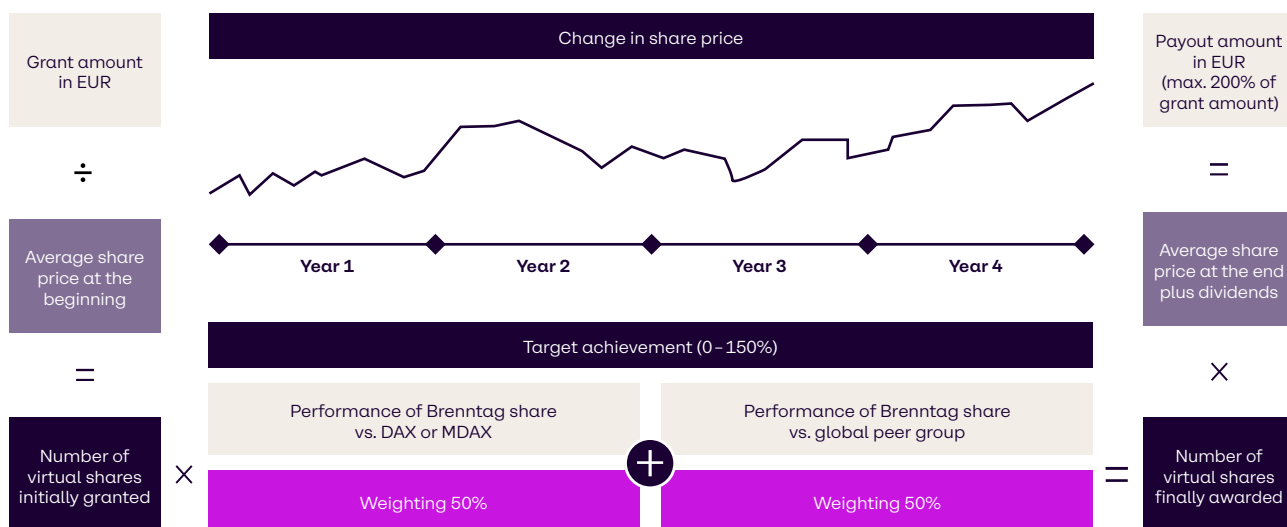
The annual virtual shares are contingently granted on January 1 of each financial year. The number of shares initially granted is calculated by dividing the individual and contractually agreed grant amount by the arithmetic mean of the

Brenntag share closing prices in the Xetra trading system during the last three months before the start of the performance period. If the service agreement begins or ends during a financial year, the amount for that financial year is granted on a pro rata temporis basis.

The number of virtual shares that a Board of Management member is finally granted at the end of the four-year performance period depends on two performance criteria that are set by the Supervisory Board and each weighted at 50%: the outperformance of the total shareholder return (TSR) of the Brenntag share compared with

- the TSR performance of the DAX or MDAX and
- the average TSR of a peer group of global competitors.

Due to the inclusion of Brenntag in the DAX, the national benchmark index was changed from the MDAX to the DAX in 2022. Furthermore, Azelis Group NV was added to the peer group of global competitors in 2022.



4.10 Structure of the performance share plan – Remuneration System 2020

The benchmark parameters for the performance criteria of the individual tranches are as follows:

Tranche	National benchmark index	Peer group of global competitors
2020	MDAX	Companies in Figure below excluding Azelis Group NV
2021		
2022	DAX	Companies in Figure below including Azelis Group NV
2023		

4.11 Overview of the benchmark parameters for each tranche – Remuneration System 2020

REMUNERATION OF THE BOARD OF MANAGEMENT

Univar Inc. was delisted on August 1, 2023 and the company is therefore no longer part of the peer group. The global peer group therefore now consists of the following companies:

Aalberts N.V.	Air Liquide S.A.	Ashland Global Holdings Inc.	Azelis Group NV
Bunzl plc	DKSH Holding Ltd.	RS Group plc ¹⁾	Evonik Industries AG
Ferguson plc	IMCD N.V.	Linde plc	McKesson Corporation
Rexel S.A.	Travis Perkins plc	W.W. Grainger, Inc.	

4.12 Peer group of global competitors – Remuneration System 2020

¹⁾ Note: RS Group plc. formerly traded under the name Electrocomponents plc.

Target achievement of each performance criterion is calculated by subtracting the performance of the DAX or MDAX or the average TSR of the global peer group from the TSR of the Brenntag share. If the performance of the DAX or MDAX or the average TSR of the global peer group equals the TSR of the Brenntag share, target achievement is 100%. If the TSR of the Brenntag share outperforms the DAX or MDAX or the average TSR of the global peer group by 25% or more percentage points, target achievement is 150%. If the TSR of the Brenntag share underperforms the DAX or MDAX or the average TSR of the global peer group by 25% or more percentage points, target achievement is 0%. Values in-between are determined by linear interpolation. Overall target achievement is calculated by multiplying the target achievement figures of the two performance criteria by their respective weightings and then adding together these two weighted target achievement figures.

The number of virtual shares that a Board of Management member is finally granted at the end of the four-year performance period is calculated by multiplying the number of virtual shares initially granted by the overall target achievement.

The payout amount is determined by multiplying the number of virtual shares finally granted by the arithmetic mean of the Brenntag share closing prices in the Xetra trading system during the last three months prior to the end of the performance period plus dividend payments during the performance period. The payout amount is capped at max. 200% of the individual and contractually set grant amount (Cap).

The payout amount is to be paid within three months from approval of the consolidated financial statements by the Supervisory Board, but at the latest twelve months after the end of the financial year in which the performance period ends.

Early payout of the tranches of the performance share plan is not possible under the Remuneration System 2020.

Malus and clawback

All variable remuneration components of a Board of Management member are only paid out after the end of the regular plan period. The Supervisory Board is contractually entitled to retain the variable remuneration (malus) in whole or in part if a Board of Management member violates their obligations under Section 93 of the German Stock Corporation Act. In addition, the Supervisory Board is contractually entitled to reclaim parts of the variable remuneration (clawback) if a Board of Management member breaches their obligations under Section 93 of the German Stock Corporation Act, payout of the variable remuneration was made on the basis of incorrect data or the company's EBITDA decreases by at least 25% within two years and during the Board of Management member's service compared with the EBITDA for which the variable remuneration was paid. Clawback of variable remuneration is possible up to an amount of 25% of the total remuneration for the respective financial year.

In financial year 2025 no variable remuneration was retained or clawed back.

Further remuneration and contractual provisions

The following describes further remuneration and contractual provisions that are largely applicable under both remuneration systems.

For building up pension entitlements, Jens Birgersson receives from the company an annual amount of EUR 330,000, Thomas Reisten receives an annual amount of EUR 160,000 and Dr. Christian Kohlpaintner receives an annual amount of EUR 300,000; they may decide at their own discretion how to use this money. The annual amount is paid out once a year to Jens Birgersson and Thomas Reisten and in twelve equal instalments at the end of each month to Dr. Christian Kohlpaintner. If the service agreement begins or ends during a financial year, the annual amount will be granted on a pro rata temporis basis for that financial year.

For building up pension entitlements, the other members of the Board of Management receive an annual amount of 13.5% (rounded to the next full EUR 1,000) of their annual base salary and the short-term variable remuneration (on 100% target achievement, i.e. irrespective of the actual targets achieved). Dr. Kristin Neumann, Michael Friede and Ewout van Jarwaarde are paid the relevant amount for building up pension entitlements every year and may decide at their own discretion how to use this money.

Apart from that, no expenses or provisions for pension commitments were incurred or recognized for the members of the Board of Management serving in financial year 2025, and they had been given no pension commitment.

Apart from the amounts explained above, which are made available to build up pension entitlements, no other arrangements for retirement and early retirement have been agreed.

In addition to the above-mentioned remuneration components, the Board of Management members receive benefits in kind and other benefits, such as a mobility allowance, and benefits for health care and long-term care insurance.

The benefits for health care and long-term care insurance are limited to max. 50% of the premium they pay into their health care and long-term care insurance. Should Ewout van Jarwaarde be subject to the statutory social security system in the Netherlands, Brenntag will pay the corresponding employer contributions to the Dutch social security system up to an amount of EUR 20,000 per year.

Furthermore, a group accident insurance has been taken out. In addition, the company has taken out Directors & Officers Insurance (damage liability insurance) for the Board of Management members. This provides for a deductible of 10% of the damages claimed in each case, but in each year limited to 150% of the annual base salary.

In the event of temporary disability due to illness, accident, or any other cause not due to the fault of a Board of Management member, said member is entitled to continued payment of the full annual base salary for a period of no more than nine months. For the first three months of such incapacity, full entitlement to the annual bonus and the target or grant amount of the long-term variable remuneration is also retained. In the event of the death of a Board of Management member, the base salary is paid to their surviving dependents for the month of their death and the six months following their death or until the date on which the service agreement would have been terminated without their death, whichever event occurs first.

Contract termination provisions

The service agreements of the Board of Management members end automatically on specified dates without any notice of termination being required. The employment of Board of Management members may only be terminated prematurely for good cause or by mutual agreement. If employment is terminated prematurely, the service agreement limits any severance pay to the value of twice the total annual remuneration, but no more than the amount of remuneration that would be paid until the end of the term of the service agreement.

A post-contractual non-compete obligation has been agreed with Jens Birgersson, Thomas Reisten, Dr. Christian Kohlpaintner, Dr. Kristin Neumann, Michael Friede and Ewout van Jarwaarde. The post-contractual non-compete obligation applies to Jens Birgersson for 12 months and to the other members of the Board of Management named above for 24 months after termination of their service agreement. During this period, there is an entitlement to continued payment amounting to 75% of their annual base salary. Any earnings pursuant to Section 74c of the German Commercial Code (HGB) are deducted from this payment.

There are no separate change-of-control arrangements.

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Target remuneration of Board of Management members serving in financial year 2025

In order to ensure transparent reporting of the Board of Management remuneration, the following table first shows the contractually agreed target amounts for the individual remuneration components for each serving Board of Management member plus the benefits in kind. As Jens Birgersson and Thomas Reisten were appointed to the Board of Management during 2025 and the service agreements of Dr. Kristin Neumann and Michael Friede ended during the year, the target amounts indicated in that year are pro rata temporis amounts.

		Jens Birgersson	Thomas Reisten	Dr. Christian Kohlpaintner
Term of service agreement		(until Aug. 31, 2028)	(until Mar. 31, 2028)	(until Dec. 31, 2025)
		in EUR k	in EUR k	in EUR k
Annual base salary	2025	433	542	1,050
	2024	-	-	1,050
Pension allowance	2025	110	133	300
	2024	-	-	300
Benefits in kind/other benefits	2025	19	31	57
	2024	-	-	61
Total non-performance-based remuneration	2025	562	706	1,407
	2024	-	-	1,411
Short-term variable remuneration	2025	433¹⁾	583	1,000
	2024	-	-	1,000
Long-term variable remuneration	2025	533	667	1,300
	2024	-	-	1,300
Total performance-based remuneration	2025	967	1,250	2,300
	2024	-	-	2,300
Total remuneration	2025	1,529	1,956	3,707
	2024	-	-	3,711

		Dr. Kristin Neumann	Michael Friede	Ewout van Jarwaarde
Term of service agreement		(until Mar. 31, 2025)	(until Nov. 30, 2025)	(until Mar. 31, 2026)
		in EUR k	in EUR k	in EUR k
Annual base salary	2025	131	481	525
	2024	525	525	525
Pension allowance	2025	35	134	139
	2024	139	146	139
Benefits in kind/other benefits	2025	9	34	44
	2024	36	37	43
Total non-performance-based remuneration	2025	175	649	708
	2024	700	708	707
Short-term variable remuneration	2025	125	504	500
	2024	500	550	500
Long-term variable remuneration	2025	150	733	600
	2024	600	800	600
Total performance-based remuneration	2025	275	1,238	1,100
	2024	1,100	1,350	1,100
Total remuneration	2025	450	1,887	1,808
	2024	1,800	2,058	1,807

4.13 Target remuneration of the Board of Management members serving in financial year 2025

¹⁾ The system for determining the annual bonus 2025 does not apply to Jens Birgersson. An explanation of this can be found at the beginning of the section "Board of Management Remuneration System 2023".

REMUNERATION OF THE BOARD OF MANAGEMENT

Performance criteria for the variable remuneration

The following table shows the respective targets and the results actually achieved for the annual bonus 2025. The respective target achievement is calculated from the two figures.

The results of organic operating EBITA are calculated on the basis of constant exchange rates. Specifically, the exchange rates used in the 2025 budget are applied, which also form the basis for setting the target values.

The system for determining the annual bonus 2025 does not apply to Jens Birgersson. An explanation of this can be found at the beginning of the section "Board of Management Remuneration System 2023".

Thomas Reisten, Dr. Christian Kohlpaintner, Dr. Kristin Neumann, Michael Friede and Ewout van Jarwaarde					
2025	Threshold	Target	Cap	Result	Target achievement
Organic operating EBITA (in EUR m)					
Brenntag Group	1,071.5	1,190.5	1,309.6	940.4	-
Brenntag Specialties	422.4	469.3	516.2	397.7	-
Brenntag Essentials	750.3	833.7	917.1	659.1	-
Working capital turnover					
Brenntag Group	7.40 x	7.90 x	8.40 x	7.30 x	-
Earnings per share (in EUR)					
Brenntag Group	3.64	4.04	4.44	1.83	-

4.14 Performance criteria for the annual bonus 2025 – Remuneration System 2023

The Supervisory Board and the Board of Management members have agreed individual performance aspects to measure individual performance. Each performance aspect is linked to specific sub-aspects which are used to assess achievement of the respective performance aspect. This approach enables a holistic view to be taken when determining the individual performance multiplier for 2025. These individual performance aspects include the following:

- **Health, Safety and Environment:** Develop and implement measures to strengthen the safety culture and achieve measurable improvements in occupational health and safety and environmental protection, including process safety. The assessment is based on measurable progress in the implementation of global safety and sustainability programs.
- **Operational performance – Gross profit, margins and portfolio:** Improve the operational performance of both divisions by implementing budget targets, optimizing the product and service portfolio, improving margins, and continuing strategic portfolio adjustments and efficiency measures. Operational performance was assessed on the basis of quantitative key financial indicators and progress in portfolio optimization. This is based on objective planned-actual comparisons.
- **Operational performance – Cost efficiency:** Achieve budgeted savings and develop further efficiency programs in the areas of transport, warehousing, sales, and support functions to sustainably reduce the operating cost base. The assessment is based on analytically tracked efficiency gains and cost improvements compared with budget targets.
- **Risk management, Compliance and ESG:** Further improve integrated risk and compliance management and the ESG strategy with a focus on transparency, compliance with regulations, reduction of CO₂ emissions, and sustainable corporate development. The assessment is based on measurable targets such as audit findings, training rates, and sustainability metrics.
- **M&A, CapEx and cash flow:** Integrate acquisitions, optimize investment and divestment criteria, and ensure disciplined capital expenditure and stable cash flow development within the framework of the corporate strategy. The assessment takes into account compliance with investment and integration targets as part of the long-term financial strategy. It is based on quantitative indicators for capital utilization and integration efficiency.

REMUNERATION OF THE BOARD OF MANAGEMENT

- **Digitalization und DIDEX refocus:** Continue and refocus the DIDEX digitalization program on system harmonization, process standardization, and efficiency improvements in the fields of sales, logistics, and ERP systems. The assessment is based on the analytical progress of the digitalization programs in terms of time, cost, and quality targets.
- **Leadership, succession and culture:** Ensure leadership and succession planning at the highest management level, promote talent, and strengthen corporate culture through transparent communication, global employee engagement, and targeted development programs. The assessment is based on defined milestones in succession planning and in-house management development programs.

In order to protect confidential company information and safeguard against competitive disadvantages, the sub-aspects and assessment criteria for individual performance aspects are not disclosed in detail.

The link to ESG in the individual performance multiplier is established directly through the relevant performance aspects. There is also the requirement that special weight is given to the avoidance of particularly serious HSE (health, safety, environment) incidents when assessing individual performance.

For Dr. Kristin Neumann, the only individual performance aspect, by way of exception, was ensuring a smooth hand-over to Thomas Reisten.

Also, from a holistic perspective, the Supervisory Board finds that the expectations placed on the Board of Management members regarding progress in the individual performance aspects have generally been met. The individual performance multiplier was set by the Supervisory Board at 1.00 for Thomas Reisten, 0.97 for Dr. Christian Kohlpaintner, 1.20 for Dr. Kristin Neumann, 0.97 for Michael Friede and 0.97 for Ewout van Jarwaarde.

The annual bonuses for 2025 are calculated on the basis of the performance criteria previously described and the individual performance multipliers as follows:

2025	Thomas Reisten	Dr. Christian Kohlpaintner	Dr. Kristin Neumann	Michael Friede	Ewout van Jarwaarde
Target amount	EUR 583k	EUR 1,000k	EUR 125k	EUR 504k	EUR 500k
Organic operating EBITA (weighting 60%)					
Brenntag Group					
Target achievement	-	-	-	-	-
Brenntag Specialties					
Target achievement	-	-	-	-	-
Brenntag Essentials					
Target achievement	-	-	-	-	-
EBITA overall target achievement	-	-	-	-	-
Working capital turnover (weighting 20%)					
Brenntag Group					
Target achievement	-	-	-	-	-
Earnings per share (weighting 20%)					
Brenntag Group					
Target achievement	-	-	-	-	-
Overall target achievement	-	-	-	-	-
Preliminary payout amount	-	-	-	-	-
Individual performance multiplier	1.00	0.97	1.20	0.97	0.97
Final payout amount	-	-	-	-	-

4.15 Calculation of the annual bonus for 2025 – Remuneration System 2023

REMUNERATION OF THE BOARD OF MANAGEMENT

The performance criteria for the 2022-2025 tranche of the performance share plan under the Board of Management Remuneration System 2020 were set at the end of 2021. Dr. Christian Kohlpaintner, Dr. Kristin Neumann and Ewout van Jarwaarde, along with former Board of Management mem-

bers Henri Nejade and Steven Terwindt, are the recipients of this tranche. The performance period ran from January 1, 2022 to December 31, 2025 and the payout amounts are determined on the basis of the performance criteria previously described as follows:

Tranche 2022-2025	Dr. Christian Kohlpaintner	Dr. Kristin Neumann	Ewout van Jarwaarde	Henri Nejade	Steven Terwindt
Grant amount	EUR 1,200k	EUR 500k	EUR 550k	EUR 600k	EUR 600k
Average share price at the beginning of the performance period	EUR 79.62	EUR 79.62	EUR 79.62	EUR 79.62	EUR 79.62
Number of virtual shares initially granted	15,072	6,280	6,908	7,536	7,536
Brenntag TSR performance	-30.5%	-30.5%	-30.5%	-30.5%	-30.5%
Average TSR performance of the global peer group (weighting 50%)	19.9%	19.9%	19.9%	19.9%	19.9%
TSR outperformance vs. global peer group	-50.4%	-50.4%	-50.4%	-50.4%	-50.4%
Target achievement	-	-	-	-	-
DAX TSR performance (weighting 50%)	53.6%	53.6%	53.6%	53.6%	53.6%
TSR outperformance vs. DAX	-84.1%	-84.1%	-84.1%	-84.1%	-84.1%
Target achievement	-	-	-	-	-
Overall target achievement	-	-	-	-	-
Number of virtual shares finally awarded	-	-	-	-	-
Average share price at the end of the performance period plus dividend	EUR 56.90	EUR 56.90	EUR 56.90	EUR 56.90	EUR 56.90
Payout amount (max. 200% of grant amount)	-	-	-	-	-

4.16 Calculation of the 2022-2025 tranche of the performance share plan – Remuneration System 2020

Information on remuneration awarded and due to Board of Management members serving in financial year 2025 and former members in accordance with Section 162 AktG

In the Remuneration Report 2025, the second interpretation option acceptable to the Institute of Public Auditors in Germany is applied and remuneration is therefore deemed to have been "awarded and due in the financial year" if the underlying activity has been performed in full by the end of the financial year or the vesting period has been completed in full and the vesting requirements have been met.

Information on remuneration awarded and due to Board of Management members serving in financial year 2025 in accordance with Section 162 AktG

Dr. Christian Kohlpaintner stepped down from the Board of Management by mutual agreement on August 31, 2025, but his service agreement remained in force until December 31, 2025 in order to support the onboarding of Jens Birgersson and ensure an orderly handover of his duties. Jens Birgersson took over as CEO of the Brenntag Group on September 1, 2025.

Dr. Kristin Neumann stepped down on March 31, 2025 and her service agreement ended on the same day. The post-contractual non-compete obligation under the Remuneration System 2023 was waived. She received compensation, which, taking into account the six-month notice period, was paid only until June 17, 2025. Thomas Reisten took over as Chief Financial Officer on April 1, 2025. His service agreement began on March 1, 2025.

On September 8, 2025, Ewout van Jarwaarde stepped down from the Board of Management by mutual agreement. His service agreement will continue until March 31, 2026 to ensure the orderly handover of his duties and to handle important queries from members of the Board of Management and interactions with business partners.

On November 30, 2025, Michael Friede stepped down and his service agreement, which was due to run until March 31, 2026, was terminated on the same date.

By mutual agreement, the post-contractual non-compete obligations for Dr. Christian Kohlpaintner, Michael Friede and Ewout van Jarwaarde were waived, meaning that no compensation will be paid after the respective termination dates of their service agreements.

Dr. Kristin Neumann and Michael Friede received their base salary and pension allowance on a pro rata temporis basis, and their annual bonuses for 2025 were also calculated on a pro rata basis. The entitlements under the current tranches of the performance share plan for Dr. Christian Kohlpaintner, Dr. Kristin Neumann, Michael Friede and Ewout van Jarwaarde will be paid out after the end of the respective performance period in accordance with the originally planned conditions (for details on the 2022–2025 tranche, see the section "Performance criteria for the variable remuneration").

REMUNERATION OF THE BOARD OF MANAGEMENT

The total remuneration for the individual Board of Management members serving in financial year 2025 is as follows:

Term of service agreement		Jens Birgersson (until Aug. 31, 2028)		Dr. Christian Kohlpaintner (until Dec. 31, 2025)		Thomas Reisten (until Mar. 31, 2028)	
		in EUR k	in %	in EUR k	in %	in EUR k	in %
Annual base salary	2025	433	43.5	700²⁾	74.6	542	76.7
	2024	-	-	1,050	40.4	-	-
Pension allowance	2025	110	11.1	200²⁾	21.3	133	18.9
	2024	-	-	300	11.6	-	-
Benefits in kind/other benefits	2025	452²⁾	45.4	38²⁾	4.1	31	4.4
	2024	-	-	61	2.3	-	-
Total non-performance-based remuneration	2025	996	100.0	938	100.0	706	100.0
	2024	-	-	1,411	54.3	-	-
Short-term variable remuneration	2025	-	-	-	-	-	-
	2024	-	-	243	9.4	-	-
Long-term variable remuneration	2025	-	-	-	-	-	-
	2024	-	-	944	36.3	-	-
Total performance-based remuneration	2025	-	-	-	-	-	-
	2024	-	-	1,187	45.7	-	-
Total remuneration	2025	996	100.0	938	100.0	706	100.0
	2024	-	-	2,598	100.0	-	-

Term of service agreement		Dr. Kristin Neumann (until Mar. 31, 2025)		Michael Friede (until Nov. 30, 2025)		Ewout van Jarwaarde (until Mar. 31, 2026)	
		in EUR k	in %	in EUR k	in %	in EUR k	in %
Annual base salary	2025	131	74.8	481	74.1	362³⁾	74.1
	2024	525	63.9	525	62.4	525	41.6
Pension allowance	2025	35	20.0	134	20.6	96³⁾	19.6
	2024	139	16.9	146	17.3	139	11.0
Benefits in kind/other benefits	2025	9	5.2	34	5.3	31³⁾	6.3
	2024	36	4.4	37	4.4	43	3.5
Total non-performance-based remuneration	2025	175	100.0	649	100.0	488	100.0
	2024	700	85.2	708	84.1	707	56.1
Short-term variable remuneration	2025	-	-	-	-	-	-
	2024	122	14.8	134	15.9	122	9.6
Long-term variable remuneration	2025	-	-	-	-	-	-
	2024	-	-	-	-	433	34.3
Total performance-based remuneration	2025	-	-	-	-	-	-
	2024	122	14.8	134	15.9	554	43.9
Total remuneration	2025	175	100.0	649	100.0	488	100.0
	2024	822	100.0	842	100.0	1,262	100.0

4.17 Remuneration awarded and due to Board of Management members serving in financial year 2025 in accordance with Section 162 AktG

¹⁾ Includes a contractually agreed sign-on bonus in the amount of EUR 433k, which is due for payment in 2026. A corresponding explanation is provided at the beginning of the section "Board of Management Remuneration System 2023".

²⁾ The annual base salary, pension allowance and benefits in kind are allocated on a pro rata temporis basis to the remuneration of former Board of Management members from September 1, 2025.

³⁾ The annual base salary, pension allowance and benefits in kind are allocated on a pro rata temporis basis to the remuneration of former Board of Management members from September 9, 2025.

REMUNERATION OF THE BOARD OF MANAGEMENT

Information on remuneration awarded and due to former Board of Management members in accordance with Section 162 of the German Stock Corporation Act (AktG)

As a former member of the Board of Management, Dr. Christian Kohlpaintner received a 100% non-performance-based base salary of EUR 469k from September 1, 2025.

As a former member of the Board of Management, Ewout van Jarwaarde received 100% non-performance-based remuneration of EUR 2,814k from September 9, 2025, consisting of a base salary of EUR 220k, a severance payment for early termination of his service agreement amounting to EUR 2,496k and the 2026 annual bonus amounting to EUR 98k. In accordance with the terms of his Board of Management service agreement, the 2026 annual bonus is calculated as the arithmetic mean of all annual bonus payments which he received during his entire term of office. The 2026 annual bonus is due for payment in 2027.

Dr. Kristin Neumann received post-contractual and 100% non-performance-based non-compete compensation of EUR 84k for the period from April 1, 2025 to June 17, 2025, as agreed in her service agreement.

In financial year 2025, EUR 315k was paid as part of a 100% non-performance-based pension commitment to a former member of the Board of Management who retired before 2014.

Under the Remuneration System 2020, entitlements under the performance share plan will be paid to Henri Nejade and Steven Terwindt upon completion of the performance period for the 2022-2025 tranche. Details regarding the 2022-2025 tranche are provided in the section "Performance criteria for the variable remuneration." Since December 2025, Henri Nejade has also been receiving pension payments.

Apart from these amounts, no remuneration was awarded or due to former Board of Management members in financial year 2025.

The following table shows the remuneration awarded and due to former Board of Management members:

		Henri Nejade		Steven Terwindt	
		in EUR k	in %	in EUR k	in %
Annual base salary	2025	-	-	-	-
	2024	-	-	-	-
Pension allowance	2025	-	-	-	-
	2024	-	-	-	-
Benefits in kind/other benefits	2025	-	-	-	-
	2024	-	-	230	32.7
Total non-performance-based remuneration	2025	-	-	-	-
	2024	-	-	230	32.7
Short-term variable remuneration	2025	-	-	-	-
	2024	-	-	-	-
Long-term variable remuneration	2025	-	-	-	-
	2024	472	100.0	472	67.3
Total performance-based remuneration	2025	-	-	-	-
	2024	472	100.0	472	67.3
Pension payments received	2025	8	100.0	-	-
	2024	-	-	-	-
Total remuneration	2025	8	100.0	-	-
	2024	472	100.0	702	100.0

4.18 Remuneration awarded and due to former Board of Management members in accordance with Section 162 AktG

REMUNERATION OF THE BOARD OF MANAGEMENT

Information on shares granted in the financial year

Jens Birgersson, Thomas Reisten, Dr. Christian Kohlpaintner, Dr. Kristin Neumann, Michael Friede and Ewout van Jarwaarde have been contingently granted virtual Brenntag shares, so-called performance share units, as part of their

long-term variable remuneration under both the Remuneration System 2020 and the Remuneration System 2023.

The performance share units are paid out after the end of the respective four-year performance period. The specific performance criteria previously defined for the relevant Board of Management remuneration system are taken into account.

	Jens Birgersson	Thomas Reisten	Dr. Christian Kohlpaintner	Dr. Kristin Neumann	Michael Friede	Ewout van Jarwaarde
2022 tranche ¹⁾	-	0	15,072	6,280	-	6,908
2023 tranche ²⁾	-	0	21,124	9,750	9,750	9,344
2024 tranche ³⁾	-	0	17,349	8,007	10,676	8,007
2025 tranche ⁴⁾	8,693	10,867	21,190	2,445	11,953	9,780

4.19 Performance share units initially contingently granted

¹⁾ The relevant Brenntag share price was EUR 79.62 at the beginning of the performance period and EUR 49.25 at the end of the performance period.

²⁾ Price of the Brenntag share applicable at the beginning of the performance period: EUR 61.54

³⁾ Price of the Brenntag share applicable at the beginning of the performance period: EUR 74.93

⁴⁾ Price of the Brenntag share applicable at the beginning of the performance period: EUR 61.35

Compliance with maximum remuneration

In order to comply with the maximum remuneration requirement, all remuneration components hitherto awarded and due for a financial year are listed and allocated to the financial years in which they were granted. These amounts are added up and compared with the maximum remuneration to be applied for that financial year.

A final assessment for the years 2023, 2024 and 2025 can only be made once all remuneration components have been awarded or are due. In particular, entitlements under long-term variable remuneration cannot be determined until after the end of the respective performance periods.

The following table gives a detailed breakdown of how the maximum remuneration requirement for financial year 2022 was observed:

Ultimately, it was determined that the maximum remuneration for each Board of Management member was not exceeded in 2022.

in EUR k	Dr. Christian Kohlpaintner	Dr. Kristin Neumann	Ewout van Jarwaarde	Henri Nejade	Steven Terwindt
Annual base salary	1,000	438	475	525	525
Pension allowance	300	116	125	-	139
Service cost	-	-	-	293	-
Benefits in kind/other benefits	38	30	36	454	44
Short-term variable remuneration	1,800	833	900	1,000	1,000
Long-term variable remuneration 2022-2025 tranche	-	-	-	-	-
Total remuneration realized in accordance with Sec. 87a, para. 1, sentence 2, no. 1 AktG	3,138	1,417	1,536	2,272	1,708
Maximum remuneration agreed	5,650	2,500¹⁾	2,700	3,400	3,000

4.20 Compliance with the maximum remuneration requirement in 2022 – Remuneration System 2020

¹⁾ On a pro rata temporis basis for the period from March 1 to December 31, 2022; full-year equivalent: EUR 3,000,000.

Remuneration of the Supervisory Board

The remuneration system for the Supervisory Board was approved by 95.32% of the votes cast at the Annual General Meeting of Brenntag SE on June 15, 2023.

The provisions of the German Stock Corporation Act and the recommendations of the German Corporate Governance Code on remuneration for members of the Supervisory Board provide the regulatory framework for the remuneration system. The remuneration of the members of the Supervisory Board is purely fixed remuneration:

Fixed remuneration of the members of the Supervisory Board

Chair
of the Supervisory Board
EUR 325,000

Deputy Chair
of the Supervisory Board
EUR 162,500

Member
of the Supervisory Board
EUR 130,000

Remuneration for committee memberships of the members of the Supervisory Board

Chair
Nomination and Remuneration Committee
Audit and Compliance Committee
Transformation and ESG Committee and
any additional committee that may be established
each EUR 125,000

Member
Nomination and Remuneration Committee
Audit and Compliance Committee
Transformation and ESG Committee and
any additional committee that may be established
each EUR 50,000

Share ownership guidelines for the members of the Supervisory Board

Personal investment in shares of Brenntag SE (20% of gross fixed remuneration per year)
with holding obligation for the duration of an appointment period.

4.21 Remuneration system for the members of the Supervisory Board

The remuneration levels take into account the functions and the respective responsibilities of the members of the Supervisory Board and are in an appropriate relationship to the situation of Brenntag. The remuneration of supervisory boards and committees in comparable national and international companies of the same industry is also considered.

The expertise of Supervisory Board members needed for constructive work in different committees and their time commitment are very similar for the committees. Therefore, the remuneration paid for committee memberships is standardized.

In line with international market practice, the members of the Supervisory Board must invest part of their fixed remuneration in Brenntag shares in order to align with the interests of shareholders.

REMUNERATION OF THE SUPERVISORY BOARD

The following table shows the amounts due in 2025 to Supervisory Board members serving in financial year 2025 and former members:

in EUR k		Fixed remuneration	Remuneration for committee work	Total
Richard Ridinger Chair	2025	325	100	425
	2024	325	100	425
Stefanie Berlinger Deputy Chair (since May 22, 2025)	2025	150	50	200
	2024	130	50	180
Dr. Andreas Rittstieg Deputy Chair (until May 22, 2025)	2025	64	49	113
	2024	163	125	288
Sujatha Chandrasekaran	2025	130	50	180
	2024	130	50	180
Wijnand P. Donkers	2025	130	145	275
	2024	130	175	305
Ulrich M. Harnacke	2025	130	145	275
	2024	130	175	305
Dominik de Daniel (since May 22, 2025)	2025	79	30	109
	2024	-	-	-
Karl von Rohr (since July 9, 2025)	2025	62	60	122
	2024	-	-	-
Susanne Wiegand (since July 9, 2025)	2025	62	24	86
	2024	-	-	-
Total remuneration	2025	1,132	652	1,784
	2024	1,008	675	1,683

4.22 Remuneration awarded and due (vesting-based interpretation) to the Supervisory Board¹⁾

¹⁾ Note: The remuneration of the Supervisory Board members is purely fixed remuneration.

The members of the Supervisory Board serving as at December 31, 2025 are obliged to invest 20% of gross fixed remuneration for 2025 as a personal investment in shares of Brenntag SE and to hold the shares in their ownership until the end of their term of office. The investment obligation comes into effect at the end of 2025 and must be met by the end of 2026. The check for compliance with this obligation as at December 31, 2026 is expected to be performed in March 2027 and a report will be given in the Remuneration report 2027.

The last check as at December 31, 2024 showed that all members of the Supervisory Board who were required to do so had fully met their investment obligations. The next check as at December 31, 2025 is expected to take place in March 2026.

Furthermore, Directors & Officers insurance (damage liability insurance) has been taken out for the members of the Supervisory Board. Beyond this, Supervisory Board members received no further remuneration or benefits for personal services rendered, in particular advisory and mediatory services, in the reporting period. No loans or advances were granted to members of the Supervisory Board in the reporting period, nor were any guarantees or other commitments entered into in their favor.

CHANGES IN EARNINGS AND REMUNERATION OVER TIME

Changes in earnings and remuneration over time

	2025	2024	25/24	24/23	23/22	22/21	21/20
Remuneration of serving members of the Board of Management							
Jens Birgersson	EUR 996k	-	+100.0%	-	-	-	-
Thomas Reisten	EUR 706k	-	+100.0%	-	-	-	-
Dr. Christian Kohlpaintner	EUR 1,407k	EUR 2,598k	-45.9%	-31.8%	+21.4%	-	+0.5%
Dr. Kristin Neumann	EUR 175k	EUR 822k	-78.7%	+17.6%	-50.7%	+100.0%	-
Michael Friede	EUR 649k	EUR 842k	-22.9%	+8.0%	+100.0%	-	-
Ewout van Jarwaarde	EUR 3,302k	EUR 1,262k	+161.7%	+78.3%	-53.9%	-0.1%	+100.0%
Remuneration of former members of the Board of Management							
Henri Nejade	EUR 8k	EUR 472k	-98.3%	-30.2%	-65.8%	-30.8%	+24.7%
Steven Terwindt	-	EUR 702k	-100.0%	-44.8%	-25.5%	+0.9%	+481.8%
Karsten Beckmann	-	-	-	-	-100.0%	+EUR 937k ¹⁾	-100.3%
Markus Klähn	-	-	-	-	-	-100.0%	-0.3%
Georg Müller	-	-	-	-	-100.0%	+25.2%	+23.3%
Remuneration of serving members of the Supervisory Board							
Richard Ridinger	EUR 425k	EUR 425k	-	+26.5%	+97.4%	-	+112.5%
Stefanie Berlinger	EUR 200k	EUR 180k	+11.0%	-	+24.1%	-	-
Dr. Andreas Rittstieg	EUR 113k	EUR 288k	-60.8%	+13.8%	+44.6%	-	+9.4%
Sujatha Chandrasekaran	EUR 180k	EUR 180k	-	+83.7%	+100.0%	-	-
Wijnand P. Donkers	EUR 275k	EUR 305k	-10.0%	+12.5%	+59.2%	-	+30.8%
Ulrich M. Harnacke	EUR 275k	EUR 305k	-10.0%	+8.2%	+37.6%	-	-
Dominik de Daniel	EUR 109k	-	+100.0%	-	-	-	-
Karl von Rohr	EUR 122k	-	+100.0%	-	-	-	-
Susanne Wiegand	EUR 86k	-	+100.0%	-	-	-	-
Remuneration of former members of the Supervisory Board							
Doreen Nowotne	-	-	-	-100.0%	-7.5%	-	+50.8%
Remuneration of employees²⁾							
Ø employee Brenntag SE	EUR 129k	EUR 131k	-1.8%	+9.2%	+9.1%	+8.9%	+6.5%
Change in earnings							
Profit after tax Brenntag Group	EUR 269.7m	EUR 543.7m	-50.4%	-24.6%	-20.1%	+95.6%	-2.6%
Profit after tax Brenntag SE	EUR 200.7m	EUR 312.4m	-35.8%	+159.0%	-51.9%	+3.8%	+8.8%

4.23 Changes in Board of Management, Supervisory Board and employee remuneration

¹⁾ Since Karsten Beckmann repaid an amount of EUR 14k, the remuneration awarded and due to him in 2021 was negative. The corresponding change in 2022 compared with 2021 can therefore only be stated in absolute terms.

²⁾ Apart from apprentices, interns and pre-retirement part-time workers, all employees of Brenntag SE and thus of the Group head office who had a valid employment contract with Brenntag SE in the respective financial year are included in the changes in average employee remuneration.

CHANGES IN EARNINGS AND REMUNERATION OVER TIME

The above table shows the changes in the remuneration of the Board of Management, Supervisory Board and employees as well as the changes in the company's earnings.

Changes in remuneration and the company's earnings were shown for the first time from 2020 to 2021 and are now updated every year in the remuneration report. With serving and former Board of Management members, the total remuneration awarded and due is taken into account as described in the section "Information on remuneration awarded and due to Board of Management members serving in financial year 2025 and former members in accordance with Section 162 of the German Stock Corporation Act (AktG)". In the case of serving and former Supervisory Board members, the total remuneration awarded and due is taken into account as described in the section "Remuneration of the Supervisory Board". Apart from apprentices, interns and pre-retirement part-time workers, all employees who had a valid employment contract with Brenntag SE in the respective financial year are included in the changes in average employee remuneration.

Part-time employment and entries and departures from the company during the year are extrapolated to the full-year, full-time equivalent. Base salary and short-term and long-term variable remuneration paid in the financial year are included in the calculation for employees. Benefits in kind and company pension schemes for employees are excluded from the calculation as these remuneration components are to a large extent purely administrative and are not subject to the classic, annual adjustment mechanism. In this analysis, we focus only on the employees of Brenntag SE in order to avoid a distorted picture in the future as a result of takeovers and different remuneration dynamics in other countries.

Report of the Independent Auditor

To Brenntag SE, Essen / Germany

We have audited the accompanying remuneration report of Brenntag SE, Essen/Germany, ("the Company") for the financial year from January 1 to December 31, 2025, including the related disclosures, which has been prepared to comply with Section 162 German Stock Corporation Act (AktG).

Responsibilities of the Executive Directors and of the Supervisory Board

The executive directors and the supervisory board of Brenntag SE, Essen/Germany, are responsible for the preparation of the remuneration report, including the related disclosures, that complies with the requirements of Section 162 AktG. The executive directors and the supervisory board are also responsible for such internal control as they consider necessary to enable the preparation of a remuneration report, including the related disclosures, that is free from material misstatement, whether due to fraud (i.e., fraudulent financial reporting and misappropriation of assets) or error.

Auditor's Responsibilities

Our responsibility is to express an opinion on this remuneration report, including the related disclosures, based on our audit. We conducted our audit in compliance with German Generally Accepted Standards for Financial Statement Audits promulgated by the Institut der Wirtschaftsprüfer (IDW). These Standards require that we fulfill the professional responsibilities and that we plan and perform the audit so that we obtain reasonable assurance as to whether the remuneration report, including the related disclosures, is free from material misstatements.

An audit involves performing audit procedures in order to obtain audit evidence for the amounts stated in the remuneration report, including the related disclosures. The choice of the audit procedures is subject to the auditor's professional judgment. This includes assessing the risk of material misstatements, whether due to fraud or error, in the remuneration report, including the related disclosures. In assessing these risks, the auditor considers the system of internal control, which is relevant to preparing the remuneration report, including the related disclosures. Our objective is to plan and perform audit procedures that are appropriate in the circumstances, but not to express an audit opinion on the effectiveness of the Company's system of internal control. An audit also comprises an evaluation of the accounting policies used, of the reasonableness of accounting estimates made by the executive directors and the supervisory board as well as an evaluation of the overall presentation of the remuneration report, including the related disclosures.

We believe that the audit evidence we have obtained is sufficient and appropriate to provide a basis for our audit opinion.

Audit Opinion

In our opinion, on the basis of the knowledge obtained in the audit, the remuneration report for the financial year from January 1 to December 31, 2025, including the related disclosures, complies, in all material respects, with the accounting principles of Section 162 AktG.

Other Matter – Formal Audit of the Remuneration Report

The audit of the content of the remuneration report described in this auditor's report comprises the formal audit of the remuneration report required under Section 162 (3) AktG including the issuance of a report on this audit. Since our audit opinion on the content audit is unmodified, this audit opinion includes that the disclosures required under Section 162 (1) and (2) AktG are contained, in all material respects, in the remuneration report.

Intended Use of the Report

We issue this report as stipulated in the engagement letter agreed with the Company. The audit has been performed for the purposes of the Company and the report is solely intended to inform the Company about the result of the audit.

Düsseldorf / Germany, March 10, 2026

Deloitte GmbH
Wirtschaftsprüfungsgesellschaft

Signed:
André Bedenbecker

Wirtschaftsprüfer
(German Public Auditor)

Signed:
Christian Siepe

Wirtschaftsprüfer
(German Public Auditor)

Liability

This report is not intended to be used by third parties as a basis for any (asset) decision. We are liable solely to Brenntag SE, Essen/Germany, and our liability is also governed by the engagement letter dated July 14/16, 2025 agreed with the Company as well as the "General Engagement Terms for Wirtschaftsprüferinnen, Wirtschaftsprüfer and Wirtschaftsprüfungsgesellschaften (German Public Auditors and Public Audit Firms)" promulgated by the Institut der Wirtschaftsprüfer in Deutschland e.V. (IDW) in the version dated January 1, 2024 (IDW-AAB). However, we do not accept or assume liability to third parties.

5 Further Information

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Responsibility statement 2025

To the best of our knowledge, and in accordance with the applicable reporting principles, the consolidated financial statements give a true and fair view of the assets, liabilities, financial position and profit or loss of the Group and the Group management report includes a fair review of the development and performance of the business and the position of the Group, together with a description of the material opportunities and risks associated with the expected development of the Group.

Essen, March 5, 2026

Brenntag SE
BOARD OF MANAGEMENT

Jens Birgersson

Thomas Reisten

Independent auditor's report

To Brenntag SE, Essen / Germany

Report on the audit of the consolidated financial statements and of the combined management report

Audit Opinions

We have audited the consolidated financial statements of Brenntag SE, Essen / Germany, and its subsidiaries (the Group) which comprise the consolidated balance sheet as at December 31, 2025, the consolidated income statement, the consolidated statement of comprehensive income, the consolidated statement of changes in equity and the consolidated cash flow statement for the financial year from January 1 to December 31, 2025, and the notes to the consolidated financial statements, including material accounting policy information. We have not audited the content of the remuneration report in accordance with Section 162 German Stock Corporation Act (AktG) referenced in section 33 of the notes to the consolidated financial statements. In addition, we have audited the combined management report for the parent and the group of Brenntag SE, Essen / Germany, for the financial year from January 1 to December 31, 2025. In accordance with the German legal requirements, we have not audited the content of the consolidated non-financial statement in accordance with Section 315b and Section 315c German Commercial Code (HGB) included in section "Group sustainability statement" of the combined management report, and the corporate governance statement in accordance with Section 289f and Section 315d HGB included in section "Corporate governance statement" of the combined management report, including the reporting on corporate governance included therein. In addition, we have not audited the content of the "Summary assessment of the internal control and risk management system" marked as extraneous to management reports, which is contained in section "Main elements of the internal control / risk management system" of the combined management report as well as further disclosures identified as extraneous to management reports and as unaudited.

In our opinion, on the basis of the knowledge obtained in the audit,

- the accompanying consolidated financial statements comply, in all material respects, with the IFRS® Accounting Standards issued by the International Accounting Standards Board (IASB) (hereinafter "IFRS Accounting Standards") as adopted by the EU and the additional requirements of German commercial law pursuant to

Section 315e (1) HGB and, in compliance with these requirements, give a true and fair view of the assets, liabilities and financial position of the Group as at December 31, 2025 and of its financial performance for the financial year from January 1 to December 31, 2025; our audit opinion on the consolidated financial statements does not cover the content of the remuneration report referred to above.

- the accompanying combined management report as a whole provides an appropriate view of the Group's position. In all material respects, this combined management report is consistent with the consolidated financial statements, complies with German legal requirements and appropriately presents the opportunities and risks of future development. Our audit opinion on the combined management report does not cover the content of the statements referred to above and of the disclosures extraneous to management reports referred to above.

Pursuant to Section 322 (3) sentence 1 HGB, we declare that our audit has not led to any reservations relating to the legal compliance of the consolidated financial statements and of the combined management report.

Basis for the Audit Opinions

We conducted our audit of the consolidated financial statements and of the combined management report in accordance with Section 317 HGB and the EU Audit Regulation (No. 537/2014; referred to subsequently as "EU Audit Regulation") and in compliance with German Generally Accepted Standards for Financial Statement Audits promulgated by the Institut der Wirtschaftsprüfer (IDW). We performed the audit of the consolidated financial statements in supplementary compliance with the International Standards on Auditing (ISA). Our responsibilities under those requirements, principles and standards are further described in the "Auditor's Responsibilities for the Audit of the Consolidated Financial Statements and of the Combined Management Report" section of our auditor's report. We are independent of the group entities in accordance with the requirements of European law and German commercial and professional law and the International Code of Ethics for Professional Accountants (including International Independence Standards) of the International Ethics Standards Board for Accountants (IESBA Code), and we have fulfilled our other German professional responsibilities in accordance with these requirements and the IESBA Code. In addition, in accordance with Article 10 (2) point (f) of the EU Audit Regulation, we declare that we have not provided non-audit services prohibited under Article 5 (1) of the EU Audit Regulation. We believe that the audit evidence we

have obtained is sufficient and appropriate to provide a basis for our audit opinions on the consolidated financial statements and on the combined management report.

Key Audit Matters in the Audit of the Consolidated Financial Statements

Key audit matters are those matters that, in our professional judgment, were of most significance in our audit of the consolidated financial statements for the financial year from January 1 to December 31, 2025. These matters were addressed in the context of our audit of the consolidated financial statements as a whole and in forming our audit opinion thereon; we do not provide a separate audit opinion on these matters.

In the following we present the key audit matters we have determined in the course of our audit:

1. Recoverability of goodwill
2. Recognition and measurement of environmental provisions
3. Presentation of risks arising from product-related legal disputes

Our presentation of these key audit matters has been structured as follows:

- a) description (including reference to corresponding information in the consolidated financial statements)
- b) auditor's response

1. Recoverability of goodwill

- a) Goodwill amounting to EUR 3.2 billion (30% of consolidated total assets) is reported under the "Intangible assets" item in the consolidated balance sheet of Brenntag SE.

Goodwill is tested for impairment by Brenntag SE once a year as of the end of the reporting period, or when there are indications of impairment. In conducting these tests, Brenntag SE allocates goodwill to the respective groups of cash-generating units. The basis for the measurement is generally the present value of the future cash flows of the respective group of cash-generating units, which is calculated as fair value less costs of disposal and compared against the carrying amount of the respective group of cash-generating units, including goodwill. To carry out the impairment testing, the executive directors engaged an external advisor to determine the present values using a discounted cash flow model and to prepare an expert opinion.

The cash flow projections are based on the five-year planning prepared by the executive directors, approved by the supervisory board and applicable at the time the impairment test is carried out. The supervisory board's approval relates to the planning of the first year in the detailed planning period. The planning also takes into account the executive directors' fundamental growth assumptions, which are specified in detail by the budget managers in the context of middle-up planning and consolidated into medium-term business planning at segment level. Discounting is based on the discount rate determined from the weighted average cost of capitals of the relevant group of cash-generating units.

The result of this measurement depends to a large extent on the executive directors' assessment of future cash flows, especially on the assumptions on which their forecast is based, and the discount rate used, and is therefore subject to major uncertainties. Against this background and in view of the complexity of the measurement of this high-value item, this matter was of particular significance in the context of our audit.

The executive directors' disclosures on goodwill are contained in section "19.) Intangible assets" of the notes to the consolidated financial statements.

- b) As part of our audit, we obtained an understanding of the processes and controls established and reviewed the method used to perform the impairment tests, evaluated the determination of the discount rates and assessed the calculation method used in impairment testing by calling in our valuation experts. With respect to the projection of future cash flows, we assessed the planning reliability by reviewing the past adherence to planning. We assessed the appropriateness of the future cash flows considered in the calculation, among others, by comparing this information against the planning prepared by the executive directors and approved by the supervisory board, as well as by reconciling the assumptions on which such planning is based with general and sector-specific market expectations. Additionally, we also reviewed whether the costs of group functions were properly included in the impairment tests on the respective cash-generating units.

Furthermore, we intensively dealt with the parameters applied to determine the discount rates used. The calculation model used was reviewed by us with respect to its methodological appropriateness and mathematical accuracy. Moreover, we assessed the external expert opinion taking into account the engaged advisor's competence, capabilities and objectivity, and used it as part of our audit, by evaluating the appropriateness of the raw data underlying the expert opinion, the assumptions made and methods used, including their consistency in comparison to prior periods, for reasonableness. Furthermore, we conducted a supplementary sensitivity analysis to assess a possible impairment risk in the event of a potential change in a material valuation assumption. In addition, we audited the completeness and correctness of the disclosures in the notes to the consolidated financial statements required to be made under IAS 36.

2 Recognition and measurement of environmental provisions

- a) As of December 31, 2025, the environmental provisions recognized in the consolidated financial statements of Brenntag SE (primarily for the decontamination of soil and groundwater at current and former Group-owned or leased sites) amounted to EUR 105.6 million. The provisions also include contingent liabilities of EUR 20.2 million for which cash outflows are not likely but nonetheless possible. Due to purchase price allocations, these were reported in the consolidated balance sheet under acquisitions in accordance with IFRS 3. The recognition of environmental provisions at the subsidiaries was coordinated centrally by an external expert. In addition, another audit firm assisted the Group in measuring the provisions and summarized the results in an expert opinion. The environmental provisions were recognized at the present value of the expected future expenditures, taking into account future inflation-related increases. The provisions were discounted using interest rates for risk-free assets with matching terms for each functional currency.

Due to the nature and large number of influencing factors that need to be taken into account when accounting for environmental provisions, the assessments required to be made in connection with their recognition and measurement are demanding and subject to accounting judgments and considerable uncertainties and, as such, this matter was of particular significance in the context of our audit.

The executive directors' disclosures on the measurement of environmental provisions are contained in the sections "25.) Other provisions" and "Assumptions and estimates" of the notes to the consolidated financial statements.

- b) As part of our audit, we first obtained an understanding of the underlying processes for determining environmental provisions and assessed whether recognition criteria existed and whether the environmental provisions were measured appropriately under IAS 37. For this purpose, we evaluated, among others, the appropriateness of the measurement assumptions and models used as well as the underlying individual facts and the competence, capabilities and objectivity of the external experts engaged. We reviewed the future cash outflows expected by the group companies on a sample basis and made an additional evaluation of the plausibility of changes in individual future cash outflows against the estimate made at the end of the prior year. By calling in our valuation specialists, we also reviewed measurement parameters (in particular inflation rates, discount rates and currency translation from the functional to the reporting currency) used by the Company. Furthermore, we reviewed and assessed the mathematical accuracy of the calculations and the appropriateness of the calculations performed by the other audit firm in its sensitivity analyses. Moreover, we examined the Company's disclosures on the measurement of environmental provisions in the sections "25.) Other provisions" and "Assumptions and estimates" of the notes to the consolidated financial statements.

3. Presentation of risks arising from product-related legal disputes

- a) In connection with the sale of talc and similar products, North American subsidiaries of the Brenntag Group are involved in court and out-of-court proceedings with end consumers and other parties. The resulting legal risks pertain in particular to product liability.

Brenntag Specialties, LLC, Wilmington / Delaware / USA, a subsidiary of Brenntag SE, is facing claims for damages from end consumers in the USA. In the lawsuits, the plaintiffs claim to have suffered damage to health as a result of contact with the products sold. In these proceedings, Brenntag has reached settlement agreements with some of the plaintiffs and their attorneys to resolve the legal disputes. In addition, compensation claims arising from product liability are being asserted against the Group in relation to the talc business of a U.S. company that was acquired as part of corporate transactions. Simultaneously, Brenntag is filing claims for compensation against third parties.

Moreover, there are legal risks associated with potential, as yet unknown cases, for which the executive directors have engaged an external assessor to investigate and prepare a valuation report.

Whether and to what extent it is necessary to recognize a provision to cover the risk on the basis of one or more of the ongoing legal proceedings is largely influenced by the assessments and discretionary assumptions of the executive directors.

Against this background and in view of the value of claims asserted over time, as well as the overall legal uncertainties surrounding these proceedings, the above-mentioned product-related disputes of the Brenntag Group were of particular significance in the context of our audit.

The executive directors' disclosures and explanations regarding the legal disputes mentioned are contained in section "31.) Legal disputes" of the notes to the consolidated financial statements.

- b) As part of our audit, we first obtained an understanding of the processes implemented within the Group to ensure the recording of court and out-of-court proceedings, their assessment with regard to the outcome of the proceedings, and the accurate recognition of a legal dispute in the balance sheet. In addition, we identified controls on this basis and tested their design.

Furthermore, during our audit, we held regular discussions with the Company's in-house legal and accounting department in order to have the current developments in the proceedings and the reasons for the executive directors' assessments of the expected obligation amount arising from the known cases explained to us and in order to obtain appropriate evidence. We critically evaluated and assessed the explanations as well as the information and evidence obtained. Additionally, we examined whether the amount of the provision has been appropriately determined on the basis of settlement agreements already concluded with individual plaintiffs.

Moreover, we assessed the external valuation report for determining the obligation amount arising from as yet unknown cases, taking into account our evaluation of the competence, capabilities and objectivity of the external assessor commissioned by the executive directors, and used it as part of our audit. In doing so, we evaluated the raw data underlying the report, the assumptions made therein and the methods used by the external assessor, including their consistency in comparison to prior periods, for reasonableness.

We obtained in-house and external attorneys' confirmations as at the balance sheet date and critically assessed them. Taking into account the executive directors' assessments, we also critically assessed the assumptions underlying the provisions for expected legal and litigation costs and examined the amount of the provisions based on past experience from similar past proceedings of the Group and other evidence.

Other Information

The executive directors and/or the supervisory board are responsible for the other information. The other information comprises

- the report of the supervisory board,
- the remuneration report,
- the corporate governance statement,
- the consolidated non-financial statement,
- the disclosures in the combined management report marked as extraneous to management reports and as unaudited,
- the executive directors' confirmations in accordance with Section 297 (2) sentence 4 and Section 315 (1) sentence 5 HGB regarding the consolidated financial statements and the combined management report, and
- all other parts of the annual report,
- but not the consolidated financial statements, not the audited content of the disclosures in the combined management report and not our auditor's report thereon.

The supervisory board is responsible for the report of the supervisory board. The executive directors and the supervisory board are responsible for the statement in accordance with Section 161 German Stock Corporation Act (AktG) on the German Corporate Governance Code and the further reporting on corporate governance within the corporate governance statement as well as for the remuneration report. Otherwise, the executive directors are responsible for the other information.

Our audit opinions on the consolidated financial statements and on the combined management report do not cover the other information, and consequently we do not express an audit opinion or any other form of assurance conclusion thereon.

In connection with our audit, our responsibility is to read the other information identified above and, in doing so, to consider whether the other information

- is materially inconsistent with the consolidated financial statements, with the audited content of the disclosures in the combined management report or our knowledge obtained in the audit, or
- otherwise appears to be materially misstated.

If, based on the work we have performed, we conclude that there is a material misstatement of this other information, we are required to report that fact. We have nothing to report in this regard.

Responsibilities of the Executive Directors and the Supervisory Board for the Consolidated Financial Statements and the Combined Management Report

The executive directors are responsible for the preparation of the consolidated financial statements that comply, in all material respects, with IFRS Accounting Standards as adopted by the EU and the additional requirements of German commercial law pursuant to Section 315e (1) HGB, and that the consolidated financial statements, in compliance with these requirements, give a true and fair view of the assets, liabilities, financial position and financial performance of the Group. In addition, the executive directors are responsible for such internal control as they have determined necessary to enable the preparation of consolidated financial statements that are free from material misstatement, whether due to fraud (i.e., fraudulent financial reporting and misappropriation of assets) or error.

In preparing the consolidated financial statements, the executive directors are responsible for assessing the Group's ability to continue as a going concern. They also have the responsibility for disclosing, as applicable, matters related to going concern. In addition, they are responsible for financial reporting based on the going concern basis of accounting unless there is an intention to liquidate the Group or to cease operations, or there is no realistic alternative but to do so.

Furthermore, the executive directors are responsible for the preparation of the combined management report that as a whole provides an appropriate view of the Group's position and is, in all material respects, consistent with the consolidated financial statements, complies with German legal requirements, and appropriately presents the opportunities and risks of future development. In addition, the executive

directors are responsible for such arrangements and measures (systems) as they have considered necessary to enable the preparation of a combined management report that is in accordance with the applicable German legal requirements, and to be able to provide sufficient appropriate evidence for the assertions in the combined management report.

The supervisory board is responsible for overseeing the Group's financial reporting process for the preparation of the consolidated financial statements and of the combined management report.

Auditor's Responsibilities for the Audit of the Consolidated Financial Statements and of the Combined Management Report

Our objectives are to obtain reasonable assurance about whether the consolidated financial statements as a whole are free from material misstatement, whether due to fraud or error, and whether the combined management report as a whole provides an appropriate view of the Group's position and, in all material respects, is consistent with the consolidated financial statements and the knowledge obtained in the audit, complies with the German legal requirements and appropriately presents the opportunities and risks of future development, as well as to issue an auditor's report that includes our audit opinions on the consolidated financial statements and on the combined management report.

Reasonable assurance is a high level of assurance, but is not a guarantee that an audit conducted in accordance with Section 317 HGB and the EU Audit Regulation and in compliance with German Generally Accepted Standards for Financial Statement Audits promulgated by the Institut der Wirtschaftsprüfer (IDW) and in supplementary compliance with the ISA will always detect a material misstatement. Misstatements can arise from fraud or error and are considered material if, individually or in the aggregate, they could reasonably be expected to influence the economic decisions of users taken on the basis of these consolidated financial statements and this combined management report.

We exercise professional judgment and maintain professional skepticism throughout the audit. We also:

- identify and assess the risks of material misstatement of the consolidated financial statements and of the combined management report, whether due to fraud or error, design and perform audit procedures responsive to those risks, and obtain audit evidence that is sufficient and appropriate to provide a basis for our audit opinions. The risk of not detecting a material misstatement resulting from fraud is higher than the risk of not detecting a material misstatement resulting from error, as fraud may involve collusion, forgery, intentional omissions, misrepresentations, or the override of internal control.

- obtain an understanding of internal control relevant to the audit of the consolidated financial statements and of arrangements and measures relevant to the audit of the combined management report in order to design audit procedures that are appropriate in the circumstances, but not for the purpose of expressing an audit opinion on the effectiveness of internal control or these arrangements and measures of the Group.
- evaluate the appropriateness of accounting policies used by the executive directors and the reasonableness of estimates made by the executive directors and related disclosures.
- conclude on the appropriateness of the executive directors' use of the going concern basis of accounting and, based on the audit evidence obtained, whether a material uncertainty exists related to events or conditions that may cast significant doubt on the Group's ability to continue as a going concern. If we conclude that a material uncertainty exists, we are required to draw attention in the auditor's report to the related disclosures in the consolidated financial statements and in the combined management report or, if such disclosures are inadequate, to modify our respective audit opinions. Our conclusions are based on the audit evidence obtained up to the date of our auditor's report. However, future events or conditions may cause the Group to cease to be able to continue as a going concern.
- evaluate the overall presentation, structure and content of the consolidated financial statements, including the disclosures, and whether the consolidated financial statements present the underlying transactions and events in a manner that the consolidated financial statements give a true and fair view of the assets, liabilities, financial position and financial performance of the Group in compliance with IFRS Accounting Standards as adopted by the EU and with the additional requirements of German commercial law pursuant to Section 315e (1) HGB.
- plan and perform the audit of the consolidated financial statements in order to obtain sufficient appropriate audit evidence regarding the financial information of the entities or of the business activities within the Group, which serves as a basis for forming audit opinions on the consolidated financial statements and on the combined management report. We are responsible for the direction, supervision and review of the audit procedures performed for the purposes of the group audit. We remain solely responsible for our audit opinions.
- evaluate the consistency of the combined management report with the consolidated financial statements, its conformity with German law, and the view of the Group's position it provides.

- perform audit procedures on the prospective information presented by the executive directors in the combined management report. On the basis of sufficient appropriate audit evidence we evaluate, in particular, the significant assumptions used by the executive directors as a basis for the prospective information, and evaluate the proper derivation of the prospective information from these assumptions. We do not express a separate audit opinion on the prospective information and on the assumptions used as a basis. There is a substantial unavoidable risk that future events will differ materially from the prospective information.

We communicate with those charged with governance regarding, among other matters, the planned scope and timing of the audit and significant audit findings, including any significant deficiencies in internal control that we identify during our audit.

We provide those charged with governance with a statement that we have complied with the relevant independence requirements, and communicate with them all relationships and other matters that may reasonably be thought to bear on our independence, and where applicable, the actions taken or safeguards applied to eliminate independence threats.

From the matters communicated with those charged with governance, we determine those matters that were of most significance in the audit of the consolidated financial statements for the current period and are therefore the key audit matters. We describe these matters in the auditor's report unless law or regulation precludes public disclosure about the matter.

Other legal and regulatory requirements

Report on the Assurance on the Electronic Reproductions of the Consolidated Financial Statements and of the Combined Management Report Prepared for Publication Pursuant to Section 317 (3a) HGB

Assurance Opinion

We have performed assurance work in accordance with Section 317 (3a) HGB to obtain reasonable assurance whether the electronic reproductions of the consolidated financial statements and of the combined management report (hereinafter referred to as “ESEF documents”) prepared for publication, contained in the file, which has the SHA-256 value c52f0bbdd16238cd6ccee8a22a2913db4249218df28a7f7e3d14bb4ec3a4e2bb, meet, in all material respects, the requirements for the electronic reporting format pursuant to Section 328 (1) HGB (“ESEF format”). In accordance with the German legal requirements, this assurance work only covers the conversion of the information contained in the consolidated financial statements and the combined management report into the ESEF format, and therefore covers neither the information contained in these electronic reproductions nor any other information contained in the file identified above.

In our opinion, the electronic reproductions of the consolidated financial statements and of the combined management report prepared for publication contained in the file identified above meet, in all material respects, the requirements for the electronic reporting format pursuant to Section 328 (1) HGB. Beyond this assurance opinion and our audit opinions on the accompanying consolidated financial statements and on the accompanying combined management report for the financial year from January 1 to December 31, 2025 contained in the “Report on the Audit of the Consolidated Financial Statements and of the Combined Management Report” above, we do not express any assurance opinion on the information contained within these electronic reproductions or on any other information contained in the file identified above.

Basis for the Assurance Opinion

We conducted our assurance work on the electronic reproductions of the consolidated financial statements and of the combined management report contained in the file identified above in accordance with Section 317 (3a) HGB and on the basis of the IDW Assurance Standard: Assurance on the Electronic Reproductions of Financial Statements and Management Reports Prepared for Publication Purposes Pursuant to Section 317 (3a) HGB (IDW AsS 410 (06.2022)). Our responsibilities in this context are further described in the “Group Auditor’s Responsibilities for the Assurance Work on the ESEF Documents” section. Our audit firm has applied the IDW Quality Management Standards.

Responsibilities of the Executive Directors and the Supervisory Board for the ESEF Documents

The executive directors of the Company are responsible for the preparation of the ESEF documents based on the electronic files of the consolidated financial statements and of the combined management report according to Section 328 (1) sentence 4 no. 1 HGB and for the tagging of the consolidated financial statements according to Section 328 (1) sentence 4 no. 2 HGB.

In addition, the executive directors of the Company are responsible for such internal control that they have considered necessary to enable the preparation of ESEF documents that are free from material intentional or unintentional non-compliance with the requirements for the electronic reporting format pursuant to Section 328 (1) HGB.

The supervisory board is responsible for overseeing the process for preparing the ESEF documents as part of the financial reporting process.

Group Auditor's Responsibilities for the Assurance Work on the ESEF Documents

Our objective is to obtain reasonable assurance about whether the ESEF documents are free from material intentional or unintentional non-compliance with the requirements of Section 328 (1) HGB. We exercise professional judgment and maintain professional skepticism throughout the assurance work. We also:

- identify and assess the risks of material intentional or unintentional non-compliance with the requirements of Section 328 (1) HGB, design and perform assurance procedures responsive to those risks, and obtain assurance evidence that is sufficient and appropriate to provide a basis for our assurance opinion.
- obtain an understanding of internal control relevant to the assurance on the ESEF documents in order to design assurance procedures that are appropriate in the circumstances, but not for the purpose of expressing an assurance opinion on the effectiveness of these controls.
- evaluate the technical validity of the ESEF documents, i.e., whether the file containing the ESEF documents meets the requirements of the Delegated Regulation (EU) 2019/815, in the version in force at the balance sheet date, on the technical specification for this electronic file.
- evaluate whether the ESEF documents enable an XHTML reproduction with content equivalent to the audited consolidated financial statements and to the audited combined management report.
- evaluate whether the tagging of the ESEF documents with Inline XBRL technology (iXBRL) in accordance with the requirements of Articles 4 and 6 of the Delegated Regulation (EU) 2019/815, in the version in force at the balance sheet date, enables an appropriate and complete machine-readable XBRL copy of the XHTML reproduction.

Further Information pursuant to Article 10 of the EU Audit Regulation

We were elected as group auditor by the general meeting on May 22, 2025. We were engaged by the supervisory board on July 16, 2025. We have been the group auditor of Brenntag SE, Essen/Germany, without interruption since the financial year 2023.

We declare that the audit opinions expressed in this auditor's report are consistent with the additional report to the audit committee pursuant to Article 11 of the EU Audit Regulation (long-form audit report).

Other matter – use of the auditor's report

Our auditor's report must always be read together with the audited consolidated financial statements and the audited combined management report as well as with the assured ESEF documents. The consolidated financial statements and the combined management report converted into the ESEF format – including the versions to be submitted for inclusion in the Company Register – are merely electronic reproductions of the audited consolidated financial statements and the audited combined management report and do not take their place. In particular, the ESEF report and our assurance opinion contained therein are to be used solely together with the assured ESEF documents made available in electronic form.

German public auditor responsible for the engagement

The German Public Auditor responsible for the engagement is André Bedenbecker.

Düsseldorf / Germany, March 5, 2026

Deloitte GmbH Wirtschaftsprüfungsgesellschaft

Signed:

André Bedenbecker
Wirtschaftsprüfer
(German Public Auditor)

Signed:

Christian Siepe
Wirtschaftsprüfer
(German Public Auditor)

Segment reporting

Business performance of the Brenntag Group

in EUR m	2025	2024	Change		
			abs.	in %	in % (fx adj.) ¹⁾
Sales	15,171.5	16,237.4	-1,065.9	-6.6	-3.7
Operating gross profit	3,831.7	4,025.4	-193.7	-4.8	-1.9
Operating expenses	-2,544.2	-2,568.6	24.4	-0.9	1.9
Operating EBITDA	1,287.5	1,456.8	-169.3	-11.6	-8.6
Adjusted depreciation and impairment of property, plant and equipment and right-of-use assets	-358.2	-354.9	-3.3	0.9	3.7
Operating EBITA (segment result)	929.3	1,101.9	-172.6	-15.7	-12.6
Net income / expense from special items	-106.5	-111.4	-	-	-
EBITA	822.8	990.5	-	-	-
Amortization of intangible assets	-205.2	-75.1	-	-	-
Net finance costs	-132.2	-172.8	-	-	-
Profit before tax	485.4	742.6	-	-	-
Income tax expense	-215.7	-198.9	-	-	-
Profit after tax	269.7	543.7	-	-	-

5.01 Business performance of the Brenntag Group 12M 2025 / 2024

¹⁾ Change in % (fx. adj.) is the percentage change on a constant currency basis.

in EUR m	Q4 2025	Q4 2024	Change		
			abs.	in %	in % (fx adj.) ¹⁾
Sales	3,512.0	3,989.7	-477.7	-12.0	-6.8
Operating gross profit	890.7	993.9	-103.2	-10.4	-5.1
Operating expenses	-622.7	-635.5	12.8	-2.0	3.4
Operating EBITDA	268.0	358.4	-90.4	-25.2	-20.2
Adjusted depreciation and impairment of property, plant and equipment and right-of-use assets	-92.4	-94.4	2.0	-2.1	2.9
Operating EBITA (segment result)	175.6	264.0	-88.4	-33.5	-28.6
Net income / expense from special items	-40.2	-24.7	-	-	-
EBITA	135.4	239.3	-	-	-
Amortization of intangible assets	-75.4	-19.6	-	-	-
Net finance costs	-31.3	-47.7	-	-	-
Profit before tax	28.7	172.0	-	-	-
Income tax expense	-52.2	-43.3	-	-	-
Profit after tax	-23.5	128.7	-	-	-

5.02 Business performance of the Brenntag Group Q4 2025 / 2024

¹⁾ Change in % (fx. adj.) is the percentage change on a constant currency basis.

Period from January 1 to December 31 in EUR m	Brenntag Specialties	Brenntag Essentials	Group and Regional Services	Group
External sales				
2025	4,801.2	10,370.3	-	15,171.5
2024	5,229.7	11,007.7	-	16,237.4
fx. adj. change in %	-5.5	-2.9	-	-3.7
Cost of materials				
2025	-3,702.9	-7,636.9	-	-11,339.8
2024	-4,056.5	-8,155.5	-	-12,212.0
fx. adj. change in %	-6.0	-3.4	-	-4.3
Operating gross profit				
2025	1,098.3	2,733.4	-	3,831.7
2024	1,173.2	2,852.2	-	4,025.4
fx. adj. change in %	-3.6	-1.2	-	-1.9
Depreciation and impairment of property, plant and equipment and right-of-use assets				
2025	-33.3	-314.7	-10.2	-358.2
2024	-33.6	-310.8	-10.5	-354.9
fx. adj. change in %	2.5	4.0	-1.0	3.7
Operating EBITA (segment result)				
2025	387.0	658.7	-116.4	929.3
2024	446.9	780.7	-125.7	1,101.9
fx. adj. change in %	-10.4	-13.4	-9.7	-12.6

5.03 Reconciliation of the reportable segments to the Group 12M 2025 / 2024

Period from October 1 to December 31 in EUR m	Brenntag Specialties	Brenntag Essentials	Group and Regional Services	Group
External sales				
2025	1,125.2	2,386.8	-	3,512.0
2024	1,281.7	2,708.0	-	3,989.7
fx. adj. change in %	-7.2	-6.6	-	-6.8
Cost of materials				
2025	-869.8	-1,751.5	-	-2,621.3
2024	-993.1	-2,002.7	-	-2,995.8
fx. adj. change in %	-7.3	-7.3	-	-7.3
Operating gross profit				
2025	255.4	635.3	-	890.7
2024	288.6	705.3	-	993.9
fx. adj. change in %	-6.5	-4.5	-	-5.1
Depreciation and impairment of property, plant and equipment and right-of-use assets				
2025	-8.7	-81.1	-2.6	-92.4
2024	-8.9	-83.1	-2.4	-94.4
fx. adj. change in %	3.6	2.5	13.0	2.9
Operating EBITA (segment result)				
2025	84.8	133.0	-42.2	175.6
2024	107.2	194.4	-37.6	264.0
fx. adj. change in %	-15.7	-28.7	2.9	-28.6

5.04 Reconciliation of the reportable segments to the Group Q4 2025 / 2024

Period from January 1 to December 31 in EUR m	Life Science	Material Science	Specialties Other	Central activities ¹⁾	Brenntag Specialties
External sales					
2025	3,192.7	1,561.8	46.7	-	4,801.2
2024	3,482.9	1,687.9	58.9	-	5,229.7
fx. adj. change in %	-5.4	-5.2	-20.8	-	-5.5
Cost of materials					
2025	-2,416.9	-1,254.3	-31.7	-	-3,702.9
2024	-2,653.0	-1,362.5	-41.0	-	-4,056.5
fx. adj. change in %	-5.9	-5.6	-23.1	-	-6.0
Operating gross profit					
2025	775.8	307.5	15.0	-	1,098.3
2024	829.9	325.4	17.9	-	1,173.2
fx. adj. change in %	-3.5	-3.1	-15.7	-	-3.6
Depreciation and impairment of property, plant and equipment and right-of-use assets²⁾					
2025	-6.7	-4.8	-21.8	-	-33.3
2024	-4.6	-4.2	-24.8	-	-33.6
fx. adj. change in %	48.9	14.3	-8.4	-	2.5
Operating EBITA (segment result)^{3) 4)}					
2025	293.8	99.2	-4.7	-1.3	387.0
2024	338.3	114.4	-1.7	-4.1	446.9
fx. adj. change in %	-9.8	-10.9	291.7	-68.3	-10.4

5.05 Segment reporting on the global Specialties division 12M 2025 / 2024

¹⁾ Central activities which are part of Brenntag Specialties but not directly attributable to any one segment.

²⁾ Certain items of property, plant and equipment and right-of-use assets are not separable and support both divisions jointly. They have been allocated to a division (depending on the region) and are depreciated there. They are charged to the other division on the basis of fixed and variable monthly amounts.

³⁾ Segment operating EBITA is calculated as segment EBITA adjusted for holding charges and special items.

⁴⁾ The prior-year figures were adjusted to reflect the current portfolio allocation

Period from October 1 to December 31 in EUR m	Life Science	Material Science	Specialties Other	Central activities ¹⁾	Brenntag Specialties
External sales					
2025	755.0	358.8	11.4	-	1,125.2
2024	866.3	404.8	10.6	-	1,281.7
fx. adj. change in %	-7.4	-7.0	8.6	-	-7.2
Cost of materials					
2025	-573.0	-289.3	-7.5	-	-869.8
2024	-657.9	-327.2	-8.0	-	-993.1
fx. adj. change in %	-7.4	-7.2	-5.1	-	-7.3
Operating gross profit					
2025	182.0	69.5	3.9	-	255.4
2024	208.4	77.6	2.6	-	288.6
fx. adj. change in %	-7.4	-6.1	50.0	-	-6.5
Depreciation and impairment of property, plant and equipment and right-of-use assets²⁾					
2025	-1.9	-1.2	-5.6	-	-8.7
2024	-0.9	-1.2	-6.8	-	-8.9
fx. adj. change in %	111.1	-	-11.1	-	3.6
Operating EBITA (segment result)^{3/4)}					
2025	68.8	19.7	-3.8	0.1	84.8
2024	84.2	22.7	0.6	-0.3	107.2
fx. adj. change in %	-12.6	-7.9	-575.0	-133.3	-15.7

5.06 Segment reporting on the global Specialties division Q4 2025 / 2024

¹⁾ Central activities which are part of Brenntag Specialties but not directly attributable to any one segment.

²⁾ Certain items of property, plant and equipment and right-of-use assets are not separable and support both divisions jointly. They have been allocated to a division (depending on the region) and are depreciated there. They are charged to the other division on the basis of fixed and variable monthly amounts.

³⁾ Segment operating EBITA is calculated as segment EBITA adjusted for holding charges and special items.

⁴⁾ The prior-year figures were adjusted to reflect the current portfolio allocation

Period from January 1 to December 31 in EUR m	EMEA ¹⁾	North America	Latin America	APAC	Trans- regional	Central activities ²⁾	Brenntag Essentials
External sales							
2025	3,607.6	4,694.1	968.4	823.8	276.4	-	10,370.3
2024	3,741.2	5,162.6	763.4	1,005.5	335.0	-	11,007.7
fx. adj. change in %	-3.2	-4.9	33.6	-13.7	-17.5	-	-2.9
Cost of materials							
2025	-2,649.9	-3,250.5	-776.5	-694.7	-265.3	-	-7,636.9
2024	-2,746.5	-3,625.8	-596.8	-863.9	-322.5	-	-8,155.5
fx. adj. change in %	-3.7	-6.9	27.6	-11.9	-17.6	-	-3.4
Operating gross profit							
2025	957.7	1,443.6	191.9	129.1	11.1	-	2,733.4
2024	994.7	1,536.8	166.6	141.6	12.5	-	2,852.2
fx. adj. change in %	-3.5	-1.7	21.4	-4.3	-11.2	-	-1.2
Depreciation and impairment of property, plant and equipment and right-of-use assets³⁾							
2025	-121.6	-157.8	-21.0	-11.1	-3.1	-0.1	-314.7
2024	-123.7	-154.3	-19.1	-10.5	-3.2	-	-310.8
fx. adj. change in %	-1.5	6.9	15.4	7.8	-3.1	-	4.0
Operating EBITA (segment result)⁴⁾							
2025	225.1	393.8	26.7	12.2	5.3	-4.4	658.7
2024	276.5	469.3	14.1	17.3	6.4	-2.9	780.7
fx. adj. change in %	-19.3	-12.2	100.8	-26.1	-17.2	51.7	-13.4

5.07 Segment Reporting on the global Essentials division 12M 2025 / 2024

¹⁾ Europe, Middle East & Africa.²⁾ Central activities which are part of Brenntag Essentials but not directly attributable to any one segment.³⁾ Certain items of property, plant and equipment and right-of-use assets are not separable and support both divisions jointly. They have been allocated to a division (depending on the region) and are depreciated there. They are charged to the other division on the basis of fixed and variable monthly amounts.⁴⁾ Segment operating EBITA is calculated as segment EBITA adjusted for holding charges and special items.

Period from
October 1 to December 31
in EUR m

	EMEA ¹⁾	North America	Latin America	APAC	Trans- regional	Central activities ²⁾	Brenntag Essentials
External sales							
2025	843.9	1,082.8	228.9	168.3	62.9	-	2,386.8
2024	915.7	1,254.6	204.9	258.5	74.3	-	2,708.0
fx. adj. change in %	- 6.6	- 5.7	18.3	- 28.3	- 15.3	-	- 6.6
Cost of materials							
2025	- 619.0	- 745.6	- 185.3	- 141.4	- 60.2	-	- 1,751.5
2024	- 670.2	- 878.6	- 159.6	- 222.3	- 72.0	-	- 2,002.7
fx. adj. change in %	- 8.2	- 6.3	7.6	- 16.2	- 16.1	-	- 7.3
Operating gross profit							
2025	224.9	337.2	43.6	26.9	2.7	-	635.3
2024	245.5	376.0	45.3	36.2	2.3	-	705.3
fx. adj. change in %	- 7.3	- 2.0	1.6	- 18.7	12.5	-	- 4.5
Depreciation and impairment of property, plant and equipment and right-of-use assets³⁾							
2025	- 31.8	- 40.5	- 5.2	- 2.8	- 0.7	- 0.1	- 81.1
2024	- 33.9	- 40.6	- 5.7	- 2.1	- 0.8	-	- 83.1
fx. adj. change in %	- 4.8	8.3	- 3.7	33.3	- 12.5	-	2.5
Operating EBITA (segment result)⁴⁾							
2025	45.1	83.0	4.5	1.2	0.9	- 1.7	133.0
2024	66.1	111.8	4.1	6.8	1.0	4.6	194.4
fx. adj. change in %	- 34.2	- 18.7	15.4	- 81.0	- 10.0	- 136.2	- 28.7

5.08 Segment Reporting on the global Essentials division Q4 2025 / 2024

¹⁾ Europe, Middle East & Africa.

²⁾ Central activities which are part of Brenntag Essentials but not directly attributable to any one segment.

³⁾ Certain items of property, plant and equipment and right-of-use assets are not separable and support both divisions jointly. They have been allocated to a division (depending on the region) and are depreciated there. They are charged to the other division on the basis of fixed and variable monthly amounts.

⁴⁾ Segment operating EBITA is calculated as segment EBITA adjusted for holding charges and special items.

Glossary

A

APAC | Asia Pacific, China and Hong Kong

B

BEST | BEST (Brenntag Enhanced Safety Thinking) is a global Brenntag initiative to improve the safety behavior / the safety culture in the whole company.

Brenntag Essentials | The global division "Brenntag Essentials" markets a broad portfolio of process chemicals across a wide range of industries and applications at local level and is managed across the geographical segments EMEA, North America, Latin America, and APAC.

Brenntag Specialties | The global division "Brenntag Specialties" focuses on the sale of ingredients and value-added services and is managed globally according to the segments Life Science with the target industries Nutrition, Pharma, Beauty & Care as well as Material Science with the target industries CASE & Construction Polymers & Ruber, Lubes & Performance Fluids, Electronics, and the segment Specialties Other.

C

Conversion ratio | The conversion ratio at Brenntag is calculated as the quotient of operating EBITA and operating gross profit. It represents one of the most important efficiency ratios.

D

Division | Since the beginning of 2021, we have been managing Brenntag through two global divisions: "Brenntag Essentials" and "Brenntag Specialties".

E

EMEA | Europe, Middle East & Africa

ESRS | The ESRS (European Sustainability Reporting Standards) are the European sustainability reporting standards developed by the EFRAG (European Financial Reporting Advisory Group). They are part of the Corporate Sustainability Reporting Directive (CSRD) and introduce detailed requirements for reporting on a variety of sustainability topics that fall into the areas of environmental, social and governance (ESG).

G

Group and Regional Services | This division essentially comprises the central functions for the Group as a whole, the regional service functions and the activities relating to the digitalization of Brenntag's business.

I

IBC | IBC stands for intermediate bulk container. IBCs are used mostly for storing and transporting liquids. A capacity of 1,000 litres is typical.

ICTA | The ICTA (International Chemical Trade Association) was established in 2016 and replaced the ICCTA as the inter-national council for chemical trade associations. It represents the interests of over 1,300 chemical distributors worldwide. ICTA provides a worldwide network, coordinating work on issues and programs of international interest across chemical trade associations.

Industrial chemicals | Industrial chemicals is the term used at Brenntag to distinguish standard chemical products that have specific properties and effects from → speciality chemicals. The manufacturer of the product is generally irrelevant for the user.

J

Just-in-time delivery | With just-in-time deliveries, the customer does not store supplies but orders the products as required ("just in time") from the supplier.

K

Key account customer | At Brenntag, we take care of our key accounts at local, national, pan-regional and global level and develop and implement tailor-made concepts for their optimum supply with industrial and specialty chemicals. For our customers, this means they can concentrate on their core business, secure in the knowledge that they have a partner they can rely on.

L

Leverage | This term has various meanings in the world of finance. In this document, it refers to the ratio of net debt to operating EBITDA.

M

Mixing & blending | The term "mixing & blending" describes the mixing and formulation of solid and liquid chemicals in the correct mixing ratio with consistent quality as well as the filling of products in the desired packaging unit. Brenntag offers its customers not just distribution services but the complete mixing & blending of end products as a value-added service.

O

Outsourcing | Outsourcing at Brenntag is understood to mean that chemical manufacturers pass on their small and medium-sized customers to Brenntag who then obtain their chemicals from Brenntag.

P

Packing drum | A packing drum is a packing unit in which a product is sold and delivered. Typical packing drum sizes are e.g. cans, barrels or → IBCs.

R

REACH | REACH (Registration, Evaluation, Authorization and Restriction of Chemicals) is a regulation of the European Union adopted to improve the protection of human health and the environment from the risks that can be posed by chemicals.

Responsible Care/Responsible Distribution | Responsible Care/Responsible Distribution (RC/RD) is a global initiative of the chemicals industry and chemicals traders. It is a voluntary commitment to act responsibly and do more than is required by law: to promote sustainability, demonstrate product stewardship, make plants and the surrounding areas safer as well as improve occupational health and safety and environmental protection.

S

SBTi | The Science Based Targets Initiative is an organization for corporate climate protection that supports companies and financial institutions worldwide in setting science-based climate targets in line with the Paris Agreement.

Segment | Component of an entity which is reported separately. In general, the definition is based on the internal reporting (management approach).

Specialty chemicals | Specialty chemicals, which are often developed for customized applications, are distinguished from → industrial chemicals by their individual formulations. Which manufacturer produces the specialty chemical is of prime importance for the user.

Supply chain solutions | Brenntag provides large chemical producers and the processing industry with efficient logistics networks. We provide transport, warehousing and distribution and assist production and marketing processes. We warrant highest efficiency and best safety standards. We optimize supply chains, synchronize distribution, take on monitoring tasks, assume responsibility for VMI (Vendor Managed Inventory) and control and schedule follow-up orders for goods.

T

Together for Sustainability (TfS) | TfS (Together for Sustainability) is the name of an industry initiative founded by major companies of the chemicals sectors. The purpose is to develop and implement a global audit program to assess and improve sustainability practices within the supply chains of the chemical industry.

TRIR | TRIR (Total Recordable Injury Rate) is an international industry, widely used performance indicator, indicating how often employees sustain injuries in work-related accidents. It shows the number of persons with work-related injuries requiring medical attention beyond first-aid per one million hours worked.

Five-year overview

		2025	2024	2023	2022	2021
Sales	EUR m	15,171.5	16,237.4	16,815.1	19,492.3	14,382.5
Operating gross profit	EUR m	3,831.7	4,025.4	4,041.8	4,319.0	3,379.0
Operating EBITA	EUR m	929.3	1,101.9	1,265.0	1,511.7	1,081.9
Operating EBITA/operating gross profit	%	24.3	27.4	31.3	35.0	32.0
Profit after tax	EUR m	269.7	543.7	721.1	902.5	461.4
Basic earnings per share	EUR m	1.83	3.71	4.73	5.74	2.90
Diluted earnings per share	EUR	1.83	3.71	4.73	5.74	2.89

5.09 Consolidated income statement

		Dec. 31, 2025	Dec. 31, 2024	Dec. 31, 2023	Dec. 31, 2022	Dec. 31, 2021
Total assets	EUR m	10,625.8	11,668.0	10,337.8	11,373.0	10,195.5
Equity	EUR m	4,348.6	4,762.0	4,356.7	4,802.7	3,995.3
Working capital	EUR m	1,892.6	2,139.3	2,005.8	2,588.6	2,109.8
Net financial liabilities	EUR m	2,527.9	2,793.0	2,186.8	2,049.7	2,070.3

5.10 Consolidated balance sheet

		2025	2024	2023	2022	2021
Net cash provided by operating activities	EUR m	966.7	906.6	1,663.9	956.7	388.6
Investments in non-current assets (CapEx)	EUR m	- 293.0	- 342.2	- 321.1	- 267.2	- 199.3
Free cash flow ¹⁾	EUR m	940.8	892.6	1,712.0	1,005.1	439.5

5.11 Consolidated cash flow

		Dec. 31, 2025	Dec. 31, 2024	Dec. 31, 2023	Dec. 31, 2022	Dec. 31, 2021
Share price	EUR	49.56	57.88	83.22	59.72	79.58
Number of shares (unweighted)		144,385,372	144,385,372	147,453,837	154,500,000	154,500,000
Market capitalization	EUR m	7,156	8,357	12,271	9,227	12,295
Free float	%	80.00	85.00	89.52	100.00	100.00

5.12 Key data on Brenntag shares

¹⁾ Calculation based on operating EBITDA.

Financial calendar 2026

May 13

2026

Q1 Interim Statement
2026

May 20

2026

Annual General Meeting
2026

August 12

2026

Half-Year Financial Report
2026

November 11

2026

9M Interim Statement
2026

The financial calendar is updated regularly. The latest dates can be found on our website at www.brenntag.com/financial_calendar

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Information on the Annual Report

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Information on rounding

Due to commercial rounding, minor differences may occur when using rounded amounts or rounded percentages.

Disclaimer

This report may contain forward-looking statements based on current assumptions and forecasts made by the management of Brenntag SE and other information currently available to the company. Various known and unknown risks, uncertainties and other factors could lead to material differences between the actual future results, financial situation, development or performance of the company and the estimates given here. Brenntag SE does not intend, and does not assume any liability whatsoever, to update these forward-looking statements or to adapt them in line with future events or developments.